PHILIPPINE ARMY MANUAL 3-0101-04

INFANTRY COMPANY OPERATIONS

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Preface

1. This manual provides doctrinal guidance on how infantry rifle companies should fight in line with the operational concepts of the full spectrum operations and land domination doctrine. It also establishes doctrine in planning, coordinating, and executing the conduct of such operations.

2. It also explains the universall-accepted tactics, techniques, procedures, experiences, and best practices that can be applied in all levels of conflict.

3. The proponent of this manual is the Maneuver Center, TRADOC, PA. However, Doctrine and Capability Integration Center is responsible for the review and updating of this publication. Send comments or recommendations to the Commander, TRADOC, PA, Camp O'Donnell, Capas, Tarlac (Attn: Director, DACIC).

4. The following references were used in this publication:

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5. All publications, manuals and directives inconsistent with this manual are hereby rescinded.

6. Unless this publication states otherwise, masculine nouns and pronouns do not refer exclusively to men.

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Chapter I
The Infantry Rifle Company

0101. The infantry rifle company is the infantry battalion's close combat maneuver force. It is a lightly-equipped and foot-mobile unit that can be deployed rapidly. It has austere maneuver support and relies more on professionally trained and disciplined soldiers under superb leadership. All its weapons are man-portable and require minimal support.

0102. The infantry rifle company, depending on the operational environment, can execute offensive, defensive operations, and support to civil governance operations to re-establish a safe and secure environment and prevent the situation from deteriorating. Hence, the infantry rifle company must be trained, equipped, controlled, and managed so that it dominates its operational environment to ensure success within the Philippine territory.

0103. The fundamental considerations for employing infantry company are dependent on its organizational structure, equipment, and capabilities. Its capability and effectiveness is entirely the result of the unit's training, leadership, morale and the collective skills and strengths of its personnel.

Mission, Organization, Capabilities and Limitations

Mission

0104. The fundamental mission of the infantry rifle company is to close with the enemy by means of fire and maneuver to destroy or capture him or repel his assault by fire, close combat, and counterattack. It also provides support to civil governance operations. It normally operates as part of larger unit to seize, retain, and exploit the initiative in order to create opportunities and achieve decisive results. The flexibility of the infantry rifle company is suited for full-spectrum operations.

Organization

0105. The infantry rifle company consists of a headquarters platoon and three rifle platoons (Figure 1.1).

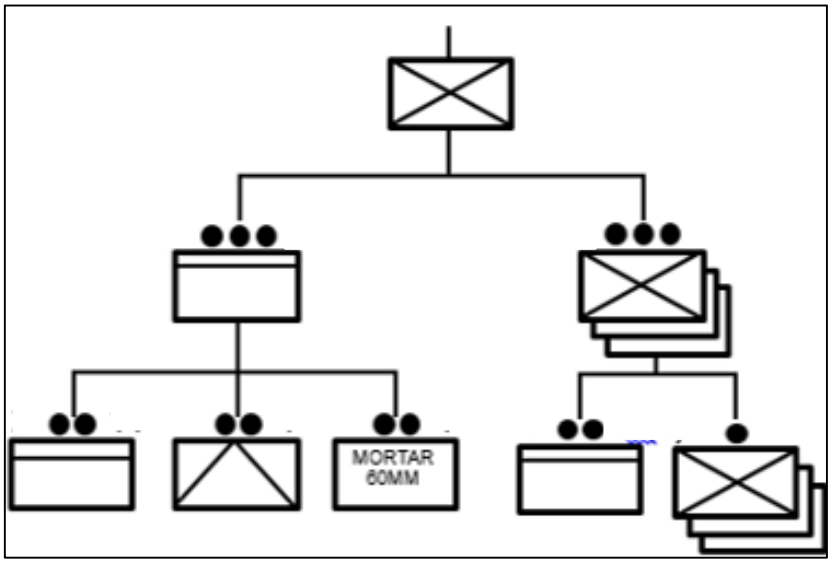


Figure 1.1-The infantry rifle company organization

a. **The Headquarters Platoon**. The headquarters platoon is composed of the command section, anti-armor section and mortar section. The company commander and his staff compose the command section. This section provides command and control of tactical operations and coordinates re-supply and evacuation of wounded personnel and equipment. It can also provide limited repair of organic equipment. The anti-armor section has two man-portable, medium anti-tank weapons (MAW) or medium multi-purpose assault weapons. This section can provide medium-range anti-armor fire support to the company and can also fight as infantry. The multi-purpose assault weapon can also be armed with anti-personnel or other types of ammunition. The mortar section has two 60mm lightweight mortars which are also man-portable. It provides immediate indirect fire support to the company, as shown below.

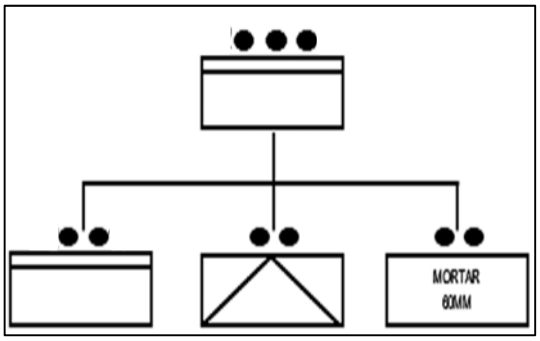


Figure 1.2 - the headquarters platoon organization

b. **The Infantry Rifle Platoon**. The rifle platoon consists of a platoon headquarters and three rifle squads. Within the platoon headquarters are the platoon leader, platoon sergeant, radio operator, light multi-purpose assault weapon gunner, ammo bearer, and four machine gun crews. It has two general purpose machine guns (GPMG) or light machine guns (LMG) operated by a crew of two (machine gunner and assistant machine gunner). These GPMGs provide sustained fire at longer ranges and with better penetration than any of

the platoon's weapons. One medical aid-man (medic) from the medical platoon of the battalion is attached to each rifle platoon. In addition to its primary function, a platoon is trained to conduct peace and development activities and disaster relief operations.

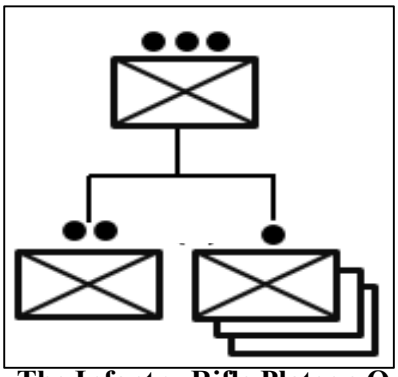


Figure 1.3 - The Infantry Rifle Platoon Organization

0106. **The Infantry Rifle Squad.** The rifle platoon has three rifle squads. Each squad has nine men each. The nine-man composition of the squad is ideal and affords flexibility and effectiveness. It can still operate even if 20% of its strength is ineffective. The rifle squad is broken down into two fire teams. Each fire team has four men composed of a team leader, grenadier, automatic rifleman who can be armed with a squad automatic weapon and rifleman who serves as combat life saver (CLS). Each squad has two 40mm grenade launchers (GL) which are attached to the assault rifle, and two squad automatic weapons (SAW). The SAW provides sustained automatic fire for the squad. It is light enough to be operated by one man moving with the rest of the squad in assault. Its range, penetration and sustained rate of fire are lesser than that of the platoon GPMG. The rest of the squad is armed with individual assault rifles. Moreover, each squad has a Squad Designated Marksman (SDM). The designated marksman is an individual with additional training in the fundamentals of marksmanship and observation. He is equipped with an optic mounted on his rifle. He delivers precision fires on positively identified threats. He can also be tasked to gather intelligence report through long range observation. The SDM is a rifleman within the rifle squad. He is not in a special organized unit nor is he an additional person on the table of organization of a company.

Table 1.1 - Squad organization and individual weapons

Unit	Members	Weapon
	Squad Leader	Assault Rifle
Fire Team A	Team Leader 1	Assault Rifle
	AutomaticRifleman	SAW
	Grenadier	Assault Rifle with 40mm GL
	Rifleman/ Squad Designated Marksman	Designated Marksman's Rifle (Accurized Rifle With scope)
Fire Team B	Team Leader 2	Assault Rifle
	Automatic Rifleman	SAW
	Grenadier	Assault Rifle with 40mm GL
	Rifleman	Assault Rifle

a. **Mission of the Squad Designated Marksman (SDM).** The mission of a designated marksman is to provide accurate fires for the infantry squad up to 500m. He is equipped with accurized assault rifle fitted with a rifle scope while a sniper is equipped with a customized Sniper Rifle with match-grade barrels, tactical scopes, fined-tuned trigger system and durable stock system.

b. **Selection.** The company commander or his platoon leaders must take special consideration in selecting the SDM. The SDM must have a solid marksmanship performance, and clear understanding of the fundamentals. He should have the basic character traits needed by an SDM such perseverance, initiative, and stability under pressure. (SP3-0039).

Capabilities

0107. The infantry rifle company is capable of:

a. Providing a base of fire and maneuver.

b. Closing with the enemy to destroy or capture him.

c. Repelling enemy assault by fire, close combat, and counterattack.

d. Seizing and holding terrain.

e. Maneuvering in all types of local weather and terrain.

f. Providing medium and light anti-tank protection.

g. Conducting combat operations under limited visibility.

h. Participating in air assault operations.

i. Participating in amphibious/waterborne operations.

j. Operating in conjunction with heavy forces.

k. Conducting Civil Military Operations.

l. Conducting limited Disaster Risk Operations.

Limitations

0108. The infantry rifle company is not as mobile as mounted forces in terrain favorable to vehicular movement. Against a heavy enemy, it may not have sufficient density of artillery or anti-armor weapons to sustain a high volume of fire for a prolonged period. It is vulnerable to all types of fire, including close air support (CAS), once observed by the enemy. Moreover, the infantry rifle company has limitations in terms of CMO capabilities.

Duties and Responsibilities of Key Personnel

0109. The company must accomplish different tactical, administrative, and logistical tasks. To accomplish such, the duties and responsibilities of key personnel must be defined, coordinated, and understood.

Company commander

0110. The company commander's principal duties include the key areas of tactical employment, training, administration, personnel management, maintenance, force protection, and sustainment of his company. He must also know the capabilities of the enemy. Furthermore, the CO:

a. Commands and controls through his subordinate leaders.

b. Employs his company to accomplish its mission according to the battalion and brigade commander's intent and concept. He requests additional support from battalion when required.

c. Selects the best location to maneuver the platoons and other elements.

d. Conducts mission analysis and troop-leading procedures (TLP) and issues operation orders for company tactical operations.

e. Maintains and expresses situational awareness and understanding.

f. Sustains the platoons and other elements and requests battalion support when needed.

g. Ensures that the company command post (CP) effectively battle tracks the situation and status.

h. Provides a timely and accurate tactical picture to the battalion commander and subordinate units.

i. Implements effective measures for force protection, security, and accountability of forces and systems.

j. Develops the leadership and tactical skill of his platoon leaders.

Executive Officer

0111. The Executive Officer (XO) is the second in command and assumes command of the company as required. His primary role is to assist the commander in mission planning and accomplishment. He also ensures that tactical reports from the platoons are forwarded to the battalion tactical operations center (TOC). Furthermore, the XO:

a. Plans and supervises, along with the First Sergeant (F/Sgt), the company's sustainment operations and ensures that pre-combat inspections are complete.

The XO plans and coordinates logistical support with agencies outside the company while the F/Sgt does the same internally. He prepares or aids in preparing paragraph 4 of the company operation order (OPORD). He may also help the company commander plan the mission.

b. Coordinates with higher, adjacent, and supporting units. He may aid in control of critical events of the battle such as a passage of lines, bridging a gap, or breaching an obstacle or, he may assume control of a platoon attached to the company during movement.

c. Performs as Landing Zone or Pickup Zone Control Officer. This may include straggler control, casualty evacuation, resupply operations, or air-ground liaison.

d. Leads quartering party or detachment. The XO may lead a quartering party, an element consisting of representatives of various company elements. Their purpose is to precede the company and reconnoiter, secure, and mark an assembly area. The XO may lead a detachment with other tactical tasks including shaping or sustaining in a company raid or attack and controlling company machine guns, or mortar section. He may also lead the reserve and the detachment left in contact during a withdrawal, control attachments to the company, and serve as movement control officer.

Platoon Leader

0112. He is responsible for the employment, training, administration, and logistics of the platoon. He is knowledgeable on all weapon systems of the platoon, including those that may be attached to the platoon, and is competent of their employment.

First Sergeant

0113. The F/Sgt is the commander's primary tactical advisor, the senior non-commissioned officer (NCO) and normally the most experienced soldier in the company. He operates where the commander directs or where he can best influence a critical point or what is viewed as the unit's decisive point. Moreover, he:

a. Executes and supervises routine operations. This can include enforcing the tactical standing operating procedures (SOP), planning and coordinating both training and full-spectrum operations, and administering replacement operations, logistics, maintenance, communications, field hygiene, and casualty evacuation operations.

b. Supervises, inspects, and influences matters designated by the commander as well as areas that depend on his expertise such as soldier care, force protection, security, and accountability.

c. Assists and coordinates with the XO and keeps him prepared to assume the CO's duties, if needed.

d. Leads task-organized elements or sub-units for the company's shaping effort or

other designated missions.

Platoon Sergeant

0114. The Platoon Sergeant provides advice to the platoon leader and leads the platoon during his absence. He supervises the administration, logistics, and maintenance requirements of the platoon.

Communications Sergeant/Senior Radio Operator

0115. He supervises operations, maintenance, and installation of organic radio communications and wire, if available. This includes sending and receiving routine traffic and making required communication checks.

Radio Operator

0116. The radio operator uses and performs maintenance on his assigned radio.

Supply Sergeant

0117. The supply sergeant requests, receives, issues, stores, maintains, and turns- in supplies and equipment for the company. He coordinates requirements with the F/Sgt and the battalion S4. Specifically, he:

a. Controls the vehicle and driver that are provided to the company.

b. Monitors tactical situation.

c. Anticipates logistical requirements.

d. If located in the infantry battalion support area, the supply sergeant may ask assistance from the headquarters and headquarters company(HHC) commander

Armorer

0118. The armorer is a supply specialist whose duties focus on organizational maintenance and repair of the company's small arms weapons.

Anti-armor Section Leader

0119. He is responsible for employing the anti-armor section. Also, he must:

a. Provide anti-armor support to the company during defensive and offensive operations, to include assisting the CO in planning the section’s employment, reconnoitering tentative firing positions, and controlling anti-armor fires.

b. Plan and lead reconnaissance, security, and combat patrol operations.

Mortar Section Leader

0120. The mortar section leader may act and perform the tasks and responsibilities of the Fire Support Officer on orders. He is responsible for employing the mortar section and ensures effective mortar support for the company. Specifically, he:

a. Helps the company commanderplan the employment of the mortar section.

b. Coordinates with the FSO and Fire Support Team (FIST).

c. Controls the section during tactical operations.

Operations NCO

0121. The Operations NCO assists the company commander in all matters concerning training and operations. He asks the commander and assists him in supervising the company training program. He prepares and supervises the execution of training within the company. He provides assistance to the company commander by maintaining company readiness and integrating fire support in all operations. He assists the company in planning troop movement, including route selection, priority of movement, training providing of security, bivouacking, quartering, staging and preparing of movement order. He recommends priorities for allocating critical command resource.

Intelligence NCO

0122. The Intelligence NCO's primary responsibility is to assist the company commander in matters pertaining to combat intelligence for counter-intelligence matters and for intelligence training. He provides aid to the company commander in the execution of intelligence mission in coordination with the intelligence platoon and other intelligence units. He helps the company commander in planning the activities to the attached intelligence units and ensures that information and intelligence are disseminated expeditiously to higher and subordinate units. He assists the company commander in liaising with higher intelligence units and supports him in recommending and supervising operational security (OPSEC) design to deny information to the enemy.

Personnel NCO

0123. The Personnel NCO provides assistance to the company commander by helping him prepare and maintain current personnel estimate of the situation. He is responsible for coordinating personnel and administrative services and performs casualty operations in coordination with the company XO. He accesses current and projected strength to maintain the readiness posture and maintains a personnel information database. He facilitates and recommends to Bn personnel officer awards of the deserving personnel.

Finance NCO

0124. The Finance NCO is responsible for coordinating and providing financial services to the company. He facilitates the disbursement of funds and claims for any

payment in coordination with higher headquarters. He coordinates with Bn S4 financial support of battle field procurement.

CMO NCO

0125. The CMO NCO assists the company commander on all civil-military operations including the civilian impact on military operations and the impact of the military operations on the civilian populace. He advises the company commander on his legal and moral obligations concerning the impact of military operations on local populace (economic, environmental and health).

Mess NCO

0126. The Mess NCO is responsible for the operations of company mess. He supervises the cook's helper in the preparation, cooking and serving of food.

Army Power

0127. Army power is done efficiently through the use of combined arms and effectively enhanced by leadership and information. It consists of eight warfighting functions which can also be considered as the summation of the potency that a total army force produces. The warfighting functions are synchronized and integrated in performing efficient and effective offensive, defensive, and support to civil governance tasks.



Figure 1.5 - The Elements of Army Power (PAM 3-00, 2014)

0128. The elements of army power are utilized by the infantry company to attain successful offensive, defensive, and support to civil governance operations. The elements of army power incorporate the eight (8) warfighting functions. These are linked to leadership and enhanced by information. If applied successfully by the company commander, it will lead to mission accomplishment.

Leadership

0129. Leadership is the least tangible and most dynamic element of warfighting functions. It is the multiplying and unifying element of the infantry rifle company. The right leadership gives purpose, direction, and motivation in combat. Effective leadership can compensate for the deficiencies in all the warfighting functions.

0130. Military leadership is the process of influencing people by providing purpose, direction, and motivation, while operating to accomplish the mission and improving organization. Leaders must know their profession, their soldiers, and the tools for combat. They instill to soldiers the will to win. Army doctrine describes essential leadership attributes (character, presence, and intelligence) and competencies (lead, develop, and achieve). These attributes and competencies mature through lifelong learning.

0131. Leaders influence not only soldiers but other people as well. Leadership is crucial in dealing with civilians in any conflict or disaster. Company commanders work with the members of other services and civilian organizations. Face-to-face contact with people in the area of operations encourages cooperation between civilians and soldiers. This requires self-aware and adaptive leaders who can both defeat an enemy in combat and master the complexities of operational environment

Information

0132. Company commanders use information to understand, visualize, describe, and direct the warfighting functions. It is a weapon against enemy command and control and is a means to affect enemy morale.

0133. Information is also critical to operations in support to civil governance where the populace is a major factor to success. Hence, infantry company must improve the information system to further enhance the warfighting functions. Ultimately, this creates opportunities to achieve decisive results.

0134. Combined arms operations multiply the effectiveness and efficiency of the different army capabilities in any military operations. It also merges leadership, information, and each of the warfighting functions and their support systems more effectively.

Warfighting Functions

0135. A warfighting function is a group of tasks and systems (people, organization, information, and processes) united by a common purpose. Hence, the combination of the tasks under this function joined with leadership and enhanced by information are the foundations of the elements of Army Power. This incorporates eight (8) functions, namely; movement and maneuver, intelligence, fires, civil-military operations, information operation, sustainment, command and control, and protection.

0136. The warfighting functions are what commanders use to accomplish missions and training objectives. These functions are incorporated in performing efficient and

effective offensive, defensive, and support to civil governance tasks.

0137. The infantry company performs the movement and maneuver warfighting functions of a battalion, brigade, division, or a joint force. The company is the cutting edge force that achieves the position of advantage in relation to the enemy's dynamic forces.

0138. The advantage in position is made possible by simultaneously combining the company's capabilities, organic direct and indirect fire assets, indirect fire support from the battalion, and other combat support units during its manuever. The company commander mass the effects of army power to achieve surprise, shock, and momentum.

Movement and Maneuver

0139. Maneuver is the means by which commanders mass the effects of combat power to achieve surprise, shock, momentum, and dominance. Movement is necessary to assure the protection, dispersion and displacement of the force as a whole. Movement and maneuver moves forces to achieve a position of advantage in relation to the enemy. It includes tasks associated with projecting, protecting and employing forces.

0140. Company's role in support of movement may be in the form of convoy security for other mobile forces. At company level, movement and maneuver may overlap particularly during movement to contact.

Intelligence

0141. Intelligence is the related tasks and systems that facilitate force generation by understanding the enemy, terrain, weather, and civil considerations. The ultimate weapon of company commander is his understanding of the enemy's strengths and weaknesses through reconnaissance and combat patrols by small units in the suspected locations of the enemy.

0142. The company' intelligence capabilities would include pinpointing the enemy's location, encampment, plan, and course of action. This information is then reported directly to the company commander.

0143. Through combat intelligence, the infantry company provides intelligence support to the infantry battalion, brigade and higher units. The company is capable of employing Observation Posts (OP) and sending out patrols for its intelligence as well as relying on higher headquarters (scout platoon and intel platoon of the battalion).

Fires

0144. The company integrates fire support in all its operatisons. It includes lethal and non-lethal fires. Non-lethal fires are used to deter hostile forces and serve as a psychological display of the company's fire capabilities to deter the enemy and distract them from attacking the company HQs.

0145. The primary fire support system for the rifle company is its organic 60mm mortar section. It can also ask for fire support from the 81mm mortar platoon of the

battalion. These assets provide its maneuver platoons with indirect fire support. The commander must know the capabilities and limitations of these assets and integrate their fires in every operation. The fire support plan must be form part of OPORD and be responsive to the requirements of the concept of operations (CONOPS).

0146. In some instances, the company will be provided with field artillery support. In this case, the company will be normally attached with a Fire Support Team (FIST). The battalion FSO, in charge of the FIST, assists the company commander with the indirect fire support planning and execution. The forward observer (FO) with each platoon also plan and coordinate fire support, locate targets, request and adjust fires to support the CONOPS.

Civil Military Operations

0147. CMO are planned activities undertaken independently or in coordination with civilian entities to gain popular support and weaken the will of the enemy to fight. Infantry units, during CMO, must often perform non-standard tasks during national and local emergencies as part of the battalion and limited disaster response operations (DRO). Civil support operations are conducted in the form of limited DRO during calamities.

Information Operations

0148. Information superiority can be achieved through the integration of intelligence, surveillance, reconnaissance (ISR), information management (IM), and information operations (IO) related activities. This must be attained in order to achieve successful information operations. Information operations are done effectively to gain understanding and superiority over the enemy. Through this, enemy perceptions, attitudes, decisions, and actions can be exploited. This can be achieved when the CO synchronizes information operations as intensely as they do in fires and maneuver.

0149. Through this, the company can utilize military and non-military capabilities to see first, understand first, and act first to favorably affect the target audience. Information operations perform three (3) basic functions:

a. Inform the people.

b. Attack the enemy.

c. Protect own troops by strict observations of operational security and strengthen the military camps and patrol bases, and the organization.

0150. For every military action, the unit must immediately explain the purpose to the people affected by the operations without violating operational security. This is in order to offer transparency and avoid misinformation which can affect popular support.

Sustainment

0151. The sustainment warfighting function is the related tasks and systems that provide support and services to ensure freedom of action, extend operational reach, and

prolong endurance. It includes tasks associated with: maintenance, transportation, supply, and field services. Sustainment allows uninterrupted operations through adequate and continuous logistical support such as supply systems, maintenance, and other services.

0152. The company has a limited sustainment support structure. Sustainment in combat is one of the greatest challenges of the company commander. He must be highly innovative and resourceful in the conduct of resupply operations and in carrying out casualty treatment and evacuation. The XO, F/Sgt, and supply sergeant are key players in the company's sustainment. (see Chapter 9 for the detailed discussion).

Command and Control

0153. The C2 warfighting function includes the tasks of acquiring friendly information, managing relevant information, and directing and leading subordinates. C2 has two parts: the commander and the command and control (C2) system. Information systems, including communications systems, intelligence-support systems, and computer networks support the command and control system. The C2 ensures that the employment of company is in accordance, guidance and orders from the battalion.

Protection

0154. Protection is the related tasks and systems that preserve the force so the commander can apply maximum combat power. Preserving the force includes protecting physical assets, information, and civilian informants. It facilitates the commander’s ability to maintain the force’s integrity and the company’s combat power. It determines the degree to which potential threats can disrupt operations and deter or mitigate those threats. Emphasis on protection increases during preparation and continues throughout execution. It is a continuous activity which integrates all protection capabilities to safeguard bases, secure routes, and protect forces.

Chapter II
Mission Command – Command and Control in Full Spectrum Operations

Introduction

0201. The battle command is the art and science of understanding, visualizing, describing, directing, leading, and assessing forces to impose the commander's will on a hostile, thinking, and adaptive enemy.

0202. In execution, the battle command is used by the company commander or the subordinate leader to make decisions when facing unforeseen opportunities or countering threats.

0203. The C2 system requires being reliable, responsive, and durable within a company. Personnel, procedures, equipment and facilities are essential to plan, prepare, execute, and assess operations. These skills, when developed, give the commander visualization of the operations and concept of the operation, which enables him to direct the actions of subordinates' intent.

0204. The company is also likely to be engaged in helping a suffering civilian population by having joint efforts in support to civil governance operations when instructed by higher headquarters. Unity of effort requires, as a minimum, common understanding of purpose and direction of all participants.

0205. Success in battle will require a combination of command and control. The proper mix of command and control is determined by the situation, but commanders must emphasize command and reduce control measures that restrict their subordinate's freedom of action.

a. **Command**. This is the process that instills the commander's will among his subordinates. It provides focus and direction to the company. The commander's leadership is an integral part of command.

b. **Control**. As the counterpart of command, follows up decisions and minimizes deviation from the commander's concept. Control provides supervisions to the operation while synchronizing all systems and activities. Control is the science of defining limits, computing requirements, allocating resources, monitoring performance, and directing subordinate action to accomplish the commander's intent.

c. **Synchronization**. Commanders must avoid too much control of units just to achieve synchronization. This tends to slow down execution and limit subordinates' initiative. A clear understanding of the commander's concept is the key to maintaining synchronization.

Battle Command Concepts

0206. In company battles, the enemy can be thinking and adaptive, hence the company commander's estimate is important in assessing the enemy's actions and course of future operations. However, its prediction is limited. In this concept, battle command and mission command are the two (2) key concepts for exercising C2 in operation. In this sense, CO's identify important information requirements and focuses his company staff on accomplishing those requirements based on the information gathered. This can be done by CO's combining analytic and intuitive approaches to decision-making to exercise battle command continuously.

0207. **Battle Command**. This describes the role of the CO in understanding, visualizing, describing, directing, leading, and assessing forces as part of the operations process. Such role is intended to address an adaptive, thinking, and hostile enemy. This synchronizes the forces and warfighting functions in time, space and purpose to accomplish mission by translating decisions into actions of company commanders. The figure below illustrates the operations process:

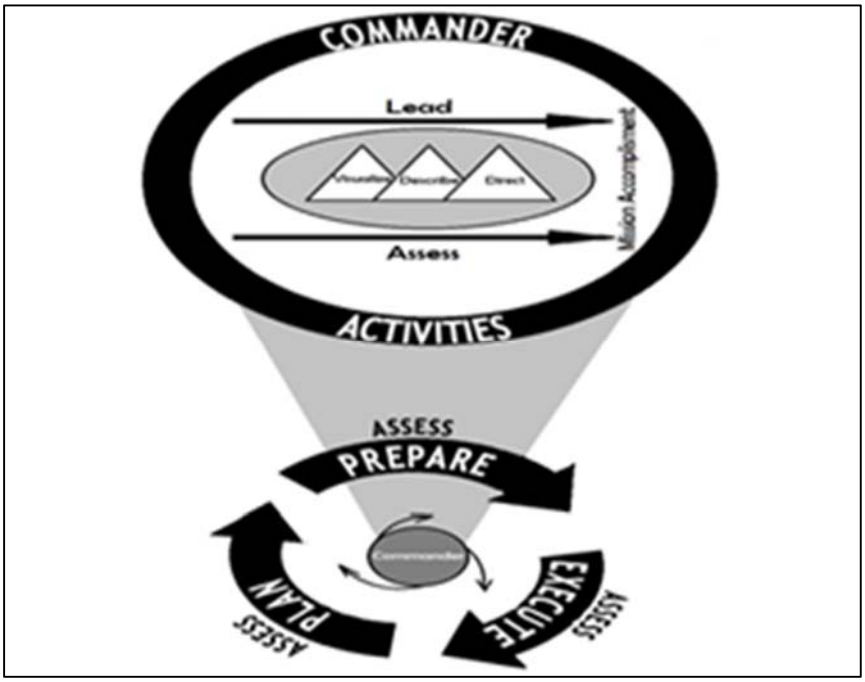


Figure 2.1 - The Operations Process

0208. **Mission Command.** This refers to the CO's centralized planning and decentralized executions of conducting military operations based on mission orders which can also be delegated to a subordinate. Emphasis is placed on clearly identifying the subordinates' tasks necessary to achieve the desired end state understanding, the higher commander's intent, and CO's timely decision-making. Moreover, this is guided by the company's operational process such as the principles below:

a. The company's framework for exercising mission command is the operations process. The major mission command activities performed during operations include: planning, preparing, executing, and continuously assessing the

operation. Commanders use the operations process to drive the conceptual and detailed planning necessary to understand, visualize, and describe their operational environment, make and articulate decisions, and direct, lead, and assess military operations.

b. The activities of the operations process are not discrete; they overlap and recur as circumstances demand. Planning starts an iteration of the operations process. Upon completion of the initial order, planning continues as leaders revise the plan based on changing circumstances. Preparing begins during planning and continues through execution. Execution puts a plan into action by applying combat power to seize, retain, and exploit the initiative to gain a position of relative advantage. Assessing is continuous and influences the other three activities.

c. The commander's role is to drive the operations process through the activities of understanding, visualizing, describing, directing, leading, and assessing operations.

0209. **Commander's Leadership**. Leadership is the critical element of both combat power and the command and control system. Through leadership, the commander causes his unit to complete demanding tasks in difficult situations. Commanders must understand the military leadership in philosophy. In addition, the following factors are the keys to the company commander's ability to lead his company on the battlefield:

a. **Will.** Often the victor in battle is the unit that refuses to lose. Competency, toughness and realistic training are the keys to developing this determination. The CO must develop a "will to win" in his soldiers and his unit.

b. **Trust.** The CO must earn the trust of his soldiers. They must have confidence in his abilities. The CO also must trust his soldiers and develop a climate that allows subordinates to make decisions.

c. **Delegation.** After ensuring his subordinates are well trained, the CO must delegate the proper authority and freedom to his men. The CO focuses his time and energy on what he determines as critical and delegates the remainder to his subordinates.

d. **Discipline.** The CO instills discipline in his soldiers. Discipline ensures that proper standards are maintained in the absence of leader supervision. The decentralized operations conducted by the company require self-discipline of every soldier in the company.

0210. **Mission-Oriented Command and Control.** Mission-oriented command and control is the Army's doctrinal approach to C2 in the battlefield. It is a method of directing military operations that encourages and expects subordinates to take action consistent with the intent and concept of higher headquarters. The following principles provide fundamentals for C2:

a. **Expect Uncertainty**. The commander must understand the environment of combat. The battle will be dynamic and non-linear. Communications will be degraded and the chaos of battle will often prevent the commander from

knowing what is happening beyond his own senses. The situation during planning will always change before execution.

b. **Reduce Leader Intervention.** Plan and direct operations to require the absolute minimum intervention during execution. When soldiers expect the leader to make the decision or initiate the action, they are reluctant to take action. When precise control is required for synchronization, such as an on-order task, the leader should also provide the subordinate the criteria for making the decision. Leaders must realize that some loss of precision is better than inactivity.

c. **Increase Subordinate Planning Time.** The commander ensures the effective use of all available planning time. Although the majority of the planning takes place at the battalion and company level, the infantry rifle platoons and squads require extra time to conduct their rehearsals and inspections. A unit SOP is a key tool for using time well.

d. **Give Subordinates Maximum Freedom of Action.** Given the expected battlefield conditions, leaders at every level avoid placing unnecessary limits on their soldiers' freedom of action. The leader at the point of decision must have the knowledge, the training, and the freedom to make the correct decision that supports the commander's intent.

e. **Commanders Lead Well Forward.** The CO locates where he can best fight and command his unit, and he considers a number of factors in determining this location. His leadership is most effective face-to-face when he can see the situation and his soldiers can see him. Since he cannot be everywhere, he focuses on the decisive action that will accomplish his mission. He normally locates with his main effort (the subordinate unit assigned the decisive action) to provide his leadership and to be in a position to shift or re-task the main effort.

0211. **Commander's Intent**. The commander's intent continuously evolves throughout the planning and preparation for the operations. It is a clear, concise statement of what the force initiative and judgments must do in the face of new opportunities, or whenever the concept of operation ceases to apply to succeed with respect to the enemy, terrain and desired end state.

0212. The relationship between the battalion commander's intent for the company, the company's role in his concept, the designation of the main effort, and the company's role in his concept and assignment of his subordinate's intent is the focus of mission orders. It must be clearly understood by all means of communication: written, face-to-face, or spoken via radio or telephone line. The following are the concepts to be considered:

a. **Commander's Intent.** It is defined as the result the commander expects the unit to accomplish in a specific operation. At the lowest tactical level (company and below), intent is normally the purpose from the mission statement. As such, the battalion commander assigns it when he determines the company's mission statement. This mission statement consists of the mission's essential tasks to be accomplished and the purpose (result) it achieves.

b. **Commander's Concept.** The commander determines the mission of the company as soon as the battalion commander develops his concept. He first determines the purpose the company must achieve and then assigns the task(s) that will achieve that purpose. During the fight, if the assigned task will not receive the purpose, the CO is expected to re-task the company to achieve it.

c. **Concept Development.** To accomplish the assigned mission, the CO assigns missions to his platoons and sections just as how the battalion commander assigns company missions and designates his main effort. He ensures that his concept fits within the battalion commander's concept. This will result in a unity of effort that supports a decentralized execution. At each level, the commander is given his mission by his superior, develops a concept to accomplish the mission, organizes his unit to fight the concept and assigns subordinate responsibilities. The vehicle for providing information is the OPORD.

d. **Main Effort.** The main effort is the focus of the company's mission with all other units in support to the quick success of its purpose. Success by the main effort shall result in the accomplishment of the commander's mission. When considering independent action, each leader makes his decision based on his relationship to the main effort.

0213. **Mission Orders**. Mission orders focus on what tasks must be accomplished without specifying how they will be done. Whenever possible, they are oral orders issued face-to-face on the group when the fight will take place.

0214. Mission orders require well-trained subordinates who understand their commander's intent and concepts (two levels higher). Mission orders address only the required information. It avoids unnecessary detail and redundancy and does not restate doctrine or SOP's.

0215. The commander determines exactly what he wants his platoons to accomplish and clearly communicates these requirements to them. If one of his leaders has not earned his trust or has not displayed the tactical competence to operate with a mission order, then the order must be tailored, based on the training, experience, and capability of the leader receiving the order.

a. This may include nothing more than providing additional instructions, establishing more restrictive control measures, or directing a specific use for one of his organic assets.

b. Or in an unusual situation, the CO may detail exactly how the platoon leader will employ his entire platoon, clearly state the limits for using his initiative, and co-locate himself or the XO with this platoon. This should be only a short-term solution. Leaders must be trained to meet their responsibilities.

Command and Control Process

0216. The company commander uses the C2 process to figure out what is going on, decide what to do about it, tell soldiers what to do, and then keep track of how well his soldiers are doing. The C2 process utilizes the troop-leading procedure (TLP) as its

main tool. This procedure provides a common framework for all echelons of command to apply the C2 process. Part of the TLP is two tools that complement the troop-leading process – the estimate of the situation and the METT-TC analysis. The relationship of these tools is depicted in Figure 2.2 below.

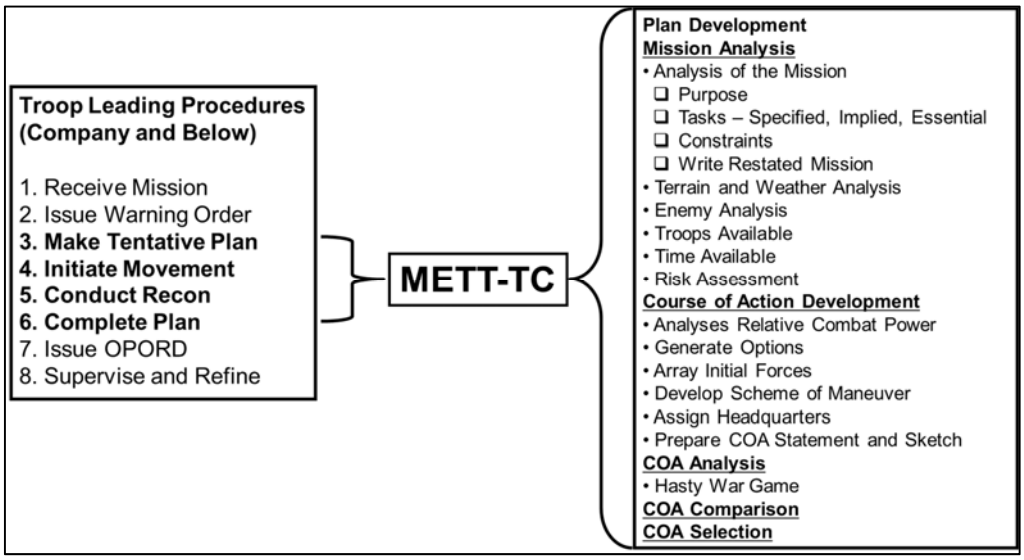


Figure 2.2 - Troop-Leading Process (Planning at Company and Below)

Troop-Leading Procedures

0217. Troop-Leading Procedure (TLP) is a dynamic process used by small unit leaders to analyze a mission, develop a plan, and prepare for an operation. These procedures enable leaders to maximize available planning time while developing effective plans and adequately preparing the company for an operation. The sequence of the TLP steps is not rigid. They are modified to meet the mission, situation, and available time. Some steps are done concurrently while others may go on continuously throughout the operations. The paragraphs below explain the steps (See Annex for detailed discussion of the TLP):

a. **Receive Mission**. It may begin with the initial warning order (WARNO) from higher headquarters or when a leader receives an OPORD.

b. **Issue Warning Order**. The WARNO contains as much detail as possible. It informs subordinates of the unit mission and gives them the leader's time line.

c. **Make Tentative Plan**. Once they have issued the initial WARNO, leaders develop tentative plan. Often, leaders perform them mentally. They may include their principal subordinates—especially during COA development, analysis, and comparison. However, Army leaders, not their subordinates, select the COA on which to base the tentative plan.

d. **Initiate Movement**. The estimate of the situation process is done in every tactical decision. This is the Army's decision-making process which helps the leader determine his mission, understand his situation, and select the best course of action.

e. **Conduct Reconnaisance**. Reconnaissance is a continuous activity during TLP. A thorough tentative plan can provide specific R&S guidance that can be given to subordinate units.

f. **Complete Plan**. During this step, the company commander incorporates the result of reconnaissance into their selected COA to complete the plan or order. This includes preparing overlays, refining the indirect fire target list, coordinating combat service support and command and control requirements, and updating the tentative plan as a result of the reconnaissance.

g. **Issue OPORD**. Small unit orders are normally issued verbally and supplemented by graphics and other control measures. The order follows the standard five-paragraph OPORD format.

h. **Supervise and Refine**. This final step of the TLP is crucial. Throughout TLP, leaders monitor mission preparations, refine the plan, perform coordination with adjacent units, and supervise and assess preparations.

Chapter III
Company Movement

0301. Moving units in the battlefield and preparing them for contact is the main purpose of tactical movement which includes various techniques and formations. Due to the different capabilities of the company, the commander must consider the unique advantages and disadvantages of these techniques. None of the movement techniques or formations described in this section should be considered inflexible or immutable. The company commander must be prepared to adapt them to the situation at hand as some movement techniques can be slower but more secure while others are faster but less secure.

Fundamentals

0302. The CO's estimate of the situation assists him in deciding how to most effectively move his unit. There is no set of method for this. The following fundamentals provide guidance for planning effective company movement:

a. **Do not confuse movement with maneuver.** Movement at the company level that is supported by fire to gain a position of advantage over the enemy is called maneuver. Tactical movement is movement in preparation for contact and maneuver is movement while in contact. However, there can be a considerable overlap between the two.

b. **Conduct reconnaissance**. Reconnoiter is done by all echelons by knowing the enemy situation and the available planning time of the unit's reconnaissance, and leaders at every level seek information about the terrain and enemy. Sending a reconnaissance element forward of the lead platoon is an effective technique to reconnoiter, if sufficient information is still lacking.

c. **Effectively use the terrain and weather.** There must be a plan to avoid identified danger areas. This can be done by company moving on covered and concealed routes.

d. **Move as squads and platoons.**The advantages to moving the company by squads and platoons include: 1) Faster movement. 2) Better security. A small unit is less likely to be detected because it requires less cover and concealment. 3) More dispersion. The dispersion gained by moving the company by squads and platoons makes it more difficult for the enemy to concentrate his fires against the company, especially indirect fires, CAS, and chemical agents. Subordinate units also gain room to maneuver. 4) Better operations security (OPSEC). It is harder for the enemy to determine what the friendly force is doing with only isolated squad-size spot reports.

e. **Maintain security during movement.**Security is critical during movement. In addition, the company commander achieves security for the company by applying the following: 1) Use the appropriate movement formation and technique for the conditions. 2) Move as fast as the situation allows. This may

degrade the enemy's ability to detect the unit and the effectiveness of his fires once he detects it. 3) Ensure that subordinate units correctly position security elements to the flanks, front, and rear at a distance that prevents enemy direct fire on the main body. (Normally, the company formation and movement technique provides greater security to the front; it is the flanks and rear that must be secured by these security elements. The company SOP should state who is responsible for providing these security elements. 4) Enforce noise and light discipline (especially when dismounted). 5) Enforce camouflage discipline (soldiers and their equipment).

f. **Make contact with the smallest element possible**. Making contact with the smallest element possible is done when the situation is not clear. However, when the situation is clear, the company commander must quickly mass the effects of his combat power to overwhelm the enemy.

0303. Although the advantages normally outweigh the disadvantages, when planning decentralized movements the commander should also consider the following disadvantages:

a. Numerous linkups are required to regroup the company.

b. In the event of enemy contact, massing combat of power may take longer.

c. Radio communications may not be available in each squad.

Location of Key Leaders and Weapons

0304. The locations for key leaders and weapons depend on the situation, the movement formation and technique, and the organization of the rifle company. This paragraph provides guidance for the CO in deciding where these assets should be located.

0305. **The Company Commander**. The CO locates where he can see and control the company. Normally, he positions the CP at his location, but at times he may move separate from the CP. He may take just his company radio operator and travel with one of his platoons. This allows him to move with a platoon without disrupting their formation. Generally, the CO (with the CP) operates just behind the lead platoon.

0306. **The Company Command Post**. This consists of the CO, radio operators, FIST HQ, the communication sergeant, and the XO, F/Sgt, or a security element. This is located where it can best maintain the communications and supports the CO and it is normally located in the company formation where it is secured by other platoons and sections. During times when the CP is located away from the CO, the XO would control the CP (or part of it) and maintain communications with higher or adjacent units.

0307. **The Company Fire Support Officer/ Fire Support Team**. The company FSO normally moves with the CO. But in some instances, he may locate elsewhere to control indirect fires or relay calls for fire from the platoon FOs.

0308. **The Company Mortars**. These are located in the formation where they can provide responsive fires in the event of enemy contact and should be positioned where they gain security from other units in the company.

0309. **The Anti- Armor Section**. This section may move as a unit or attach its teams to the platoons. Moving as a section allows the CO to quickly mass his anti- armor fires. Attaching teams to the platoons provides some anti- armor capability throughout the company. This also allows alternating over watch platoons without having to shift the anti- armor section from platoon to platoon.

0310. **Other Attachments.** The locations of other attachments will depend on the situation. CS assets, such as engineers are positioned where they can best support the company. For example, the engineers may follow the lead platoon where they would be more responsive.

Company Movement Considerations

0311. When moving the company, the CO may consider the following areas:

a. **Distance between Soldiers and Units.** When moving cross-country, the distance between soldiers and between platoons varies according to the terrain and the situation. Soldiers should constantly observe their sectors for likely enemy positions, and look for cover that can be reached quickly in case of enemy contact.

b. **Unit Formations to be used**. Specifying the platoon formations to be used within the company formation is decided by the CO. However, in his absence, each platoon leader selects his platoon's formation.

c. **Designate a Base Platoon to Control Movement**. The base platoon is the lead platoon. The other platoons base their speed and direction on the base platoon. In the line or the vee formation, the CO must specify which the base platoon is. This is to adapt quick changes and provide the CO control the movement of the entire company.

d. **Movement Readiness Conditions**. One technique used to alert units for possible movement is the use of a movement alert status. This technique normally consists of four readiness conditions that designate the amount of time required before a unit is expected to move. 1) REDCON 1: Be prepared to move immediately. 2) REDCON 2: Be prepared to move in 15 minutes. 3) REDCON 3: Be prepared to move in 1 hour. 4) REDCON 4: Be prepared to move in 2 hours.

0312. Using this technique, a CO can quickly and concisely alert a unit for movement or the unit can report to the CO its readiness to move.

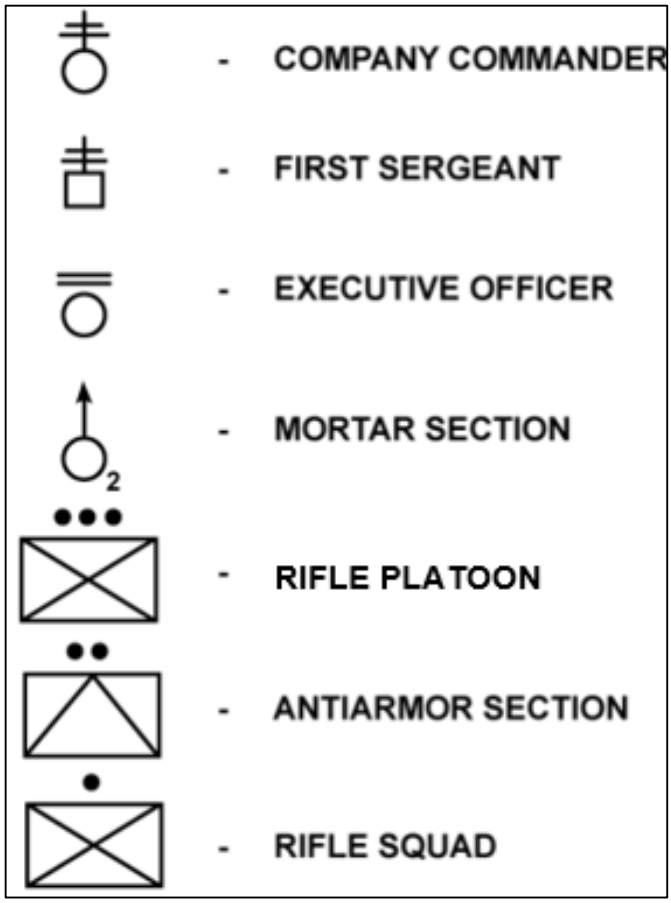


Figure 3.1 - Legends and Symbols.

Movement Formations

0313. The column, the line, the vee, the wedge, the file, and the echelon, right or left are the six basic movement formations of the company which aids control, security, and firepower to varying degrees. The best formation to use depends on the:

a. Mission

b. Enemy situation

c. Terrain

d. Weather and visibility conditions (ability to control)

e. Speed of movement desired

f. Degree of flexibility desired

0314. The following is a discussion of the infantry company movement formations. See Figure 3.1 for a legend of symbols for company personnel and elements. The following are the types of movement formations: (Column, Company line, Company wedge, Company vee, Company file and Company echelon).

a. **Column**. Figure 3.2 depicts one version of a company column which shows the lead platoon in vee formation, the middle platoon in a wedge formation, and the last platoon in column. This movement formation allows the company to make contact with one platoon and maneuver with the two trail platoons which provides good all-round security and allows fast movement.

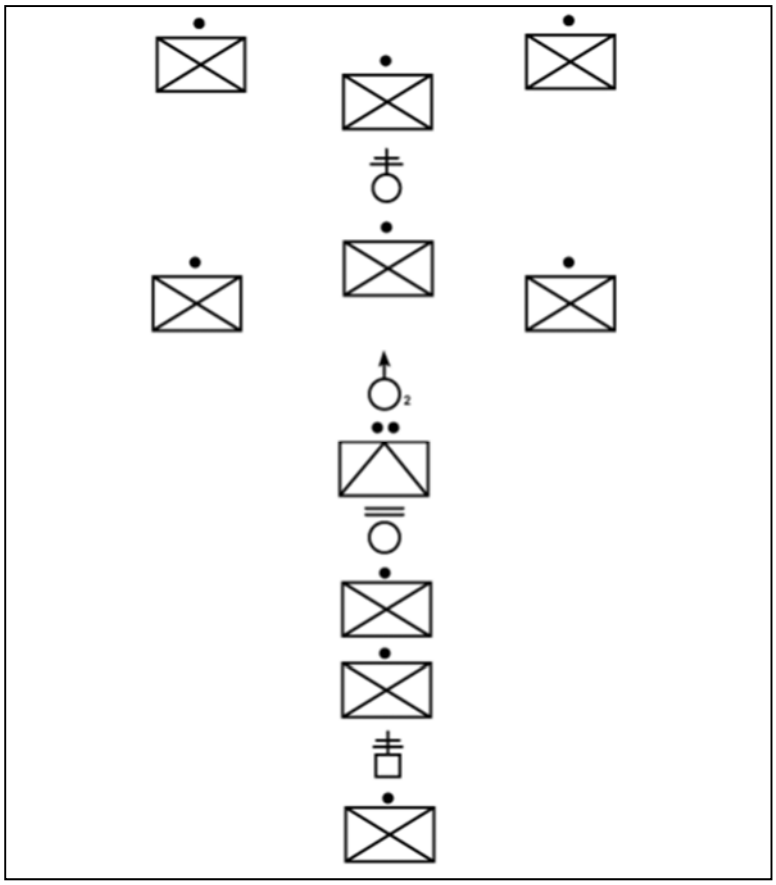


Figure 3.2 - Company Column

b. **Company Line.** This is the most difficult formation to control. Figure 3.3 depicts one example of a company line which shows the left platoon in echelon left, the center platoon in line, and the right platoon in echelon right. This formation puts three platoons forward along the same direction of movement and provides for the delivery of maximum fire to the front, but less to the flanks.

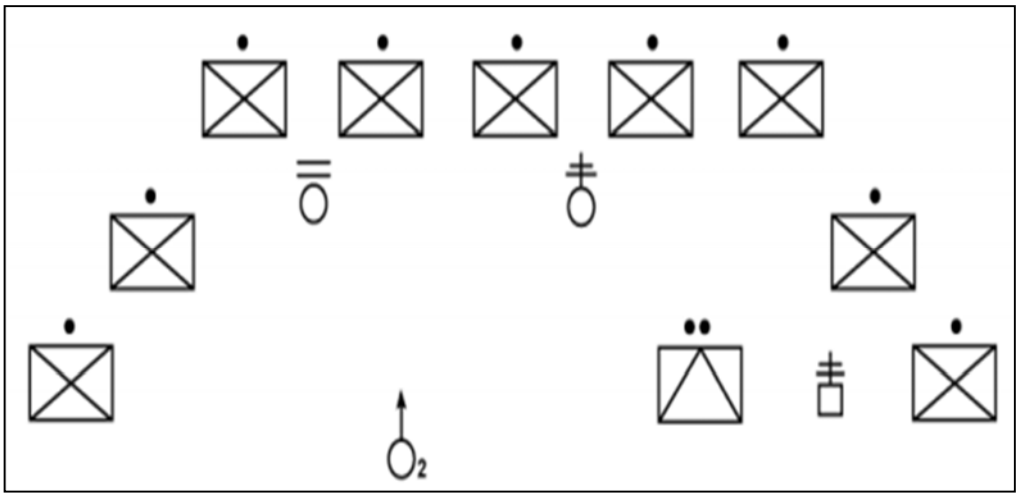


Figure 3.3 - Company Line

c. **Company Wedge.** This formation is hard to control, but it allows faster movement than the company vee formation. Figure 3.4 depicts one example of the company wedge. It shows the lead platoon in wedge, the left platoon in column, and the right platoon in echelon right. This formation has two platoons in the rear that can over- watch or trail the lead platoon. It provides for immediate fire to the front of the flanks.

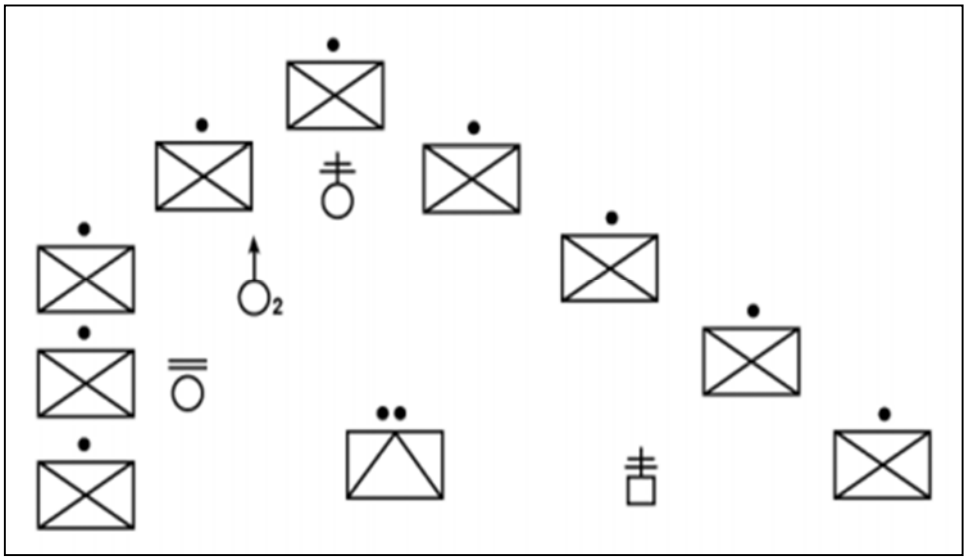


Figure 3.4 Company Wedge

d. **Company Vee.** Figure 3.5 depicts one example of a company vee. It shows all platoons in wedge. This formation has two platoons forward to provide immediate fire on contact to the front or flank. It also has one platoon in the rear, which can either over-watch or trail the others.

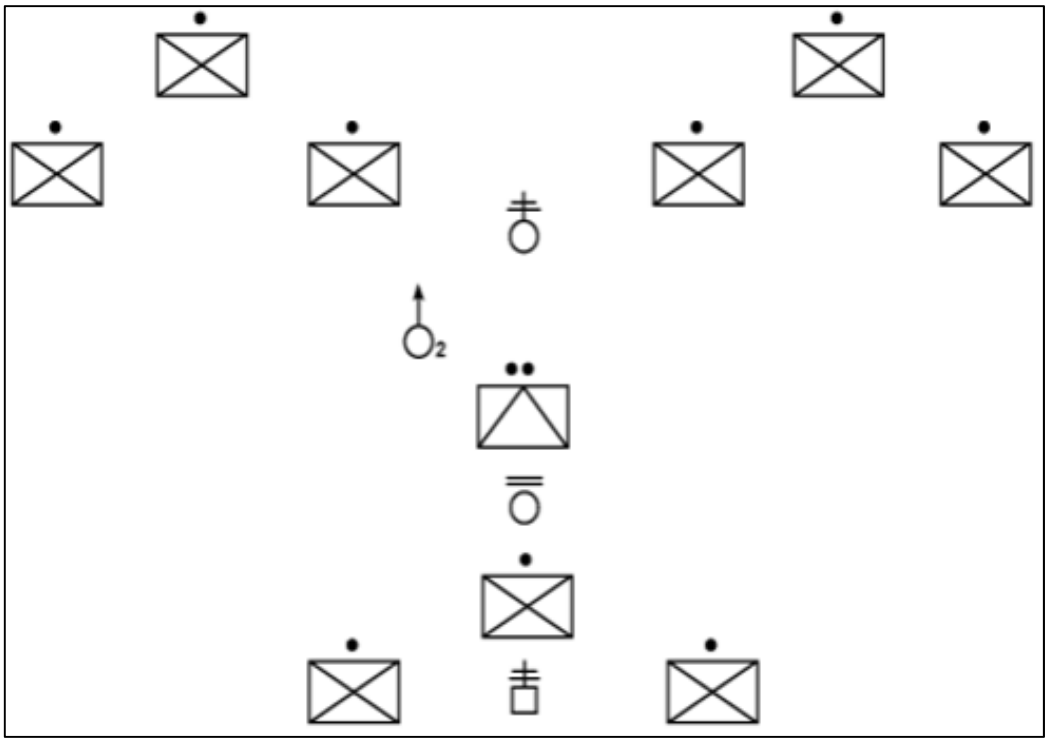


Figure 3.5 - Company Vee

e. **Company File**. Figure 3.6 depicts one example of a company file. It shows all units in file. This formation allows rapid movement in close or restricted terrain, limited visibility and enhances control and concealment. It is formed by arranging platoon and sections in file behind the lead element and is the easiest formation to control but also the least secure formation and hardest from which to maneuver. The following are considered: 1) The lead platoon or right is placed behind the lead security element. The CP can be placed farther back (behind the lead platoon) to avoid interfering with the lead platoon's movement and to aid communications with the other elements. 2) The XO or F/Sgt is placed (nearly) last, in the company file to provide leadership and to prevent breaks in contact within the file. 3) This is vulnerable to breaks in contact and should only be used when necessary and for short periods of time. A company of 120 men will stretch out over 600 meters in a company file with a pass time of more than 20 minutes.

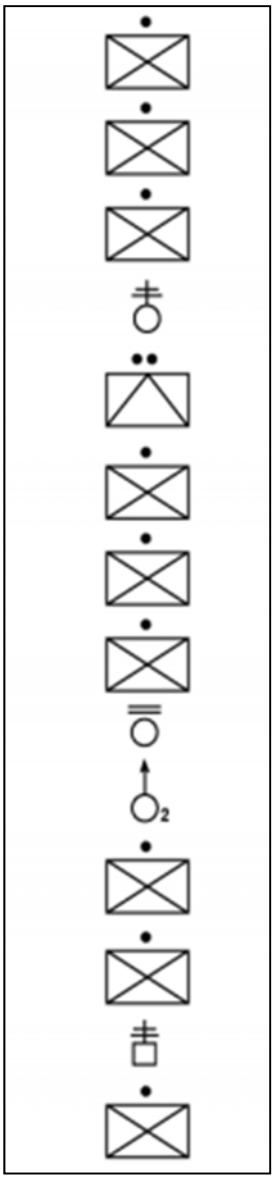


Figure 3.6 - Company File

f. **Echelon Right or Left**. This formation is used if the situation is vague and enemy contact to the front or on one of the flanks is likely. Normally, an obstacle or another friendly unit exists on the flank of the company opposite the echeloned flank. This prevents enemy contact on that side. This formation provides a good volume of fire and protection to the echeloned flank. Figure 3.7 depicts one example of the echelon right formation; it shows the lead platoon in echelon left, the middle platoon in wedge, and the last platoon in column.

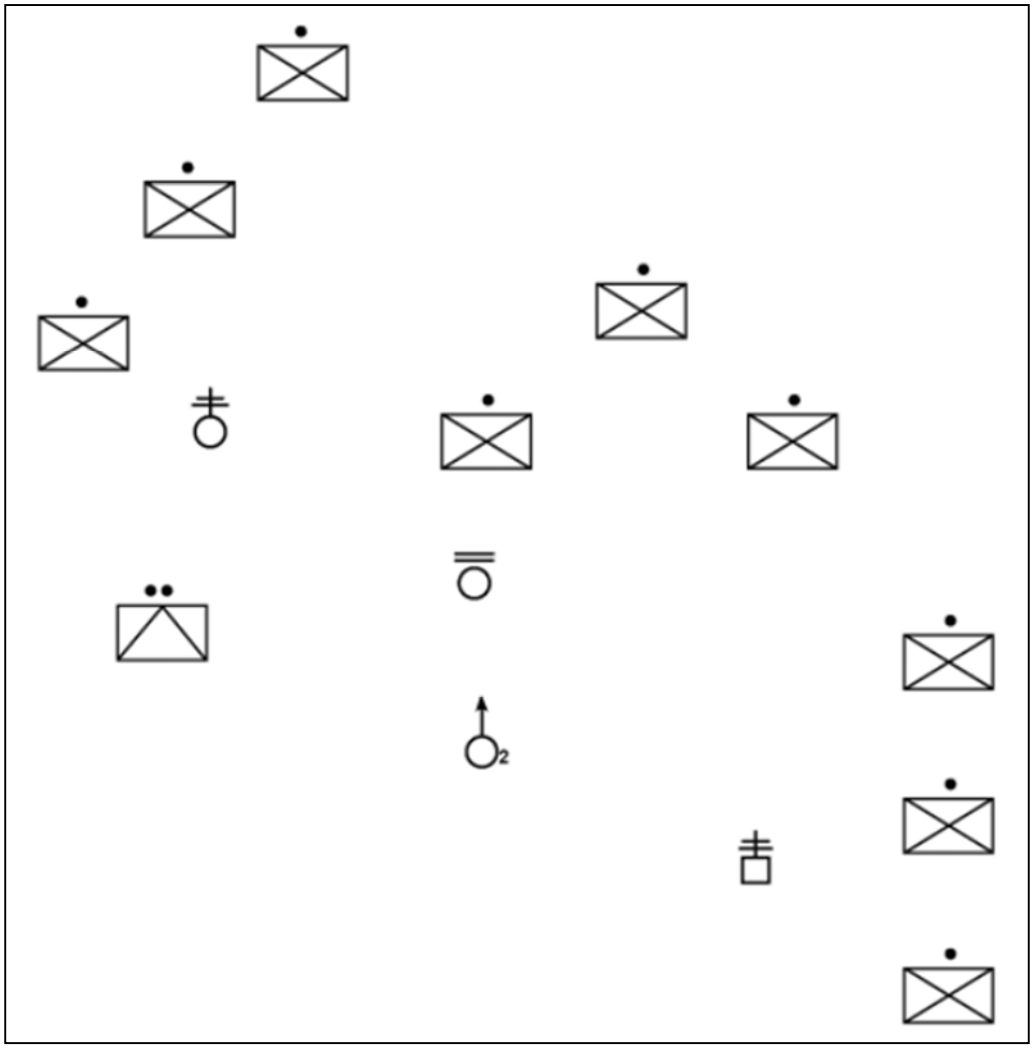


Figure 3.7 - Echelon Right

Formation Selection

0315. The CO selects the formation that provides the proper control, security, and speed. Table 3.1 provides a comparison of the six movement formations:

Table 3.1 - Movement Formation Comparison Chart

FORMATION	SECURITY	FIRES	CONTROL	SPEED
COLUMN	GOOD DISPERSION GOOD 360° SECURITY	GOOD TO FRONT & REAR EXCELLENT TO THE FLANKS	EASY TO CONTROL FLEXIBLE FORMATION	FAST
LINE	EXCELLENT TO THE FRONT POOR TO THE FLANK & REAR	EXCELLENT TO THE FRONT POOR TO THE FLANK & REAR	DIFFICULT TO CONTROL INFLEXIBLE FORMATION	SLOW
WEDGE	GOOD 360° SECURITY	GOOD TO THE FRONT & FLANKS	LESS DIFFICULT THAN THE LINE FLEXIBLE FORMATION	FASTER THAN THE LINE
VEE	BETTER TO THE FRONT	VERY GOOD TO THE FRONT	VERY DIFFICULT	SLOW
FILE	LEAST SECURE EFFECTIVE USE OF CONCEALMENT	POOR	EASY TO CONTROL	FAST
ECHELON	GOOD TO THE ECHELONED FLANK & FRONT	GOOD TO THE ECHELONED FLANK & FRONT	DIFFICULT	SLOW

Movement Techniques

0316. There are three techniques for moving when not in contact. The commander decides which one to use based on the likelihood of enemy contact, the need for speed, and the terrain and visibility. Movement techniques are not fixed formations. The distances between the soldiers and the units vary based on the mission, enemy, terrain, visibility, and any other factor that affects control. The three movement techniques are traveling, traveling over-watch, and bounding over-watch.

a. **Traveling.** This technique (Figure 3.8) is used when speed is important and enemy contact is not likely. The company moves in a company column with 20 to 50 meters between platoons. The distance depends on the visibility afforded by terrain, weather and light. All six company formations are effective when using the traveling technique. The commander usually follows the base platoon to ease navigation and control. This lets him see the route and direct the base platoon. All platoons use traveling. Adequate distance is kept between squads and between soldiers to maintain dispersion in case of enemy contact.

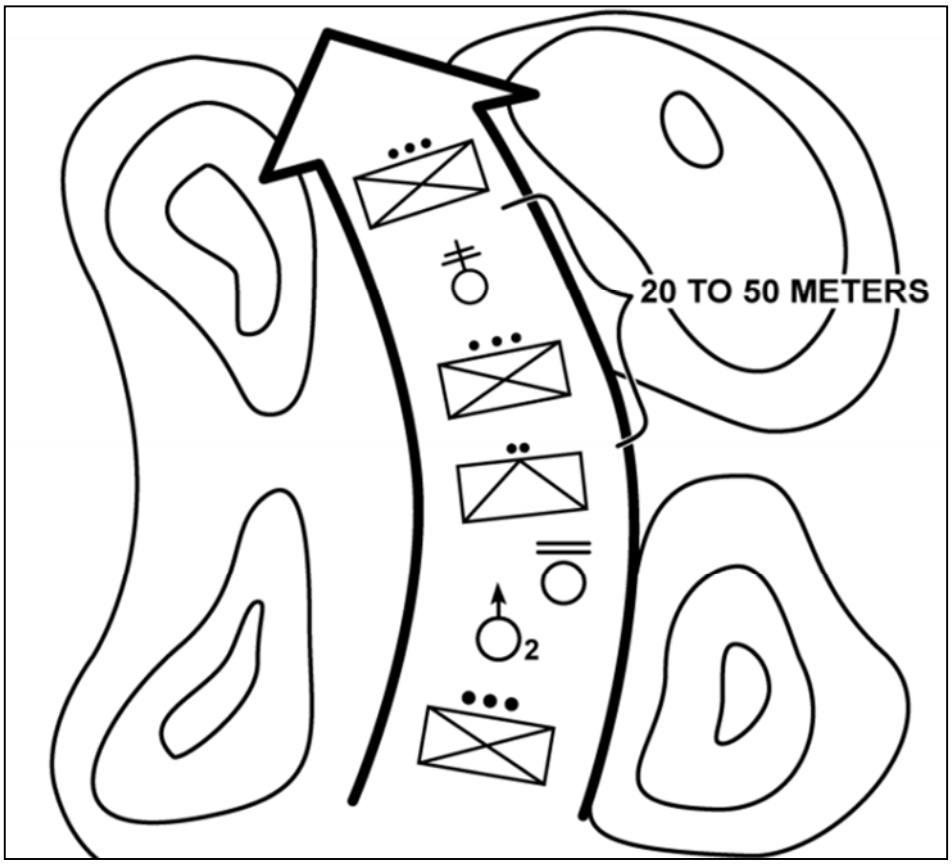


Figure 3.8 - Traveling

b. **Traveling Over watch**. Figure 3.9 depicts this technique and is mostly effective for column and wedge formations. This is used when enemy contact is possible, but speed is important.

The distance between the lead platoon and the trailing platoons is not fixed. The trailing platoons stay far enough behind the lead platoon to avoid fire directed at the lead platoon; but close enough so they can provide fire support or maneuver when the lead platoon makes contact.

The lead platoon normally uses traveling overmatch while the other platoons use traveling and key their movement on the trail squad of the platoon they follow. However, the company commander may have the lead platoon use bounding over-watch.

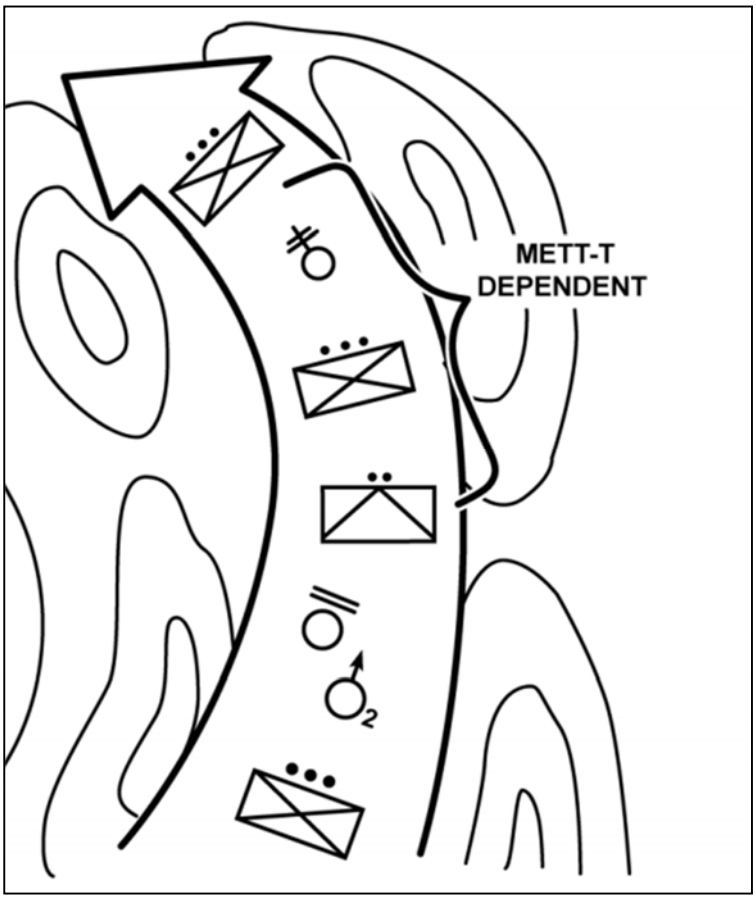


Figure 3.9 - Traveling Over watch

c. **Bounding Over-watch.** It is the most secure, but the slowest movement technique. This technique is used when enemy contact is expected (Figure 3.9). All movement is keyed to the next position from next bounding element and will be over-watched. The bounding element never moves beyond the range where it can be supported by the weapons in the over-watch element, such as: 1) The bounding element (platoon) moves on a covered and concealed route as per CO's command. When deciding where to bound, the commander looks for a position that has cover, concealment, and good observation and fields of fire. When the CO can view the entire route of the bounding platoon, he may specify which platoon movement technique to use. When the platoon reaches its new position, it deploys to over-watch the movement of the rest of the company. Once in position, it remains there while another platoon bounds ahead to the next forward position (alternate method); 2) The over-watch element (one platoon and the 60mm mortar section) is positioned to support the bounding element if it makes contact. Any remaining platoons remain ready and await orders to maneuver or support the bounding element by fire; and 3) Before a bound, the commander tells the platoon leaders: (a) The position of the over-watch element; (b) The location of the next over-watch position; (c) The route of the bounding element; (d) The actions on contact; (e) The planned sequence of action; and, (f) How the next order will be given.

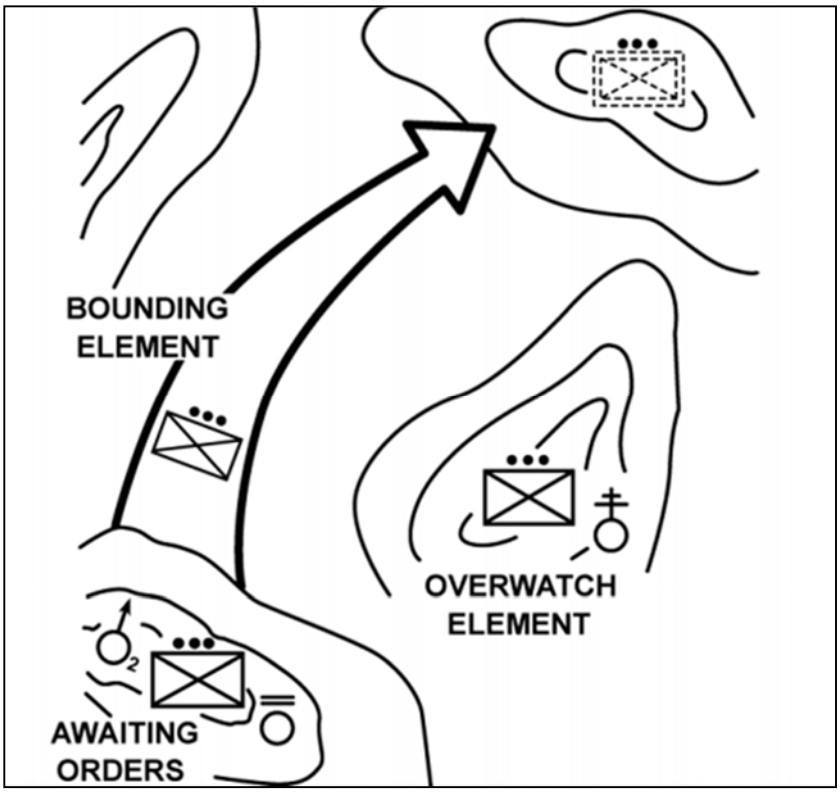


Figure 3.10 - Bounding Overwatch

Control Techniques

0317. The following techniques may help in controlling company movements:

a. **Graphics.** Terrain considerations are a priority in ensuring that each graphic control measure can be easily located. These may include boundaries, routes, checkpoints, release points, and TRPs on likely enemy positions, to control direct fires.

b. **Reconnaissance.** This provides the CO a better idea of where movement is more difficult and where graphic control measures are needed.

c. **Guides.** This is the best way to provide control when located in a terrain. Reconnoitering the difficult areas and guiding the company through them is done when it is not possible to have guides for the entire movement.

d. **Navigational Aids.** Compass and a pace man for all moves are used by all leaders. Routes that allow leaders to use prominent terrain to stay oriented must be selected.

e. **Limited Visibility Movements**. The following measures will provide extra control during these periods: 1) Reduction of the interval between soldiers and units. 2) Use luminous tape on the back of the helmets, slowing the speed of movement; use guides or moving leaders closer to the front. 3) Use night vision devices, if available.

Security during Movement

0318. Each platoon is responsible for a sector during movement. This is dependent on his position in the formation.

a. Soldiers spread out and assume prone positions behind cover during short halts. They keep movement to a minimum. Soldiers with night vision devices scan areas where the enemy may be concealed during limited visibility. Leaders set up OPs, machine guns, and anti-armor weapons on enemy likely approaches towards the halt position. Soldiers remain alert and may speak (but quietly) only when necessary.

b. The company sets up a perimeter defense during long halts. The company SOP should address the actions required during long halts.

c. Small ambush teams maybe concealed and remain in position after short halts for additional security.

d. The CO should ensure that the enemy is unaware of his location before occupying a static position (ORP, Patrol Base, or AA). The CO may also conceal security teams in or near the tentative static position as the company passes by.

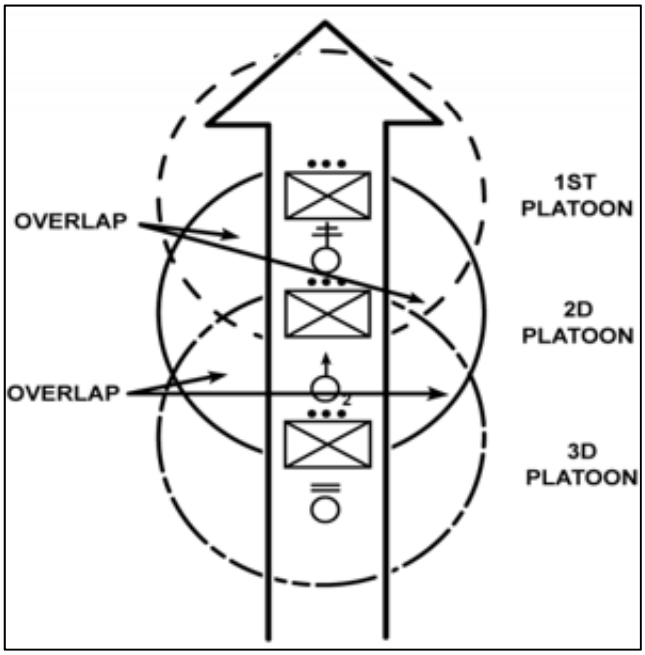


Figure 3.11 - All-Round Security

Movement as Part of a Battalion

0319. The battalion commander assigns the company a position within the battalion formation, since the company often moves as part of the battalion. Movement technique and movement formation that best suits the likelihood of enemy contact and unit mission are what the CO uses for effective movement and maneuver.

Chapter IV
Offensive Operations

0401. The infantry company typically performs the offensive operations which are part of a larger unit. The offensive operations enable the commander to take hold of the initiative in choosing where and when to fight, maintain the initiative and at the same time, make use of the company's strengths. The results of the crucial combat are obtained through offensive actions. Offensive operations are mainly designed to support and transition the offense. It is only by means of offensive actions that a company will be able to achieve its main mission: to close with the enemy by means of fire and maneuver to destroy or capture him, or to repel his assault by fire, close combat, and through full spectrum operations. A sound doctrinal foundation during offensive planning assists the commander in capitalizing on the increased tactical flexibility of the infantry rifle company.

Fundamentals of Offensive

0402. The infantry company is appropriate for offensive operations at night. This is proven to be most effective especially during attacks at night in order to destroy the enemy C2 and CS assets. When it is necessary to fight the combat forces of the enemy, the infantry company has to achieve surprise as well as utilize the indirect approach in order to reach the decisive point. For operations that are sustained and in instances when it is necessary to fight the enemy with mobility advantage or significant firepower, the infantry company commonly necessitates augmentation with SS and CS assets.

0403. Offensive operations are conducted for varied purposes. Some of these are:

a. **Dislocate, isolate, disrupt, and destroy enemy forces.** Offensive maneuver aims to put the enemy in a positional disadvantage. Through the offensive maneuver, friendly forces intended to mass the overwhelming effects are enabled while defeating in detail the parts of the enemy force before an enemy is able to escape and be reinforced. When it is necessary, the friendly forces are able to destroy the enemy in close combats. Eventually, the enemies surrender, retreats is disorder and/or altogether eliminated.

b. **To seize or secure key or decisive terrain.** This provides attackers with decisive advantage. The enemy either risks defeat, retreats or is destroyed. When the enemy forces retreat or makes an attempt to recapture the key terrains, exposure to fires and friendly maneuver happens.

c. **Deprive the enemy resources.** Losing resources significantly reduces an enemy's ability to resist.

d. **To gain information and develop intelligence.** Security, concealment and enemy deception may thwart friendly forces from obtaining the necessary intelligence. Certain offensive operations are performed to discover an enemy's capabilities, disposition and intent as well develop the situation.

e. **To deceive and divert the enemy.** The offensive operations distract reconnaissance, surveillance and enemy intelligence. These typically cause the enemy to shift their reserves away from friendly decisive operations.

f. **To create a secure environment for recovery operations**. The SCG operations may not occur when the enemy forces directly attack or threaten the local public. The offensive operations must isolate or destroy the enemy in order for the recovery operations to proceed. Offensive operations against the rebels help keep them lopsided. Such actions commonly force the insurgents to defend their base and keep them from further attacks.

0404. During any offensive operation, the CO typically identifies and aims the attack on the weaknesses of the enemy. Attacks on the enemy are commonly avoided. Attackers have to have a superior combat power in any decisive point in order to beat the enemy defense. The economy force may be used in order locations to attain combat power concentration at decisive point. When the attack is proven to be successful, the enemy has to be pressed persistently to keep him off his balance. The goal of the commander should be to strike the enemy with an overwhelming concentration of combat power from an unexpected direction when he least expects it.

Characteristics of Offensive Operations

0405. The traditional characteristics of an offense include speed, surprise, flexibility, concentration as well as audacity. The commander of the infantry rifle company has to be able to master both digital and analog capabilities. Through this dual capability, the flexibility that is needed to gather the benefits of the digital capabilities is provided. At the same time, the ability to rapidly transition to the analog capabilities while continuing the offense in case of disruptions in digital capability is achieved through the dual capability. The commander decides how to apply the following characteristics for each mission: (surprise, speed, concentration, flexibility, and audacity).

a. **Surprise.** Surprise entails striking the enemy while he is unprepared. Disrupting or delaying the reaction from the enemy is effective in most cases. By achieving surprise, the reaction from the enemy is delayed which thus allows the attacker to succeed with fewer forces. It is important to exploit the effects of surprise on the enemy prior to his recovery and to achieve this; the company may operate in small units, infiltrate and attack during limited visibility.

b. **Speed**. Speed promotes surprise, keeps the enemy off balance, contributes to the security of the attacking force, and prevents the defender from taking effective counter-measures. By increasing speed, commanders maintain momentum. Speed stops and confuses the defender which enables the attack to become unstoppable. Speed is built through careful planning, synchronization, coordination, and transition to the next operation. Increasing speed is achieved through simple plans, quick decision-making, decentralized control, mission orders, and rehearsed operations. Speed is maintained by ensuring that sustainment operations are well-coordinated and continuous, thus preventing culmination. Speed of movement depends on reconnaissance, reducing the soldiers' loads, using proper movement formations, and selecting good routes. Speed in planning results from effective SOPS, capable leaders, and the proper

use of time.

c. **Concentration**. The attacker concentrates combat power at the decisive point and time to achieve the unit's purpose. Leaders strive to concentrate the effects of their combat power without concentrating forces. By concentrating overwhelming combat power at a weak area, the attacker can reduce the enemy fires' effectiveness and the amount of time the attacker is exposed to enemy fires. Concentrating combat power and simultaneously reducing the enemy's ability to do the same is the challenge for the CO. Actions that make the enemy shift its combat potential away from the decisive point produces greater advantage. The commander makes use of Infantry capabilities to attain combat power at decisive point.

d. **Flexibility**. There are certain points in attacks where the original plan needs to be adjusted based on situational changes. The commander has to be flexible at all times so as to attack the weaknesses of the enemy. The commander should not fight against the plan but instead, focus on fighting against the enemy's weaknesses. Mission orders, a clear commander's intent, and competent subordinate leaders who exercise initiative ensure that proper adjustments are made. The commander must expect uncertainties and be ready to exploit opportunities. The flexibility required often depends on the amount of reliable intelligence the commander has on the enemy. The commander has to build flexibility into the plan during the process of making decisions. In conducting thorough war-games, the commander is able to develop complete appreciation for every possible enemy action. The flexibility of the company commander increases through a reserve. However, because of the increased situational understanding through COP and the infantry company's organization, the reserve may prove to be smaller as compared to the strictly heavy and light units.

e. **Audacity**. Audacity is defined as the willingness in taking risky and bold actions in order to achieve positive results. Audacious commanders are able to develop their confidence by means of conducting thorough estimates. The commander's actions, while being decisive and quick, are primarily based on reasoned approach to tactical situations as well as the knowledge on the enemy, the terrain and the soldiers. An audacious commander is original and daring but not rash. Audacious commanders throughout history have used the "indirect approach." In order to maintain a positional advantage over the enemies they make sure that maneuvers are done successfully even if this would briefly expose their flanks. Boldness and calculated risks have been important keystones in achieving success in offensive operations. However, the risks need to be consistent with the intent and mission of the higher commander. Commanders are able to dismiss uncertainties through action and they recompense for the lack of information by means of pressing the fight and seizing initiatives.

Primary Offensive Tasks

0406. The company forces attack through the use of maneuvers to attain objectives that either conclude the campaign or enable it to move to the subsequent phase. The operational-level offensives in counterinsurgencies may be performed to eradicate the

sanctuaries of insurgents. The counterinsurgencies typically combine offensive operations and support to the civil governance tasks to achieve the decisive results.

0407. During offensive operations, one force often switches from an offensive task to another without stopping. For instance, an attack may lead to exploitation as well as pursuit to exploitation. This may be followed by another attack as the company forces assemble. The company performs the following primary offensive tasks:

a. Movement to Contact

b. Attack

c. Exploitation

d. Pursuit

e. Strike

0408. **Movement to Contact.** The movement to contact has two main purposes: first is to develop the situation and second is to establish or regain the contact. It creates satisfactory conditions for any subsequent tactical action. The company unit executes the task and makes contact with the smallest friendly force possible. On contact, the commander has five options: attack, defend, bypass, delay, or withdraw. Movements to contact include search and attack, and cordon and search operations.

0409. **Attack.** An attack is classified as an offensive operation which destroys the enemy forces, secures or seizes terrain. An attack commonly requires maneuver and is supported by indirect and direct fires which characterize the manner by which an attack is performed. During attacks, there may be shaping or decisive operations. Attacks may also be deliberate or hasty depending on the time made available for preparation and planning. The company commander will more likely participate in synchronized attacks as part of the battalion. The CO executes hasty attacks especially when there is a need for immediate action with minimal preparation and available forces. Deliberate attacks are conducted when there is more time to prepare.

0410. **Exploitation.** The objective of exploitation is to complete the destruction of the enemy following a successful attack. Companies may perform movements to contact and/or attacks as part of the battalion. However, companies must exploit success at local level within the concept of operation of the higher commanders.

0411. **Pursuit.** A pursuit typically follows a successful exploitation and is designed to prevent a fleeing enemy from escaping and to destroy him. The infantry company may participate either in a larger force or as an independent unit that performs pursuit at local level within the concept of operation of the higher commanders

0412. **Strike.** This is a fast-paced offensive operation that is characterized with lethal and surprising firepower that are called off immediately and as soon as practicable in order to ensure minimal exposure among the civilian populations. It has a short duration and is targeted to a confirmed and very specific military target. Planning a strike is usually hasty but done with specific intelligence support that may include technical

means sometimes human guides that enhance precision. When given orders from the higher headquarters, a company may participate in strikes.

Offensive Framework

0413. A simple and complete operation concept serves as the basis for all tactical operations. All offensive operations performed by a company typically consist of R&S activities, main attack as well as supporting attacks and sometimes even reserve operations. Companies must perform any of the following operations as part of a main battalion mission. The framework includes the following:

a. Reconnaissance and Security

b. Attacks

c. Reserves

0414. **Reconnaissance and Security.** Prior to any attack, the enemy has to be found through the use of gaps, flanks, weaknesses, flanks and obstacles in the position or formation. Simultaneously, friendly forces must be protected from surprise and still be able to rapidly deploy when contact is made with the enemy.

a. Reconnaissance is conducted to acquire information about the terrain or the enemy and is focused on collecting critical information to the attack. These requirements are directed by the battalion or the CO.

b. Security requires use of protective measures in preventing enemy observation or delivery of fires. Each unit is responsible for its own local security and is given security tasks as part of company R&S plan.

c. All units conduct patrols, establish Ops, and move using appropriate movement formations to accomplish both reconnaissance and security tasks. Commanders and subordinates must understand what they are to accomplish in R&S operations. In some instances, the company may be required to observe, report or fight.

0415. **Attacks.** Attack is the main task of the Infantry in warfare. It involves closing with the enemy by maneuver to destroy or capture. The company may be designated as the main or supporting attack and may likewise designate its own main and supporting attacks through its platoons and sections.

a. The decisive operations complete the mission. A platoon serves as the main attack for the company especially if it accomplishes the companymission.

b. A supporting attack platoon contributes in the success of the main attack. Supporting attacks are utilized in order to suppress enemy units, seize terrain and protect the main attack from enemy counterattacks. A follow and support force also acts as a supporting attack and a committed force which is assigned specific missions to support the main attack. These include: destruction of by-passed units, reduction of obstacles, securing lines of communications,

providing EPW search teams, demolition teams, first-aid and litter teams and ammunition resupply.

c. During attacks, the main effort serves as the focus of combat power. The main attack and main effort are not synonymous but are both mechanisms for concentrating combat power. For example, the company concept for seizing an enemy strongpoint has 1st PLTN supporting by fire, 2nd PLTN conducting a breach and seizing a foothold, and 3rd PLTN seizing the decisive point on strongpoint. The 3rd PLTN has the decisive action which enables the accomplishment of mission. They are the main attack throughout the operation; however, 3rd PLTN's success depends upon 2nd PLTN's success. When 2nd PLTN is conducting the breach, this is the most critical action that they should be designated the initial main effort (Figure 4.1). 1st PLTN initially supports 2nd PLTN's breach, but upon commitment of 3rd PLTN, they support the main attack.

0416. **Reserves.** In this offense, reserves as positioned and expected to weigh the main attack efforts. Reinforcement or maintenance of the momentum as well as dealing with enemy counterattacks and providing security is expected. They are also expected to exploit the success.

a. Reserves are committed at decisive point in battle to assure the mission's success or capitalize on the opportunities that are generated by successful attacks. Reserves are expected to always be available as they provide flexibility on the plan. When it is not possible to have a designated reserve, it is the CO that provides flexibility through other means such as reconnaissance tasks for the committed platoons, additional security and be-prepared missions. The control measures which support the quick issuance of the FRAGOs also enable plan flexibility.

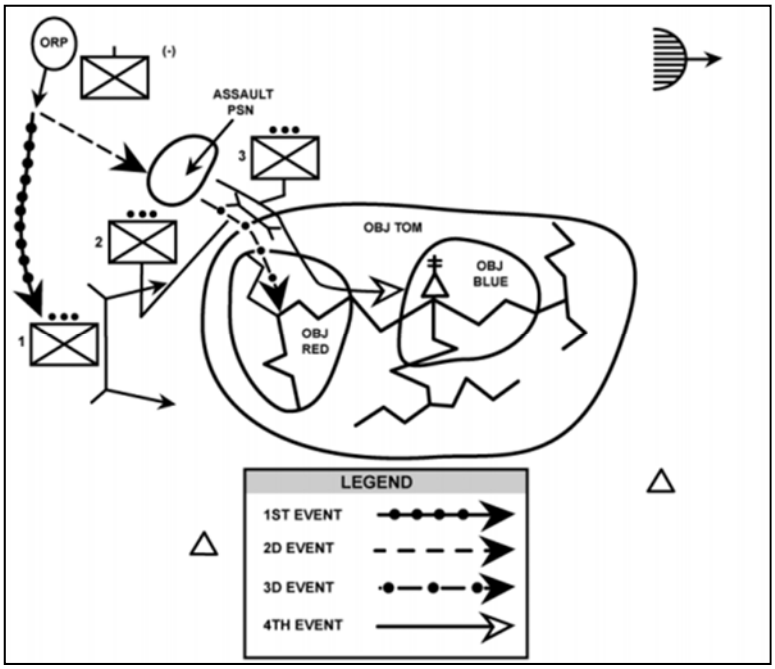


Figure 4.1 - Main Attack Concept Sketch

b. A unit held in reserve is not committed to a specific mission. The reserve leader is provided the planning guidance. For instance: “The top priority is to be prepared in continuing the main attack; be prepared in beginning a movement in contact right after success is achieved in maintaining contact with the enemy through the main attack; be prepared in blocking the counterattack along the avenue of approach 2, from the west to avert main attack’s disruption”.

c. The leader prepares for each mission in this order. The be-prepared missions may not be necessary to achieve the mission of the company. The reserve leader has to be given the standards that the CO will need to use to initiate or begin each be-prepared mission.

d. The size of a reserve and the headquarters which control it depends on the commander’s estimate of the on the situation. Commonly, the broader the enemy situation is, the larger the required reserve. If the company serves as the main attack while the battalion has a reserve, there may not be a designated small reserve.

e. However, if the company is a supporting attack, a large reserve may be needed. When the reserve does not include a platoon headquarters, the XO or F/Sgt may be the reserve leader. The leaders of the reserve must understand their be-prepared missions, keep up with the current situation and must keep their unit ready for action on short notice.

Forms of Maneuver

0417. The positional relationships of opposing forces to one another are described as forms of maneuver. In every attack, the CO must determine how to maneuver his unit to achieve overwhelming combat power at the decisive point. He applies these basic forms of maneuver, individually or in combination. Reconnaissance is the key to selecting the proper form of maneuver. Once the maneuver is initiated, surprise, speed, and stealth are crucial to the unit’s security. These also prevent the enemy from countering effectively. The following are the forms of maneuver:

a. Penetration

b. Envelopment

c. Turning Movement

d. Frontal Attack

e. Infiltration

0418. **Penetration.** Penetration is used when enemy flanks are not assailable and when time does not permit some other form of maneuver. Its purpose is to rupture enemy defenses on a narrow front and thereby create both assailable flanks and access to the enemy's rear (Figure 4.2).

a. The Rifle Company normally conducts a penetration as part of a larger force.

Penetration may be tried at one or several points, depending on the forces available. However, a company will usually focus combat power at one breach point.

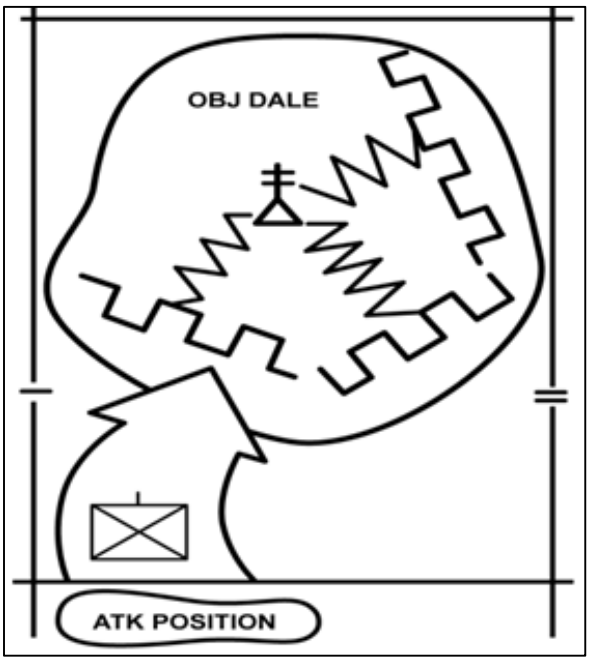


Figure 4.2 – Penetration

0419. **Envelopment.** Envelopment avoids the enemy's front where his forces are more protected and his fires more easily concentrated. Instead, while fixing the defender's attention forward by supporting attacks, the attacker maneuvers his main effort to strike at his flanks and rear. Flank attacks are a variant of the envelopment in which access to the enemy's flank and rear results from the enemy's movement.

a. Successful envelopment requires discovery or creation of an assailable flank. In meeting engagements and counterattacks, this may actually be the flank of the enemy force. In less fluid conditions, it may be a gap or weak point in the enemy's defense.

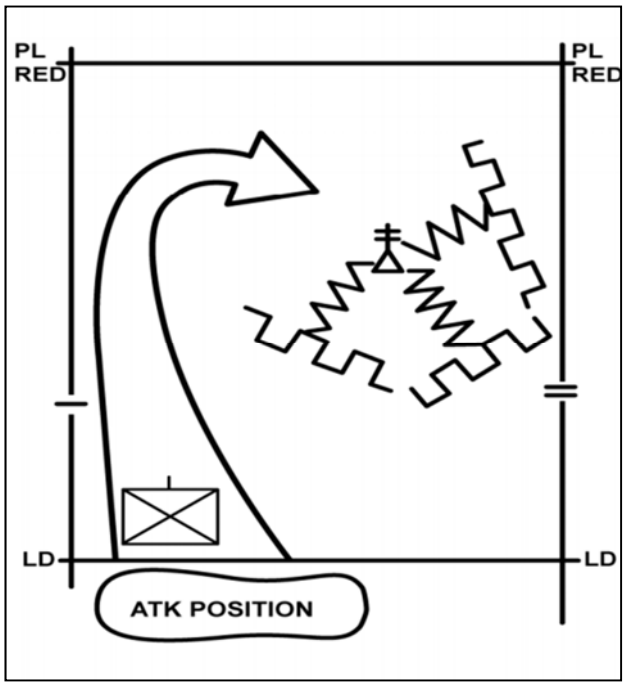


Figure 4.3 - Envelopment

0420. **Turning Movement.** The turning movement is a type of envelopment in which the attacker attempts to avoid the defense entirely. Instead, he seeks to secure key terrain deep in the enemy rear and along his lines of communication. Faced with a major threat to his rear, the enemy is thus "turned" out of his defensive positions and forced to attack rearward.

0421. For a turning movement to be successful, the unit trying to turn the enemy must attack something that the enemy will fight to save. For some, it is their supply routes; for others, it may be artillery emplacements or a headquarters. In addition to attacking a decisive target, the turning unit must be strong enough to pose a real threat to the enemy (Figure 4.4). A company will never be able to turn a corps, but it may turn a battalion.

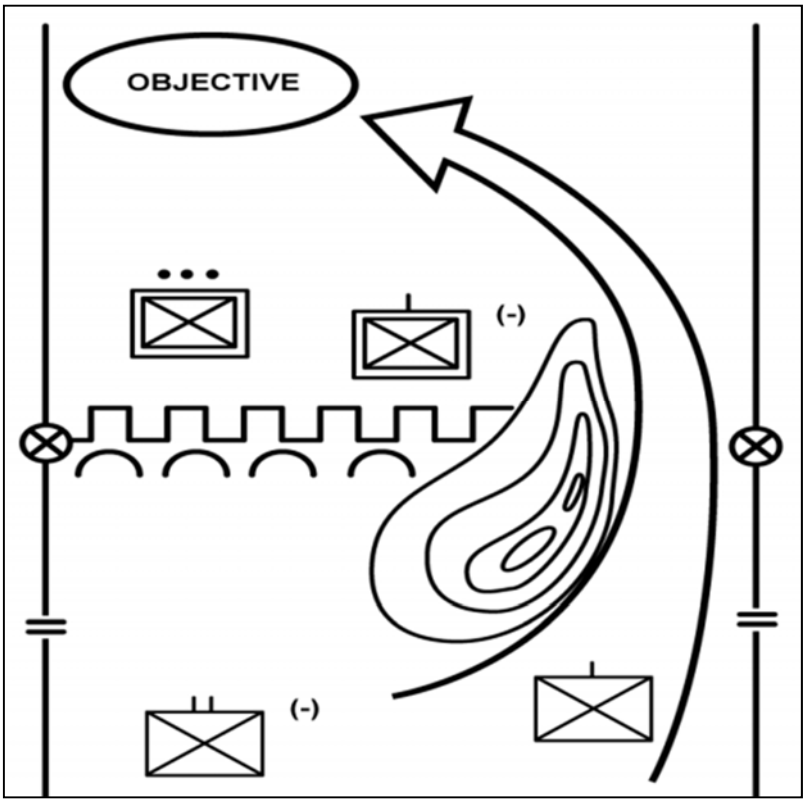


Figure 4.4 - Turning Movement

0422. **Frontal Attack.** A frontal attack strikes the enemy across a wide front and over the most direct approaches. For deliberate attacks, it is the least desirable form of maneuver since it exposes the attacker to the concentrated fire of the defender while at the same time limiting the effectiveness of the attacker's own fires. As the simplest form of maneuver, however, the frontal attack is useful for overwhelming weak defenses, security outposts, or disorganized enemy forces. It is often the best form of maneuver for an attack or meeting engagement in which speed and simplicity are keys.

0423. **Infiltration.** Infiltration is a means of reaching the enemy's rear without fighting through prepared defenses (Figure 4.5). It is the covert movement of all or part of the attacking force through enemy lines to a favorable position in their rear. The infiltrating unit avoids detection and engagement. Infantry companies are well suited for infiltrations. Their lack of protection and small signature when moving also make infiltrations an effective form of maneuver.

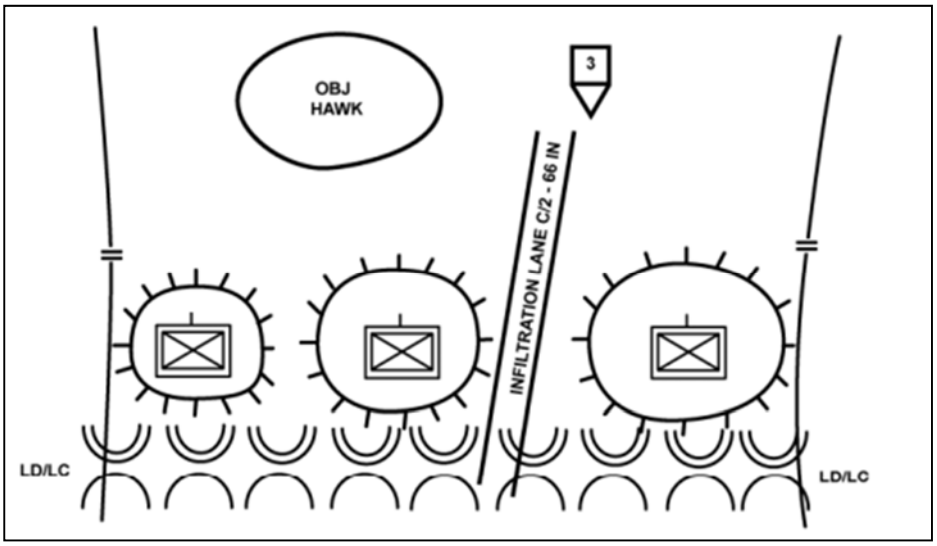


Figure 4.5 - Infiltration

Infiltration

0424. Infiltration is a form of maneuver used by Infantry units in many situations. During an attack, strong enemy defensive positions may be encountered. To avoid the enemy's strength, the commander may move units by stealth through gaps or around the enemy positions to conduct operations in the enemy's rear area. The company may infiltrate to conduct raids, ambushes, or other attacks. Infiltrations may also be used for many other types of operations, such as stay-behind and reconnaissance.

Fundamentals

0425. Infiltration allows the infantry to exploit its capabilities. By infiltrating, the companycan maneuver undetected by squad or platoons to critical targets, achieve surprise, and avoid the effects of enemy fires. Limited visibility, bad weather, and restrictive terrain reduce the chances of detection during an infiltration.

0426. A unit may infiltrate for the following reasons:

a. To gather information.

b. To attack the enemy at a weak point.

c. To seize key terrain or destroy vital installations behind enemy positions.

d. To harass and disrupt the enemy with ambushes in his rear area.

e. To attack enemy reserves, and fire support units and command posts.

0427. The phases of an infiltration are as follows:

a. **Patrol**. Find gaps or weak areas in the enemy defense and locate enemy

positions.

b. **Prepare**. Conduct troop-leading procedures.

c. **Infiltrate**. Avoid enemy contact. Move by smallest units as possible.

d. **Consolidate**. Link up and prepare for actions at the objective.

e. **Execute**. Complete the mission.

0428. Infiltrations do not always require that all units move through the enemy's positions without detection or fighting. Depending on the mission, the company can still complete the mission even though some of the squads made contact en-route to the linkup point. Although the enemy may have some idea of what is taking place, it will be very difficult to estimate exactly what these small contacts mean. OPSEC may require that only key leaders have the entire plan during the infiltration phase to prevent disclosure due to possible casualties or friendly prisoners.

Considerations

0429. An infiltration plan must be prepared. Units must be given enough time for preparation and movement. The company may infiltrate by itself or as part of the battalion. In either case, movement techniques and formations are based on the likelihood of enemy contact, the terrain, the visibility, and the need for speed and control. The following considerations apply:

0430. **Size.** The size of the infiltrating unit depends on the amount of time available, the amount of cover and concealment, and the enemy. Other considerations may include the need for communication, the difficulty of navigation, and the number of infiltration routes. Generally, smaller units can move quicker and make better use of available concealment. However, this may increase the number of linkups that require more time. While, infiltrating by companyor platoons ensures control and provides more combat power in the event of contact; but is highly detectable.

0431. **Infiltration Lane**. The company may be assigned an infiltration lane or a zone. The CO must decide whether to move the entire company together through the company's lane or assign each platoon a separate infiltration lane within the company lane. He also has the option to stagger the start time for each platoon while traversing at the company lane. The infiltration lane should be wide enough to allow the infiltrating units to change their planned routes in order to avoid enemy contact. The following considerations apply:

a. If the company uses a single company lane, the CO picks a route through it and an ORP (Figure 4.6). If multiple lanes are used, the CO assigns each platoon a lane and a start time, picks linkup point for the platoons, and a company ORP. The platoon leaders pick the routes through their lanes;

b. In making his decision whether to use single or multiple lanes, the CO considers several things. Moving as a company on a single lane: 1) May get the company to the ORP faster; 2) Makes control easier; 3) Makes navigation easier; 4)

Increases the chance of the entire company being detected; and, 5) Provides greater combat potential, if detected.

c. Moving on multiple lanes (Figure 4.7) or by platoons on one lane: 1) requires linkups; 2) Makes control harder; 3) May make navigation more difficult; and, 4) Decreases the chance of the entire company being detected. However, if detected there is less combat potential available; and,

d. Routes. The routes selected must: 1) Avoid enemy positions; 2) Have cover and concealment; 3) Provide ease in control and navigation; and, 4) Avoid obstacles and danger areas.

e. Likewise, routes should consider the following: a) Routes should be reconnoitered without alerting the enemy. This may be possible by map reconnaissance only; however, consider using guides or by marking the routes; b) Rally points may be selected based on a map reconnaissance. Others are selected as the company moves along the route. If the infiltrating company is dispersed by enemy action, it rallies at the last rally point passed that is not within enemy small-arms range or impact area. The assembled unit then waits until a set number of units (soldiers) arrive at the rally point, or for a specified time, before continuing the mission. The senior man at the rally point should, in the absence of the CO, take charge and decide how to best continue the mission; and, c) Locate the ORP as close to the objective as possible without being detected or losing security. It should be large enough so that the company can deploy in it. It should be secured before it is occupied.

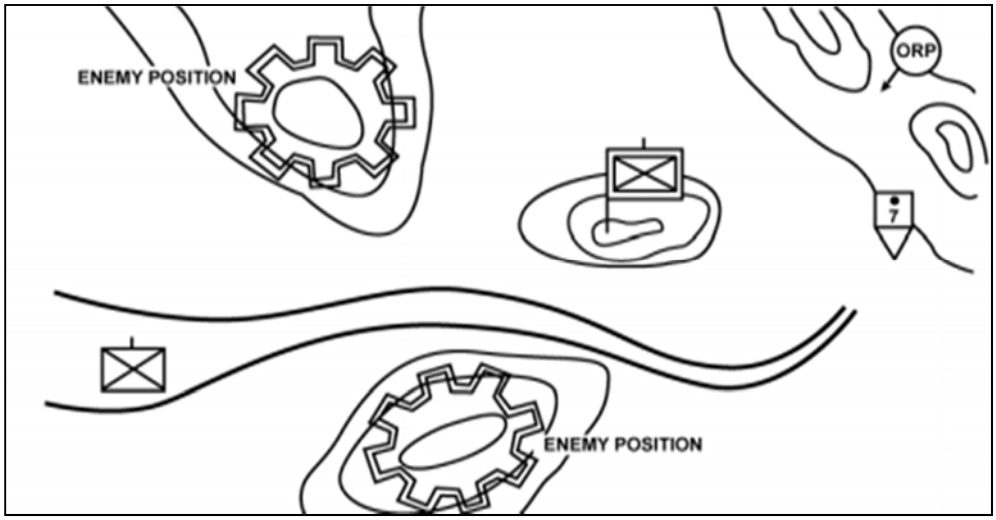


Figure 4.6 - Single Infiltration Lane

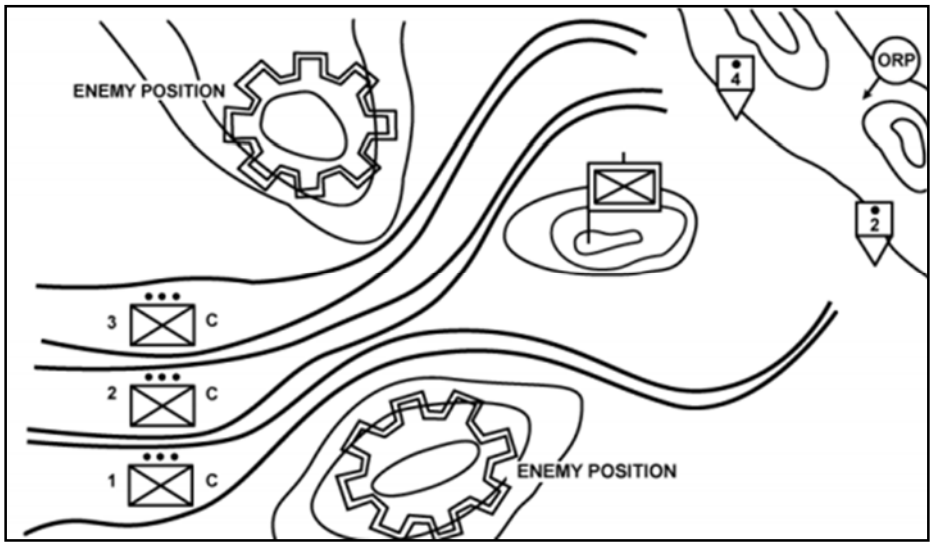


Figure 4.7 - Multiple Infiltration Lane

0432. **Linkup Point.** When multiple lanes are used, the platoons meet at a linkup point and then move as a company to the ORP. Do not plan linkups at the ORP. If a unit misses its linkup, it moves to a contingency linkup point located away from the ORP and links up with a small element from the ORP.

0433. **Signals**. Visual signals, such as arm-and-hand signals, infrared devices, and flashlights with colored lenses, reduce the chance of detection. Avoid sound signals and flares. Recognition signals are critical for actions at a linkup point or a rally point.

a. Radio listening silence should be enforced, except when it is necessary to report the progress of the unit or when a unit detected by the enemy needs supporting fire.

b. Radio messages to report crossing of phase lines or checkpoints (if required) should use one code word. They may be transmitted without using call signs; each unit shall have a separate code word.

c. When required, units operating out of radio contact (because of terrain or distances) can be required to monitor or send codes only at a certain time. At these times, they move to terrain or set up expedient antennas so they can communicate.

0434. **Fire Support.** Indirect fires are always planned but only used when contact is made or when needed to support the mission. If contact is made with an enemy element, the infiltrating unit should use indirect fire to divert the enemy's attention, suppress enemy positions, and screen friendly movement to help them disengage. Indirect fires may also be used to assist in navigation and cause the enemy soldiers on security to seek cover.

0435. **Actions on Contact**. When infiltrating on multiple lanes, detection of one infiltrating unit may alert the enemy and compromise the other infiltrating units. The OPORD must state whether to continue the mission or return to friendly lines, if detected by the enemy. Units following on the same lane should switch to an alternate

lane. If a soldier in the unit speaks the enemy's language, he should be positioned at or near the front of the column in case the unit is challenged by an enemy patrol. The order must also specify what to do in the event of casualties.

0436. **Methods of Handling Casualties and Prisoners**. During the infiltration, it may be hard to evacuate casualties without jeopardizing security. Casualties can be carried to the ORP or linkup point and evacuated when the operation has ended or concealed and left to be picked up later. Moving the wounded, dead, or prisoners to the ORP is dangerous when trying to avoid detection. If casualties are left, soldiers with medical supplies are left with them. The KIA can be concealed and recovered later. Leave prisoners under guard at a rally point and evacuate them when the operation is over.

0437. **Rehearsals.** Every soldier must know the plan and his role in it. Units should rehearse their formations and movement techniques and their actions:

a. On enemy contact

b. At rally points

c. At the linkup point

d. At the ORP

e. At danger areas

f. At the objective

Movement to Contact

0438. Movement to contact is an offensive operation. It is used in gaining and maintaining contact with the enemy and is also used when there is no time to reconnoitre and trace the enemy. The techniques discussed in this section also apply to approach phase of a hasty attack. Since the enemy situation is not clear, the company moves in a manner which supports rapid build-up of combat power against the units of the enemy. In the attack's approach phase, the enemy situation is clearer. Therefore, the company moves toward the objective in a manner which avoids detection from enemy and supports deployment in the assault. Two methods for conducting a movement to contact are the search-and-attack technique and the approach-march technique.

Fundamentals

0439. The CO determines the implementation of the fundamentals as he chooses proper tactics in conducting mission. The CO maintains freedom of maneuver by means of moving the company in a way that:

a. Make enemy contact with the smallest element possible. (Ideally an R&S element.)

b. Rapidly develops combat power upon enemy contact.

c. Provides all-around security for the unit.

d. Supports the battalion concept.

0440. He reports all information rapidly and accurately, and strives to gain and maintain contact with the enemy.

Considerations

0441. The battalion may lead the company's technique. If not, the CO considers the battalion concept as he conducts estimate to select the best technique. Normally, when operating as part of a battalion movement to contact, the company will employ the same technique. The following considerations may assist the commander in developing his concept:

0442. **Time Available.** The time intended for planning, coordinating, and rehearsing may affect the decision. The approach-march technique necessitates less time for preparation. The company may require only a brief FRAGO in conveying the movement formation and the graphic control measures. The search-and-attack technique may require more preparation time because the platoons and squads have more planning responsibilities, such as patrol base, linkups, and casualty evacuations.

0443. **Speed of Movement.** The speed that the company is required to move is a major factor. With either technique, the faster the company moves, the less effective its R&S efforts will be. It becomes more likely that the enemy will initiate fires at the time and place he selects. The approach-march technique is normally more effective in quickly reacting to enemy contacts.

0444. **Enemy.** The CO considers the clarity of the enemy situation. Although the enemy situation is vague in every movement to contact, the CO should have some information. The possible enemy locations and probable strength is the key. The CO considers these locations to plan the company's movement and their probable strength to determine his security needs and to analyse the risks for each technique. The expected enemy action upon contact is also considered. If the CO expects him to fight, then the approach march may be the more effective technique. If the enemy is attempting to avoid detection or quickly disengage, the search-and-attack technique may be the better method.

0445. **Security.** The amount of preparation time, the required movement, speed and the enemy situation all has a direct impact on the company's security requirements. The CO also considers the terrain, the adjacent units, the available combat support, and the present status of his unit to determine how to provide security for his company. Successful movements to contact depend on locating the enemy without being detected. This provides the CO the initiative to develop the situation by fully coordinating and supporting the attack with all available resources.

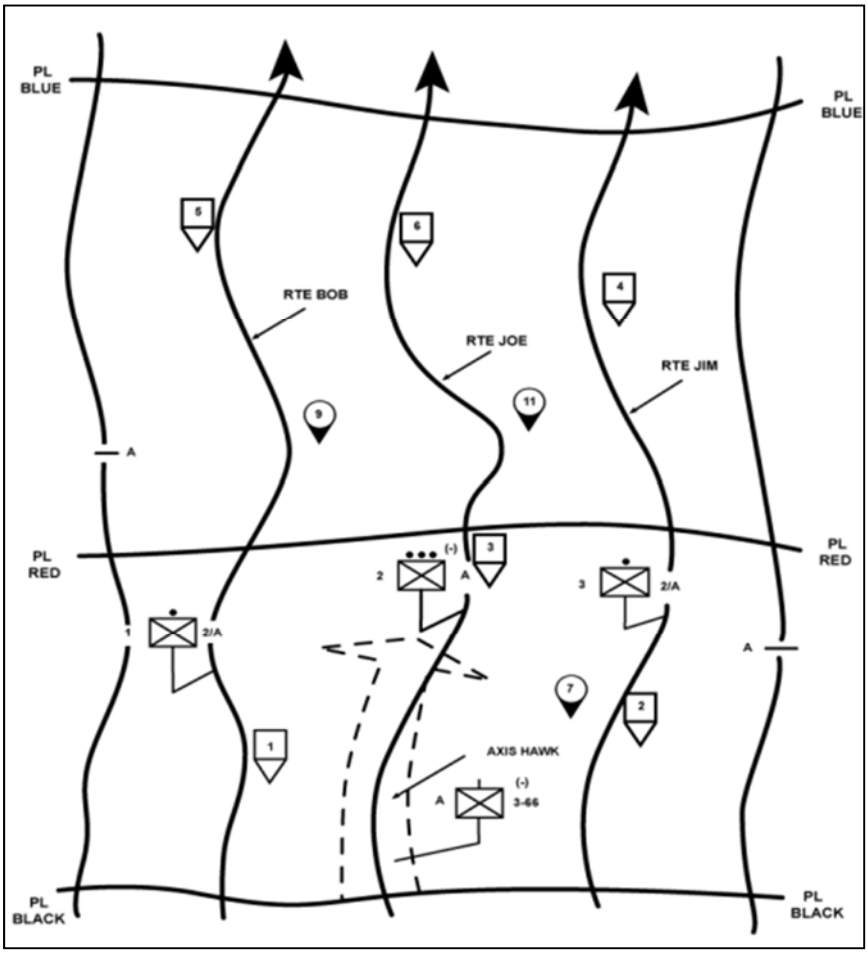


Figure 4.8 - Combined Techniques

0446. **Combined Technique.** Figure 4.8 shows assigned reconnaissance missions to find the enemy by the lead platoon. Combined techniques through the use the search-and-attack technique by the lead platoon and the rest of the unit using the approach-march technique is a good option. The formation and movement technique for the main body will vary but generally applies the fundamentals for the approach-march technique.

The Search and Attack Technique

0447. The search and attack technique is a decentralized technique which makes use of small-unit (squad/platoon), coordinated and multiple actions in finding the enemy. When the company makes contact while not being detected by an enemy, the CO has to take the initiative. It is the CO that has the option in destroying the enemy with the available combat potential, maneuvering the rest of the company to destroy the enemy or follow an enemy back to the base camp and perform destruction. During the planning, the CO may decide how to find an enemy, how to follow or fix the enemy and how to finish him off.

0448. **Concept Development.** The process of concept development applies for the search and attack technique. Primarily, the decisive points are recognized as the most probable enemy locations. When the enemy has been located, the decisive point has to

be identified as with any attack. Also, a concept for generating the overwhelming combat power must be developed. The initial concept has to include actions in finishing the enemy force immediately after they are located. There are times when the part of the plan may appear to be very general or may only consist of control measures as well as be-prepared missions that will provide flexibility. The manner supports the quick issuance of the FRAGOS.

a. The CO has to understand the concept of the battalion commander as well as what freedom of action the company has in engaging the enemy. There are times when the company has to engage as well as destroy all the enemies within their own capabilities. However, there are other cases when the company will be expected to follow, locate as well as report the small enemy units in order to enable the battalion to concentrate and destroy the forces.

b. The CO has to focus the squads or platoons on the probable enemy locations. He is able to assign the missions IAW based on the concept of the battalion commander. Some possible tasks include an area or zone reconnaissance, surveillance, or an ambush. The small-unit leaders have to know the specific actions to take should they locate an enemy with or without detection. Platoons that are more likely to make the contact are commonly assigned the main effort.

0449. **Considerations.** The determination of the size and the number of units that will conduct reconnaissance and combat operations against the enemy is done by the CO. The following must be considered:

a. Size of the area

b. The duration of the mission

c. The soldier's load

d. The probable size of the enemy force is a key to this decision.

0450. The **size of the area** of operations is considered in relation to how much time is available to search the area. When allocating terrain, the CO must consider how the platoons will conduct the reconnaissance, how to provide security, and how to provide control.

a. One technique is to assign small AOs that keep the platoons more concentrated and help maintain control. The platoons are directed to move into the next AO on order.

b. Another technique is to divide the company area into zones. The CO concentrates most of the company in one zone and uses small team or squad patrols to reconnoitre the next zone or the rest of the area. Once the company (-) has completed the reconnaissance in the initial zone, it moves into the area that has been reconnoitred by the small units. This technique is effective when a detailed reconnaissance is required but also supports the seizure of the initiative through speed, stealth, and surprise. The small, dispersed units have a better chance of locating the enemy undetected. They also provide initial

reconnaissance information for the CO to focus the remainder of the company's reconnaissance efforts.

0461. The CO must consider how **the duration of the mission** affects the company's ability to conduct continued operations. If the mission will continue for days or longer, the CO must develop a concept that allows his subordinates to maintain combat effectiveness. The concept must address the use of patrol bases and limited visibility operations.

0462. The CO must ensure that the concept provides sufficient rest to maintain his soldiers' stealth, alertness, and security. The duration of the mission will also affect **the soldier's load**. The longer the mission is expected to last, the heavier the soldiers' loads may get to reduce the need for re-supply. The soldier's load has a tremendous impact on a search-and-attack mission. The ability to move with stealth and security while close to the enemy is hindered by heavy loads. But, resupply operations may also hinder the company's operation and allow the enemy to locate the unit by following or observing the resupply vehicles.

a. The CO must determine what the essential requirements are for the soldiers' loads. If this results in excessive loads, he plans for resupply operations that avoid enemy detection and maintain the security of the company.

b. The CO may combine techniques to reduce the risk of moving with these heavy loads. He identifies ORPs or company patrol bases throughout the AO, and the company moves between these ORPs using the approach-march technique to provide greater control and security. After securing and occupying the ORP, the platoons leave their rucksacks and move out to conduct decentralized search-and-attack operations. A security force secures the ORP until the units return to get their rucksacks and move to the next ORP. Platoons can use this same technique when the risk is acceptable.

0463. **The size of the enemy units** that the company is likely to make contact with will assist the CO in determining the risk to the company. The CO must also consider the enemy's capabilities and likely COA. The specific enemy weapons capabilities are keys to understanding the threat. The CO must consider these as he develops his concept to ensure the security of his company even when conducting decentralized operations. The CO may direct specific force protection restraints such as no patrols smaller than a squad, or platoons must be able to consolidate within 20 minutes, or platoons will depart their patrol bases NLT 60 minutes prior to BMNT.

0464. **Find the Enemy.** During this phase of operation, the focus is on locating the enemy through reconnaissance. Generally, small units that are capable of moving quickly and with stealth are more likely to locate the enemy without detection. The CO's concept may restrict the platoon's authority to destroy the enemy once located. It may be more important to locate and follow enemy units to identify their base camps. When not restricted, the unit making contact takes immediate action to destroy the enemy. If it is not within this unit's capabilities, the platoon may conduct linkups to mass sufficient combat potential and to coordinate the attack together with indirect fire support integrated into the attack.

a. Normally, platoons receive a mission by stating specific concept. His concept must also address the actions to destroy the enemy. Specific tasking may include route, area, and zone reconnaissance or surveillance tasks. Platoons may be tasked to be prepared to conduct an attack on enemy forces, provide security for another force or to act as the company reserve.

b. During limited visibility, reconnaissance is more difficult and dangerous. If a unit comes in contact with the enemy while in the dark, conducting a hasty attack proves to be very risky. Reconnaissance is also considered less effective in the dark since the units are unable to detect signs of activity from the enemy. Nevertheless, the unit may be able to detect the enemy by sight or smell. Route and small-area reconnaissance tasks are more effective for limited visibility.

c. Ambushes are also effective during limited visibility. The enemy may avoid daylight movements once aware of the presence of the company in the AO. Ambushes should be set up on the probable routes of the enemy. Patrol bases must integrate OPS and ambushes in their security plans. Such tasks support seizure and maintenance of the initiative.

0465. **Fix and Finish the Enemy**. These search and attack phases are closely related. An initial attempt to finish the enemy may become the fixing effort for the attack if the enemy proves to be too strong for the platoon. When the authority to conduct offensive actions has been decentralized, the fundamentals of an attack apply at every echelon. The following are considered:

a. Achieve surprise

b. Limit the enemy's freedom of action

c. Maintain security

d. Concentrate combat power

0466. **Achieve Surprise**. Locate the enemy without being detected. This allows more time to plan and coordinate the attack. Once detected, speed and violence in the assault may also achieve surprise, but this will rarely be true against a prepared enemy defense.

0467. **Limit the enemy's freedom of action**. Suppressing weapons systems, obscuring vision, disrupting command and control together with fixing the enemy in position and blocking routes of escape with maneuver forces or indirect fires must be done. If the unit in contact has insufficient combat power in destroying the enemy, the leader must focus on reconnoitring to support the attack by the next higher echelon.

0468. **Maintain Security**. While taking actions against the enemy--the enemy is doing the same thing. The identified enemy may have mutually supporting units so it is unwise to assume that the enemy is alone. The flank attack of one enemy position may move through another unit's kill zone or the maneuver may uncover the flank of the assault force to fires from hidden positions.

0469. **Concentrate combat power**. Once contact is made, the plan must support the concentration of combat power to destroy enemy. Leaders at the echelon plan have to destroy the enemy within their capacity. The small units' combat potential may increase by request of fire support.

a. The CO may allot a portion of the company in reserve to react to enemy contact. However, when the company is dispersed, this company reserve may not be as responsive. It may be more effective for the platoon to maintain its reserve.

b. If the platoon cannot destroy the enemy, the CO determines enemy containment while concentrating on dispersed combat potential. He creates an attack plan in destroying enemy force. He may utilize the fixing force to support by fire, and assault with other platoon(s). He may also utilize artillery and CAS to complete enemy destruction.

c. The leaders must report the reconnaissance results to support the CO's planning. They have to recommend support positions that are effective, good assault positions and enemy weak points. The leader of the unit in contact should also recognize good linkup points if the pre-planned points are not effective. The leader should coordinate face to face with the CO prior to initiating any assault.

0470. **Follow the Enemy**. When locating enemy's base camps is the operation's key purpose, the company concept must avoid small units' non-decisive fights. When small enemy units are found, the units report and track these units back to base camps. Well-trained trackers may follow enemy tracks that are days or hours old. The CO must ensure that his concept does not risk the security of force while ensuring undetected contact and tracking enemy units. Units tracking the enemy must be ready to react to enemy contact. It is possible to track enemy's movement through the AO through the use of stationary OPs as trail watchers.

0471. **Enter the Area of Operations**. The CO also decides how the company will enter its area of operations, how to move, where to locate units and what the contingency plan requirements are. This includes establishing proper graphic control measures to control unit movement, providing linkups between units, and supporting combat power concentration. It also includes synchronizing the actions of the company and providing specific tasks or restraints to ensure subordinates understand what actions should be taken once contact with the enemy is made.

a. The company may enter the area or zone by moving as a company (Figure 4.9) and then splitting up, by air assault, or by infiltrating squads and platoons (Figure 4.10).

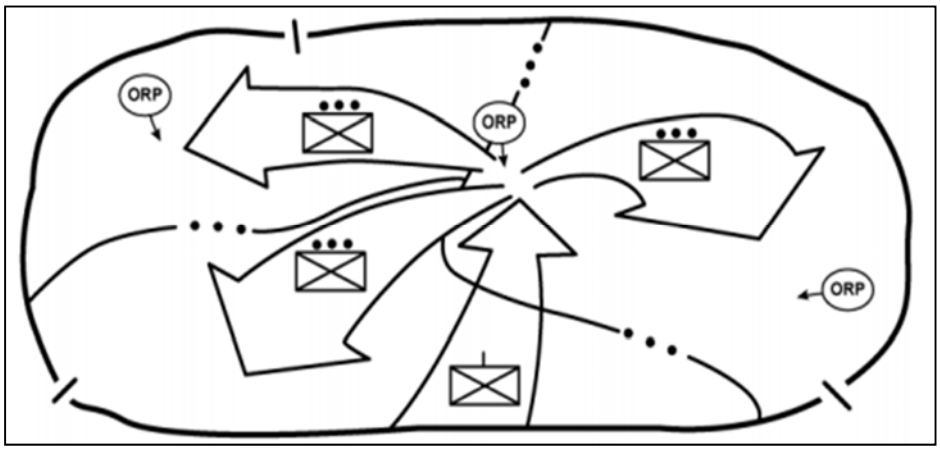


Figure 4.9 - Entry by Company

b. Movement within the area or through the zone of attack may be conducted by the entire company or by individual platoons. Figure 4.11 shows a concept sketch for a search-and-attack conducted without a company linkup.

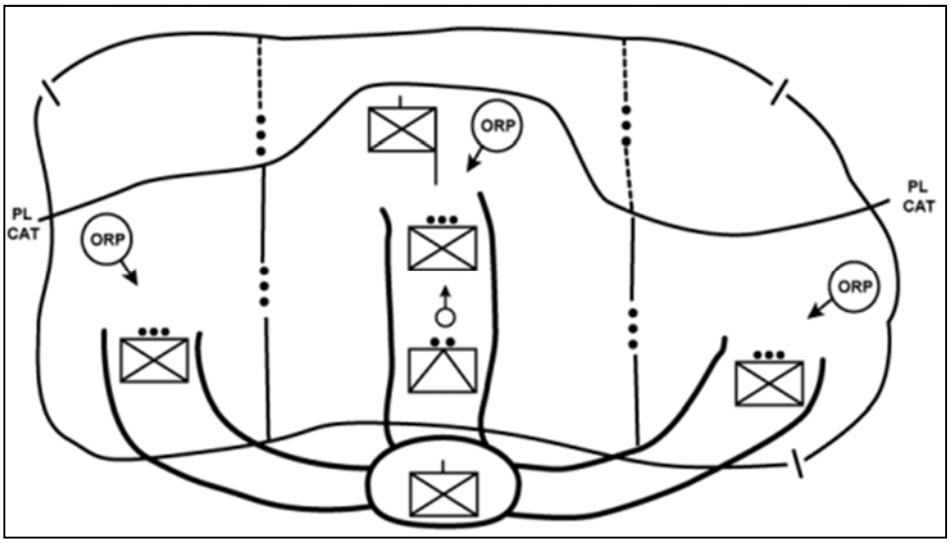


Figure 4.10 - Infiltrations by Squad/Platoon.

c. The CO must decide where the company CP will be. It may collocate with the main effort platoon, or it may position itself in a central location where it can communicate with and move quickly to each platoon's location. A technique to support CONOPS is to rotate a reserve platoon each day to provide security for the CP and the company mortars. Each platoon spends only 48 hours actively searching for the enemy and then rotates into the reserve role. This should prevent a serious degradation in effectiveness due to sleep loss.

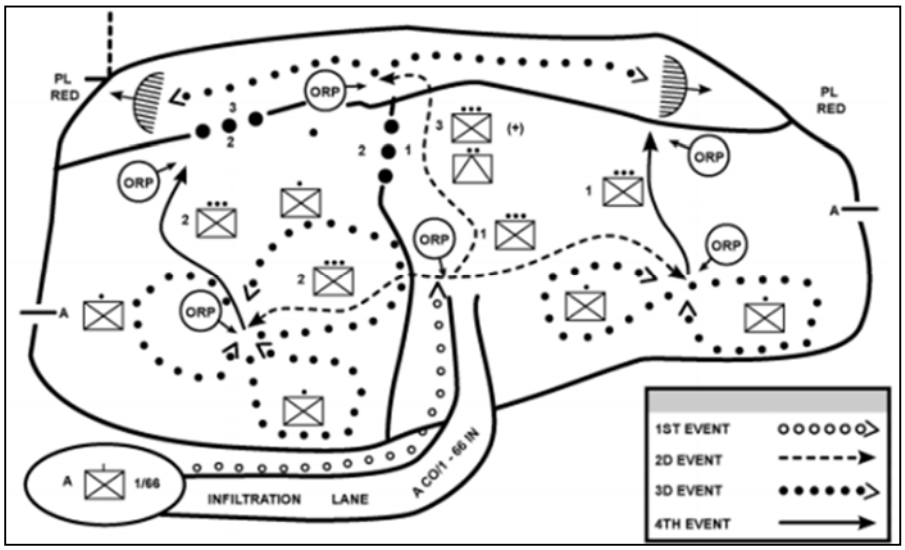


Figure 4.11 - Company Search-and-Attack Concept Sketch

d. Company mortars must be located where they have security and can support the platoons. The CO may co-locate them with the company CP. The movement of their ammunition is the most difficult challenge. The CO may direct the reserve platoon to carry the ammunition to the next firing position. Another option is to establish company ORPs or patrol bases and place the mortars at these locations. The mortar ammunition can then be carried by the entire company; the soldiers drop-off the rounds before moving out to the platoon areas. However, the entire company must return to this location before continuing the operation through the zone.

e. The threat of enemy armor and the soldier's load are two primary considerations for employing the anti-armor assets. If there is an armored threat, then the CO must decide where to position the anti-armor weapons. The company anti-armor assets normally will be attached to the platoons.

f. Contingency plans may include actions in case one platoon becomes decisively engaged or in case the company receives a new mission. All units should routinely report possible LZ/PZ locations, mortar firing positions, any sign of recent enemy activity, and any sightings of civilians in the area.

The Approach-March Technique

0472. The company normally uses this technique when it is conducting a movement to contact as part of the battalion. The Rifle Company can be tasked to act as the advanced guard, to move as part of the battalion main body, or to provide flank or rear guards for the battalion, depending on its location in the formation and its assigned mission.

0473. When planning for an approach-march movement to contact, the CO needs certain information from the battalion commander. As a minimum, he needs to know:

a. The company’s mission.

b. The friendly and enemy situations.

c. The route (axis of advance) and the desired rate of movement.

d. The control measures to be used.

e. The attachments (engineers, etc.).

f. The company's actions on contact.

g. The fire support plan.

h. The company's actions upon reaching the march objective, if one is used.

i. With this information, the CO develops his scheme of maneuver and fire support plan. He provides this same information to the platoon leaders.

0474. The battalion may conduct a movement to contact on a single axis or on multiple axes. The lead company (advance guard) on an axis is responsible for the following:

a. To protect the battalion from a surprise attack by providing early warning of enemy positions and obstacles.

b. To assist the forward movement of the battalion by removing obstacles or finding routes around them.

c. To destroy enemy forces (within its capability).

d. To rapidly develop the situation once contact is made.

0475. The lead company or advanced guard on an axis moves using traveling over-watch or bounding over-watch, depending on the situation. It is normally assigned an axis of advance or a zone of action and a march objective on which to orient its movement. Phase lines and checkpoints may also be used to help control movement.

0476. The CO selects the movement technique and formation based on the likelihood of enemy contact and the speed of movement desired by the battalion commander. Bounding over-watch provides the best security; but, traveling over-watch is faster. If traveling over-watch is used by the company, the lead platoon may use bounding over-watch for added security.

0477. The CO must retain the freedom to maneuver his platoons and weapons. He analyses the terrain, anticipates where he might make contact, and plans fires on those locations. He should avoid terrain, such as draws, ravines, narrow trails, and steep slopes that will restrict maneuver.

0478. When not in the lead, the company uses traveling or traveling over-watch. It must be ready to fire or maneuver in support of the lead company, or to assume the lead company's mission.

0479. Once contact is made with the enemy, the CO maintains that contact until ordered to do otherwise by the battalion commander. The following actions must take place at once:

a. Return fire, deploy, and report.

b. The squad or platoon that initially received direct fire immediately executes the attack drill.

c. Upon receipt of this information, the CO determines the proper action to be taken.

0480. **Return fire, deploy, and report**. The platoon in contact returns fire at once and takes cover when contact is made. The maneuver to a position of advantage should be done to maintain the element of surprise, especially if the enemy is unaware. Thus, the platoon making contact reports and deploys to prevent detection until preparation for the hasty attack is completed.

0481. **The squad or platoon that initially received direct fire immediately executes the attack drill**. Rapidly seizing the initiative at the lowest echelon possible with aggressive small-unit actions and achieving fire superiority to fix or suppress the enemy with the resources that are immediately available, are top priorities.

0482. **Upon receipt of this information, the CO determines the proper action to be taken.** He (or the XO) also reports the situation to battalion. The CO may conduct or direct his units to conduct additional reconnaissance. The company FSO should be requesting or coordinating indirect rates to support the company’s maneuver. The actions may be to:

a. **Conduct a Hasty Attack.** If the CO feels he can defeat the enemy force and an attack supports the battalion commander's concept, he quickly conducts a hasty attack before the enemy can react.

b. **Bypass the Enemy**. The CO, with battalion permission, may bypass an enemy force. He may bypass the enemy with one platoon at a time or with the entire company at once (Figure 4.12). Or, he may be directed to fix or suppress the enemy while the battalion bypasses. Indirect fires are also used to suppress the enemy. When the company has suppressed the enemy, the battalion commander may order the company to disengage and re-join the battalion, or hand-off the enemy to a following unit.

c. **Fix and Suppress the Enemy**. When the enemy cannot be bypassed and a hasty attack by the company would be too costly, the battalion will normally have the company fix and suppress the enemy (Figure 4.13). This ensures that he does not have the freedom to fire or maneuver against the main body of the battalion while it moves to attack the enemy. The CO supports the battalion commander's planning by reconnoitring to identify the enemy's disposition, strengths, and weakness. Covered and concealed routes, good support positions, and enemy obstacles are also identified and reported to battalion.

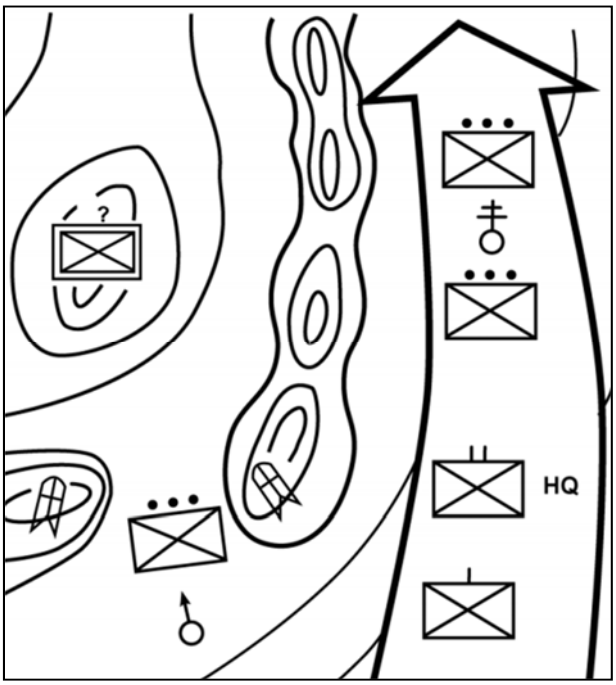


Figure 4.12 - Bypass

d. **Establish a Hasty Defense**. Although this action tends to give the initiative to the enemy force, it might provide a needed advantage. This might be required in a meeting engagement with a superior force. The company may establish a hasty defense to protect itself while the remainder of the battalion is maneuvering against the enemy.

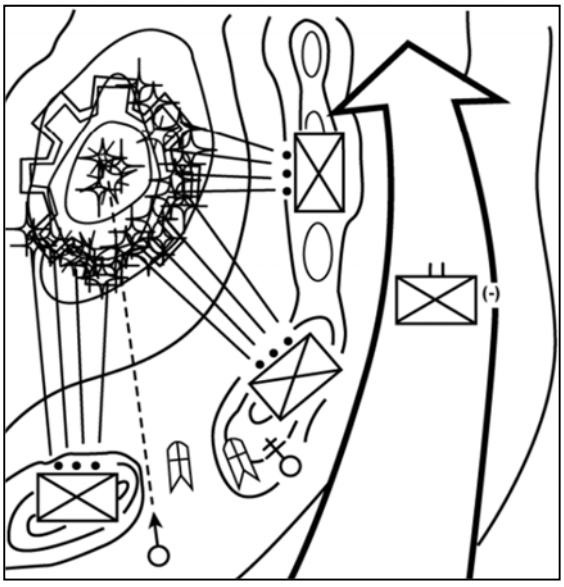


Figure 4.13 - Fix and Suppress

e. **Disengage**. This action is not a preferred option unless disengaging is the only way to ensure preservation of the force. Use of indirect fires and bounding/over-watch elements are essential in disengaging from a superior force. The company

may disengage while another unit maintains contact or the company may disengage by moving back through the battalion to draw the enemy into an ambush.

Attacks

0483. The company may conduct attacks independently or as part of the battalion. An attack may be either hasty or deliberate. Because of the difficulties with fire control, navigation, and identification of friendly and enemy soldiers, limited visibility attacks are normally deliberate attacks requiring detailed reconnaissance and planning. Upon receiving of the battalion warning order, the CO starts his troop-leading procedure and begins his planning.

Types of Attack

0484. The infantry rifle company attacks as part of any operation. The following are the types of attack:

a. **Hasty Attack**. The CO may conduct a hasty attack when the company makes contact with an enemy force to deploy, suppress the enemy, attack through a gap, flank, or weak point and report to the commander. As a result of a movement to contact, a meeting engagement, or a chance contact during movement, the company may conduct hasty attacks.

b. **Deliberate Attack**. This is normally coordinated as part of a battalion attack and conducted when the enemy is in well-prepared defensive positions or when a hasty attack is not possible. This has the same principles as hasty and deliberate attacks. The difference lies in the amount of planning, reconnoitring, coordinating, and preparing prior to execution.

c. **Raids**. A raid is a surprise attack that includes a planned withdrawal from the objective.

d. **Ambushes**. These are surprise attacks against moving or temporarily halted enemy units. Infantry companies may conduct ambushes as part of offensive and defensive operations.

e. **Spoiling Attack**. This is a limited-objective attack made to delay, disrupt, or destroy the enemy's capability to attack.

f. **Counterattack**. This is an attack by defensive forces to regain the initiative or to deny the enemy success with his attack.

0485. **Offensive Concept Development.** The restated mission statement and the other critical facts and deductions provide the focus for developing the offensive concept. The following considerations apply:

a. **Begin Developing the Concept at the Decisive Point on the Objective and Work Backward to the LD.** First consider the decisive action on the objective. Then consider (as required) the conduct of the breach, the positioning of the

support, assault, and security elements, the leader's reconnaissance, the occupation of the ORP, and the maneuver from the company's current location to the assault position. Once the CO has identified his potential decisive point(s), he develops his concept.

b. **Determine Decisive Points and Times to Focus Combat Power.** The battalion commander's concept and tasking for the company may focus on a very specific decisive point and time. This is most likely when the company is the battalion's main effort. For example, the company may be tasked to conduct the main attack for the battalion's attack. In this case, the company decisive point will be somewhere in the vicinity of the objective (key terrain, a critical enemy position, or the enemy CP), and the CO's concept will seek to generate maximum combat power here to accomplish his mission.

c. **Critical Actions.** In the offense, series of critical actions must be accomplished for the company to complete mission. For instance, the reconnaissance has to locate the position of the enemy and recognize defensive schemes to identify weak points at which to conduct the breach. Then the breach element must successfully breach the enemy's obstacles to allow the assault element to maneuver into the objective. The assault element must achieve success at decisive point.

d. **Designation of the Decisive Operations.** In developing a concept, the CO identifies the critical actions, decisive locations and times they will be accomplished. The subordinate unit tasked to accomplish these actions is designated the main effort. The subordinate unit that is assigned the final critical action which accomplishes the company's mission, is designated the main attack.

e. **Shift and Concentration of Combat Potential**. The CO must identify critical actions and decide when to shift the main effort. His concept must support the success of each. Proper planning and execution results in a synchronized operation that concentrates combat power at decisive points. The effect on the enemy is loss of combat potential. The following considerations apply: 1) Determine the results that must be achieved at these decisive point(s) to accomplish the mission. The purpose of the mission statement states the desired results for the main attack. During decentralized operations, the CO must analyse the situation closely to determine desired results. 2) Determine the purposes to be achieved by the main and supporting efforts throughout the operation. The supporting purposes must be linked to the main effort's assigned purpose. The CO must avoid employing main attack to support a prior main effort because of the risk of not having sufficient combat potential available in the main attack at a decisive point.

f. **The Decisive Operations' Purpose**. It is often the purpose from the company's mission statement. At times, the company's purpose must be modified to be appropriate for the main attack platoon. It must be clear that main attack's success results in company's success.

g. **The Supporting Effort's Purposes**. These are selected to allow the main effort to maneuver on the objective, support the main effort's success, allow the breach element to breach obstacles, and prevent surprise on the main body. The focus is on decisive action by the main attack in the objective area, supporting attacks, reconnaissance and security requirements, and the need for a reserve must also be addressed.

h. **When linked with the purpose, a clearly defined, attainable, and decisive mission statement is assigned.** The mission should clearly focus the subordinate unit on the terrain, the enemy, or a friendly unit.

i. **Position the main and supporting attacks to concentrate combat power at the decisive point. Identify reconnaissance and security requirements.** Consider the need for a reserve or other means to provide flexibility.

j. **Task-organize units (platoons and sections) to accomplish the identified missions.** When particularly under strength, the CO may have to task-organize below squad level (size of range from a squad to a reinforced platoon) or to specific weapons or equipment. Modifications may be done if there are insufficient resources to ensure that each of the supporting effort missions is attainable.

k. **Assign command and control headquarters for each of the task-organized units.** The following must be applied in doing so: 1) All platoon or section leaders should be used fully. If additional leaders are required, the XO, F/SGT, company FSO, and other company leaders are used. 2) When no senior leader is available, the senior squad leader maybe the unit leader. Or if the company has a one squad reserve, it may be led by its assigned squad leader.

l. **Complete a task organization by assigning all organic or attached units; of particular concern may be the FOs, medics, and other attachments.** They should be attached to the unit where their unique capabilities are most effectively employed or possibly where they provide the most flexibility.

m. **Establish control measures that clarify and support the accomplishment of the assigned mission.** These are the following: 1) Time events and use control measures (axis, boundaries, DOA, assault positions, support positions, objectives, etc.) to synchronize subordinate actions without stifling initiative. 2) Certain control measures may be required to provide additional safety for the unit. These may include fire control measures, procedures, special signals or markings to ensure understanding.

n. **Weight the decisive operations**. The focus of this next phase in the concept development is to ensure the main effort is weighted. The CO can weigh the decisive operations in many different ways. Some examples include: 1) Attaching additional squads/weapons. 2) Assigning priority of fires or allocating a priority target. 3) Assigning priority of any support (CS/CSS), such as 1st in priority for engineer support. 4) Limiting the main effort's area of responsibility to allow this unit to focus on the critical action. For example, tasking supporting efforts to provide security for the main effort. 5) Locating

other resources in the vicinity of the main effort that support the main effort's focus on the decisive action. 6) Providing additional time to prepare, rehearse, or conduct reconnaissance

o. **Complete the offensive concept**. This can be done by the following actions: 1) **Complete the movement plan.** This should address the movement of the entire unit from its present location(s) through its eventual consolidation. Likely COAs for exploitation should also be considered. Routes, order of movement, timings, and the requirements for security and control must also be considered and addressed as appropriate. 2) **Completing the reconnaissance and security plan.** The R&S requirements at the objective may be complete, but the CO must consider these requirements throughout the mission. What are the security requirements during movement, in the ORP, during consolidation? The company's reconnaissance effort must be focused on the decisive action, but it may also include reconnaissance of all routes, danger areas, key terrain, or other locations that may be critical to the mission. The CO then prioritizes these requirements and tasks units to accomplish them. 3) **Completing the fire plan.** The CO plans both direct and indirect fires in detail, as required by the situation. The fire planning must address all phases of the attack to include the approach into the objective area, the actions on the objective, any contingency missions, and the consolidation plan. At times, the situation may require less planning at company level and more at the platoon level. Platoon leaders routinely coordinate their fire plans. 4) **Developing the SS operations plan.** The CO must plan for casualty evacuation, resupply, and movement of rucksacks or other equipment. The CO also plans for the supplies and equipment needed to support the attack and subsequent operations. He always considers the impact of soldier's load on the mission and normally provides additional instructions to ensure the soldiers carry only what are required. He may also plan for transportation of the items normally maintained in the battalion trains so he can maintain the momentum of the attack or prepare a defense against an enemy counterattack. 5) **Planning likely contingencies.** The CO must plan ahead for any possibilities, such as his actions in the event of detection during an infiltration or in the event of an increased threat of chemical attack by the enemy.

0486. **Actions on the Objective.** The commander's concept, in every case affects the company's actions on the objective. The decisive point on the objective is where the concept is developed. Other considerations that must be included for the actions on the objective, such as the following is determined by the commander's estimate will:

a. **Determine Critical Actions in the Objective.** These actions may include breaching enemy obstacles, destroying bunkers, clearing trench lines searching EPWS, treating/evacuating casualties, providing supporting fires, and many other tasks.

b. **Assigns Tasks and Resources.** To complete his concept, the commander must ensure that he understands what must occur on the objective for the company to accomplish its mission. He then assigns tasks and allocates resources to complete these. He must determine how much detail is required to control and synchronize the actions of his subordinates. These measures should be kept as

simple as possible.

c. **Detailed Control.** The amount of control required will vary based on the situation. As in any operation, the minimum essential control measures should be used. Control is provided by the units' relationship to the main attack. This method of control has the best chance of being effective once the fight begins: 1) Effective reconnaissance also provides control by ensuring leaders understand the situation and the terrain's effect on their unit during execution; and, 2) Rehearsals are an excellent means of ensuring control during execution. Full-scale rehearsals are essential to successful, deliberate attacks. They also support synchronization.

d. **Synchronization of Actions.** This is also provided through the relationships to the main attack. If the support element clearly understands the commander's intent, they are more likely to provide effective support. As an example, the mortar section can move, initiate fire, or lift or shift fires based on the actions of the main effort; and in a similar manner, the reserve can move and or reposition based upon the actions of the main effort.

0487. The action on an assault's objective against the enemy strongpoint is a good model to use given that the considerations and fundamentals for the operation may apply to the other objectives of the Company.

0488. **Reorganization.** This is referred to as the reorganization of the squads, sections and platoons in continuing operations. This is an uninterrupted process and must be part of the SOP of the company. In times of reorganization, every platoon leader has to report the ammunition status, location, casualties and situation to the CO. It is the CO that reports the same thing to the battalion. The ammunitions are redistributed and the units are resupplied. Casualties are then evacuated and treated. The key positions are occupied (both weapons and leaders). The prisoners are managed and sent to the collecting points while the enemy material and information are collected as well as reported. The company will always reorganize after an attack, but it may not always consolidate.

0489. **Consolidation**. Consolidation refers to the positioning and organizing of weapons and platoons on newly seized objective in order to defend against the counterattack. The CO must always plan for consolidation after an attack. It is possible for a company not to consolidate especially if it failed to achieve its assigned purpose and if the company has an opportunity as well as the combat potential in exploiting a successful attack within the battalion concept's framework. The following considerations apply:

a. It is also the CO that decides whether or not the situation or the mission requires the company to consolidate the objective. If not, the CO may direct the company to consolidate on adjacent terrain or to withdraw to the ORP. There are also disadvantages in consolidating the objective which include mainly the enemy's knowledge of the terrain as well as the fact that a counterattack or an indirect fire may have already been planned on it.

b. The planning considerations for consolidation are similar to a perimeter defense.

It is the CO that assigns one sector of the objective of the company for each platoon to perform the consolidation. The CO locates every subordinate. In addition, the CO identifies the main effort and the reserve. He makes sure that all the units are aware of their locations and specific responsibilities. He also integrates all supporting assets in the defense. When the time becomes limited, the CO can either use the terrain feature method or the clock method for consolidation such as: 1) Clock Method. The CO divides the objective into hour segments like a clock (Figure 4.14). Twelve o'clock is either a compass heading or the direction of the enemy. He then assigns each platoon a sector by hour segments; and, 2) Terrain Feature Method. The CO gives each platoon two easily identifiable terrain features as the right and left limits of its sector/BP (Figure 4.15).

0490. During consolidation, security is established (OPs and security patrols). Platoons and weapons crews are positioned to cover the most likely avenues of approach. Fields of fire are cleared, and fighting positions are prepared. Combat service support elements are moved forward, and casualties and EPWs are evacuated. Other reorganization actions also occur. Indirect fires are coordinated and FPFs are adjusted.

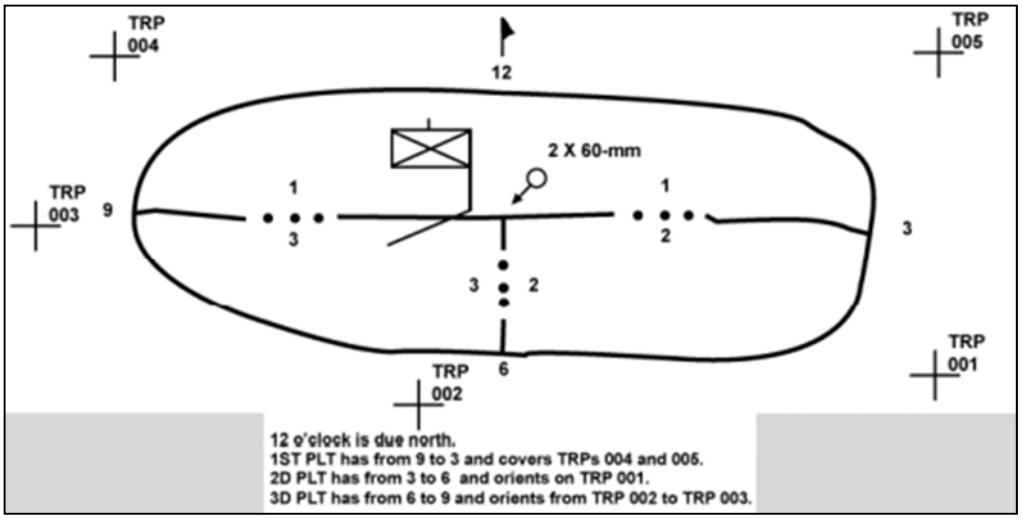


Figure 4.14 - Clock Method

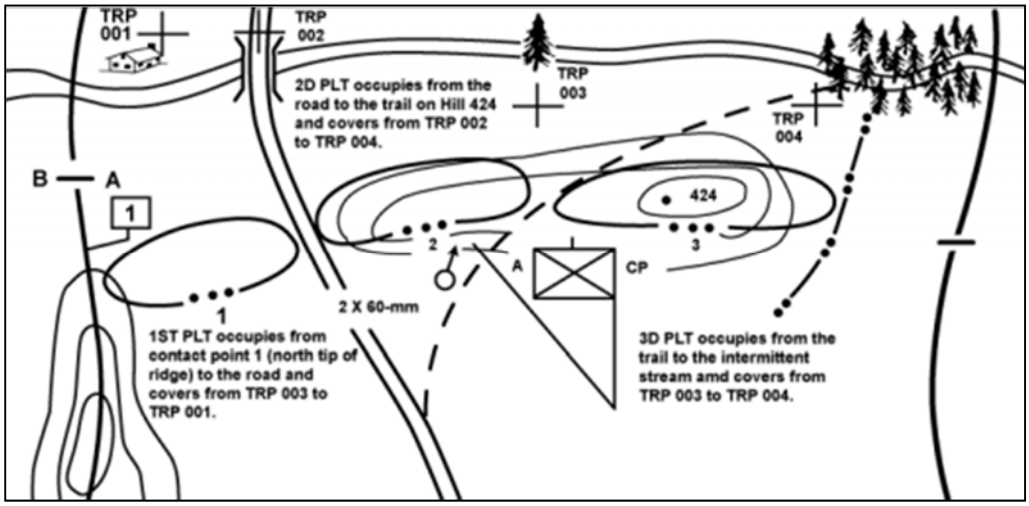


Figure 4.15 - Terrain Feature Method

Fire Support

0491. This plan is developed at the same time as the scheme of maneuver. The FSO integrates the indirect fires, based on the CO's guidance, to support the company's maneuver throughout the operation. The desired outcome is to ensure that all available indirect fires are synchronized to have the greatest effect on the enemy. This requires that the pre-planned targets are correctly positioned; that the best weapon engages each target using the proper shell/fuse combination, and that the responsibility for firing the target is assigned to the observer who is in the right location and understands how this target is synchronized to support the maneuver.

0492. The fire planning normally begins at levels above the company. When the company FSO begins his planning, he normally has the battalion's target list, the battalion's priority of fires and the allocation of priority targets, and the commanders' guidance for employing the indirect fire assets.

0493. The company fire planning is a continuation of the process that begun at the battalion level. The company FSO or CO designates additional targets, establishes a company priority of fires, and either directs priority targets or allocates this resource to the platoons.

Phases of Fire Support

0494. Fires are planned to support all phases of the attack:

a. The approach

b. The deployment into the assault, support and security positions

c. The isolation of the entire objective and the breach site

d. The assault

e. The consolidation/exploitation

Elements of Fire Support

0495. Targets are planned on all known or suspected enemy locations. They may also be planned on likely avenues of approach or on prominent terrain features to provide flexibility. The elements are the following: Purpose; Priority of fires; Priority targets; Firing locations; Control Measures.

0496. **Purpose.** Indirect fire is planned to suppress, obscure, neutralize, destroy, deceive, or disrupt enemy forces. Smoke or WP is used to screen the company when moving across danger areas or when breaching obstacles. It can be used also to isolate the objective by disrupting any reinforcing or counterattacking forces.

0497. **Priority of Fires**. A priority of fires is set for the company to resolve conflicts in the event two units call for fire at the same time. A different priority may be set for each supporting indirect system. For example, priority for artillery fires is: 1st PLTN, 2nd PLTN, 3rd PLTN; priority for mortar fires is 2nd PLTN, 1st PLTN, and 3rd PLTN.

0498. **Priority Targets.** Critical targets are the first priority for engagement or the CO may either decide which target(s) will be designated as priority targets. He allocates this resource to one of his platoons for planning.

0499. The suppression of the enemy weapon systems on the objective during the assault is normally the most critical aspect of the company fire planning. The CO must decide (if not directed by battalion) when (or if to initiate the indirect fires on the objective). If the company is detected, these fires may have to begin earlier than planned. He must also decide when to shift the indirect fires to prevent friendly casualties. This will depend on the gun-target line, the accuracy of the firing system, the bursting radius of the round, and the ability of the direct-fire weapons to suppress the enemy. Generally, CAS or artillery will have to be shifted earlier than 81mm or 60mm mortars.

04100. **Firing Locations**. The location for the company mortars are selected during the fire planning. Considerations include:

a. Maximum effective range;

b. Desired gun-target line;

c. Movement or transportation of mortar ammunition; and

d. Control and security requirements: 1) If the mortars will be able to support the attack from its present location or from the position near an LD, this may certainly reduce the problem on ammunition transportation. They may also be able to acquire support from the ORP. The advantage from the location is that despite the fact that the ammunition is to be carried forward, extra movement to bring it to the firing position was not required. Also, the personnel that secure the ORP may provide security to the mortars. Some disadvantages of these include the fact that the ORP location is compromised because of the mortar

firing; also, the mortars may probably fire through the use of an FDC instead of the direct alignment or direct lay mode; and, 2) Another option involves collocating the mortars with support element. This commonly requires an extra movement for the ammunition; however, the security and control of the mortars is improved in this manner. It is also more likely that they can employ direct lay since the support position has line of sight to the objective.

04101. **Control Measures**. It is the job of the CO to ensure that the company's fire plan is supported with the proper control measures. These responsibilities need to be understood clearly. Visual signals should be established to communicate critical actions, such as to initiate, cease, or shift indirect fires.

Attack Techniques

04102. The attack on the enemy strongpoint as well as limitations on visibility attack are considered two of the most demanding attacks that a rifle company can conduct. The techniques and fundamentals tackled in the section may assist the CO in preparing, planning and performing all the attacks.

Assault on a Strongpoint

04103. The hardest objective for the dismounted force involves seizing or clearing the enemy strongpoint complete with the fortifications and obstacles. The CO may employ techniques that will avoid direct attacks on the main strength of the enemy; instead, he may try to determine and attack a specific weakness in its defense. The CO may deceive an enemy to the point of the main attack. He may use surprise to take advantage of the initiative in identifying the place and time for the attack. He attempts to use the indirect approach to strike the enemy on exposed flanks or the rear.

04104. A deliberate attack of a strongpoint is usually conducted in the following phases:

a. **Reconnoiter the Objective and Develop the Concept**. The CO may either recon the objective or enables someone to do it. The recon must identify the positions in the objective (vehicles, C2 locations and crew-served weapons), defense gaps, level of preparation as well as the other potential weaknesses. The recon should be followed by keeping eyes on the objective to ensure the CO is informed of any change in the enemy situation. This action is done as follows: 1) **Organize the Reconnaissance Element then Conduct the Reconnaissance**. The reconnaissance may be performed in various ways. One effective technique is to task-organize the different leaders from the support, breach elements and assault and form a reconnaissance patrol. There has to be sufficient personnel in order to establish the objective's surveillance as well as secure the ORP. The reconnaissance patrol may either return to the location of the company or meet the company in a designated linkup point with the aim of guiding them into the ORP. There are times when the scout platoon and the other battalion assets will be tasked to conduct reconnaissance to support the mission of the company; 2) **Task Organize Units**. Once the CO has developed the concept, he may task-organize the unit into the breach element, assault element and support element. This may also possibly involve a reserve. The

reserve normally is under the CO's control and is placed in a position where the success of an attack may be best exploited. It can also increase combat power when necessary. The reserve must not be that close such that it loses the flexibility during an assault. The reserve leader has to know the place he will locate during the attack. The task organization for an assault usually consists of: a). *The Breaching Force.* A breach force is normally formed around the Infantry unit. The engineers, when they are available, are all part of the breaching element. Any mechanical or explosive breaching assets are also attached to this element. The breach force will be making the initial breach and enable the assault element to pass through. It may have to organize its own assault element (to secure the breach), support element (to provide close-in suppression), and breach element (to actually breach the obstacles). The following considerations are applied: b). The Breach Support Force. The support element is typically organized in order to provide the supporting direct or indirect fires, initially to the breach element and then afterwards, to the assault element. The support element commonly consists of the machine gun teams, the Infantry squads, the M203 gunners, the anti-armor section and the 60mm mortar section. Their primary responsibility is to suppress the enemy that can engage the breach element, and to isolate the breach site from enemy reinforcement. c). The Assault Force. This is commonly comprised of one or two Infantry platoons, (depending on the situation of the enemy, level of preparation, complexity of fortifications and the number of personnel), the composition and size of the breach as well as the support elements. The team may be required to breach the enemy obstacles on its objective to determine the best task organization for the whole mission.

b. **Movement to the Objective.** Figure 4.16 shows the phases of the attack. The company approaches the objective in a manner, which supports its deployment prior to the assault. The following are the fundamental phases of the attack: **1) Movement from Assembly Area to Line of Departure (AA/LD)**. The movement from the AA to the LD is timed so the movement to and across the LD is continuous. The lead element of the company starts crossing the LD at the attack time specified in the battalion OPORD. Before the company's movement, a patrol may be sent to reconnoitre and mark the route and check the time it takes to move to the LD. The following considerations are applied: a). Movement of the Support Element. The support element may move ahead of the assault and the breach elements to the LD in order to be in an over-watch position ready to fire when they cross the LD. Mortars are moved forward to a firing position near the LD to allow maximum coverage of the objective area. b) Occupation of the Attack Position. The CO avoids stopping in the attack position, but if they are ahead of schedule or told to hold in the attack position, they shall post security and wait until it is time to move or until told to move. **2) During Movement from LD to the Assault Position**. The company makes the best use of cover, concealment, smoke, and supporting fire. The anti-armor section can over-watch from positions that best support the advance of the company. As the company advances, the anti-armor section leader displaces to ensure continuous support, such as the following: a) If the company is hit by indirect fire en route, it moves quickly out of the impact area. If it meets enemy resistance short of the objective, it returns fire at once. The leader of the platoon in contact has his FO call for and adjust indirect fire on the enemy. Depending

on the place and type of resistance and the company plan, the platoon may be ordered to bypass an enemy position that cannot affect the mission. The locations of all bypassed enemy are reported to the CO who, in turn, reports them to the battalion. b). If an enemy position cannot be bypassed, the leader of the platoon in contact and the CO must take prompt and aggressive action. The platoon leader attempts to conduct the platoon attack drill and destroy the enemy position. The CO quickly conducts an estimate of the situation and issues FRAGOs as needed to carry out his plan. He should not commit platoons piecemeal. He coordinates actions and fires so the company will attack the enemy with its full combat power. The CO should maneuver to assault the flank or rear of the enemy position. When the enemy is destroyed/suppressed, the company continues toward its objective. c). Obstacles along the route are either bypassed or breached. The CO must decide the best way to overcome the obstacle without losing momentum. The battalion commander is told of obstacles that may affect units following the company. Engineers are positioned forward to provide a rapid assessment of the obstacle. d) If a support element (from the company) is to be used, it should be positioned before the company's assault element reaches the assault position. The support element initiates its fire on the objective on order or at a specified time. Supporting indirect fires are synchronized to impact at the same time.

c. **Isolate the Objective and the Selected Breach Site**. Normally, the battalion isolates the objective area to allow the company (s) to concentrate its combat potential on the enemy strongpoint (Figure 4.17). The following actions are needed: 1) The company may begin the isolation during the leader's reconnaissance by positioning security elements to prevent enemy movement into or out of the objective area. The CO must ensure that these units understand what actions to take. They may initially just observe and report until the company is deployed for the assault. At a designated time or signal, they begin active measures to isolate the objective. 2) Once the isolation of the objective area is complete, the CO focuses on isolation at the breach point or point of attack. This isolation is to prevent enemy reinforcement at the breach site and also to suppress enemy weapons and positions that have observation of the breach site. The support element is assigned the main responsibility for this isolation. 3) The CO masses all combat power at initial penetration. He uses indirect fires to obscure adjacent enemy positions and isolate them from the breach site.

d. **Attack to Secure a Foothold.** The breach of the enemy position is the company's initial main effort. The breach element penetrates the enemy's protective obstacles, gains foothold in the trench line, and creates gap large enough for the assault element to pass through. The following considerations apply: 1) **Preparations.** In conducting a breach, the unit must execute the following steps: a) Suppress the enemy covering the breach site; b) Obscure the enemy's observation of the breach element with smoke; c) Secure the far side of the breach by seizing terrain or destroying the enemy that engage the breach site; and, d) Reduce the obstacle, mark the lane, and assist passage of the assault elements; 2) **Planning.** In planning breach operations, the following should be considered: a) *Cover and Concealment for the Breach Element*. The breach element moves forward by concealed routes. If possible, the breach should be

covert to reduce the time the breach and assault elements are exposed to enemy fire. If the breaching attempt is compromised, the breach element moves under the suppressive fires of the support element. Pass through figure 18; b) *Penetration along a Narrow Front.* The penetration of the enemy is made on a narrow front. The concept focuses on narrow penetration into enemy defenses and an expansion to allow quick passage of assault element. The company must concentrate combat power at one breach point. Two breach sites may be used if they are mutually supporting and do not result in a piece-meal assault. An alternate site may be planned as a contingency if the primary breach is unsuccessful; c) *Sustainment of Fire Support*. The support element provides suppression for the breach and assault element to cross the enemy's killing ground. Each weapon in the support element should be assigned a sector of responsibility. Initially, the support element establishes fire superiority with a maximum volume of fire. Once established, fire superiority is maintained throughout the attack. When indirect fires are shifted, the support element increases the rate of direct fire to maintain suppression; d) *Location of the Support Element*. The support element occupies one position to simplify control. At times, the support element must occupy several positions to effectively suppress enemy. This is to prevent the masking of fires by the breach or because of the characteristics of the supporting weapons (that is, 60mm mortar versus LAW). Also, the support element must reposition once the assault element begins clearing the objective. They may follow the assault element through the breach or reposition outside enemy position.

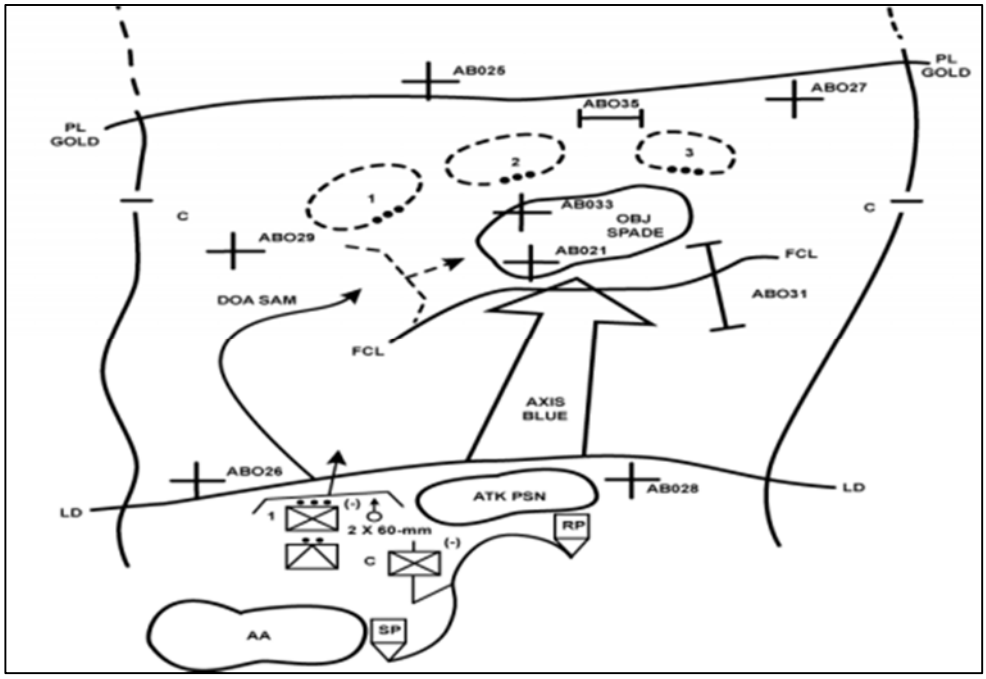


Figure 4.16 - Movement to the Objective

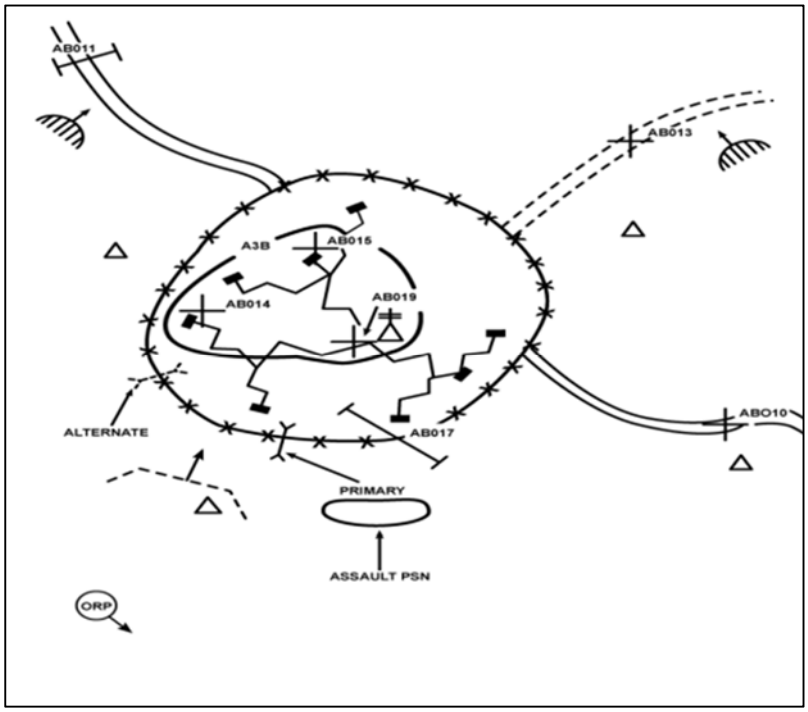


Figure 4.17 - Isolation Activities

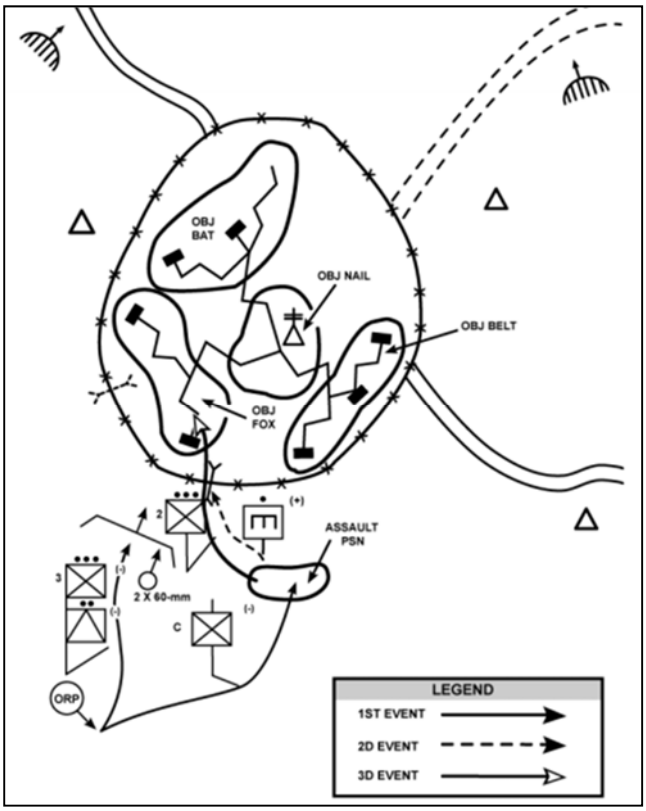


Figure 4.18 - Breach and Secure a Foothold.

e. **Exploit the Penetration and Seize the Decisive Point**. After the successful breach, the assault element conducts the main attack. The assault element passes through the breach, supported by fires of the support and breach element. In planning the assault, consider the following points: 1) **Seize the Enemy Key Position**. The assault element must quickly reduce enemy position. If the assault element can, capture the enemy command and control facilities or other key weapons, the enemy may abandon the position. If there is key terrain, this may be the decisive point for the assault element to task-organize for seizing enemy key position. The assault element must also organize into support, assault, and breach elements. As subsequent positions are encountered, the breaching operations may be repeated. As in the initial breach, a support by fire position is established as the same sequence of breaching and assaulting is conducted to reduce position (Figure 4.19): The designation of a reserve allows the CO to retain flexibility during attack. The CO should be prepared to commit his reserve to exploit success and continue the attack and repulse counterattacks during consolidation and reorganization. 2) **Exploit a Weakness.** Upon the start of the assault, the company maneuvers aggressively to lessen enemy's time to react. The CO monitors the situation. He adjusts plan and exploits a weakness found during the attack. If a situation develops that is beyond the company's capability, he notifies the battalion commander and holds his position until other companies can maneuver to support him. 3) **Continue the Assault.** In moving from their assault positions, platoons advance in the formation most suitable to the situation. When the assault element must move through a narrow lane in the obstacles, they maintain dispersion and assault through the lane by fire teams. The CO moves where he can best control the platoons and supporting fire. Indirect fire and direct fires of the support element are lifted when they endanger the advancing soldiers; and; 4) **Clear the Objective**. The assaulting soldiers clear enemy positions, secure and search prisoners, and move quickly across the objective. When they reach the far side, they take up hasty fighting positions and continue to fire at the enemy. When the objective is secured, the fire element, mortars and trains are called forward.

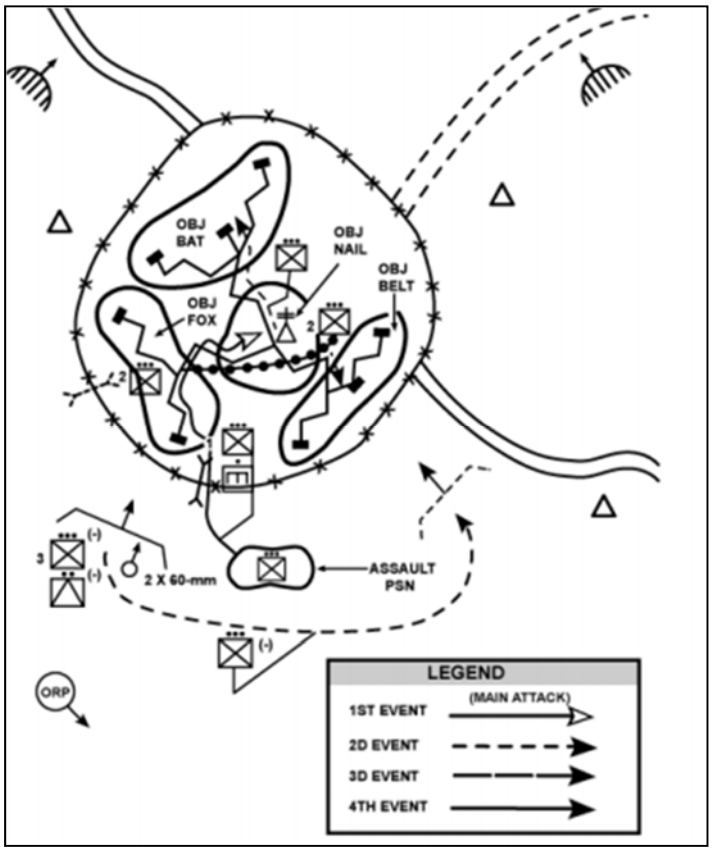


Figure 4.19 - Exploit the Penetration

f. **Reorganize and Consolidate**. Once the objective is seized, the company consolidates. The CO decides if he can exploit his success IAW his commander's concept to support the main effort.

04105. **Attack during Limited Visibility.** Successful attacks during limited visibility depend on leadership, reconnaissance, training, planning, and surprise. Although these fundamentals are also keys to daylight attacks, attacks during limited visibility require certain considerations and proper application of techniques to ensure control in the attack. Darkness, fog, heavy rain, and falling snow limit visibility. Smoke and dust from HE fires produce the same effect; but are more temporary. Infantry companies attack during limited visibility:

a. To achieve surprise.

b. To avoid heavy losses.

c. To cause panic in a weak or disorganized enemy.

d. To exploit success and maintain momentum.

e. To keep pressure on the enemy.

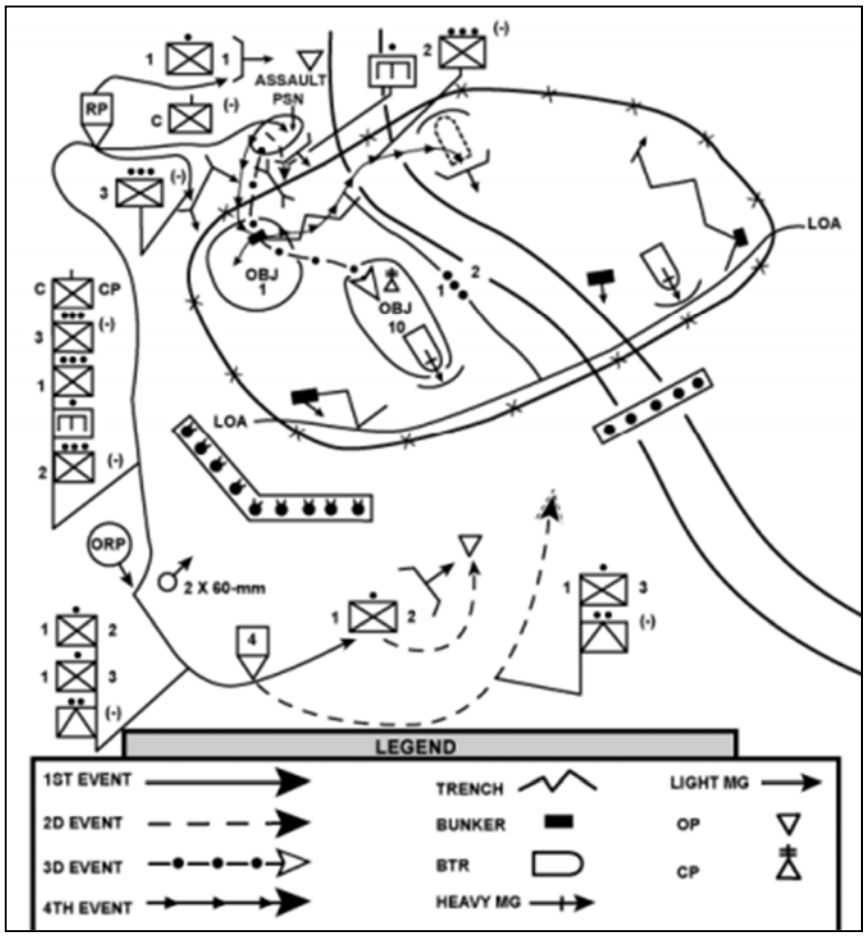


Figure 4.20 - Limited Visibility Attack with NVDs

04106. The rifle company, when equipped with NVDS, conducts limited visibility attacks very much like daylight attacks (Figure 4.20).The fundamentals for a daylight attack, discussed earlier in this chapter, still apply for night attacks. To conduct attacks in this manner requires:

a. A company that is well trained in limited visibility attacks.

b. Enough natural light to employ the unit's NVDS.

c. A simple, effective concept that takes advantage of the enemy's surprise and confusion.

d. A successful reconnaissance of the objective area.

e. Additional control measures or techniques, as needed.

04107. When planning attacks at night, the CO must consider the increased difficulty.

a. Controlling units, soldiers, and fires.

b. Identifying and engaging targets.

c. Navigating and moving.

d. Identifying friendly from enemy soldiers.

e. Locating, treating, and evacuating casualties.

f. Locating and by-passing or breaching enemy obstacles.

04108. In planning limited visibility attacks, the CO should also consider different aspects.

a. Feints and other deceptions (false positions or other deceptive measures) may be more effective.

b. If a small element can infiltrate the enemy position, it can be extremely effective in supporting the main attack; or it may covertly breach obstacles or neutralize key positions to allow the main attack to quickly seize a foothold.

c. It may be possible to actually infiltrate the main attack inside the enemy's positions and then fight from inside to outside. The unit inside the position may be able to occupy defensive positions and force the enemy to attack him.

04109. There are two basic decisions to be made for conducting limited visibility attacks whether to illuminate the objective, and whether to use indirect fires to support the attack.

a. The infantry company conducts non-illuminated attacks to exploit its training advantage. However, illumination is planned for every attack at night so that it is readily available if the enemy detects the attack and uses illumination, or if he possesses NVDS. Illumination is also effective after the objective is secure to support the consolidation, particularly the casualty evacuation.

b. The infantry company conducts illuminated night attacks like a daylight attack. Illumination is available from artillery, mortars, M203s, and hand-fired flares. Permission to fire illumination is often retained by battalion because the light may affect adjacent unit operations. The illumination rounds may be fired to impact on the ground, providing both light and markings on the objective to orient on. They may be placed behind the objective and in the air causing the enemy to be silhouetted. Once illumination has begun, it should be continued until the objective is secured. Sufficient ammunition must be available.

c. Non-illuminated, non-supported attacks offer the best chance of gaining surprise. Several techniques are used to conduct these attacks. For highly trained units possessing modern NVDS, they are conducted like daylight attacks. For Infantry units that do not have NVDS, a linear assault is one technique. Another option is to infiltrate close to the enemy and assault under illumination.

d. Illuminated, supported attacks are like daylight attacks. These are most effective when speed is essential, when there is limited time for reconnaissance, or when the enemy is weak. In conducting these types of attacks, the attacking unit still

attempts to use stealth with concealment of limited visibility to gain surprise and then initiate illumination to support the assault.

04110. The reconnaissance plan should also establish surveillance on the objective in case the enemy repositions units, weapons or add obstacles.

a. The reconnaissance plan should also establish surveillance on the objective in case the enemy repositions units, weapons or add obstacles. Surveillance elements should also secure critical locations such as assault and support positions, the LD/PLD, and key routes and RPs to protect the company from enemy ambushes or spoiling attacks. These security forces may become part of the isolation element during attacks.

b. When reconnaissance is unsuccessful, the commander should request a delay in attack time to enable further reconnaissance. If this is not possible, a supported attack should be considered. A night attack with marginal information of the enemy's defense is risky and difficult to successfully conduct.

04111. A simple concept for actions on the objective also supports control during an assault.

a. Avoid developing a concept that requires the company to fight for each enemy fighting position. Like the daylight attack, a decisive point must be identified and combat power focused at this location. Once the decisive action is accomplished, the plan must also address any remaining enemy. If required by the higher commander's concept, all enemies may be cleared from the objective area.

b. A smaller assault element maneuvering on the objective is easier to control and less likely to suffer casualties from friendly or enemy fires. The assault element must have clear signals to ensure control of supporting direct or indirect fires.

c. If a non-illuminated attack was planned but illumination is fired during execution due to detection by the enemy, the concept should be flexible to allow adjustments to daylight attack. This is a problem for units that planned to conduct a modified linear assault attack and is forced to conduct an illuminated attack. A contingency plan that reorients this attack similar to a daylight attack should be issued. Every soldier should know under what conditions this plan is executed. In some cases (when already deployed through the PLD and advancing on the enemy), the company may continue the attack as planned or attempt to disengage.

04112. Fire control techniques inclusion. The following considerations will apply:

a. **Using tracer fire.** Leaders in the assault element fire all tracers. Their men fire where the leader's tracers impact. The support element positions an automatic weapon on a tripod on the flank nearest the assault element. This weapon fires a burst of tracers every 15 seconds to indicate the near limit of supporting fires. All other weapons in the support element keep their fires on the side of this trace away from the assault element. The assault element signals to shift fires to the

next position. If required, these rounds can be adjusted well over the head of the assault element to preclude casualties;

b. **Marking with luminous tape or chemical lights.** Mark the assault personnel to prevent fratricide. Do this in a way that avoids enemy detection, such as tape on the back of the helmet or small infrared chemical lights (if the enemy has no NVDS). The support element should know where the lead assault element is. If the individual soldier markings do not suffice, use a large chemical light. Place these on the ground or throw them in front of the assault element. When clearing a trench line, put the lights on a stick and move them with the lead element; and

c. **Assigning weapon control restrictions to reduce the risk to the assault element**. These may include other techniques to increase control during the assault: 1) Not allowing flares, grenades, or smoke on the objective; 2) Only allowing certain personnel with NVDs to engage targets on the objectives; 3) A magnetic azimuth for maintaining direction; 4) Mortar or artillery rounds to orient attacking units; 5) The use of guides; and, 6) Reduced intervals between soldiers and units.

04113. Mortar, artillery, and anti-armor fires are planned as in a daylight attack. They do not fire, however, until the company is ready to assault. Some weapons may fire before the attack and maintain a pattern to deceive the enemy. This will not be done if it discloses the attack.

a. Indirect fire is hard to adjust when visibility is poor. If doubt exists as to the exact friendly locations, indirect fire is directed at enemy positions beyond the objective, and onto the objective. Illuminating rounds fired to burn on the ground, can be used to mark objectives. This helps the company orient on the objective but may adversely affect NVDs.

b. Smoke is planned to further reduce the enemy's visibility, if there are night vision devices. The smoke is laid close to the enemy positions so as to not to hinder the breaching of obstacles. Employing smoke during the assault may make it hard for assaulting soldiers to find fighting positions. If sufficient thermal sights are available, using smoke on the objective may provide a decisive advantage for well-trained units.

c. Illumination is always planned for attacks to be conducted in limited visibility. That gives the commander the option of calling for it. The battalion commander normally controls illumination, but may authorize the CO to call for it. If the commander decides to use illumination, it should not be called for until the assault is initiated. It should be placed several locations over a wide area to confuse the enemy on the place of the attack. It should also be placed beyond the objective to help assaulting soldiers see and fire, at withdrawing or counterattacking enemy soldiers.

d. Illumination may also be required if the enemy uses it to disrupt the effectiveness of the company’s NVDs. Once used, illumination must be continuous because attacking soldiers may temporarily lose their normal night vision. Any break in illumination may also reduce the effectiveness of

suppressive fire when the attackers need it most. Care must be taken to ensure that the squad and platoon leaders do not use hand flares before the commander has decided to illuminate the objective.

e. When limited NVDs are available, they must be prioritized and employed at the most critical locations. These may be with the key soldiers in the breach element, key leaders in the assault element, other members of the assault element, and key leaders or weapons in the support element.

04114. When the objective has been seized, the company consolidates and reorganizes. Consolidation and reorganization are the same as for a daylight attack with the following exceptions:

a. Guides are used to lead trains and support elements forward to their positions.

b. The consolidation plan should be as simple as possible. Avoid change in task organization.

c. Locating and evacuating casualties and EPWs take longer. They must have to be moved to the rear of the objective and kept there until visibility improves.

d. Platoon positions are closer together to ease control and to improve mutual support. Position distances are adjusted as visibility improves.

04115. The modified linear assault is a technique for conducting a non-illuminated attack without NVDs to seize an occupied objective. This technique is effective in controlling the fires of the assault element by maintaining a liner formation. Each soldier assault using individual movement techniques, while remaining generally "on line" with the soldier on his right and left. The following considerations apply:

a. In the true linear assault, the company would deploy through their respective squad release points and the entire company conducts a linear assault across the objective (Figure 4.21). This technique normally modified to reduce the vulnerability of the assault element. This technique may be modified in number of ways depending on the situation: 1) The most effective modification is to establish part of the company in a support by fire position. The remainder of the company deploys at the PLD and conducts the assault (Figure 4.22). The machine guns, and mortars are normally most effective if employed in this role. M203s may also be effective if sufficient visibility exists for their employment. It is essential that the flank of the assault element nearest the support element be visible to the support element. The fire team on this flank may mark themselves with chemical lights or glint tape to ensure they are visible. 2) Other variations of this technique may include attacking on a much narrower front with a smaller assault element and having a large follow-and-support. For example, instead of two platoons deploying at the PLD, a platoon (-) could deploy against an identified enemy weak point (Figure 4.23). They could be tasked to bypass enemy positions to quickly seize or destroy a critical location or facility and the follow-and-support force reduces bypassed positions. Or, the assault element may be assigned a shallow objective to support the forward passage of the trailing unit. Another option is to deploy through the platoon

release points and then to attack in squad files. This technique is most effective when the situation will support an infiltration through the enemy defenses to seize decisive terrain or positions to the rear.

b. The modified linear assault also simplifies the control of supporting fires from outside the objective by establishing support positions perpendicular to the direction of assault. The supporting fires can be employed next to the assault element and then shifted in front of them as they advance.

c. The linear formation during the assault is also the biggest weakness with this technique. If the enemy is in well-prepared defensive positions, the linear formation ensures at least part of the assault element attacks through the enemy's kill zones. Also, assaulting using this technique makes it very difficult for the leader to concentrate combat power against an identified enemy weakness. Finally, if the enemy has NVD's or the assault element runs into unidentified obstacles after employing at the PLD, fire superiority may not be achieved and the assault will rapidly come to a halt. This may result in the majority of the company being decisively engaged in the enemy killing ground.

d. Although there are significant difficulties with this technique, it remains a viable technique for the units without NVDs to attack during limited visibility. It is most effective against a weak or disorganized enemy. If the enemy has NVDs or a well-prepared defense with protective obstacles, this technique should not be used. An illuminated, supported attack conducted, as a daylight attack may be the most effective option in this situation.

e. Before attacking in this manner, the company should secure the PLD and provide guides for the company from the LD to the PLD. Each platoon provides personnel to secure their portion of the PLD and guide the platoon from the platoon RP.

f. These soldiers are briefed on the routes from the LD to the platoon RP, actions on enemy contact, time of departure, and other information needed by the patrol units to conduct their mission.

g. This element moves forward to the platoon RP. They then move forward to reconnoitre and or mark the platoon routes, secure their respective parts of the PLD, and observe the objective. The platoon guides come back to the platoon RP to guide their platoons to the squad RP and to the PLD.

h. Once the company crosses the LD, movement to the PLD is continuous. They move slowly to maintain stealth. Platoons are released at the platoon RP so they can deploy before reaching the PLD. Once their units are deployed, the platoon leaders and the support element leader notify the CO. When the company is fully deployed, the CO informs the battalion commander. On the battalion commander's order, the company moves silently forward from the PLD, as the platoons guide on the base platoon.

i. When the attack is discovered; or on the CO's order, the support element opens fire. On order or when discovered, the platoons assault. Scattered enemy fire

must not be taken as a loss of surprise, and it should not be cause to start the assault. Leaders must recognize that this technique for conducting a limited visibility attack results in a linear assault. To be successful, the assault must achieve surprise and rapidly overwhelm the defender. If the initial assault fails, it will be difficult to regain control.

j. Soldiers assault aggressively using individual movement techniques to maneuver. The support element must quickly gain fire superiority with a heavy volume of fire. Tracers are used to improve accuracy, control fires, and allow the assault element to see where its supporting fires are impacting. The FO's call for indirect fire around and beyond the objective is to disrupt enemy reinforcement. As the assault closes on the objective, fires are shifted beyond the limit of advance or lifted entirely. Soldiers must not go beyond the limit of advance; and,

k. If the enemy discovers the attack before the company reaches the PLD, the CO may: 1). Call for planned, supporting fire to suppress the enemy; 2). Call for illumination (if authorized by the battalion commander) to ease control and movement; 3) Continue as if it were a daylight attack by modifying the attack plan to a daylight attack; and, 4) A linear assault, even a modified variation, is generally a very risky assault technique when conducted under illumination.

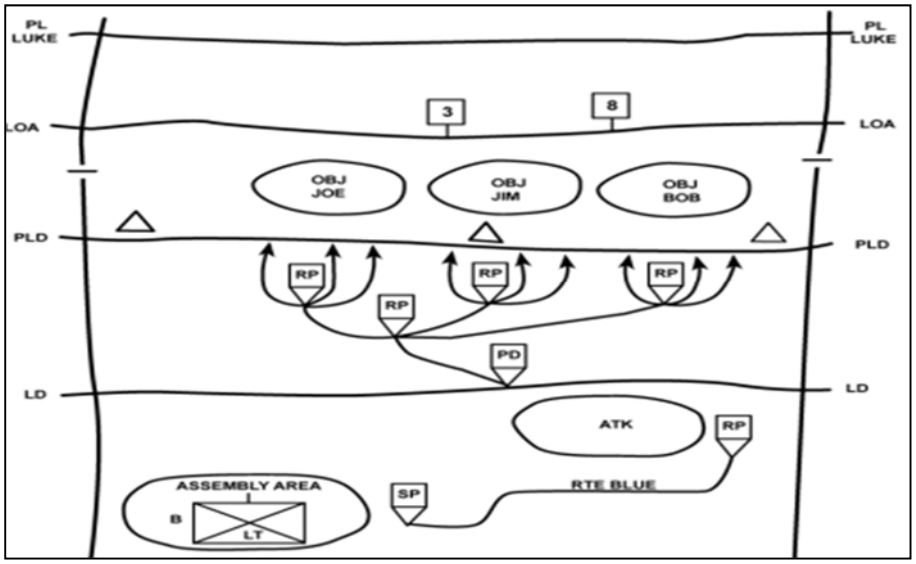


Figure 4.21 - Linear Assault

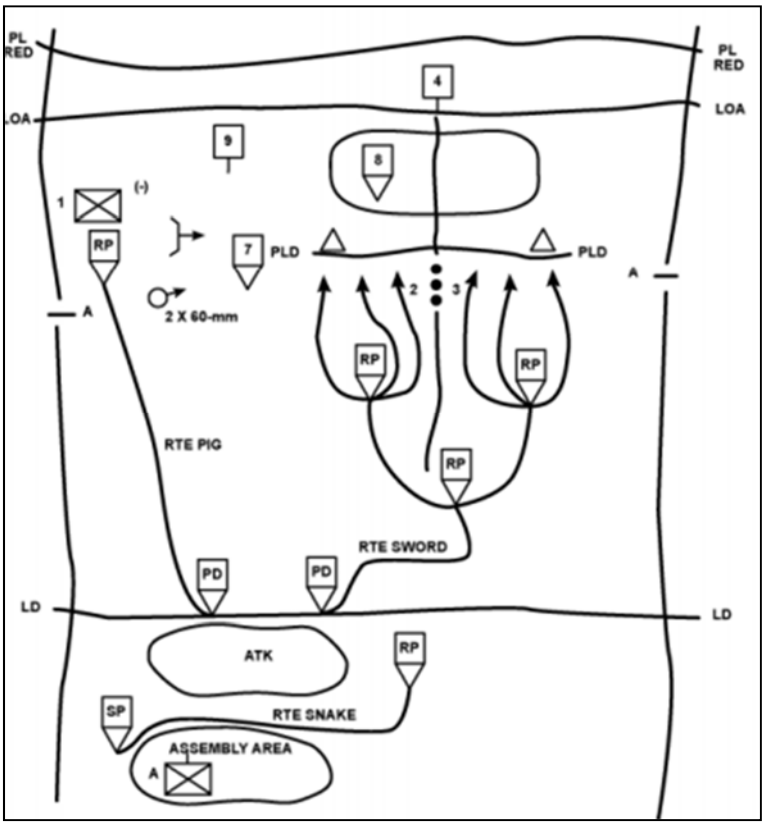


Figure 4.22 - Linear Assault with Support Element

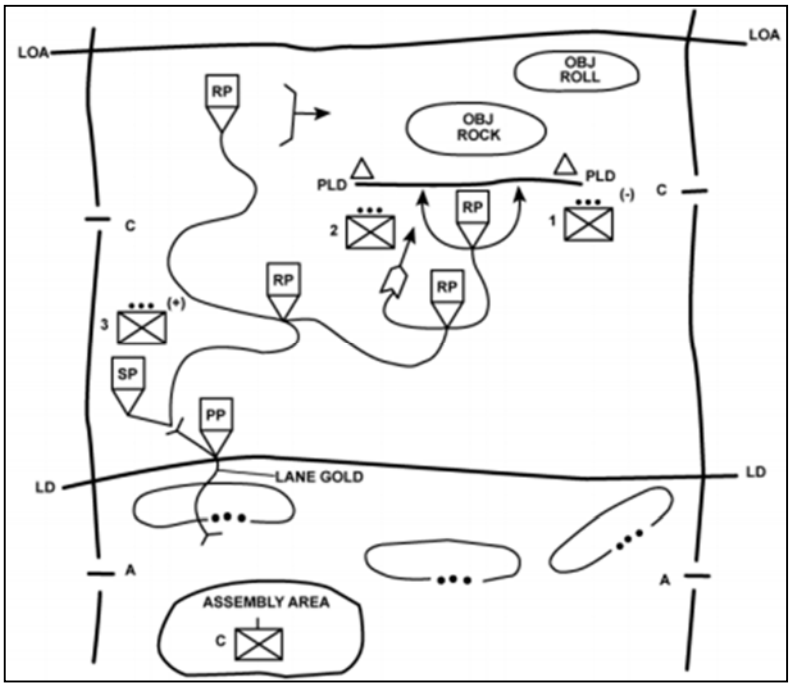


Figure 4.23 - Linear Assault with Follow and Support

Deception Operations

04116. The company may be assigned to perform a feint or a scheme demonstration which is a part of the battalion attack. The CO may also use the same planning process as well as the same troop-leading procedures for any attack. These operations are:

a. Feint

b. Demonstration

04117. **Feint.** A feint refers to the restricted objective supporting attack which requires the company to make a contact with the enemy. In most cases, this could be a direct-fire contact. As with any form of attack, the main purpose that the battalion commander intends to achieve is the CO's main concern in planning or preparing the feint. The purpose is normally stated in terms of some form of an activity by the enemy. This may cause the enemy:

a. To reposition or commit his reserve.

b. To shift his supporting fires away from the main attack.

c. To reveal his defensive positions.

04118. The CO has to ensure that he completely understands the feint's timing vis-à-vis the main attack. The CO also has to consider what he can do if the feint is able to achieve more success than what is expected. This would result from an unexpected weakness from the enemy or the enemy commander's failure to react on the attack. Either way, the battalion commander has power to decide to shift the main effort and support the unexpected success.

04119. The CO must also ensure that the attack is aggressively performed. This would help attain the preferred reaction by the enemy as well as reduce any friendly casualties. Once the company loses the momentum while being under the effective fire from the enemy force, the company may either disengage or establish a quick defense. Either of the two actions would result in unnecessary casualties.

04120. **Demonstration.** A demonstration has the same characteristics as the feint. However, no contact is mandatory with the enemy force. In a demonstration, the battalion commonly provides specific actions which are required as part of it. For example, the company could be directed to provide a smoke screen using smoke pots, and to simulate preparations for an attack in this area.

Security Operations

04121. The battalion has an option of assigning the company a security mission in order to guard or screen another friendly asset or unit. This is part of the counter-reconnaissance mission of the battalion. Also, the CO may assign one of the important tasks to his platoons and make it part of the scheme of maneuver. Such tasks may require the unit to adjust on the friendly force and prevent the enemy forces from engaging, detecting and observing. The CO analyzes the situation and develops his plan

as in any tactical situation (as explained in Chapter 2). Special considerations are explained in the paragraphs below:

a. **Mission.** The task identifies the detailed requirements that each unit has to accomplish. The screen task which provides early warning and destroys the enemy reconnaissance is usually easier to conduct as compared to a guard task which is the same as a screen plus preventing the enemy ground observation as well as directing fire on the friendly forces within the same situation. The asset or unit that is being protected also affects the plan significantly. For example, if the company is tasked to guard the left flank of the battalion during movement, the CO's concept must consider how to maintain this security while the battalion is moving and dispersed in length.

b. **Terrain**. The terrain analysis will indicate likely enemy approaches, good observation points, and places where risk may be accepted.

c. **Enemy.** The enemy analysis that is incorporated with the terrain analysis must indicate the areas that will provide enemy observation as well as direct fire on the friendly unit. These probable enemy locations must be the focus of the concept of the CO. The expected strength and size of the enemy unit may assist the commander when it comes to determining the need to concentrate the forces as well as identifying the location and size of the reaction force or the reserve. The effective range of the direct-fire weapon systems of the enemy may also assist the battalion commander in determining the extent from which the friendly force will be able to establish the screen line, which is not directed by the battalion.

d. **Troops.** The friendly troops that are available, specifically any attached surveillance assets or vehicles, may obviously affect the planning of the CO. If the vehicles are available, they may provide an improved mobility to the reaction force or reserve.

e. **Time**. One important concern for the CO involves how long the security is to be maintained. During extended periods of time, the plan has to allow a part of the force to conduct sustainment activities which include maintenance, resupply and sleep. Also, the plan must address the essential adjustments particularly during restricted visibility. During daylight, a screen line consisting of OPs supported by platoon reaction forces may be sufficient. During limited visibility, additional OPs would be established and gaps between the OPs would need to be covered by squad-sized patrols.

Strike Operations

04122. Strike operations are utilized in counterinsurgency operations. It ultimately seeks to destroy insurgent forces and base areas, isolate insurgent forces from their support, and interdict insurgent infiltration routes and lines of communications (LOCs).

04123. In order to find, fix and destroy insurgent forces in contested or insurgent controlled urban or rural areas, strike operations must be done with speed and surprise. Moreover, commanders must direct their forces to attack, pursue, and destroy the

insurgents.These are conducted to:

a. Encourage reconcilable insurgents to the negotiation table.

b. Harass the insurgent to prevent the build-up of personnel and logistical resources.

c. Destroy the insurgent force and its base complexes.

d. Demonstrate government resolve and garner support from the populace in the local area.

e. Set the conditions to expand clear-hold-build operations.

Chapter V
Infantry Company Defensive Operations

0501. The immediate purpose of defensive operations is to defeat an enemy attack, gain time, economize forces, or set conditions that encourage support for offensive operation to the civil governance operations. The defensive operations are not conclusive; they need to be combined with or followed by SCG operations and offensive operations. Although the result of the decisive combat springs from offensive operations, the commanders may find it important and advisable to defend. Upon making the choice, they need to set conditions for defense in a manner that enables the friendly forces to withstand as well as hold the enemy as they prepare in seizing the initiative as well as launching the counter attack. A thorough understanding of the commander's intent is especially critical in defensive operations, which demand precise integration of combat, combat support, and sustainment support elements.

Defensive Fundamentals

0502. The instantaneous purposes of defensive operations include defeating an enemy attack as well as gaining the initiative for the offensive operations. Also, the Infantry companymay conduct defense in order to achieve one or more purposes such as follows:

a. **Deter or defeat enemy offensive operations.** Effective defenses discourage actions from the enemy and establish opportunities to take hold of the initiative. Defensive operations may deter potential aggressors if they believe that breaking the friendly defense would be too costly.

b. **Gain time.** Company commanders may conduct a defense to gain time. These defense operations are effective in slowing down or temporarily stopping an attack and at the same time enabling friendly reserves to maximize time in reinforcing their defense. Delaying actions trade space for time to improve defenses, expose enemy forces to joint attack, and prepare counterattacks.

c. **Achieve economy of force.** The defense is also used to achieve economy of force. The clever use of terrain, depth, and security operations enable the friendly forces to decrease their use of resources for defense purposes. This allows the CO to concentrate combat power for offensive operations.

d. **Retain key terrain.** Such defenses are necessary to prevent enemy forces from occupying key terrain. Control of key terrain can sway the outcome of the battle or engagement depending on which side controls it. In company operations dominated to SCG tasks, friendly bases become key terrain.

e. **Protect the populace, critical assets, and infrastructure.** Defense of the local populace and vital assets is important to SCG operations. Infantry rifle companycan protect civilian areas that are important to success and provide indirect support to other government organization. This protection is very important in counterinsurgency operations where some facilities have significant economic and political value as opposed to tactical military

importance.

f. **Develop intelligence.** A particular phase or task within a defense may be **conducted** to satisfy commander's critical information requirements about the enemy's direction of attack and main effort.

Primary Defensive Tasks

0503. At the operational level, an enemy offensive may compel joint forces to conduct major defensive operations. Such operations may require defeating or preventing attacks or halting an insurgent movement's mobilization. An infantry company normally defends as part of a larger unit. The following primary defensive task may be executed anywhere in the operational area. The primary tasks are associated with the defense. The company commander combines these tasks to fit the situation:

a. **Area Defense**. Concentrates on denying the enemy access to designated terrain for a specified time, rather than the outright destruction of the enemy. The Infantry Rifle Company, with its enhanced mobility, has the capability to perform an area defense.

b. **Mobile Defense**. Orients on the destruction of the enemy through a decisive attack(s) by a striking force. The infantry rifle companyparticipates in a mobile defense as the striking force or as part of a larger unit.

c. **Retrograde Operations**. Forced or voluntary movements to the rear or away from the enemy. The infantry rifle companynormally participates in retrograde operations as part of a larger unit.

Characteristics of the Defense

0504. The characteristics of the defense are also planning fundamentals for the infantry company. These characteristics include:

a. **Preparation.** The defender arrives in the battle area before the attacker. He must take advantage of this by making the most thorough preparations for combat possible in the time available. By analyzing the factors of METT-TC, the infantry rifle companycommander gains an understanding of the tactical situation and identifies potential friendly and enemy weaknesses. He then war-games friendly and enemy options and synchronizes his concept of the operation with all available combat multipliers.

b. **Disruption.** Defensive plans vary with the circumstances, but all defensive concepts of operation aim at disrupting the attacker's synchronization. Counterattacks, indirect fires, obstacles, and retention of key or decisive terrain prevent the enemy from concentrating his strength against portions of the defense. Destroying enemy command and control vehicles disrupts enemy synchronization and flexibility.

c. **Concentration.** The defender must concentrate combat power at the decisive

time and place if he is to succeed. He must obtain a local advantage at points of decision. Offensive action and the use of surprise and deception are often the means of gaining this advantage. The defender must remember that this concentration refers to combat power and its effects--not just numbers of soldiers and weapons systems. To concentrate combat power, the defender normally must economize in some areas, retain a reserve, and maneuver to gain local superiority. Local counterattacks may be needed to maintain the integrity of the defense. Indirect fire can shift to critical points to concentrate destructive effects rapidly.

d. **Flexibility.** Flexibility is derived from sound preparation and effective C2. The defender must be swift enough to counter or avoid the attacker's blow and then strike back effectively. This results from a detailed mission analysis, an understanding of the unit's purpose, aggressive reconnaissance and security, and organization in depth and retention or reconstitution of a reserve (when applicable). Flexibility requires that the company commander "see the battlefield"—physically and through timely and accurate reports. Supplementary positions on secondary avenue of approach may provide additional flexibility to the CO. After proper analysis of the terrain and enemy situation, the commander can anticipate enemy actions and be prepared to act through the positioning of maneuver units or a reserve.

Defensive Framework

0505. As part of a larger unit, the infantry rifle companyconducts defensive operations in a sequence of integrated and overlapping steps. The following paragraphs focus on the tactical considerations and procedures involved in each element. This discussion illustrates an attacking enemy that uses depth in its operations, but there will be situations where a company must defend against an enemy that does not have a doctrinal operational foundation. Such a situation requires a more flexible plan that allows for more centralized combat power rather than spreading it throughout the company's area of operations. There are five complementary elements of the framework: reconnaissance, security, defensive, rear, and reserve operations.

a. Reconnaissance

b. Security

c. Defensive

d. Rear

e. Reserve operations

0506. Infantry companies normally conduct defensive operations as part of a battalion. The company may operate in the security area, in the defensive area (or main battle area), or the rear area, depending on the assigned missions. The company may take part in deep and rear operations as part of a larger unit.

0507. At the company level, the company’s defensive framework normally focuses on

reconnaissance and security actions, defensive operations, and actions by the reserve. At times, the company may fight a more decentralized defense that requires them to provide forces for each of the elements of the framework.

0508. The rifle company normally defends as part of a battalion to disrupt or destroy the enemy, to protect a friendly force, or to control terrain. The orientation of the company defense is determines from the mission analysis normally, the company's purpose in the mission statement will clearly focus the company towards the enemy, the terrain, or a friendly force.

0509. A simple, complete concept of operation is the basis of all defenses. The Rifle Company routinely uses attacks, raids, ambushes, and other offensive techniques in the conduct of defensive operations. At brigade level and below, defenses normally consist of three complementary elements:

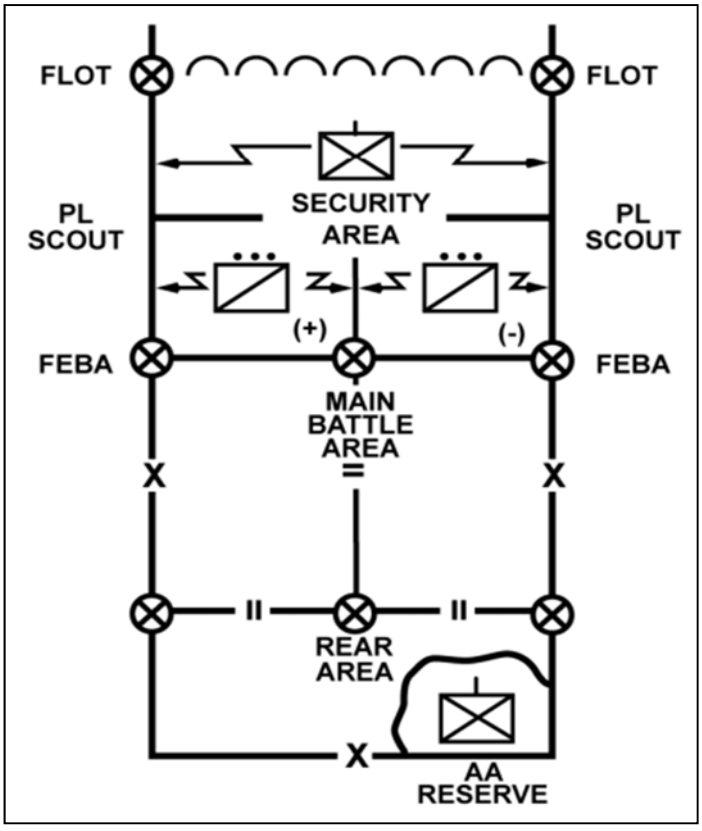


Figure 5.1 - Defense Framework at Brigade Level

a. **Security operations forward of and to the flanks of the MBA.** These operations consist of security, reconnaissance, and counter-reconnaissance tasks. Depending on the specific missions assigned, the company may simply observe and report, engage with indirect fires, and or engage with direct-fire weapons. Security operations are crucial throughout the defense, initially, in order to support the preparation of the defense; early in the fight, to disrupt the enemy attack and or to identify his main effort; and in the main battle area, to support the commander's decision-making process.

b. **Defensive operation conducted in the MBA.** These activities are oriented on enemy destruction, terrain retention, or force protection. Normally, the decisive fight occurs in the MBA; therefore, the main effort is located there. Units tasked with security missions or reserve missions must support the main effort in the commander's concept for conducting the defense.

c. **Reserve operations.** Reserves that allow the company commander to seize and maintain the initiative and preserve his flexibility. Although the reserve does not have an assigned mission that directly supports the main effort, the CO attempts to employ the reserve at the decisive time and place to ensure the success of the defense.

0510. A company may perform all these operations at the same time in its own sector; or, it may be tasked to do one or more of them for a larger unit. An example of the former is a company assigned its own defensive sector during counterinsurgency operations. For security, the CO may have a combination of OPs and R&S patrols. Within his MBA, the CO may consider larger ambushes and more positional defenses. For a reserve, he may position a force at a location that allows the most flexibility. As a portion of a larger force, the company may be tasked to serve as the brigade reserve.

Plans and Preparations

0511. Upon receiving a warning order from the battalion defense, the CO begins the TLP and estimates the situation. As a result of the estimations, preparations on the control measures, logistics plan, fire plan, R&S plan and if necessary, employment plan of a reserve, are made.

0512. Defensive Concept Development. The restated mission statement and the other critical facts and deductions provide the focus for developing the defensive concept. Each COA should be developed starting at a potential decisive point. Once the CO has identified his potential decisive point (s), he develops his concept using the following process:

a. **Determine decisive points and times to focus combat power.** The battalion commander's concept and tasking for the company may focus on a very specific decisive point and time. This is most likely when the company is the battalion main effort. For example, the company may be tasked to conduct the central ambush as part of the battalion area ambush. In this case the company decisive point will be somewhere in the assigned kill zone and the CO's concept will seek to generate maximum combat power there to accomplish his mission.

b. **In other situations, the decisive point may be less obvious and the techniques for generating combat power much more difficult than arraying units and weapons around a kill zone or engagement area.** This may be the case when the company is a supporting effort for the battalion or when the battalion concept is much more decentralized. For example, the company may be defending in sector with a mission to guard the right flank of the battalion main effort to prevent the enemy from enveloping the man effort.

0513. Determine the results that must be achieved at the decisive point to accomplish the mission. Normally, the purpose from the company mission statement clearly states the desires results. At times, particularly during decentralized operations, the CO must analyse the situation more closely to determine the desired results.

0514. Determine the purposes to be achieved by the main and supporting efforts. The supporting purposes must be clearly linked to the main effort's assigned purpose:

a. **The main effort's purpose is often the purpose from the company's mission statement**. At times, the company purposes must be modified slightly to be appropriate for the main effort platoon. When modified, it must be clear that by achieving the main effort's purpose the company will achieve its purpose.

b. **The supporting purposes are selected by determining what must be achieved to support the success of the main effort**. Examples of supporting effort purposes include: to prevent the envelopment of the main effort, to force the enemy into an engagement area, to prevent enemy reconnaissance and identify the enemy's main attack, to deceive the enemy of the main defense locations, or to allow the main effort to maneuver against the enemy.

c. **The CO uses the framework of the defense to assist him in developing his concept**. Although the focus is on the decisive fight in the main battle area, security requirements and the need for a reserve must also be addressed.

0515. Determine the essential tasks for subordinate units (main and supporting efforts) that achieve these purposes. The task should clearly focus the subordinate unit on the terrain, the enemy, or a friendly unit. When linked with the purpose, a clearly defined, attainable, and decisive mission statement is assigned.

a. The CO also considers how to achieve mutual support. It is achieved by designating a main effort and by assigning supporting effort missions that support this unit. Positioning units increase it where they can provide security and or the ability to fire/maneuver in support of each other.

b. Task-organize units (Platoons and sections) to accomplish the identified missions. The CO allocates resources to the main effort first and then to the supporting efforts. Normally, the CO will not task-organize below squad level of specific weapons or equipment. At time, the CO may have to, particularly when under strength. The size of the organizations may range from a squad (-) to a platoon (+). If there are insufficient resources to ensure each of the supporting effort missions is attainable, the task may be modified. For example, the original mission may have been to guard the flank of the main effort to prevent his envelopment; it may now be changed to a screen task. If required, the purpose may also be changed. In this case, it might be changed to provide early warning and prevent surprise of the main effort. Or if the original task was to block, which is a delay task – to block enemy movement south of PL red for two hours may be attainable and still achieve the desired results.

0516. Assign command and control headquarters for each of the task-organized units. All platoon or section headquarters should be fully used. If additional leaders are

required, use the XO, F/Sgt, company FSO, and other company leaders. In some cases, when no senior leader is available, the senior squad leader may be the unit leader. Or if the company has a one-squad reserve, its assigned squad leader probably may lead it.

0517. Complete a generic task organization by assigning all organic or attached units. Of particular concern may be the FOs, medics, and other attachments. They should be attached to the unit that can best employ them or possible where they provide the most flexibility.

0518. Establish control measures that clarify and support the accomplishment of the assigned mission. These can be done as follows:

a. Use time events and control measures to synchronize subordinate actions without stifling initiative – such as axis, sectors, BPs, engagement areas, DOA, assault positions, objectives, etc.

b. Certain control measures may be required to provide additional safety for the unit. These may include fire control measures, procedures, or special signals or markings to ensure understanding.

c. At times, both a sector and a battle position may be an effective control measure to support the mission and to allocate terrain.

0519. Weight the main effort. The CO can weigh the main effort in many different ways. Some examples include:

a. Attaching additional squads/weapons;

b. Assigning priority of fires or allocating an FDP or priority target;

c. Assigning priority of CS/SS support;

d. Limiting the main efforts is of responsibility to allow the unit to focus on the critical action. For example, assigning a smaller sector;

e. By locating other resources in the vicinity of the main effort that support the main effort's focus in the decisive action; and,

f. By providing additional time to prepare, rehearse, or conduct reconnaissance. The plan is now completed by: 1) Including the occupation plan for the defense; 2) Completing the fires planning (both direct and indirect); 3) Positioning other assets (such as the CP, mortars or the company trains) and assigning them missions; 4) Developing the SS plan for resupply, casualty, evacuation, and movement of rucksacks/other equipment; and, 5) Planning for likely contingencies (such as a be-prepared mission for one unit to become the company reserve if the initial reserve is committed).

Sectors and Battle Positions

0520. The estimate of the CO determines the critical control measures for each operation. There are no standard criteria in selecting control measures. However, Figure 5.2 presents some criteria that may be considered:

a. Sector

b. Battle Position

c. Based on his estimate and factors stated in Figure 5.2

d. In some situations, a platoon may receive both a battle position and a sector to provide the proper control based on the commander's concept.

e. Regardless of the control measure assigned by the CO, each platoon leader prepares and provides the CO with a platoon sector sketch.

BATTLE POSITION			SECTOR
WELL-DEFENDED; ENEMY CAN BE CANALIZED	←	AVENUES OF APPROACH	→ NOT EASILY DEFINED
DOMINATES AVENUES OF APPROACH	←	TERRAIN	→ DOMINATING TERRAIN NOT AVAILABLE
NARROW/ SMALL	←	UNIT AREA OF OPERATIONS	→ WIDE/ LARGE
ACHIEVABLE	←	MUTUAL SUPPORT	→ CANNOT EASILY BE ACHIEVED
GOOD	←	COMMANDERS ABILITY TO SEE/CONTROL	→ DEGRADED
RETAIN BLOCK	←	ASSIGNED TASK	→ DISRUPT CONTAIN

Figure 5.2 - Selecting Control Measures

0521. **Sector.** A sector is the control measure that provides the most freedom of action to a platoon. It provides flexibility to allow the platoon to operate in a decentralized manner while still ensuring that sufficient control exists to prevent confusion and to synchronize the company's operation. In the close terrain that the Infantry prefers to operate in, it is often difficult to achieve mutual support between platoon battle positions. It is also very difficult for the CO to see and control the fight throughout the company sector. For these reasons, the infantry routinely operates in sectors.

0522. **Battle Position.** A battle position is a general location and orientation of forces on the ground from which units defend. The platoon is located within the general area of the BP. Security elements may be located forward and to the flanks of the BP. Platoons defending a BP may not be tied in with adjacent units; in which case, the requirement for all-round security is increased. The use of on-order BPs with the tasks of "prepare" or "recon" provides flexibility and depth to the defensive plan.

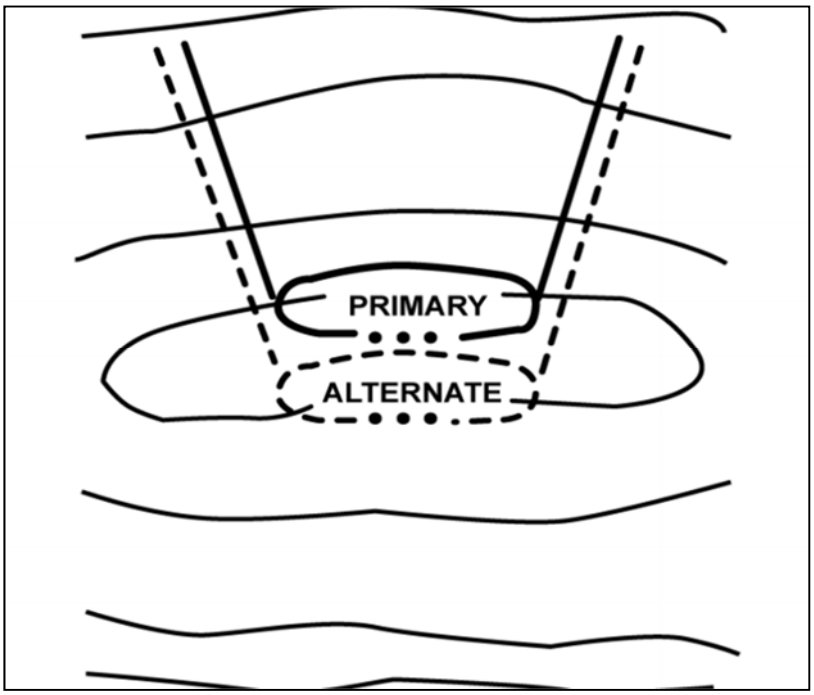


Figure 5.3 - Alternate Position

a. Assigning BPs, the CO assigns the platoon a primary position to defend and a sector of fire. Every position has to contribute in accomplishing the purpose and assigned task within the concept of operation of the battalion commander.

b. A CO can also assign alternate or supplementary positions to platoons, depending on the situation. An alternate position is a position to the front, flank, or slightly to the rear of the primary position (Figure 5.3). It has to allow the platoon to cover the same fire sector which is the primary position. It may also be the primary position's "forward" when it is occupied in times of limited visibility. If the platoon will be removed from the primary position by assault or due to enemy fire, the alternate position is allowed to be occupied. It may also be occupied in order to begin fight and deceive the platoon's enemy in the primary position.

c. A supplementary position is to the flank or the rear of the primary position. It allows the platoon to defend against an attack on an avenue of approach not covered by the primary position (Figure 5.4). This may be assigned if the platoon will cover not only one avenue of approach. The CO may approve the moving of the platoon from the primary, alternate and the supplementary position when a specific condition arises which prescribes the necessity for the move.

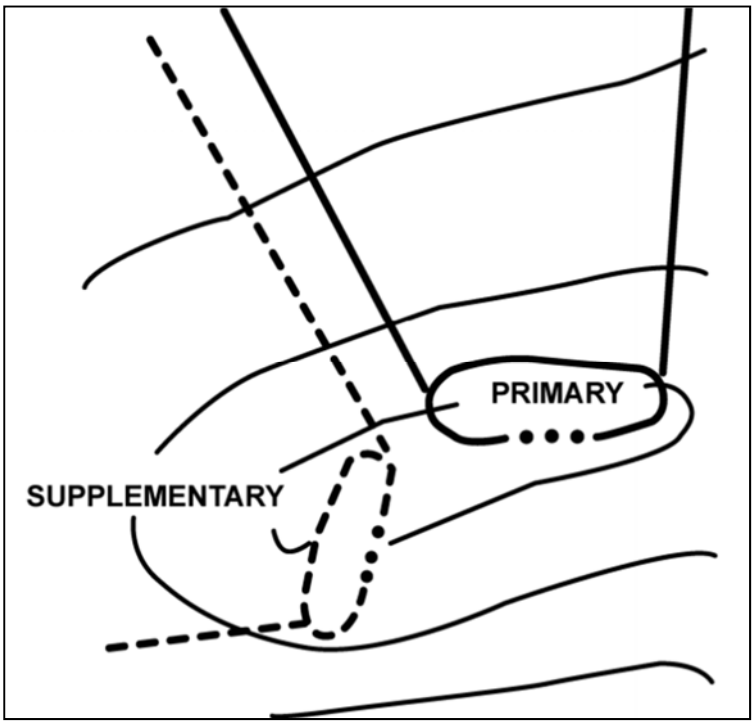


Figure 5.4 - Supplementary Position

0523. Based on his estimate and the factors stated in Figure 5.2, the CO can decide to assign platoon sectors. A defensive sector is an area designated by boundaries that define where a unit operates and the terrain for which it is responsible. Sectors are normally deeper than they are wide to allow the platoon to fight the battle in depth.

0524. In some situations, a platoon may receive both a battle position and a sector to provide the proper control based on the commander's concept. An example is when a platoon is initially tasked to delay or interdict enemy forces moving through an area to disrupt their attack. Sectors maybe the most effective control measure to allow decentralized operations and increase the subordinate's freedom of action. If this same platoon has a subsequent mission to block enemy movement through a choke point to allow the remainder of the company to counterattack critical parts of the enemy's flanks, a BP may now be the proper control measure. A BP orients this platoon on the choke point and would allow indirect fires to be employed with fewer restrictions.

a. In this example, only one control measure would be in effect for the platoon at a time. This is depicted graphically by using a dashed line for the battle position graphic. In a different situation, the commander's concept may require both control measures to be in effect at the same time.

b. The use of multiple control measures is not routine. The CO must ensure that he is not over-tasking the platoon. He must also ensure that his concept and the purpose for each control measure are clear to all of his subordinates. There is a significant risk of confusion unless the concept is effective and articulated well during the OPORD. A brief-back is essential.

0525. Regardless of the control measure assigned by the CO, each platoon leader prepares and provides the CO with a-platoon sector sketch. These sketches help the CO determine whether or not the company AO is well-covered. From the platoon sector sketches, the CO develops his company sector sketch. These sketches do not, however, reduce the need for him to physically inspect his company's defense.

Company Fire Plan

0526. The company fire plan fully integrates the impact of the weapon systems, the obstacle plan as well as the scheme of maneuver in achieving the biggest impact on the force of the enemy. The extent of fire planning varies depending on the situation and the concept of the CO. When the concept is centralized, that is, when it is organized around a huge engagement area, fire plans may be in full detail. When fighting a more decentralized defense, such as a company area ambush with platoons in dispersed sectors, the company fire plan may only address minimal information. Although this example is focused on employing anti-armor weapons, the process is essentially the same for the company's small arms. The company fire plan has two parts – direct and indirect.

0527. **Direct Fires.** The direct-fire planning begins with the CO guaranteeing his understanding and compliance with the fire plan of the battalion. The plan’s extent will depend on the available time, the fire planning as well as the control measures required:

a. To synchronize the company battle.

b. To maximize the effect of the weapons on the enemy.

c. To achieve mutual support.

d. To provide coverage of assigned areas of responsibility.

e. To ensure the soldiers' safety from friendly fires.

0528. **Control Measures for Direct Fires.** The CO uses control measures to support the company fire plan. The following are the different measures:

a. Sector of fire

b. Engagement areas

c. Target reference point

d. Trigger line or points

e. Engagement priorities

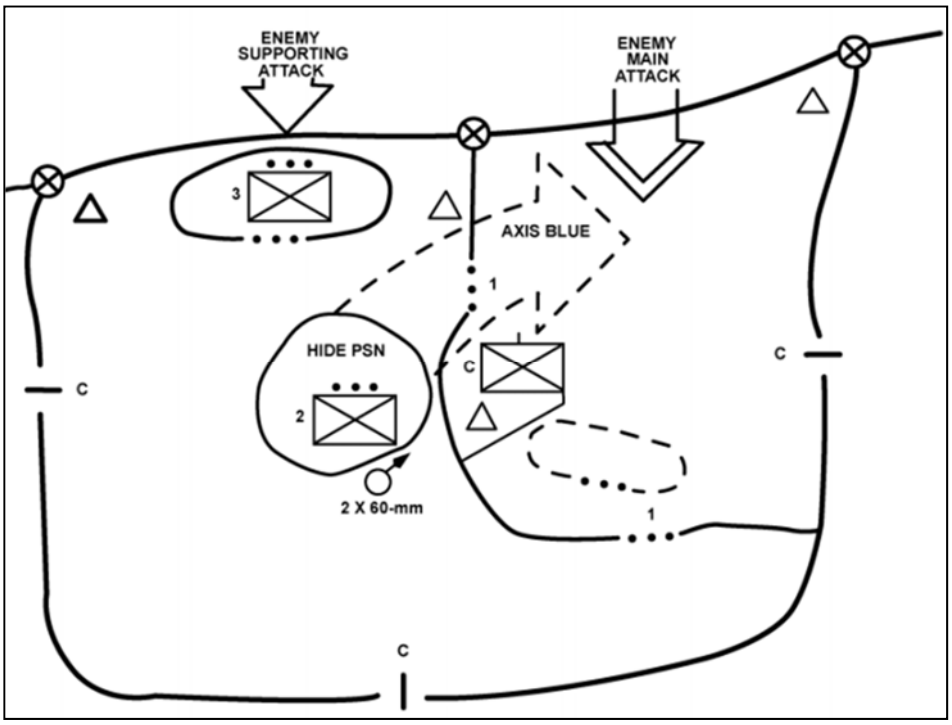


Figure 5.5 - Uses of Multiple Control Measures

0529. **Sectors of Fire.** These may be assigned to a unit or to a specific weapon system. A primary and a secondary sector of fire may be assigned to provide flexibility or as part of a contingency mission.

0530. **Engagement Areas.** EAs or kill zones are normally located along an avenue of approach and are used to mass fires of one or more units to destroy the enemy within these areas. Engagement areas and sectors of fire are not intended to restrict fires or cause operations to become static or fixed. They are used only as tools to concentrate fires and to optimize their effects.

0531. **Target Reference Points.** TRPs are versatile fire control measures. They can be used to identify the limits of a sector of fire and they can also be used to concentrate fires into a very precise area. When properly planned and marked, they can be used to rapidly shift fires during the battle.

0532. **Trigger Lines or Points.** These are used to synchronize the fires of the company and to prevent engaging enemy beyond the maximum range of the weapon.

0533. **Engagement Priorities**. These are assigned to specific units or weapons to provide guidance on what targets to engage when multiple targets are available.

0534. Other consideration for use of direct fire weapons are:

a. **Control measures.** The CO uses control measures to support the company fire plan.

b. **Small Arms.** Small arms include all the rifles, machine guns, and pistols

organic to an Infantry Company. The company fire plan normally assigns control measures to the units and allows the unit leaders to control the fires of individual weapons.

c. **Special Weapons/Munitions.** The company fire plan may address special weapons such as sniper rifles, hand grenades demolitions or other special purpose weapon or munitions.

d. **Anti-Armor Weapons.** An Infantry rifle companyhas Medium Multi-Purpose Assault Weapon and Light Multi- Purpose Assault Weapon.CO normally employ MMAW/ LMAW in the company main effort to ensure that there are no gaps and to see that the units and the weapons have mutual support.

0535. **Indirect Fires.** The CO and company FIST plan indirect-fire targets to support the company scheme of maneuver. They plan targets on all likely enemy approaches and on areas the enemy may use in the attack, such as enemy OPs, support positions, avenues of approach, assault positions, and defiles. Targets are also planned in front, on top of, and behind friendly positions to stop likely penetrations or to support a counterattack. It is possible to plot too many targets. Plan targets on prominent terrain and adjust fire from them. During the defense, the company may be supported by the company mortars, the battalion mortars, or any of the artillery units supporting the battalion. The following considerations apply:

a. **The CO and the company FIST plan the exact locations for any FPF.** An FPF is a barrier of fire planned on the most dangerous enemy avenue of approach to provide immediate close protection for defending soldiers during an enemy assault. It must be integrated with the direct-fire plan (particularly any machine gun FPLs) and the company obstacle plan. It is adjusted as close as possible to friendly soldiers without endangering them. Once the FPF is called for by code word over the radio or by pyrotechnic signal, it is fired continuously until the CO orders it stopped or the firing unit is out of ammunition. The company has an FPF from its mortar section and may have FPFs from the battalion mortars or supporting artillery.

b. **A target list of indirect fire targets planned by the CO and company FSO is sent to the battalion FSO.** The battalion FSO consolidates and coordinates the company fire plans and returns the consolidated list to the CO or company FIST. The target list is then distributed to the platoon leaders and their FOs. This is an example of top-down fire planning.

c. **The company mortar section is positioned where it can place fires on its assigned targets.** It should be far enough to the rear so the mortar's minimum range does not prevent hitting targets within the company sector or BP. This allows mortars to help stop an enemy that has penetrated the defense or to help support a counterattack. A rule of thumb for positioning mortars is to have one-half to two-thirds of their range forward of the company position. However, the distance at which the company can observe and identify targets must be considered. Firing positions should be in defilade and concealed.

0536. **IEDs and Obstacles**. Engineers, if available or the company constructs tactical obstacles to support the commander's concept and maximize the effect of the company's fires. Obstacles are placed to disrupt the enemy formations, force the enemy into EAs with turning obstacles, and hold the enemy in engagement areas with fixing or blocking obstacles. The following considerations apply:

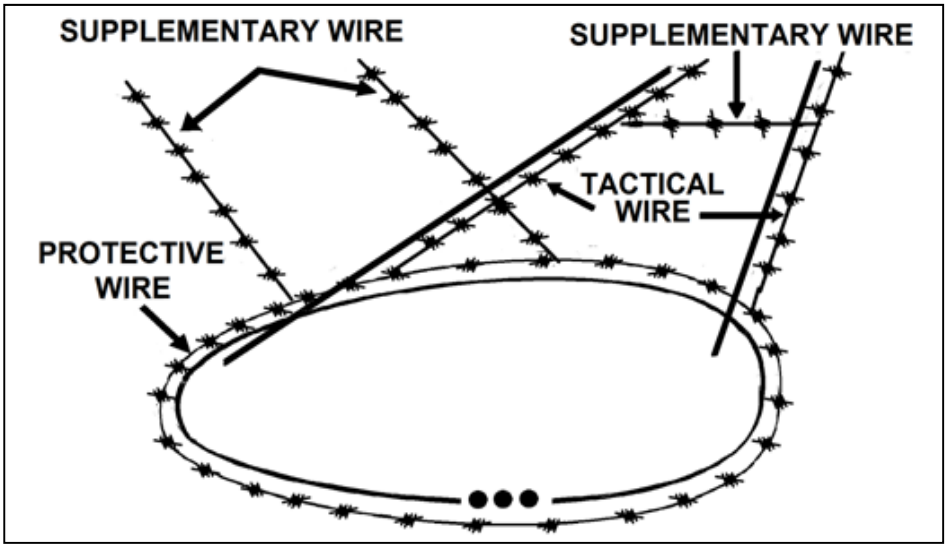


Figure 5.6 - Wire Obstacles

a. For best results, obstacles are employed in depth and existing obstacles are reinforced to increase their effectiveness. The company constructs protective obstacles to defeat the enemy's final assault. A certain type of obstacles is oriented against the most severe close combat threat – antipersonnel obstacles against dismounted infantry and antitank obstacles against an armored force. As with tactical obstacles, protective obstacles are sited according to the terrain and covered by fires. During limited visibility, soldiers are repositioned to ensure obstacles are still covered by fire, and are not covertly breached.

b. Protective obstacles are usually located beyond hand grenade distance (40 to 100 meters) from the soldier's fighting position. Protective wire (Figure 5.6) may be a complex obstacle providing all-round protection of a platoon perimeter, or it may be a simple wire obstacle on the likely dismounted AA into a squad ambush position. Protective IED may be integrated into the protective wire or used separately.

c. Tactical obstacles are positioned to increase the effectiveness of the company's fires. Tactical wire is usually positioned along the friendly side of the machine gun FPLS. IEDs may also be integrated into these wire obstacles or used separately.

d. Supplementary wire obstacles are used to break up the line of tactical wire to prevent the enemy from locating friendly weapons (particularly the machine guns) by following the tactical wire.

e. When planning obstacles, the CO should consider the amount of time required

to prepare them, the burden on the logistical system, the soldiers' loads, and the risk of the enemy detecting the obstacles and the resulting loss of surprise.

Security Requirements

0572. Part of the security plan of the battalion is receiving tasking on the part of the company. There may also be more security tasking that result from the company defense concept of the CO. These tasking may be oriented on friendly units (screen, guard, or secure); on the enemy or terrain (reconnaissance), or on the enemy's reconnaissance assets counter (reconnaissance). The CO establishes a security plan to keep the enemy from observing or surprising the company. This security is established before moving the company into the area and is continuously maintained. He bases this plan on tasks received from the battalion, on the enemy situation, the terrain, and on the visibility conditions. The plan provides active and passive measures and counter-reconnaissance.

0573. **Active Measures.** These include OPs, stand-to, and patrols. The CO can require each platoon to have a set number of OPs. If not, the platoon leaders decide what they need; there should be at least one OP for each platoon. In close-terrain or during limited visibility, there may be one for each squad. The following considerations apply:

a. **Post Personnel for Security.** The CO can also require a set number of men to be on security at all times. The number varies with the enemy situation, terrain, visibility and the units need for rest. As a guide, at least one-third of the soldiers should be on security at all times.

b. **Full Alert.** When an attack is expected, the entire company should be on alert; however, this should not be maintained for long periods. The CO must keep in mind that his soldiers need rest to function in future operations. A sleep plan must be established and enforced. Security however cannot be sacrificed for rest.

c. **Stand-to.** A stand-to is held both morning and evening to ensure that each man adjusts to the changing light and noise conditions, and is dressed, equipped, and ready for action. The stand-to should start before first light in the morning and continue until after light. It should start before dark in the evening and last until after dark. The starting and ending times should vary to prevent establishing a pattern, but the stand-to must last long enough to accomplish its purpose.

d. **Conduct of Patrols**. The battalion can have its companies dispatch patrols whose missions contribute to battalion security. The CO can dispatch patrols in addition to those required by the battalion to satisfy the security needs. He may have the patrols reconnoitre dead space in the sector, gaps between platoons, gaps between the company and adjacent units, or open flanks. The company reserve may provide these patrols.

e. Likewise, the platoons may dispatch similar security patrols. All patrols sent out by the company or its platoons must be coordinated with battalion.

0574. **Passive Measures.** These measures include camouflage, movement control, light and noise discipline, proper radiotelephone procedures, and the use PEWS. The company should also use its NVDs for surveillance.

0575. **Counter-Reconnaissance**. This operation entails denying enemy reconnaissance elements from gaining accurate information on friendly preparations through destruction of enemy recon or through deception. It is seldom possible to deny all information to the enemy. Based on the expected enemy reconnaissance action, the CO decides what information and locations he must protect. He also considers what information would make the enemy act the way he wants him to (such as, to deploy prematurely, deploy too late, attack a false objective, or move into a kill zone). The CO should determine the priorities for the counter-reconnaissance effort and focus his efforts toward denying that information to the enemy. The following considerations apply:

a. **The Company's Counter-Reconnaissance Plan.** The plan shall be integrated into the concept of operation and coordinated with the battalion's plan. At times, the company may be the counter-reconnaissance force for the battalion. An example of the use of counter-reconnaissance is a defense along a river line against a motorized force. The CO determines the importance of denying the enemy knowledge of the crossing sites along the river. He then focuses his counter-reconnaissance efforts on the crossing sites. The CO employs ambushes, IEDs, obstacles, false fighting positions, security patrols, OPs, indirect fires, camouflage, demonstrations, and other measures to destroy or deceive the enemy's reconnaissance elements.

b. **The Concept for the Defense Must Address the Counter- Reconnaissance Battle.** If the battalion order does not provide sufficient detail, the Rifle Company commander must decide how to defeat the enemy's reconnaissance effort. There are two general approaches to this task: 1) Destruction of Enemy Reconnaissance. 2) Allow Entry of Enemy Reconnaissance into MBA.

0576. **Destruction of Enemy Reconnaissance.** The first is to identify and destroy all reconnaissance assets before they can reach the company's MBA. This may be very difficult and may reduce the chance of gaining surprise against the enemy's main body. To fight the counter-reconnaissance battle in this manner requires:

a. **Unity of Command**. All assets/units involved in this effort must be controlled by one leader.

b. **A Well-Planned Concept**. It must include clear tasking, effective task organizations, and detailed fire planning and engineer support. The SS plan must provide the required maintenance, re-supply, and casualty evacuation support.

c. **A Mix of Finders and Fighters**. Certain units are tasked to find the enemy reconnaissance assets. Once located, they report or call for fires. Other units are responsible for destroying these enemy units. They may need to be mobile to cover the entire area.

d. **A Withdrawal Plan**. The rearward passage or repositioning of the units in the counter reconnaissance force must be planned and coordinated with all units involved. The timing for this event is critical and normally depends upon early identification of the enemy's attack forces to be successful.

0577. **Allow Entry of Enemy Reconnaissance into MBA.** The second option is to allow the reconnaissance to move through the area in order to achieve surprise on the enemy main body. This option requires battalion's consent and the maximum use of camouflage and concealment. A variation of this technique would be to allow the enemy's reconnaissance assets to move through the company area and destroy them in the rear. Although the main body may be alerted, they will not have a sound understanding of the defensive scheme.

0578. **Limited Visibility Security.** During limited visibility, the CO must increase security measures to ensure that the enemy does not surprise the company. This can be done by:

a. Increasing the number of OPs and patrols;

b. Occupying supplementary positions if they allow better coverage of obstacles and probable limited visibility avenues of approach;

c. Employing trip flares and other early warning devices;

d. Employing night sights or NVDs;

e. Employing EPWS;

f. Adjusting fire control measures;

g. Increasing the number of soldiers on security in each position;

h. Maintaining noise and light discipline; and

i. Limiting movement by doing the following: 1) At night, the CO may plan for illumination (by artillery, mortars, hand-held flares, and grenade launchers) forward of the company's position (or an open flank) to expose an attacking enemy force. However, all plans for the use of illumination must be coordinated with the adjacent units and approved by the battalion; and, 2) The CO must not fire illumination or allow his soldiers to initiate direct fire too soon. The enemy may employ small patrols to probe the company's defense to find a weak point or to cause soldiers to reveal their positions by initiating fire. If enemy patrols are detected, units should use grenade launchers, Claymore, or indirect fire to engage them. They shall not use direct-fire weapons, particularly crew-served weapons, until the enemy attacks. When the enemy does attack, the CO may call for illumination if the battalion approves it, and the company defends just like in a daylight condition.

Employment of the Reserve

0579. The company may either be the brigade or the battalion reserve. When the company is able to maintain a reserve, battalion commanders may send an order to the CO to not commit the reserve especially without seeking permission. The employment of a reserve that is assigned and is under the control of the company commander is discussed herein.

0580. **Designation of a Reserve.** Even at company level the CO should strive to retain a reserve – even if it is only a squad. Reserves must be used during critical points of the battle. A reserve can be used for any decisive action and for destroying the enemy.

0581. **Size of Reserve**. The size of the reserve may be as large as a platoon or as small as a squad, depending on the flexibility required by the CO to react to the enemy situation. When the enemy only has limited choices in the area of operations, about one or two squads are sufficient. However, when the COA of the enemy is difficult to predict and there are various avenues of approach, the decision of the CO to retain the entire platoon as reserve may be necessary. There are situations which may also require the preparation of committed forces in acting as company reserve. Hence, the estimate of the CO may indicate the platoon that has the smallest probability of danger on the mission. The platoon may also be ordered to prepare as company reserve and be assigned with prioritized missions for the purposes of planning.

0582. **Location of the Reserve**. The reserve is assigned a BP or AA near its most likely place of commitment. It should be located where it can support the main effort and accomplish its be-prepared missions. However, it should also be in a covered and concealed location where soldiers are likely to remain uncommitted until necessary; and mentally and physically ready until committed. An example of a be-prepared mission assigned to the leader of the reserve is: "In priority, be-prepared to block envelopment to the west to protect the company flank, destroy enemy forces in EA Green to prevent enemy penetration of PL Blue, and occupy BP 5 to destroy enemy attempting to envelop 3rd platoon." In the absence of these be-prepared missions, the leader of the reserve begins his planning based on his own estimate.

0583. **Other Tasks for the Reserve**. The reserve may provide assistance to the CO concerning other tasks that are not related to the main defensive mission such as for example, as reconnaissance or resupply. It is the duty of the CO to ensure that the reserve has sufficient rehearsal time and preparation for possible missions. Also, the immediate availability of the reserve must be ensured in times that are necessary. The reserve can perform any critical task for the CO. The following are some common tasks. They are always assigned in priority. The purpose of each task must be clearly stated. The following are the tasks:

a. **Block a Penetration**. The reserve blocks an enemy penetration by fire or maneuver (Figure 5.7). The defending platoons help by firing across the flanks of the penetration when possible. When the company reserve is blocking a penetration, the battalion reserve may counterattack to destroy the penetrating force. Indirect fire helps to contain and reduce the penetration.

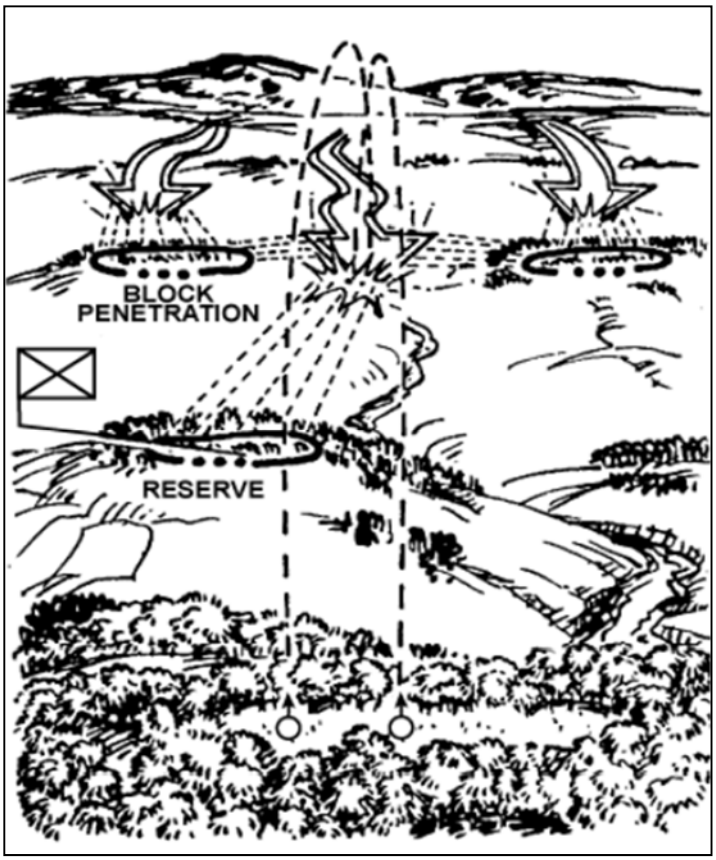


Figure 5.7 - Reserve Blocking a Penetration

b. **Secure the Company Flanks and Rear.** The reserve prepares supplementary positions to secure the company flanks and rear (Figure 5.8). The CO selects which approach to secure. The reserve's position must tie in with supplementary positions of the forward platoons and adjacent units. The reserve may have to occupy a supplementary position to secure a flank when the sector of an adjacent company has been penetrated.

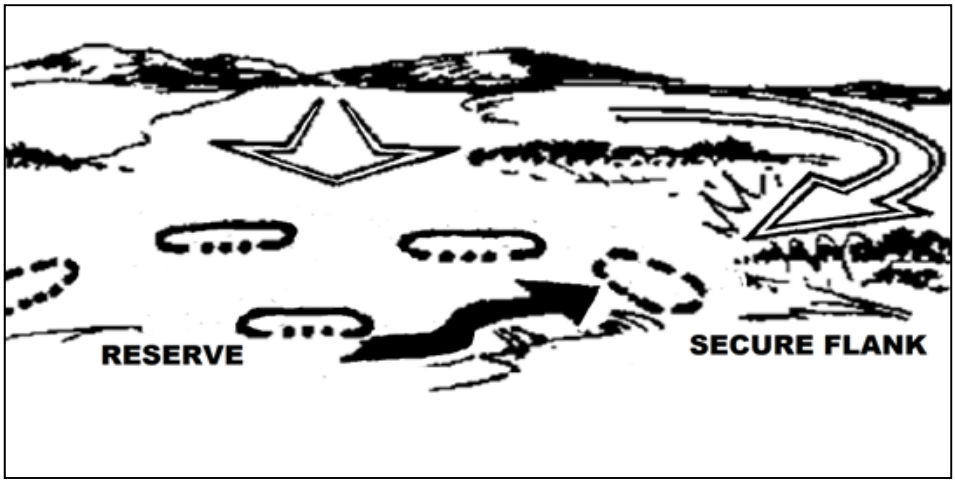


Figure 5.8 - Reserve Securing the Company Flanks and Rear

c. **Support a Forward Platoon by Fire.** For this mission, the reserve is positioned where it can fire into unoccupied areas between forward platoons and on flanks and rear (Figure 5.9). The reserve's position must be so that it can hit enemy soldiers who bypass that position. The reserve is normally kept intact and is moved by the CO as the situation dictates. The paragraph described company-directed and company-controlled counterattacks.

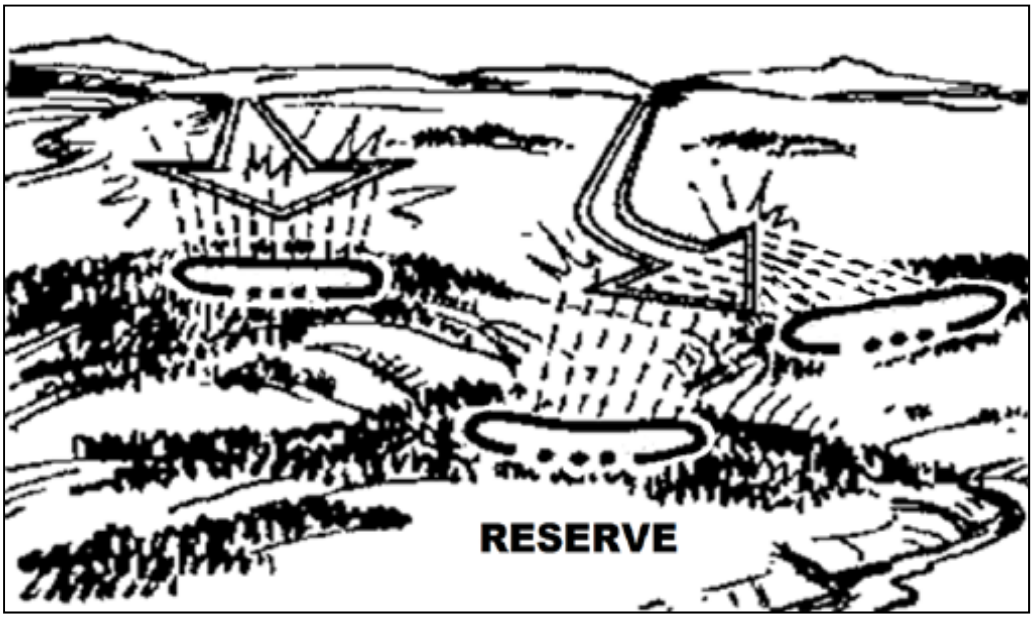


Figure 5.9 - Reserve Supporting a Forward Platoon

d. **Counterattack.** The aim of the counterattack involves total enemy destruction. This means reinforcing success and not failure (Figure 5.10). It is the task of the CO to plan for the counterattack through one or more probable penetrations. Each is a complete attack plan and has a tentative objective and a direction of attack. A plan may have an LD, a route to the LD, an attack position, an LOA, or an RFL with defending platoons. With time, each counterattack plan is rehearsed in order of priority. At least a dry run or a walkthrough of the attack is performed. This helps synchronize the plan with the forward platoon's actions. The reserve executes its other tasks until the CO gives the counterattack order. When initiated, it becomes the main effort and gets priority of all available supporting assets.

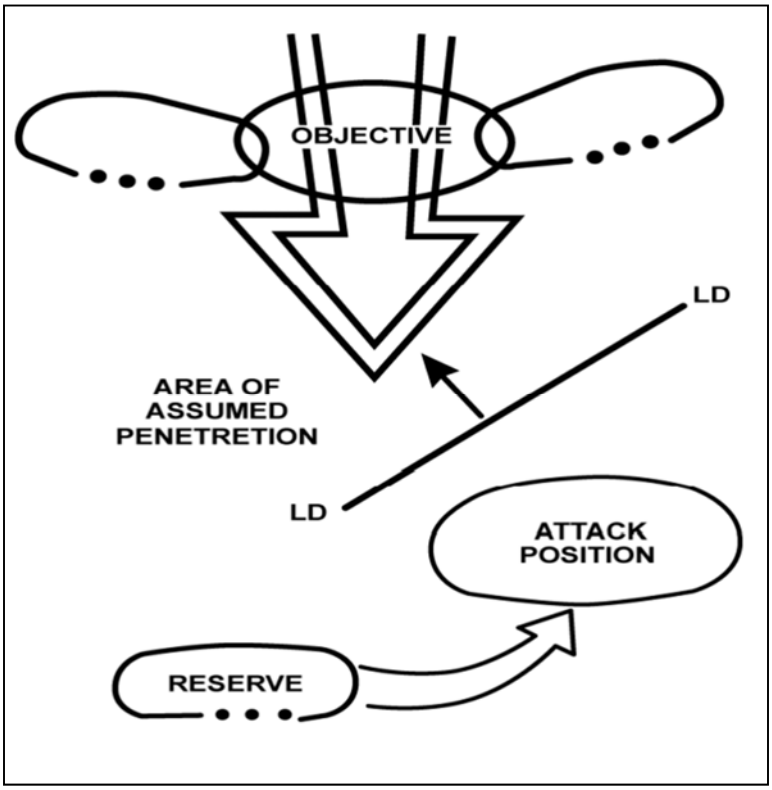


Figure 5.10 - Reserve Counterattacking

Logistics Considerations

0584. The CO chooses the EPW collection point, casualty collection point and the main locations for the company trains.

0585. Company trains are typically split. There are elements that join the company while there are other elements that join the battalion combat trains. Once improved with transportation or medical assets from the battalion, the supplies, personnel and vehicles needed in immediately supporting the company are considered forward in the company. The forward elements of the company trains should be in defilade (in a covered and concealed position) behind the company.

0586. Equipment that is not constantly needed by soldiers, such as rucksacks, sleeping gear, and personal items, should be maintained in the battalion field trains and brought forward only when needed.

0587. The company casualty collection point and the EPW collection point are normally in defilade to the rear of the company. The CO should consider the likely movement of casualties to the rear, generally following the natural lines of drift, to select the casualty collection points.

Command Post Location

0588. The CO locates a CP where he can best control the battle (Figure 5.11). The CO must also consider security and communications requirements when positioning the CP.

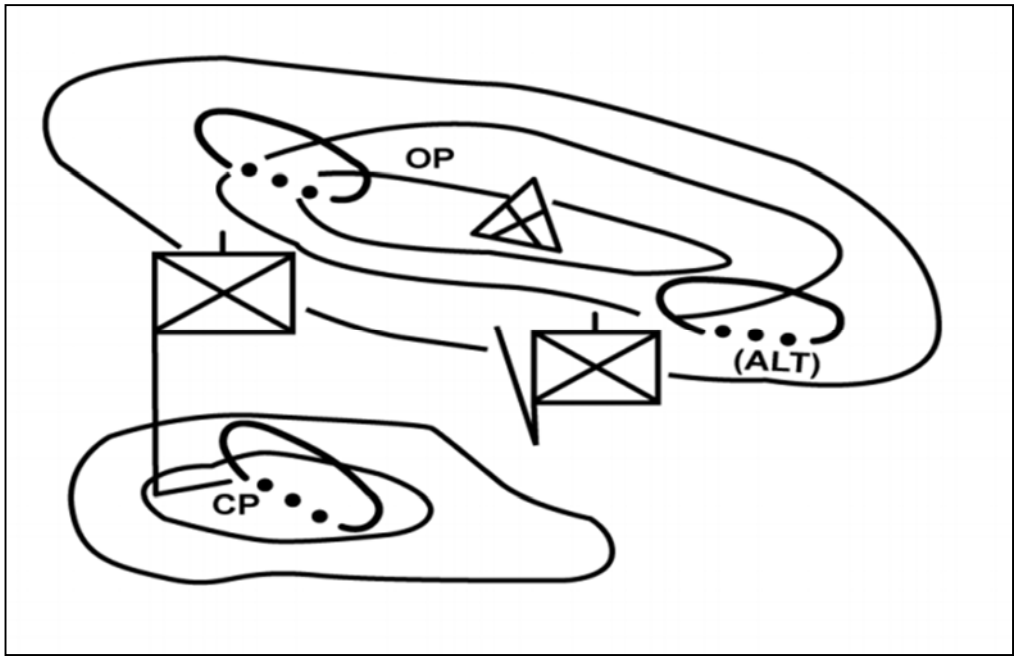


Figure 5.11 - Command Post Location

0589. The CP should be in defilade and concealed from air and ground observation. The CO also selects covered and concealed routes to and from the CP. The CP normally provides its own security with headquarters personnel; however, more security may be obtained by positioning the CP near the reserve. Fighting positions are prepared at the CP.

0590. The company may establish an alternate CP to assume command of the company if the CP is destroyed or ineffective. Normally, the XO, F/Sgt, and possibly the senior medic locate there. This may also be the casualty collection point. In this case, the alternate CP bunker should be large enough to provide overhead cover for the casualties.

Conduct of Defensive Operations

0591. This specific section tackles the sequence of actions which an Infantry company follows in conducting a defensive mission. Normally, the company performs a reconnaissance prior to occupying an area. The unit immediately begins its preparations IAW a detailed priority of work. The use of time, particularly daylight hours, is critical to the success of the defense. Once the enemy attacks, the battle is fought IAW the CO's concept, which may include a counterattack as the decisive action. The company reorganizes throughout the fight to maintain its effectiveness.

Reconnaissance

0592. Prior to occupying defensive positions, the CO typically stops the company that is short of the position. The CO also establishes the local security and gathers all platoon leaders for the reconnaissance which may be conducted in various ways. The CO may perform the reconnaissance on the defensive position even without the platoon leaders. However, the reconnaissance may also be performed again in the presence of the platoon leaders. The time available will have a major impact on the conduct of the reconnaissance. In extreme cases, a map reconnaissance may be the only means available to the CO.

0593. **Reconnaissance Plan.** With any tactical operations, a reconnaissance plan must be developed to either deny or confirm the concept for defense. The requirements for the reconnaissance of the leader will have to be identified as well as prioritized. Once this is completed, the CO may assemble the key leaders and plan one reconnaissance patrol, or he may assign missions to each subordinate unit.

0594. **Personnel Involved.** Normally, the key leaders involved in the leader's reconnaissance include the CO, FSO/FIST, platoon leaders, section leaders, and the leaders of any attached units or weapons. In addition to the key leaders, additional personnel will be required to provide communications and security. The size of the leader’s reconnaissance is dependent upon the plan to conduct the reconnaissance, the need for security, speed, and stealth, and also the occupation plan for the defense.

0595. **Conduct of Reconnaissance.** During the reconnaissance, he confirms enemy avenues of approach, primary, alternate, and supplementary positions for platoons and weapons, dead space in front of the positions, and locations for the company CP, OP, trains, and the EPW collection point.

Occupation of the Defense

0596. **The CO has to plan the defense occupation.** This refers to the company’s movement from their current locations into the specified area for defense. The occupation plans for the different defensive techniques are an SOP. The plan must be based on the defensive concept. It may include a simple route, order of movement, and platoon or section release points. Or it may be a detailed plan involving the leader's reconnaissance, a helicopter insertion into company areas, and an immediate transition to the defensive mission.

0597. **Occupation Plan.** All occupation plans should logically support the defensive concept and provide for the security of the force. They take advantage of cover, concealment, and limited visibility periods and maximize the use of available time for the preparation of the defense.

0598. **Steps in Occupation**. In a company occupation of a battle position, the following steps are taken:

a. Company halts in a covered and concealed location to the rear of the battle position; then, local security is established.

b. The leader's reconnaissance is conducted. Security elements or guides may be left in position as the leaders return to the company.

c. Then the company moves forward as a unit or by platoons or sections to occupy their positions. At a designated place, the CO releases control of the platoons to the platoon leaders, who move their platoons forward and occupy their positions.

d. Undertake defensive activities. They follow the priority of work established by the CO in preparing their defensive positions.

Priority of Work

0599. This refers to the set method in controlling the preparation as well as conducting the defense. It must be recommended by SOP in order to include all necessary individual duties. The task of the CO is to change priorities depending on the given situation. Company leaders should have specific priorities of work for their assigned duty position.

05100. **Priority Tasks.** Although listed in sequence, several tasks may be performed at the same time. An example priority of work sequence is as follows:

a. Establish the company R&S operation.

b. Post local security.

c. Position TOWS, machine guns, and soldiers and assign sectors of fire.

d. Position other assets (CP, mortars, and vehicles).

e. Designate FPLs/FPFs.

f. Clear fields of fire and prepare range cards or sector sketches.

g. Adjust indirect-fire FPFs. The firing unit FDC should provide a safety box that is clear of all friendly units before firing any adjusting rounds.

h. Prepare fighting positions.

i. Install wire communications, if applicable.

j. Emplace obstacles and IEDs.

k. Mark or improve marking for TRPs and direct fire control measures.

l. Improve primary fighting positions such as overhead cover.

m. Prepare alternate and supplementary positions.

n. Establish sleep or rest plan.

o. Reconnoiter movements.

p. Rehearse engagements or disengagements.

q. Adjust positions or control measures, as required.

r. Stockpile ammunition, food, and water.

s. Dig trenches between positions.

t. Reconnoiter routes.

u. Continue to improve positions.

05101. **Routine Personnel Tasks.** Routine priorities for various duty positions or personnel in the company are as follows:

a. **Company Commander**. Many of these duties can be delegated to subordinates, but the CO must ensure they are done. The CO must: 1) Establish Local Security. Set up OPs if not already done and establish a company perimeter. 2) Conduct Leader's Reconnaissance with the Platoon and Section Leaders. Confirm or deny significant deductions or assumptions from the estimate. Designate primary, alternate, and supplementary positions for platoons, sections, and supporting elements. Require platoons to conduct coordination. Designate kill zones, engagement areas, major barriers, and the general CP location. Position key weapons. 3) Check the CP and brief the F/Sgt/XO on the situation and logistics requirements. 4) Upon receipt of the platoon sector sketches, make two copies of a defensive sector sketch and fire plan. Retain one and send one to the battalion (see sample in Figure 5.12). 5) Confirm the platoon positions before digging starts. Coordinate with the left and right units. 6) Check with the battalion commander for any changes or updates in the orders. 7) Finish the security, deception, counterattack, and barrier plans. 8) Walk the company positions after they are dug. Assume a position behind key weapons to confirm clear fields of fire and complete the coverage of the sector of fire; and, 9) Check dissemination of information, interlocking fires, dead space, and security. Correct deficiencies immediately.

b. **Executive Officer and First Sergeant.** One of them must: 1) Establish the company CP. Ensure wire communications link the platoons, sections, and attached elements and send a guide to battalion communications, if applicable. 2) Establish casualty collection points, company logistic release points, and EPW collection points. 3) Brief platoon sergeants on the CP location, logistics plan, and routes between positions. 4) Assist the CO with the sector sketch. 5) Request and allocate pioneer tools, barrier material, rations, water, and ammunition. 6) Walk the positions with the CO. Start supervising emplacement of the platoons and sections, and check range cards and sector sketches. 7) Establish routine security or alert plan, radio watch, and sleep plan. Brief the CO; and, 8) Supervise continuously and assist the CO with other duties as assigned.

05102. **Planning Considerations.** The preparation for delay involves the company commander's use of planning considerations which are identical with those for defense but varies in terms of purpose. Planning for the delays must cover several areas related to hindering enemy movement and maintaining mobility. These considerations include:

a. Use existing terrain and obstacle, enhance by employment of reinforcing obstacle; and

b. Designating a position where the friendly force can harass or impede the enemy without risking decisive engagement itself. This applies specially to a delay in sector. When a battalion is delaying in sector, companies are normally assigned a series specific BPs to enhance command and control across the sector.

c. Likewise, in a company delay in sector, the CO assigned a series of specific BPs for each platoon.

05103. The following are the key personnel who are responsible in specific BPs in the company:

a. **Fire Support Officer.** The FSO must: 1) Assist the CO in planning the indirect fires to support the defense. 2) Advise the CO on the current status of all firing units and on the use of smoke or illumination. 3) Coordinate with the battalion FSO, firing units, and platoon FOs to ensure the fire plan is synchronized and fully understood. 4) Ensure the platoon FO's equipment is fully operational. 5) Ensure the indirect fire plan is rehearsed as fully as possible. 6) Ensure all FPFs are adjusted in as soon as possible; and, 7) Coordinate and or rehearse any repositioning of FOs within the company sector to ensure they can observe targets or areas of responsibility.

b. **Mortar Section Leader.** He must: 1) Choose a tentative firing position(s) and OP(s). Complete his portion of the fire plan (based on the company OPORD and his own estimate). 2) Take part in the company leader's reconnaissance. Confirm or adjust the firing position, select OPs, and coordinate the indirect fire plan with the company FSO. 3) Issue FRAGOs to squads. Conduct a section leader's reconnaissance with squad leaders. Require squad leaders to coordinate with platoons and squads for security and logistic support. 4) Direct the mortar section to begin digging. 5) Establish internal and external wire communications, if applicable. 6) Assist the FSO in completing the fire plan and overlays. 7) Register or adjust the FPF. 8) Inspect the mortar position; and, 9) Reconnoitre routes to alternate firing positions.

c. **Anti-Armor Section Leader.** He must: 1) Select tentative firing positions based on the OPORD, estimate, and map reconnaissance, if the section is acting an anti-armor role. 2) Take part in the company leader's reconnaissance to confirm firing positions. 3) Issue FRAGOs to teams. Conduct a section leader's reconnaissance with team leaders. Require team leaders to coordinate with platoons and squads for security and logistic support. 4) Devise an anti-armor fire plan. Assist with the company sector sketch. Brief the CO and F/Sgt or XO) Ensure the required section equipment and supplies (batteries and bottles) are available and coordinate the resupply requirements. 5) Inspect positions. Check

sight pictures, cover and concealment, range cards, and communications. Correct deficiencies; and, 6) Ensure the fire control measures are understood and clearly marked for observation during limited visibility.

d. **Communications NCO.** He must: 1) Supervise setting radio communications (and wire, if applicable) with the battalion, platoons, and sections. 2) Organize a radio watch. 3) Supervise the performance of PMCS on the radios. 4) Check the platoon radio operators for PMCS and their knowledge of SOI. Brief the CO; and, 5) Assist the F/Sgt / XO, as required. Help organize local security for the CP, dig fighting positions, prepare OPORDS, and so forth.

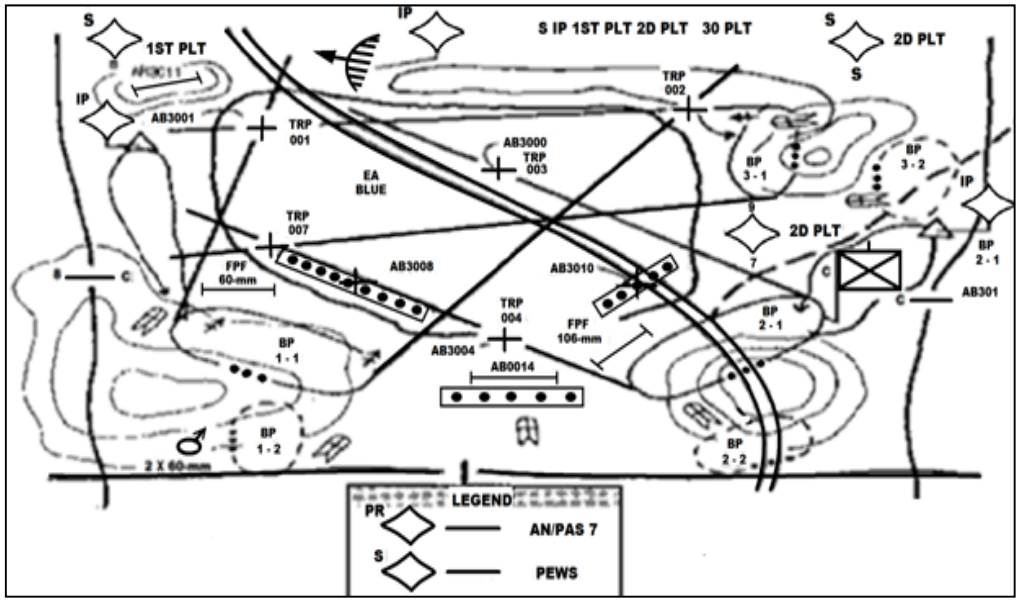


Figure 5.12 - Company Defensive Sector Sketch

Time Management

05104. A critical aspect of defensive planning is managing available time. The CO decides what must be accomplished during daylight to allow platoon and squad defensive preparation to continue during darkness. Because there is never enough time to prepare the defense, the CO must make the best use of time available.

05105. Platoon and squad positions identified and prepared during hours of limited visibility may not be completely effective during daylight. The CO's initial estimate of the time available must include the amount of daylight needed for subordinate leaders to identify primary positions.

05106. The CO may establish a detailed time schedule for completing key actions or events in the priority of work. This ensures that all units are generally at the same point in the priority of work. This also allows rehearsals to be scheduled for the entire unit. An example of this time schedule might be:

a. 1000--Primary fighting positions dug and camouflaged.

b. 1500--Company rehearsal for the counterattack.

c. 1600--Leaders' sand table rehearsal of the indirect fire plan.

d. 1900--Primary positions complete, platoons rehearse disengagement and movement to supplementary positions.

e. 2200--Limited visibility rehearsal for the counterattack.

Daylight Scenario

05107. A planning scenario is provided herein for conducting an estimate when the limited hours of daylight is a significant factor.

05108. The CO receives the defensive OPORD at 0900 on Day 1 in the AA 5 kilometers from the defensive positions. The enemy is not expected to attack within 48 hours, which is not earlier than 0900 on Day 3. BMNT is at 0700 and EENT is at 1800. The CO's one-third of the time would allow him to complete issuing the OPORD at 0100 on Day 2. This, however, will waste the available time for position preparation the first night and, at first light, platoon leaders will still be reconnoitring to site key weapons and squad positions. In the best case, personnel will be just starting to prepare fighting positions two hours after daylight (0900, Day 2), leaving them only 24 hours to prepare.

05109. A better use of the available daylight hours in the above scenario follows:

a. 0900-1000. Upon receipt of the battalion OPORD, the CO conducts a quick METT-T analysis. He then issues an immediate FRAGO to move to and occupy a position in the defensive area; places the XO in charge of the preparation and movement of the company; and departs to the defensive area with his platoon leaders, FSO, and security elements from each platoon.

b. 1100. The CO and platoon leaders (with security) arrive on site.

c. 1115. The CO dispatches platoon leaders (with security) to reconnoitre key points of their tentative positions or sectors as determined from the map reconnaissance.

d. 1115-1300. The CO makes a tentative plan.

e. 1300. Upon the return of the platoon leaders, the CO revises the tentative plan based upon the reconnaissance reports.

f. 1330-1400. The CO issues the OPORD to the available orders group. Platoon leaders then continue their planning process.

g. 1530. When the rest of the company arrives, the platoon leaders have reconnoitred their positions and completed their platoon OPORDS.

h. 1600. Squad leaders designate primary, alternate, and supplementary positions during daylight. The platoon leader and CO have two hours of daylight left to

make adjustments before position preparation is final.

Defensive Battle

05110. The defensive battle starts when the planned signal or event for initiating fires occurs. In a very non-linear fight, the authority for the initial engagement may be delegated to the lowest level. This initial engagement may be a squad ambush, massed fires in an EA, or by engaging the enemy at maximum effective range of each system. The platoon and squad leaders then conduct the fight in accordance with the CO's concept. The following is a discussion of a centralized company defense. Remember, this does not apply when conducting a decentralized, non-linear defensive battle consisting of squad and platoon actions.

05111. All company weapons fire at appropriate targets as they come within range IAW the fire plan. Leaders and FOs are alert to direct and control fire where it is needed to avoid wasting ammunition.

05112. The rate of fire increases as the enemy approaches. If tanks and Infantry are attacking, fire is placed to force the tanks to button up and separate foot soldiers from the tanks (SP 3-014, 2005).

05113. If attacking formations are not broken up forward of the company's position, the enemy will assault. The CO then calls for his FPF. Machine guns that have an FPL fire on that FPL; those that do not, fire along their PDF. Mortars and artillery fire their FPFs if allotted. All other weapons fire within their sectors until the assault has been halted. The following considerations apply:

a. An arranged signal, such as a flare, is used to stop the firing when the assault has been halted. The FPF may be repeated, as needed. Since the FPF expends a lot of ammunition, it should only be on a case-to-case basis since it is used for stopping an enemy assault from closing on the defense position. If the enemy gets through the FPF, he is repelled by close combat and or counterattack; and

b. If the company is threatened from the flanks or the rear, the CO may move platoons or the reserve to fight from supplementary positions. If platoons and squads are forced from their primary positions, they move to their alternate positions: 1) Throughout the conduct of the defense, the platoon leaders keep the CO informed of their situation. He, in turn, must keep the battalion commander informed of the company's situation; and, 2) Once the enemy is repelled, the CO re-establishes OPs and sends patrol units forward to maintain enemy contact. Indirect fire is called on areas where the enemy is apt to regroup. In some situations, a spoiling attack may be appropriate. The company reorganizes and prepares for another enemy attack.

Counterattack

05114. As in an attack, the same exact principles apply in any counterattacks. The timing is always critical. In order to be decisive, counterattacks must be conducted in times when the enemies are dispersed, disorganized and overextended during the actual attack. Counterattacks may be conducted by a designated counterattack unit; usually

the reserve or by a subordinate unit with a be-prepared mission to conduct a counterattack. It may be a planned action in the CO's concept or it may be an immediate action by a subordinate unit based on the situation. All counterattacks should be rehearsed in the same conditions that they are expected to fight in. Counterattacks are most effective against an enemy force that has been stopped.

05115. Counterattacks may be extremely effective when conducted by small units as part of a decentralized, non-linear defense. When combined with an ambush to halt and disorganize an attacker, a small counterattack force can achieve superior combat power. If the attack is not decisive, the force can disengage and seek out another part of the enemy to attack.

05116. Larger scale counterattacks that are keys to the CO's concept require additional planning, coordination, and rehearsals. Normally, the defense is organized to force the enemy into a position where the counterattack can be decisive. The entire company must understand the timings, responsibilities and the fire plan. Ideally, the counterattack force is located in a covered and concealed location requiring minimal movement to begin the assault or fires. The farther they must move, the more likely the enemy will be able to identify them and react to their attack.

05117. When the company reserve conducts the counterattack, it normally becomes the main effort and is given priority of fire from all available fire support. The reserve avoids friendly positions, makes a quick decisive assault, and clears the penetrated area. Any soldiers from the forward platoon who stay in the penetrated area come under the control of the reserve when it comes into this. Once the counterattack is ordered, a new reserve should be constituted. When the CO decides to commit his reserve in a counterattack, he notifies the battalion commander at once.

05118. Any subordinate unit may conduct an immediate counterattack if they are in position with adequate combat potential to be effective and it supports the CO's concept. Simple contingency plans designating rally points and likely support positions and or kill zones will provide this flexibility.

Reorganization

05119. The reorganization automatically begins at lowest levels. Beginning the engagement, company leaders need to be fully aware of their units' status in order to enable immediate reorganization whenever required. However, some of the considerations in this section must wait until a lull in the battle. The following considerations apply:

a. **Assignment or Replacements**. Assign personnel to replace key soldiers lost during the fight. For example, ensure crew-served weapons are manned and the chain of command is re-established.

b. **Re-establish Security**. If soldiers withdrew from the OPs to their fighting positions, return them to their OPs. If some did not get back to the platoon position, check their status and replace casualties. Coordinate with adjacent units to determine the situation in their areas. As soon as feasible, re-establish the security system.

c. **Treat or Evacuate Casualties.** Treat casualties as far forward as practical. Those who can continue to fight are returned to their positions. Evacuate the others. Report the dead and evacuate the bodies as soon as practical.

d. **Redistribute Ammunition and Supplies.** Distribute remaining ammunition and supplies equally among the soldiers, including ammunition from casualties. Issue any stockpiled ammunition to the squads. Take a quick inventory of other needs. Submit status reports to the company headquarters, including ammunition, barrier materials, and medical supplies. Consider the use of any enemy arms and ammunition that may be available from their casualties.

e. **Reposition.** During the assault, the enemy may have pinpointed some of the positions. Move to an alternate or supplementary position. If certain positions are in danger or is dependent upon surprise to be effective, reposition soldiers and weapons (particularly crew-served weapons) that are vulnerable or do not have good observation and fields of fire. Adjust positions to maintain mutual support.

f. **Re-establish Communications.** Provide a status report to the CO. When radio contact is impossible and landline not available, send a messenger. The unit SOP should allow units to continue operations without communications. Only send a messenger when unable to continue the mission or when changing the plan. If a visual signal was already used, consider changing that signal since the enemy may have recognized it. These signals must be coordinated with adjacent units to prevent confusion.

g. **Repair Fighting Positions.** Each soldier checks and, if needed, replaces the camouflage, overhead cover, and sandbags on existing positions and camouflages new positions.

h. **Repair or Replace Damaged or Breached Obstacles, IEDs, and Booby Traps**. Replace these devices only if enemy soldiers are far enough away so it can be done safely. This is risky, especially if the enemy has snipers. Wait for poor visibility to do so or use smoke to hinder observation.

i. **Use Snipers.** Before an attack is initiated and after it has been stopped, the defending unit may add to its security by using snipers. They should be allowed to move anywhere in the position. They find and hit targets such as enemy reconnaissance parties, infiltration teams, leaders, obstacle-breaching teams, weapon crews, stragglers, and enemy snipers. If no dedicated snipers are available, use the best marksmen in the unit. They are effective out to 560 meters when armed with the M16A1.

Defensive Techniques

05120. There are various defensive techniques that may be employed by the infantry company. Estimates must be properly conducted and must focus on the defensive concept by means of identifying potential decisive points. The commander then determines the most effective means of positioning or maneuvering his units or weapons to generate overwhelming combat power at these points. The techniques

discussed in this section should be used only as basic approaches to developing a defensive concept. The ideal concept may be a combination of several different techniques. The paragraphs and sub-sections below provide detailed information on such techniques.

Non-Linear Defense

05121. The non-linear defense is the most decentralized and dynamic defense conducted by an Infantry Company. It is frequently used when operating against an enemy force that has equal or greater firepower and mobility capabilities. This type of defense is almost exclusively enemy-oriented and is not well-suited for retaining terrain. This defense depends on surprise, offensive action, and the initiative of small unit leaders to be successful (Figure 5.13). It is a very fluid defense with little static positioning involved. The following considerations apply:

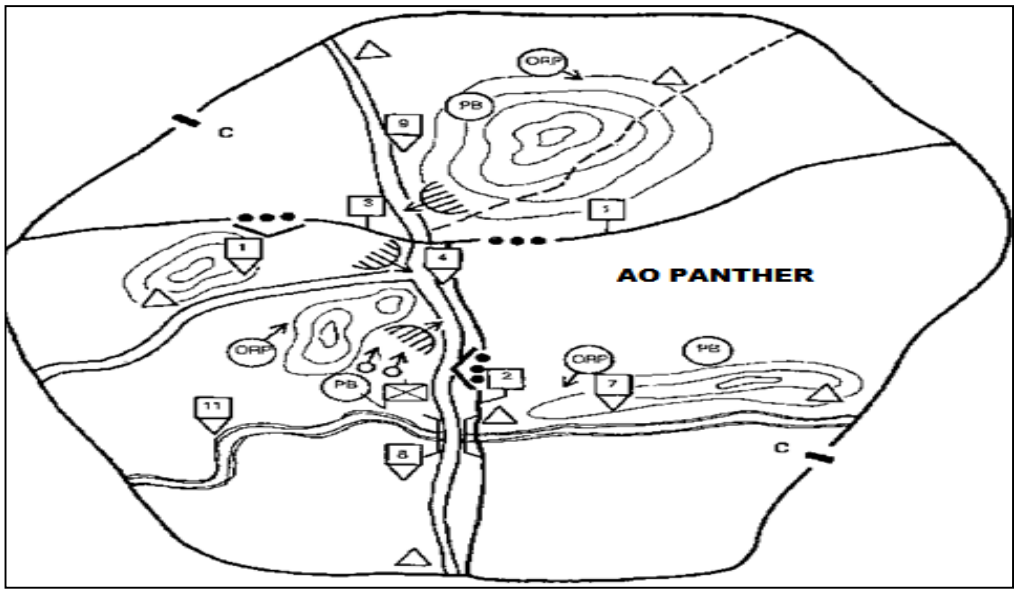


Figure 5.13 - Non-Linear Defense

a. Normally, the battalion directs this defensive technique when the battalion concept does not focus the company at a single decisive point. An example is when the battalion assigns the company a sector and a mission that focuses the company on the enemy force. Mutual support is achieved solely through the linkage of purposes in the mission statement.

b. The CO may decide to conduct a non-linear defense when he is unable to identify a single decisive point that will allow the company to concentrate combat power and achieve its mission. A terrain that prevents mutual support between platoons and or an enemy force capable of directing overwhelming firepower against identified friendly positions also support conducting a non-linera defense.

c. The reconnaissance and security plan for this type of defense will focus on avoiding detection by the enemy's reconnaissance assets. Operating in smaller units supports this requirement. Preparation and activity along likely

reconnaissance routes must be closely controlled. Ideally, the enemy reconnaissance will be allowed to move through the area before they are destroyed.

d. The CO assigns platoon sectors and may also identify likely ambush positions and rally points for each platoon. He identifies a main effort and assigns the supporting efforts missions that provide mutual support and degrade the enemy's ability to generate combat power against the main effort. The main effort may be weighted by assigning priority of fires, by the allocation of IEDs, barrier materials, and other supplies, and by locating the CP, casualty collection point, and most of the caches in their vicinity.

e. The platoons conduct numerous squad and platoon ambushes, raids, and counterattacks, but they avoid decisive engagement. Before the enemy is able to react and concentrate against these small units, they disengage and seek out another enemy weak point. The synchronization for this defense may be event-oriented or accomplished by assigning ambush locations and initiating times or signals. The event-oriented synchronization involves identifying key enemy assets or vehicles that, if destroyed or disrupted, will have the greatest effect on the enemy.

f. A company reserve is normally quite small. Due to the extended distances that the company and platoons are operating over, the timely employment of the company reserve in a decisive action is not likely. Generally, the platoons will be able to employ the resources more effectively. A squad-sized company reserve could be employed under the control of the F/Sgt as a logistics squad, for casualty evacuation, or as a reaction force to support the main effort.

g. Other concerns include the difficulty of conducting resupply operations or casualty evacuation when defending in this manner. The resupply can be affected through prepositioning of the critical supplies. Casualty evacuation will require detailed planning and battalion support. Casualty collection points must be identified well forward to support each platoon. Litter teams moving on routes that avoid the enemy normally accomplish the evacuation from these points to the BAS or the company collection point. If possible, vehicular evacuation begins at the company collection point or as far forward as possible. Request that treatment teams from the BAS be positioned at the company collection point particularly if it is expected that casualties may have to be held until darkness for evacuation.

Defense in Sector

05122. This disposition may consist of platoon sectors and a series of mutually supporting BPs on armor-restrictive terrain, or a combination of the two (Figure 5.14). Positions are arrayed in depth. The strength of this defense comes from its flexibility. This defense normally orients on the enemy force and not retaining terrain. It is effective because it allows the enemy to expose his flanks and critical C2 and CS assets through his own maneuver into the depth of the defense.

05123. The company defense in sector may be fought very similar to the non-linear defense, as this is done by assigning platoon sectors. This decentralized technique for conducting a defense in sector requires greater initiative and delegates more of the control to subordinate leaders. The small-unit actions are very similar to the non-linear defense. When required, squads or platoons may disengage independently and move to another location within the sector to continue the fight. Considerations for the company R&S plan and employment of a reserve are also very similar to the non-linear defense.

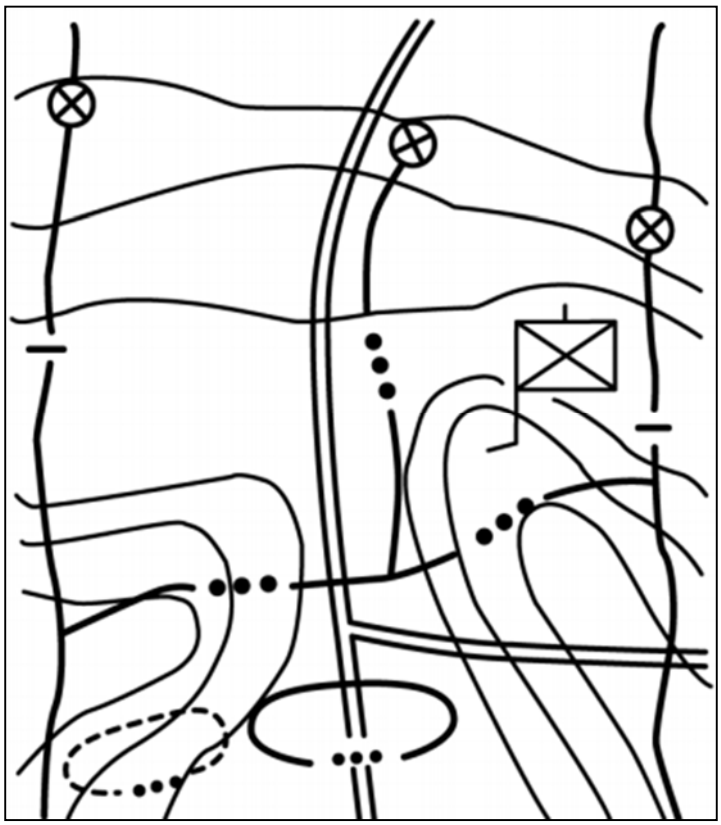


Figure 5.14 - Defense in sector

05124. When fighting a company defense in sector from platoon battle positions, the concept is to defeat the attacker through the depth of his formation, confronting him with effective fires from mutually supporting BPs as he attempts to maneuver around them. IEDs, other obstacles, Infantry positions, patrols, and PEWs cover gaps that, due to terrain masking or heavy woods, cannot be covered effectively by fire. Units remain in place except for local or internal movement to alternate or supplementary positions. If certain positions become untenable during the battle, the CO may withdraw them according to prepared plans. The following considerations apply:

a. One technique is to allow the enemy to move into the EA and destroy him with massed fires. Another technique is to engage the attacker at maximum range with fires from tactical aircraft, attack helicopters, field artillery, and mortars. Then engage with organic anti-armor weapons positioned to deliver fires at maximum effective ranges from flanks and rear. As the enemy closes, anti-armor weapons may move to alternate and supplementary firing positions within the BP to continue firing and to avoid being bypassed.

b. The company defense in sector from platoon battle positions generally requires the CO to be able to see and control the battle. It also requires good fields of fire to allow mutual support to be achieved. If the terrain or the expected enemy course of action would prevent this, the defense may be more effective if control was more decentralized and the platoons were fighting in sector.

05125. A significant concern, particularly when fighting from BPs, is the enemy's ability to isolate a part of the company, fix, and then destroy them. Without effective mutual support between the BPs, this will likely occur. Even with mutual support, responsive and effective fire support may be critical to defending the BPs. Without a responsive fire support a capable enemy can quickly concentrate combat power at identified BP.

Defense from Battle Positions

05126. While this specific defensive technique appears to be centralized and more linear at company level, it must not be a static defense (Figure 5.15). Battle positions must be positioned in order to achieve the surprise as well as allow the maneuver in and between the BPs. In this manner, it prevents the enemy from isolating one part of the company and concentrating his combat power in a specific area. Normally, platoons are assigned mutual supporting battle positions that cover the enemy likely avenue of approach. It is effective in concentrating combat power into an engagement area. These BPs are located on terrain that provides cover and concealment and restricts vehicular movement.

05127. The commander's concept for fighting this type of defense should concentrate on achieving surprise from each of the BPs. This is accomplished by conducting an effective counter-reconnaissance effort to prevent the enemy from locating the BPs and by initiating fires from one BP and waiting for the enemy to react to this engagement prior to engaging from the other BPs (Figure 5.16). Fighting in this manner will cause confusion among the enemy and disrupt his C2.

05128. When the terrain provides a large EA and the commander’s concept allows most of the enemy into the EA, the company may engage with massed fires from the entire platoon BPs. A disadvantage to this technique is that if there are still uncommitted enemy forces outside the EA, they will know the locations of the BPs and will attempt to isolate any of the BPs and concentrate its combat potential against it. Contingency plans to disengage from these BPs and reorganize and to continue the fight must be developed. This may involve displacing to alternate BPs by engaging to conduct counterattacking or spoiling attacks against identified enemy C2, CS, or SS assets.

05129. Instead of one company EA, multiple EAs may be identified to provide flexibility to the plan (Figure 5.17). The plan must clearly state when platoons must reorient fires into the alternate engagement area.

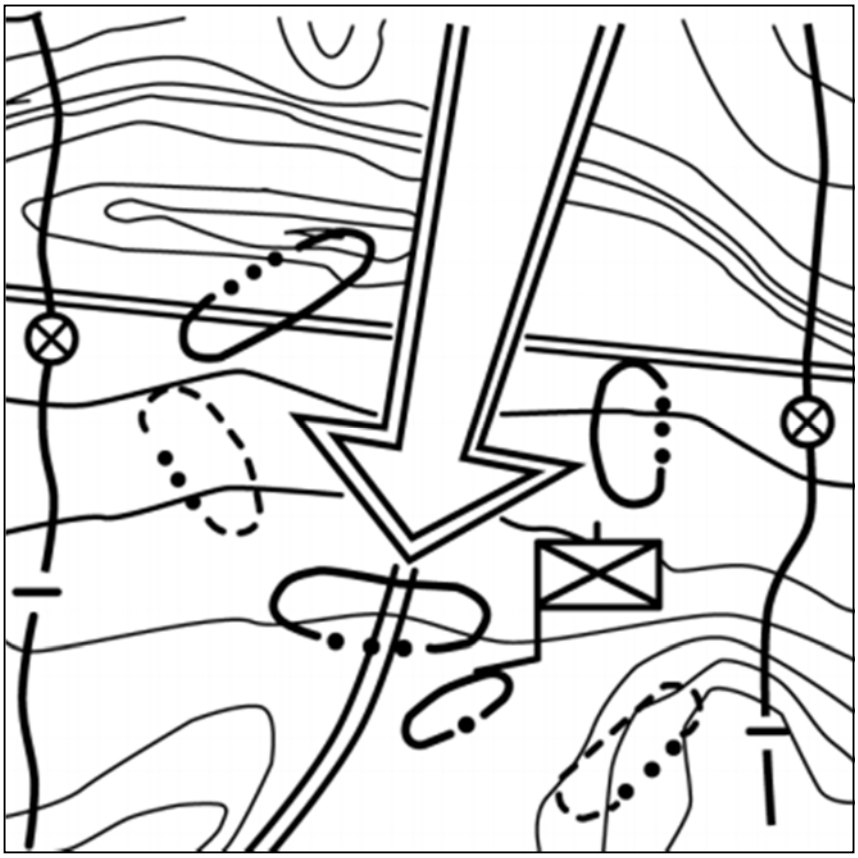


Figure 5.15 - Mutually Supporting BPs

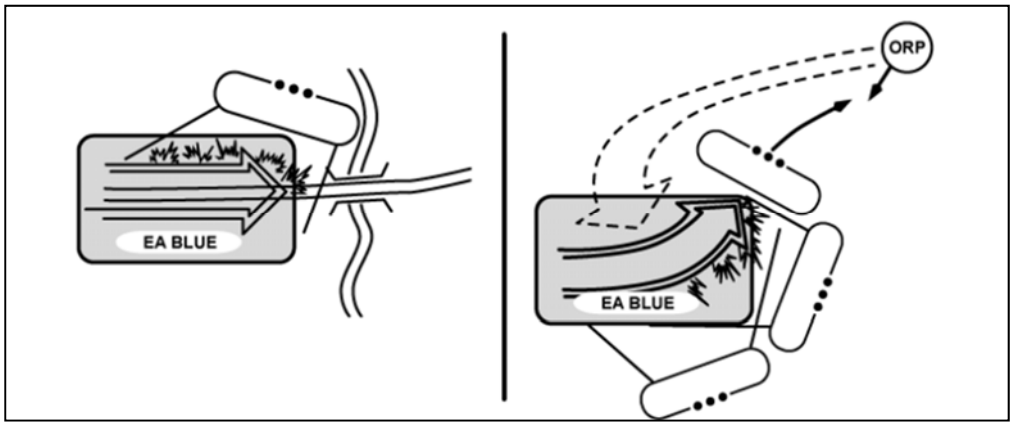


Figure 5.16 - Opening Fire to Achieve Surprise

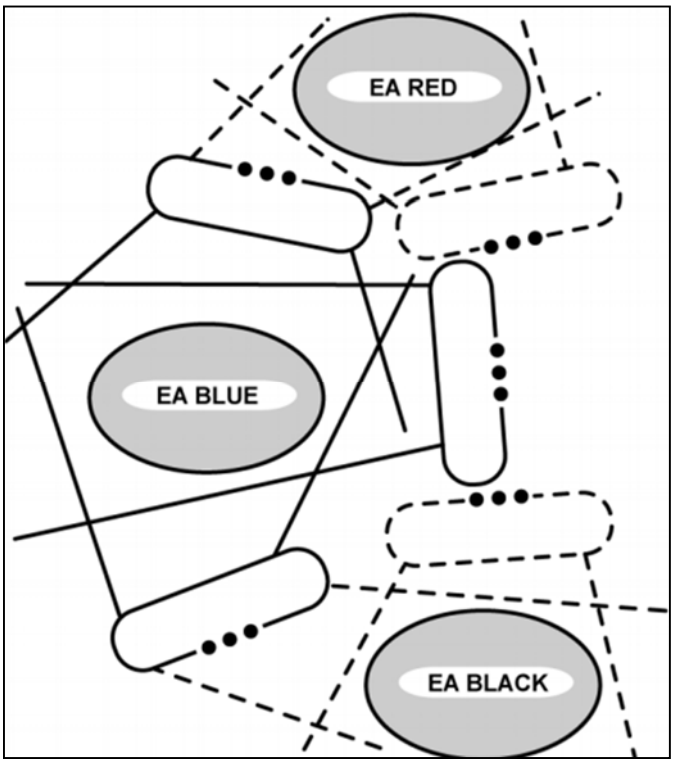


Figure 5.17 - Multiple Engagement Areas

05130. An alternative to defending on the forward slope of a hill or a ridge is to defend on a reverse slope (Figure 5.18). In such a defense, the company is deployed on terrain that is masked by the crest of a hill from enemy direct fire and ground observation. Although, some units and weapons may be positioned on the forward slope, the crest, or the counter slope (a forward slope of a hill to the rear of a reverse slope), most of the units must be positioned on the reverse slope. The key to this defense is control of the crest by fire. The following considerations apply when defending on a reverse slope:

a. The crest protects the company from direct fire. This is a distinct advantage if the attacker has greater weapons range than the defender. The reverse slope defense can eliminate or reduce the "stand-off" advantage of the attacker. It also makes enemy adjustment of his indirect fire more difficult since he cannot see his rounds impact. It keeps the enemy's second echelon from supporting the first echelon's assault.

b. The enemy may be deceived and may advance to close contact before he discovers the defensive position. Therefore, the defender has the advantage of surprise.

c. The defender can improve positions, build obstacles, and clear fields of fire without disclosing his positions.

d. The defender may use dummy positions on the forward slope to deceive the enemy.

e. Resupply and evacuation (when under attack) may be easier when defending on

a reverse slope.

f. Enemy target acquisition and jamming efforts are degraded. Enemy radar, infrared sights, and thermal viewers cannot detect soldiers masked by a hill. Radios with a hill between them and the enemy are less vulnerable to jamming and direction finders.

g. Enemy use of CAS and helicopters is restricted. Enemy aircraft must attack defensive positions from the flank or from the rear, which makes it easier for friendly air defense weapons to hit them.

h. A counterattacking unit has more freedom of maneuver since it is masked from the enemy's direct fire.

i. It may allow anti-armor shots at the thinner armor on top of armored vehicles.

j. The crest can provide protection from the blast effect of a nuclear explosion.

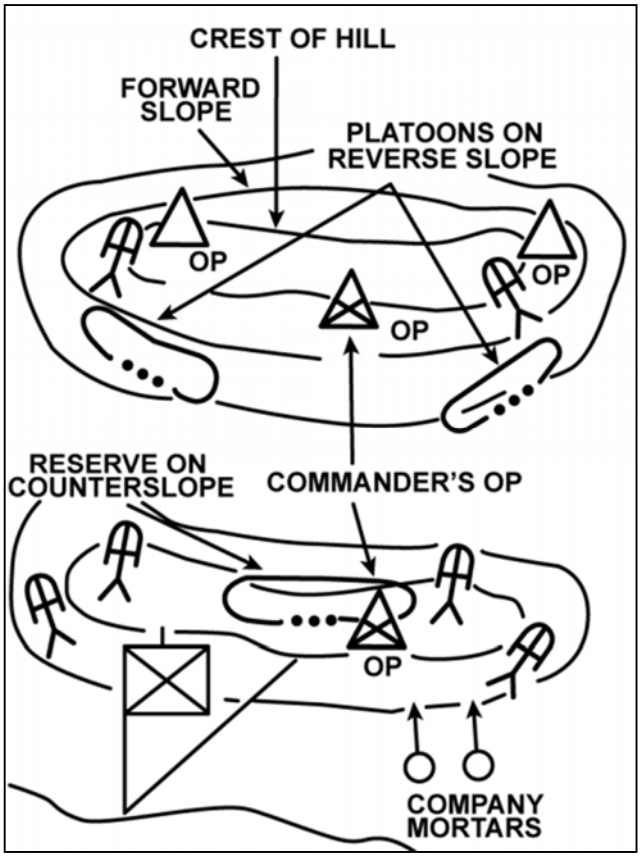


Figure 5.18 - Company Defense on a Reverse Slope

05131. **Special Considerations.** The following considerations may apply when defending on a reverse slope:

a. Observation of the enemy is more difficult. Soldiers in this position see forward no farther than the crest. This makes it hard to determine exactly where the

enemy is as he advances, especially when visibility is poor. OPs must be placed forward of the topographic crest for early warning and long-range observation.

b. Egress from the position maybe more difficult.

c. Fields of fire are normally short.

d. Obstacles on the forward slope can be covered only with indirect fire or by units on the flanks of the company unless some weapons systems are initially placed forward.

e. If the enemy gains the crest, he can assault downhill. This may give him a psychological advantage.

f. If OPs are insufficient or improperly placed, the defenders may have to fight an enemy who suddenly appears in strength at close range.

g. Feasibility. A defense on a reverse slope may be effective when the enemy has more long-range weapons than the defender, the forward slope has little cover and concealment, the forward slope is untenable because of enemy lire, the forward slope has been lost or not yet gained, there are better fields of fire on the reverse slope, and it adds to the surprise and deception.

05132. **Plans.** The fundamentals of the defense apply to a defense on a reverse slope:

a. Position of forward platoons shall be within 200 to 500 meters of the crest of the defended hill or ridge and sited so they block enemy approaches and exploit existing obstacles. They should permit surprise fire on the crest and the approaches around the crest. Forward fighting positions should have rear and overhead cover to protect friendly soldiers from fratricide.

b. Post OPs, including FOs, on the crest or the forward slope of the defended hill. At night, OPs and patrol units should be increased to prevent infiltration. Machine guns may be attached to Ops:

c. Position the unit designated to operate in depth or as reserve at a location where it can: 1) Block the most likely enemy penetration. 2) Support the forward platoons by fire. 3) Protect the flanks and the rear of the company; and, 4) Counterattack.

d. Position the company CP to the rear where it will not interfere with the reserve or supporting units. The CO may have an OP on the forward slope or crest and another on the reverse slope or counter slope. He uses the OP on the forward slope or crest before the battle in order determine the enemy's intentions. During the fight, he moves to the OP on the reverse slope or counter slope for better control of the battle.

e. Plan indirect fire well forward of, on, and to the flanks of the forward slope, crest, reverse slope, and counter slope. Plan indirect FPF on the crest of the hill to control the crest and stop assaults. Put the mortar section in defilade to the

rear of the counter slope.

f. Reinforce natural obstacles. A hasty protective IED on the reverse slope just down from the crest where it can be covered by fire can slow the enemy's advance and hold him under friendly fire.

g. The CO normally plans counterattacks. He plans to drive the enemy off the crest by fire, if possible. But he must also be prepared to drive the enemy off by fire and movement.

Perimeter Defense

05133. It is the Rifle Company that prepares the perimeter defense especially when friendly units adjacent to it are not available (Figure 5.19). A perimeter defense may be used in a reserve position, in an assembly area or patrol base, on a semi-independent operation, during resupply, or when the company is isolated. The following actions constitute setting up a perimeter defense.

05134. Prepare a perimeter defense as any position of defense, but disperse the company in a circular configuration for all-round security; its actual shape depends on the terrain. The company must be prepared to defend in all directions.

05135. The CO assigns a unit that covers the most likely enemy approach. It is a smaller sector compared to other units. He prepares alternate and supplementary positions within the perimeter.

05136. Keep the mortars near the center of the perimeter so their minimum range (70 meters) does not restrict their ability to fire in any direction. They should be dug in and have covered ammunition storage bunkers. They communicate by phones, if applicable (the wire should be buried). The FDC is dug in with overhead cover.

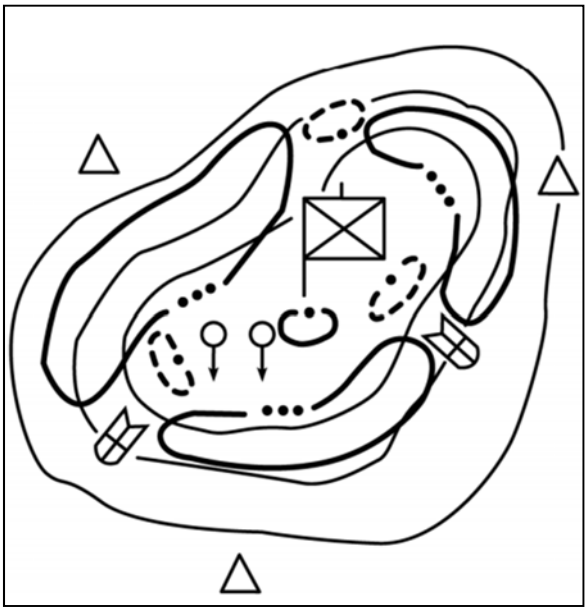


Figure 5.19 - Company Perimeter Defense

05137. Hold at least one rifle squad in reserve. The CO assigns a primary position to the rear of the platoon, covering the most dangerous avenue of approach. It may also be assigned supplementary positions since it must be prepared to fight in all directions.

05138. Prepare obstacles and IED in depth around the perimeter.

05139. Plan direct and indirect fire as for any type of defense. Plan and use fire support from outside the perimeter when available.

05140. Counter enemy probing attacks by area fire weapons (artillery, mortars, Claymores, and grenade launchers) to avoid revealing the location of fighting positions. If the enemy continues to advance, have the machine gunners and riflemen fire.

05141. If the perimeter is penetrated, the reserve blocks the penetration and covers friendly soldiers while they move to their alternate or supplementary positions. Even though the company's counterattack ability is limited, it must strive to restore its perimeter.

05142. SS elements may support from within the perimeter or from another position. Supply and evacuation may be by air. Consider the availability of LZs and DZs (protected from enemy observation and fire) when selecting and preparing the position.

05143. A variation of the perimeter defense to effectively use the terrain is the Y-shaped perimeter defense. This defense is used when the terrain, cover and concealment, or the fields of fire do not support the physical positioning of the platoons in a circular manner. The Y-shaped perimeter defense (Figure 5.20) has three different axis radiating from one central point. It is still a perimeter defense because it is effective against an attack from any direction. This defense provides all-round perimeter fires without having to position soldiers on the perimeter. It is most likely to be effective in mountainous terrain, but it also may be effective in a dense jungle environment due to limited fields of fire. All of the fundamentals of a perimeter defense previously discussed apply but some adjustments and special considerations are required, such as:

a. Although each platoon battle position has a primary orientation for its fires, each platoon must be prepared to reorient to mass fires into the kill zone at the rear.

b. When there is not a most likely enemy approach identified or during limited visibility, each platoon may have half of its soldiers oriented into the kill zone to the front and half into the kill zone to the rear. Ideally, supplementary individual fighting positions are prepared to allow the soldiers to reposition when required to mass fires into one kill zone.

c. When a most likely enemy avenue of approach is identified, the CO may adjust the normal platoon orientations to concentrate fires (Figure 5.21). This entails excepting risk in another area of the perimeter. The company security plan should compensate for this with additional OPs, patrols, or other measures.

d. The positioning of the CP, mortars, a reserve, or any SS assets is much more difficult due to a lack of depth within the perimeter.

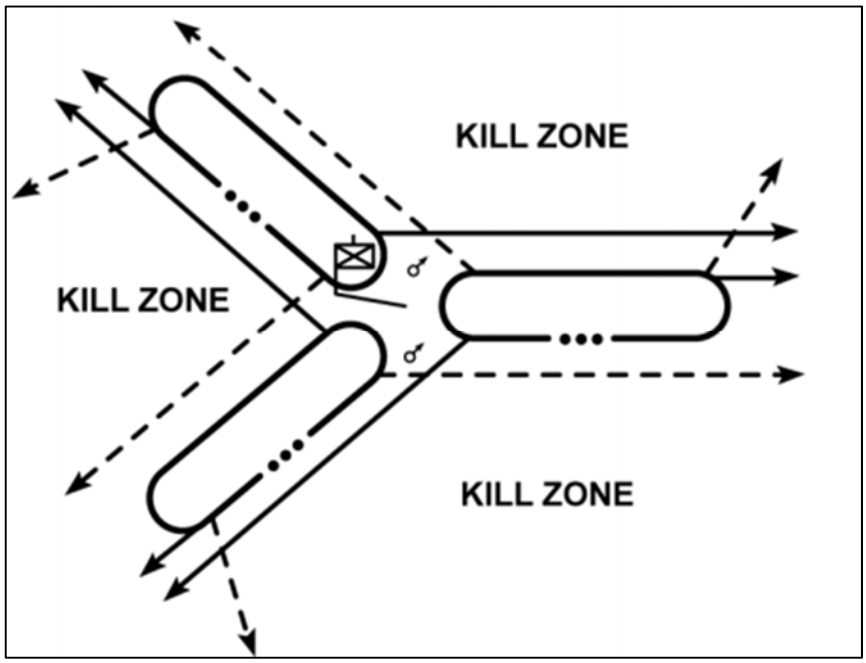


Figure 5.20 - Y-Shaped Perimeter Defense

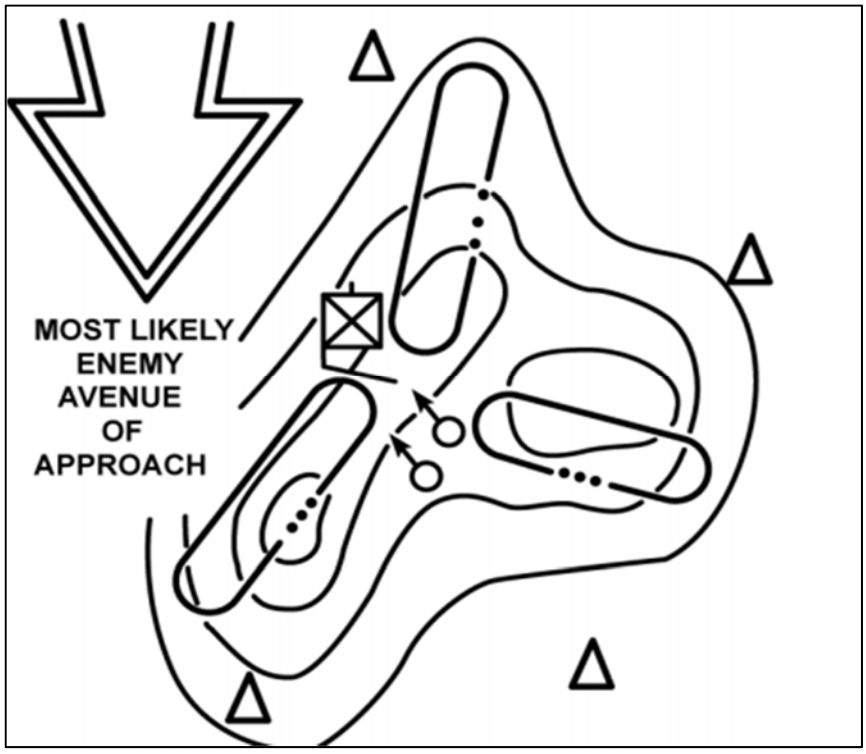


Figure 5.21 - Modified Y-Shaped Perimeter Defense

e. The most difficult aspect of this type defense is the fire control measures that must be established. To safely fight with this defense without casualties from friendly fires, the leaders must ensure the limits of fire for each weapon so as not to allow fires into the adjacent platoon position. In a mountainous environment, this may be simpler due to firing downward into the kill zones.

Some measures to consider include: 1) Position machine guns near the apex of the Y to allow an FPL that covers the platoon front while firing away from the adjacent platoon. 2) Cover the areas of the kill zones closest to the apex with Claymores, IEDs, or obstacles to reduce the need for direct fires in these areas. 3) Identify those positions at most risk to friendly fires and prepare the fighting position to protect the soldier from fires in this direction. 4) The loss of one platoon position may threaten the loss of the entire company. Plan and rehearse immediate counterattacks with a reserve or the least committed platoon to prevent this. 5) Consider allowing the enemy to penetrate well into the kill zones and destroy him as though this was an ambush; and, 6) Be aware that if this type of defense is established on the prominent terrain feature and the enemy has the ability to mass fires, he may fix the company with direct fires and destroy it with massed indirect fires.

Linear Defense

05144. This technique allows interlocking and overlapping observation and fields of fire across the company's front (Figure 5.22). A majority of the combat power of the company is well forward. Enough resources must be made available in order to provide sufficient combat power across the entire sector as well as detect and halt an attack. A company usually relies on fighting from the well-prepared and mutually supporting positions. It uses a high volume of direct and indirect fires to stop the attacker. The reserve is usually small, perhaps a squad. The concepts below are applied:

a. The main concern when fighting a linear defense is the lack of flexibility and the difficulty in both seizing the initiative and seeking out enemy weaknesses. When the enemy has a mobility advantage, a linear defense may be extremely risky. It is difficult to reposition forces, both laterally and in depth, to reinforce areas or to prevent a penetration. Obstacles, indirect fires, and effective contingency planning are key to this maneuvering. The company depends upon surprise, well-prepared positions, and deadly accurate fires to defeat the enemy. Therefore, the company usually fights in this manner because the battalion plan requires it. The battalion then compensates for these weaknesses with other resources.

b. A linear defense may be used when defensible terrain is available in the forward portion of the company's sector or to take advantage of a major linear natural obstacle. It is also used when the enemy is mainly Infantry, for conducting a security mission such as counter-infiltration, or when directed by the battalion.

c. IEDs and other obstacles are positioned and covered by fire to slow the attacker and to inflict casualties on him. Initially, engage him at long range by supporting fires (tactical air, attack helicopters, and field artillery) to disrupt the momentum of his attack. Use fires from mortars, machine guns, and small arms as he comes into range. If he penetrates the defense, block his advance with the reserve and shift fire from the forward platoons onto the enemy flanks. Then counterattack (either by the company reserve or the least committed platoon) with intense fires to destroy isolated or weakened enemy forces and regain key terrain.

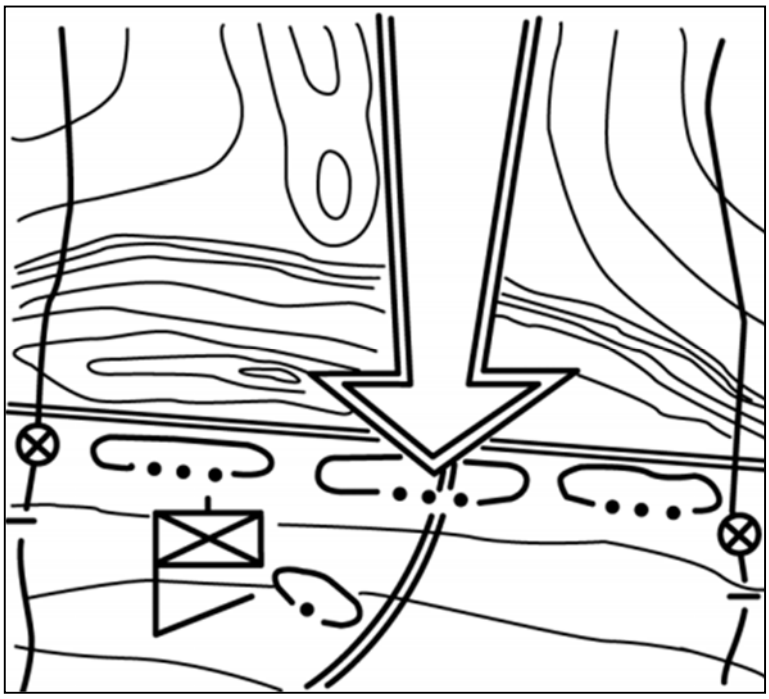


Figure 5.22 - Linear Defense

d. The counter-reconnaissance effort is critical when lighting a linear defense to deny the enemy the locations of the company's forward positions. If the enemy is able to locate the forward positions, he will concentrate combat power where he desires while fixing the rest of the company to prevent their maneuver to disrupt his attack. This effort may be enhanced by initially occupying and fighting from alternate positions forward of the primary positions. This will enhance the security mission and also deceive the enemy reconnaissance that may get through the security force.

Defense of a Strongpoint

05145. The company may be directed in constructing a strongpoint which is part of the battalion defense (Figure 5.23). In doing so, this may be improved with SS resources, more weapons and engineer support. The defense on the strongpoint is performed until such time that the commander who directs the defense sends an order for the unit to be out of it.

05146. The specific positioning of unit in the strongpoint depends on the CO's mission analysis and estimate of the situation. The same considerations for a perimeter defense apply in addition to the following:

a. Reinforce each individual fighting position (to include alternate and supplementary positions) to withstand small-arms fire, mortar fire, and artillery fragmentation. Stockpile food, water ammunition, pioneer tools, and medical supplies in each fighting position.

b. Plan or construct covered and concealed routes between positions and along routes of supply and communication. Use these to support counterattack and

maneuver within the strongpoint.

c. Divide the strongpoint into several independent, but mutually supporting, positions or sectors. If one of the positions or sectors must be evacuated or is overrun, limit the enemy penetration with obstacles and fires and support a counterattack.

d. Construct obstacles and emplace IEDs to disrupt and canalize enemy formations, to reinforce fires, and to protect the strongpoint from the assault. Place the obstacles and IEDs out as far as friendly units can observe them, within the strongpoint, and at points in between where they will be useful.

e. Prepare range cards for each position and confirm them by fires. Plan indirect fires in detail and register them. Indirect fires should also be planned for firing directly on the strongpoint using proximity fuses.

f. Plan and test several means of communication within the strongpoint and to higher headquarters. These are radio, wire, messenger, pyrotechnics, and other signals.

g. Improve or repair the strongpoint until the unit is relieved or withdrawn. More positions can be built, tunnels and trenches dug, existing positions improved or repaired, and barriers built or fixed.

05147. A strong point may be part of any defensive plan. It may be built to protect vital units or installations, as an anchor around which more mobile units maneuver, or as part of a trap designed to destroy enemy forces that attack it.

05148. The strongpoint is molded to the terrain. Natural camouflage and obstacles are used. Mountains, rivers, swamps, and forests can support a formidable strongpoint, providing cover, concealment, and obstacles. Urban areas are also easily converted to a strongpoint. Stone, brick, or steel buildings provide cover and concealment. Buildings, sewers, and some streets provide covered and concealed routes and can be rubble to provide obstacles.

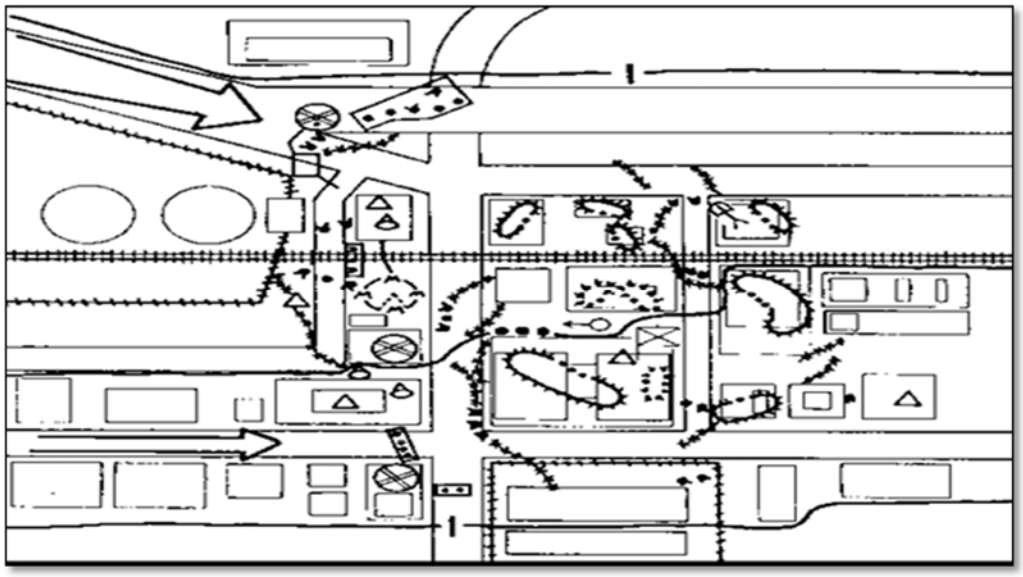


Figure 5.23 - Company Strongpoint

Retrograde Operations

05149. The retrograde is a type of defensive operation that involves organized movement away from the enemy. An enemy may force the retrograde operations and it is also possible for a commander to voluntarily execute them. Either way, the force's higher commander must first approve the operations. Retrograde operations are performed to enhance tactical situation as well as prevent worse situation from happening. Companies typically perform retrogrades as part of larger force and may perform independent retrogrades (withdrawal) as necessary such as on raids.

05150. Retrograde operations accomplish the following:

a. Resist, exhaust, and defeat enemy forces.

b. Draw the enemy into an unfavorable situation.

c. Avoid contact in undesirable conditions.

d. Gain time.

e. Disengage a force from battle for use elsewhere in other missions.

f. Reposition forces, shorten lines of communication, or conform to movements of other friendly units.

g. Secure more favorable terrain.

Types of Retrograde Operations

05151. The three types of retrograde operations are explained in the sub-paragraphs below. They are:

a. Delay

b. Withdrawal

c. Retirement

Delay

05152. The operation enables the unit to trade their space for time, avoid decisive engagements and safeguard the elements. A delay refers to the series of offensive and defensive actions over succeeding positions that are in depth. It is also described as an economy of force operation which trades space for time. Whereas the enemy gains access to the vacated space or area, the friendly elements have sufficient time to perform the required operations while retaining maneuver and freedom of action. This enables the friendly forces to influence their actions, prevent decisive engagement and postpone the actions that may occur in a critical place and time on the battlefield.

05153. **Types of delay mission.** The two types of delay missions are as follows:

a. Delay in sector.

b. Delay forward of a specified line or position for a specified time.

05154. **Components of Successful Delay.** For either type of delay mission, the flow of the operation can be summarized as "hit hard, and then move." A successful delay has three key components:

a. The ability to stop or slow the enemy's momentum while avoiding decisive engagement.

b. The ability to degrade the enemy's combat power.

c. The ability to maintain a mobility advantage.

05155. **Delay within a Sector**. The company might be assigned a mission to delay within a sector AO. The higher commander normally provides guidance regarding intent and desired effect on the enemy, but he minimizes restrictions regarding terrain, time, and coordination with adjacent forces. This form of a delay is normally assigned when force preservation is the highest priority and there is considerable depth to the AO.

05156. **Delay Forward of a Specified Line for a Specified Time**. The company might be assigned a mission to delay forward of a specific control measure for a specific period. This mission is assigned when the battalion must control the enemy's attack and retain specified terrain to achieve some purpose relative to another element, such as

setting the conditions for a counterattack, for completion of defensive preparations, or for the movement of other forces or civilians. The focus of this delay mission is clearly on time, terrain, and enemy destruction. It carries a much higher risk for the battalion, with the likelihood of all or part of the unit becoming decisively engaged. The timing of the operation is controlled graphically by a series of phase lines with associated dates and times to define the desired delay-until period.

05157. **Culmination of Delay.** Delay missions usually conclude in one of three ways: a defense, a withdrawal, or a counterattack. Planning options should address all three possibilities.

05158. **Planning Considerations.** In preparing for the delay, the commander uses planning considerations that are identical to those for a defense in sector, varying only in their purpose. Planning for the delay must cover several areas related to hindering enemy movement and maintaining mobility. These considerations include:

a. Use of existing terrain and obstacles, enhanced by employment of reinforcing obstacles.

b. Designation of positions where the friendly force can harass or impede the enemy without risking decisive engagement itself. This applies especially to a delay in sector.

c. When a battalion is delaying in sector, companies are normally assigned a series of specific BPs to enhance command and control across the sector. Likewise, in a company delay in sector, the commander will assign a series of specific BPs for each platoon.

d. Assessment of opportunities to conduct limited counterattacks to disrupt enemy actions.

e. Designation of high-speed avenues of withdrawal.

f. Rehearsal of operations anticipated for the delay. These may include engagement of the enemy and maneuver through the delay area.

05159. **Techniques.** In executing either a delay in sector or a time-related delay, the commander can choose from the following techniques:

a. Delay from subsequent positions or phase lines.

b. Delay from alternating positions.

05160. **Delay from Subsequent Positions or Phase Lines**. This delay technique normally is used when the sector is so wide that available forces cannot occupy more than a single line of positions. The commander must be aware of several factors that may put his unit at a disadvantage during the delay:

a. Lack of depth at any particular time.

b. The possibility of inadequate time to prepare subsequent positions.

c. Decreased security during disengagement.

d. The possibility of gaps between units.

e. When the unit receives the order to conduct the delay from its initial positions, one element, such as a company in a battalion delay or a platoon in a company delay, displaces and occupies its subsequent BP. The remainder of the unit maintains contact with the enemy until the first displacing element is in position to engage the enemy from the subsequent position. The first element then provides over-watch or base of fire as other elements displace to their subsequent positions. Figure 5.24 shows a company conducting a dismounted delay from subsequent positions.

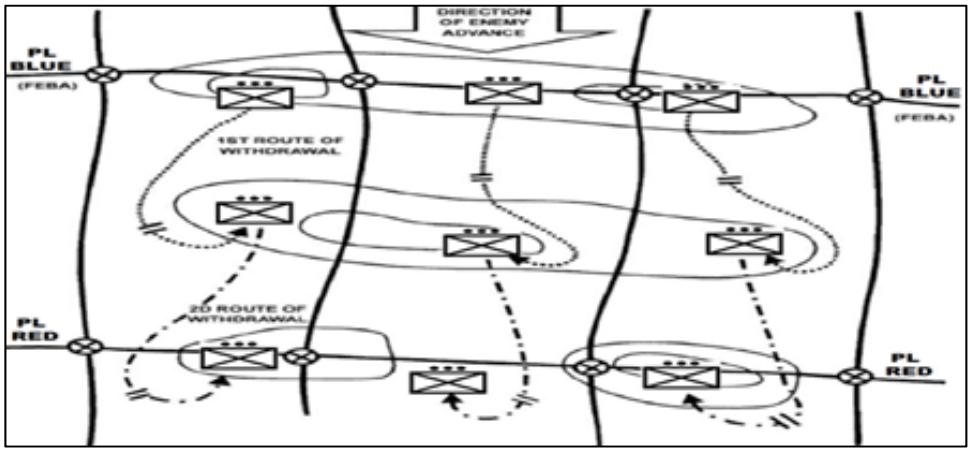


Figure 5.24 - Example of Company Dismounted Delay from Subsequent Positions

05161. **Delay from Alternating Positions**. This method of delay might be used when the delaying element has sufficient forces to occupy more than a single line of positions (normally in a narrow sector). The delaying battalion or company arrays one or more of its subordinate elements in the initial delay positions. This first echelon then engages the enemy while the rest of the unit occupies and prepares second-echelon delay positions. The unit then alternates fighting the enemy with movement to new positions. The elements in the initial delay positions engage the enemy until ordered to displace, or until displacement criteria are met. They then displace, moving through the second-echelon delay positions to their own subsequent positions (which become the third echelon of the delay).Elements in the second echelon over watch the displacing units' movement and assume responsibility for engaging the enemy. This sequence continues until the delay operation is completed. Figure 5.25 shows a company delay from alternating positions.

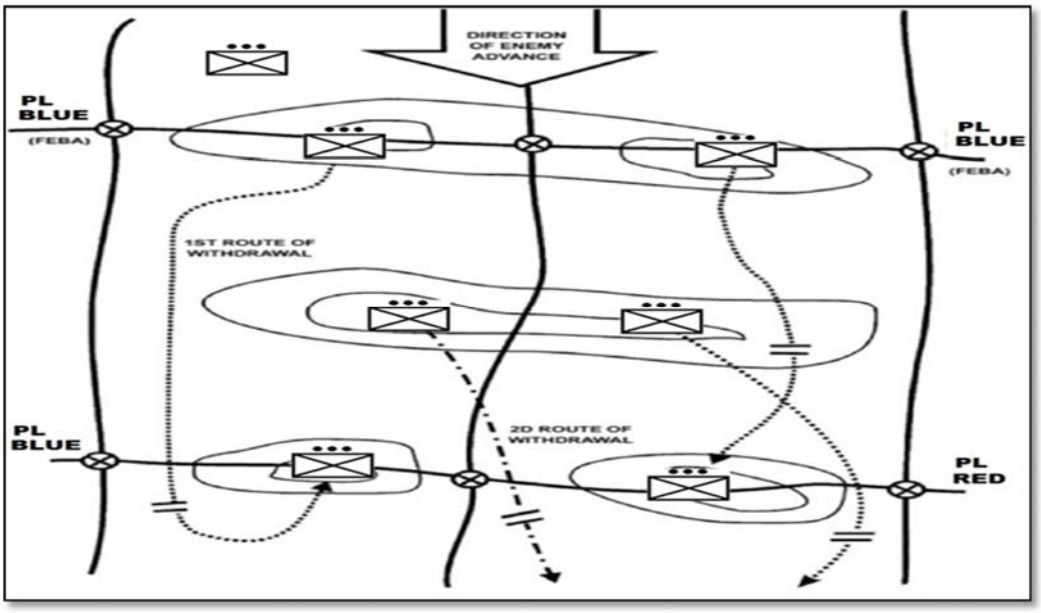


Figure 5.25 - Example of Company Delay from Alternating Positions

Withdrawal

05162. A commander uses withdrawal operations in order to break the enemy's contact, particularly when there is a need to free a unit for new missions. Withdrawal is described as a planned operation in which the force in contact frees from the enemy force. A withdrawal may or may not be performed under enemy pressure.

05163. **Types of Withdrawal.** The two types of withdrawals are explained in the paragraphs below. They are:

a. Assisted

b. Unassisted

05164. **Assisted.** The assisting force occupies positions to the rear of the withdrawing unit and prepares to accept control of the situation. It can also assist the withdrawing unit with route reconnaissance, route maintenance, fire support, and sustainment. Both forces closely coordinate the withdrawal. After coordination, the withdrawing unit delays to a battle handover line, conducts a passage of lines, and moves to its final destination.

05165. **Unassisted.** The withdrawing unit establishes routes and develops plans for the withdrawal and then establishes a security force as the rear guard while the main body withdraws. Sustainment and CS elements normally withdraw first, followed by combat forces. To deceive the enemy as to the friendly movement, battalion may establish a DLIC if withdrawing under enemy pressure. As the unit withdraws, the DLIC disengages from the enemy and follows the main body to its final destination.

05166. **Phases.** Withdrawals are accomplished in three overlapping phases, as follows:

a. **Preparation**. The commander dispatches quartering parties, issues WARNOs, and initiates planning. Non-essential vehicles are moved to the rear.

b. **Disengagement.** Designated elements begin movement to the rear. They break contact and conduct tactical movement to a designated assembly area or position.

c. **Security.** In this phase, a security force protects and helps the other elements as they disengage or move to their new positions. This is done either by a DLIC, which the unit itself designates in an unassisted withdrawal, or by a security force provided by the higher headquarters in an assisted withdrawal. As necessary, the security force assumes responsibility for the sector, deceives the enemy, and protects the movement of disengaged elements by providing over-watch and suppressive fires. In an assisted withdrawal, the security phase ends when the security force has assumed responsibility for the fight and the withdrawing element has completed its movement. In an unassisted withdrawal, this phase ends when the DLIC completes its disengagement and movement to the rear.

Unassisted Withdrawal

05167. In an unassisted withdrawal, the unit conducting the withdrawal establishes the DLIC to maintain contact with the enemy or to deceive him.

05168. **Battalion Withdrawal.** In a battalion withdrawal, the DLIC may consist of an element from each company (under leadership of the company XO or a platoon leader), with the battalion S-3 as the overall DLIC commander. As an alternative, a company may serve as the DLIC for the rest of the battalion. The company commander has several deployment options. He can reposition elements across the entire battalion frontage. Another option is to position the company to cover only the most dangerous enemy avenues of approach. Other avenues into the sector are covered with observation from additional security elements provided by the battalion such as the reconnaissance platoon.

05169. **Company Unassisted Withdrawal.** The commander has similar options in an unassisted company withdrawal. He may designate one platoon to execute the DLIC mission for the company, or he can constitute the DLIC using elements from the three rifle platoons with the XO as the DLIC commander. Figure 5.26 shows an example of an unassisted withdrawal.

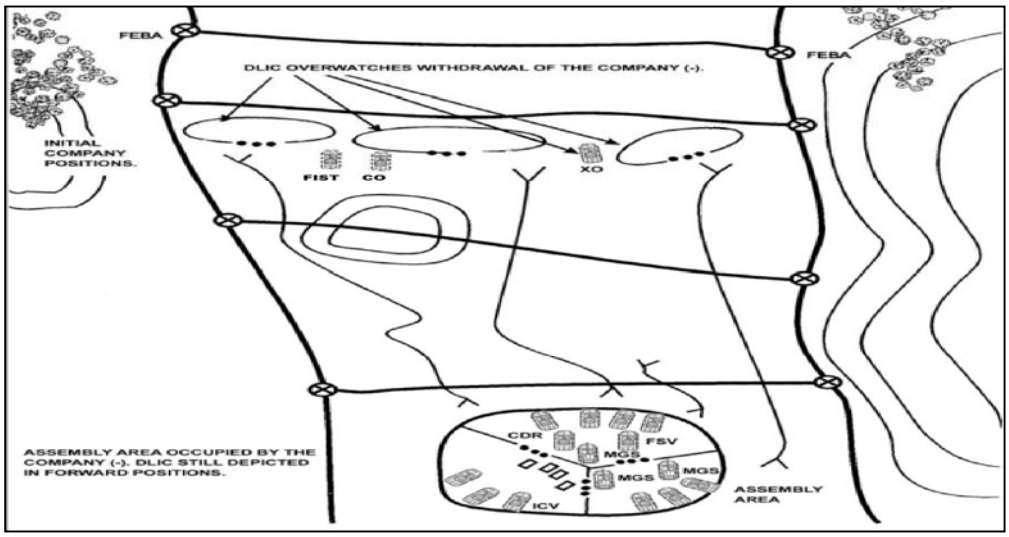


Figure 5.26 - Example of Unassisted Withdrawal

Assisted Withdrawal

05170. In assisted battalion withdrawals, the higher Hqs normally provide security elements in order to maintain the contact as well as mislead the enemy while the battalion performs withdrawal. Similarly, in company withdrawals, the battalions provide security force. The security force creates defensive positions behind the withdrawing unit and performs preparations for the rearward passage of lines. The withdrawing force also disengages from the enemy and performs rearward passage through security force to the assembly areas in the rear.

Retirement

05171. This type of operation is employed in order to move, away from the enemy, a force which is not in contact. Normally, the company allows retirement and considers it as part of a much larger force while a different unit's security force protects the movement. The retiring unit arranges for combat but does not expect intervention from the enemy ground forces. Some triggers for retirement may possibly include the necessity of repositioning forces for future operations as well as accommodating other changes to the current CONOP. The retiring unit should move sustainment elements and supplies first, and then should move toward an assembly area that supports preparations for the next mission. Where speed and security are the most important considerations, units conduct retirements as tactical road marches.

Chapter VI
Company Operations in Support to Civil Governance

Overview

0601. The Infantry Rifle Company deployed for operations often find themselves in areas with civilian presence. No matter what type of operational environment, civilians have the potential to disrupt the conduct of company operations by:

a. Uncontrolled and uncoordinated movement of frightened civilians affected by the operations.

b. Uncontrolled and uncoordinated movement of civilians with legitimate activities within the area of operation.

c. Civilians with illegal or illegitimate activities and presence in the area of operation. Thus, company forces can conduct Civil Military Operations as part of battalion in coordination with civilian entities in the area. The purpose is to gain popular support and weaken the will of the enemy to fight. The CMO activities include: 1). Public Affairs (PA) 2). Civil Affairs (CA); and, 3). Information Support Affairs (ISA).

0602. The simultaneous execution of offensive, defensive, and support to civil governance tasks of the Infantry Rifle Company is common in irregular warfare and peace operations. Sometimes, the force available is inadequate for executing simultaneous combination of tasks. In these cases, company commanders inform the battalion (BN) of the requirement for additional forces. Thus, the capacity of the company to provide support to civil governance is limited to the leading certain CMO activities due to operational requirements.

0603. The combination of company tasks conducted during SCG operations depends on the situation. In some operations, the LGU can meet most or all of the population's requirements. In those cases, the Infantry Rifle Company work with and through these authorities. Company Commanders use Civil Affairs (CA) activities to mitigate how the company presence affects the populace and vice versa. Conversely, the Infantry Company operating in a chaotic locality may need to support the well-being of the local populace. That situation requires company forces to work with civilian agencies to restore their capabilities. Again, CA activities are important in establishing the trust between company forces and civilian organizations required for effective working relationships. Support to Civil Governance tasks are as elaborated in the paragraphs below:

Company Support to Civil Governance Tasks

Counterinsurgency Operations

0604. Government actions in terms of counterinsurgency (COIN) operations aim to defeat organizations that can cause armed conflicts or insurgencies. These actions can civic, policitcal, military, economic, and para military in nature. This manual defines *insurgency* as a military struggle influenced by protracted politics in an organized manner. It mainly aims to weaken the government in order to increase the control of the insurgents.

0605. The Infantry Rifle Company is part of the Battalion in addressing Counterinsurgenncy Operations (COIN). The Infantry Company in most times, will operate into insurgent–laden environments. The full-spectrum operations require continuous and simultaneous combinations of offensive and defensive support to civil governance tasks which may wholly or partly apply in these battlefield conditions and its applications will depend on the analysis of the METT-TC factors. Likewise, there are certain tasks and responsibilities that are peculiar to the conduct of counterinsurgency operations that the Infantry Rifle Company may perform in order to attain its mission.

Peace Operations

0606. Peace operations (PcO) seek to mitigate the security effects of physical and psychological strife generated by warring factions in a locality. Company forces, due to their combat potential and discipline, maybe called upon to assist or directly conduct peace operations. Generally, the company assists in law enforcement tasks that local police and security elements cannot handle. In this type of operations, defining and promulgating the rules of engagement (ROE) acceptable to all stakeholders is of prime importance. Peace operations may include, but not limited to:

a. **Peace Enforcement Operations (PcEO)**. These involve using Infantry Company forces and capabilities in enforcing a peace agreement between warring factions in areas within the national sovereignty, as drafted and approved by the appropriate national agency of government. Specifically, the company commander in coordination support with the battalion S2 can act as a mediator in settling in tribal conflicts within the company's area of responsibility.

b. **Peace Making Operations (PcMO)**. These also involve using the Infantry Company forces and capabilities to respond to and resolve crisis situation attributed to warring factions. As a rule, the primary consideration is the de-escalation of hostilities to enable peace negotiations. Neutralization and disbarment maybe necessary while open hostilities are happening. The company commander can initiate the negotiation with the CNN commander in his AOR to surrender and avail of the "balik-baril" program of the government in coordination with the OPAPP.

Disaster Response Operations

0607. The Infantry Rifle Company forces respond immediately with the guidance of higher headquarters in order to alleviate suffering and prevent loss of lives and properties during natural and man-made disasters and terrorist acts. Immediately after information of the incidence of the disaster, whether natural or man-made, the company quickly qualifies their response (with appropriate transitions) by conducting the following sub-operations, depending on the situation on the ground, and/or as directed by higher authority:

a. **Disaster Response Operations (DRO)**. These are done in order to conduct prompt rescue of affected populations and properties. The primary consideration is to save lives and property from the disastrous event itself.

b. **Disaster Relief Operations (DRfO)**. This is done to provide relief to affected populations and properties to ensure survival from the effects of the disastrous event.

c. **Disaster Retrieval Operations (DRvO)**. This is done to recover casualties and salvage affected properties. The primary consideration is to enable relatives of casualties and local governance to cope up with the losses associated with the disastrous event, according to local customs and traditions.

Civil Population and Vital Installation of Security Operations (CPVISO)

0608. These operations involve protecting the populace and vital installations from security threats. Simultaneously, they assist local police and security elements as they maintain internal security against terrorists, criminal, and small hostile groups. For the other SCG tasks to be effective, civil population and vital installation security is required. As soon as the local security forces can safely perform these tasks, the company forces transition security responsibilities to them. These operations are aimed at reducing risks to individuals or groups while promoting security. Specific tasks are:

a. **Civil Disturbance Management Operations (CDMO)**. This is when the Infantry Company is tasked to stabilize areas affected by violent or seditious gatherings and activities of local population. Specifically, the company can provide augmentation with PNP personnel, as needed. This is primarily conducted in support to other agencies of government, especially law enforcement agencies.

b. **Vital Installation Security Operations (VISO).** This is done to protect installation of facilities, critical to the survival or normalcy of a specific locality or the nation as a whole, form hostile element, foreign or domestic. As an example, the company can provide security assistance within the area in coordination with the battalion hqs and local police. Vital installations may include power plants, water facilities, and the like that have inimical implications to local and national interest.

Support to Law Enforcement Operations (SLEO)

0609. When authorized and directed, company forces provide support to local and state law enforcement officers in the implementation of the penal and specials laws of the land. In extreme cases, and when directed by the President, regular Army forces, specifically the Infantry Rifle Company maintain law and order. However, law enforcement operations to maintain security, are generally handled by the PNP and the AFP company unit acting as a supporting effort. These operations must be covered by the appropriate decrees and/or memoranda of understanding or agreement enabled by inter-agency coordination and convergence. Examples of specific tasks include:

a. Conduct joint checkpoint operations with PNP.

b. Conduct joint operations in the pursuit operations with the high-profile and heavily-armed criminals.

c. Conduct security assistance initiated by higher headquarters and LGU for local civilian agencies during medical and dental missions.

Support to Community Development Operations (SCDO)

0610. These operations then establish conditions that enable actions by local civilian government and agencies to succeed. By establishing security and control, SCG operations provide a foundation for successful governance by the local civilian government. Support to local governance task in the company level includes providing security assistance to civil authorities in the area.

Support to Environmental Protection and Development Operations (SEPDO)

0611. The Infantry Rifle Company can help a local government, or the national government as a whole, develop capability and capacity in the areas of protection and develop the environment and ecological equilibrium. It may involve direct and indirect military assistance to local governments, national entities and people's organizations at various levels. It may also include initiatives and involvement in environmental projects, by being environmental protection and development advocate themselves. A sample activity would be tree planting activities in coordination with the DENR, beach clean-up activities, joint checkpoint with the PNP for illegal logging activities and after acts, and other environmental-related activities.

Non-Critical Support Operations (NCSO)

0612. The Infantry Rifle Company is frequently called upon to provide support to civil authorities. Most of this support is identified well in advance and planned with civil authorities. It usually consists of providing support to communities in its AO. Examples of types of non-critical support provided by civil authorities include the following:

a. Provide manpower and security assistance.

b. Perform other tasks in support to the battalion activities.

Joint Interagency Intergovermental Support to National Government

0613. Although company forces focus on achieving the military end state, they ultimately need to create conditions where the other instruments of national and local power are preeminent. SCG operations focus on creating those conditions. Specific activities and tasks under each purpose are performed by the company level in support to higher HQS such as battalion, brigade, and division. Most of the time, the company provides manpower and security assistance. The following paragraphs discuss the purposes of SCG operations:

a. **Interagency Support**. The interagency support describes the company commander's military procedures in directing the infantry company in terms of working with different government and non-government agencies when conducting operationsto support to civil governance. Particularly, the different activities involve the following: **1) Provide a Secure Environment**. This involves isolating enemy from the local populace in order to protect the population. This is done by persuading the populace to support an acceptable, legitimate local government. The main goal is to isolate the enemy economically and politically. **2) Meet the critical needs of the Populace**. This involves providing the essential services for the populace by the Army forces until the local government or other agencies are able to do so. Example would involve: evacuation, rescues, and the like. **3) Shape the Local Environment for Interagency and Local Government Success**. This is done by the infantry company by providing security and control that are necessary for the local government and interagency elements to function and enable such agencies, through the infantry company to also support these agencies key functions. **4) Security**. The infantry company provides security by establishing and maintaining a safe and secure environment for the populace through the use of indigenous and local forces. Public order and safety mainly aims to protect the populace, infrastructure, and institutions. Like the other security activities, the main goal of security is to isolate the enemy indirectly, through compelling the populace to stray away from supporting adversaries, insurgents, and focus on supporting the local government. The infantry company conducts offensive and defensive operations to provide security. **5) Justice and Reconciliation**. The infantry company do this by establishing public order and safety through implementing public laws and order with respect to human rights, freedom, and proper observation of internationally recognized standards. **6) Humanitarian Assistance and Social Well-Being during Disasters**. The infantry company conduct programs to reduce human suffering, disease, and deprivation that are endemic, natural, and manmade in nature. Example of these activities include: food feeding programs, relief goods drive, and the like. **7) Non-Critical Support Operations (NCSO)**. The infantry company assists in providing support to other civil authorities by providing support to communities that are surrounding the company's home stations. Activities often involves: support to state and local veteran funerals, participation in major public sporting events, and providing military equipment and soldier to community events.

b. **Intergovernmental**. The intergovernmental support describes the company commander's military procedures in directing the infantry company in terms of working with different local government unitis and its representatives such as barangay chairman/officials and municipal/city officials when conducting operations to support to civil governance. Particularly, the different activities involve the following: **1) Governance and Participation**. The infantry company is involved in the restoration and creation of effective government institutions through strengthening local governance and infrastructure rehabilitations. The infantry company works hand-in-hand with civilian agencies according to the following activities: re-establishing the administrative framework, support local governance development, support political reforms, and establish fair taxation. **2) Secure Land Areas and Vital Installations**. The infantry company works closely with the local government unit in utilizing its capabilities to secure land areas and vital installations. **3) Gain Support for the National and Local Government**. The infantry company conduct programs and operations to provide successful support to a legitimate national and local government. The main aim is to have the local populace accept the legitimacy of the governing body and its activities. **4) Support to Environmental Protection and Development Operations (SEPDO)**. The infantry company assists that local or national government to develop capability and capacity in protecting the development of environmental and ecological equilibrium. Such assistance includes initiatives of environmental projects and environmental protection such as tree planting activities and the like. **5) Local Economic Stabilization**. The infantry company assists in restoring economic production and distribution by meeting the basis needs of the populace. The operations also involve restoring employment opportunities, initiating market reforms, mobilizing domestic and foreign investments, supervising monetary reforms, and rebuilding public structures.

0614. The SCG operations' purpose may include gaining support for the national and local government, shaping the local environment for interagency and local government success, providing security, justice and reconciliation, providing humanitarian assistance and social well-being during disasters, governance and participation and local economic stabilization, if it is part of the operations of a larger unit.

Use of Force in Support to Civil Governance Operations

0615. When using force, precision is important in SCG missions as applying massed, overwhelming force is in offensive and defensive operations. Company commanders emphasize that in SCG operations, violence not precisely applied, is counter-productive. Speed, surprise, and shock are vital considerations in lethal actions. Perseverance, legitimacy, and restraint are vital considerations in SCG operations. The company's use of force in SCG tasks is ultimately aimed at providing area security to any activities done among different government agencies within the company area of responsibility.

0616. The presence of armed soldiers operating among the local populace causes tension. Discipline and strict adherence to the rules of engagement are essential but not sufficient to reassure the population. In addressing the populace's apprehension, company commanders maintain balance in protecting the force, defeating hostile

forces, and tasking constructive action throughout the area of operations. They also stress cultural awareness in training and preparing for operations. Cultural awareness makes soldiers more effective when operating in an unfamiliar or indigenous population. This also allows them to leverage local culture to enhance the effectiveness of their operations. Hence, well-trained soldiers that are properly briefed on different cultures in the locality are usually deployed among the concerned areas.

0617. Especially in peace operations, company commanders emphasize impartiality in the use of force in addition to credibility and transparency. Impartiality is not neutrality. Impartiality does not imply that Infantry Company forces treat all sides equally. Force is used against threats in accordance with the rules of engagement. Fair treatment of the local populace improves the prospects for lasting peace, stability, and security. Thus, officers and soldiers and its attendant system must possess the moral ascendancy, the characters, technical expertise and values system drawn from universally-accepted concepts of human martial behavior and thinking. These standards exemplify the required professionalism and character of a soldier and the benchmark of successful military operations.

Chapter VII
Tactical Enabling Operations

0701. Tactical enabling operations include reconnaissance, special purpose operations (linkups, reliefs in place, and passages of lines), breaches, security, and patrols. The company conducts these operations to set conditions for future operations or support the current operations of its higher headquarters.

0702. The planning, preparation, and execution for these operations are just as important and require the same level of detail as conducting defensive or offensive operations. This edition eliminates all reference to friendly force use of non-command-detonated anti-personnel mines or booby traps.

Reconnaissance

0703. Every company commander uses visual observation or other methods in order to gain information about the activities and resources of enemy forces or the physical characteristics of a particular area. This refers to reconnaissance. It should be a focused collection effort, aimed at gathering timely and accurate information about the enemy and the terrain in the area of operations. (See Appedix A for detailed discussion on TTPs for the Conduct of Reconnaisance).

Special Purpose Operations

0704. This section defines linkup, relief in place, and passage of lines operations. It also describes when these might occur, discusses planning considerations for planning, and lists the steps to apply on the paragraphs below:

Linkup

0705. A **linkup** is an operation that entails the meeting of friendly ground forces (or their leaders or designated representatives). The company conducts linkup activities independently or as part of a larger force. Within a larger unit, the company may lead the linkup force (See Appedix B for detailed discussion on TTPs for the Conduct of Linkup Operations). Linkup may occur in, but is not limited to, the following situations:

a. Units coordinating a relief in place.

b. Cross-attached units moving to join their new organization.

c. A unit moving forward with a fixing force during a follow-and-support mission.

d. A unit moving to assist an encircled force.

e. Units converging on the same objective during the attack.

f. Units conducting a passage of lines.

Relief in Place

0706. A **relief in place** is an operation in which one unit replaces another unit and assumes the relieved unit's responsibilities. The primary purpose for a relief in place operation is to maintain the combat effectiveness of committed units. A relief in place may also be conducted:

a. To reorganize, reconstitute, or re-equip a unit that has sustained heavy losses.

b. To rest units that has conducted sustained operations.

c. To establish the security force or the DLIC during a withdrawal operation.

d. To allow the relieved unit to conduct another operation.

0707. See Appedix C for detailed discussion on TTPs for the Conduct of Relief in Place.

Passage of Lines

0708. The **passage of lines** is the movement of one or more units through another encompass this technique when the moving unit(s) cannot bypass the stationary unit and must pass through it which might be designated as either forward or rearward. Maintenance of the momentum of the moving elements is the primary purpose of the passage. (See Appedix D for detailed discussion on TTPs for the Conduct of Relief in Place).

Security Operations

0709. Security operations provide early and accurate warning of enemy operations which may be conducted to the front, flanks, or rear of the force to allow the commander to employ the protected force effectively.

Types

0710. Screen, guard, cover, area security, and local security are the five forms of security operations. The deployment of progressively higher levels of assets provides increasing levels of security for the main body screen, guard, and cover. The preservation of a commander's freedom to move his reserves, position fire support assets, conduct command and control operations, and provide for sustainment operations covers area security. The company can conduct screen or guard operations on its own.

Width and Depth of Security Area

0711. The company sector is defined by lateral boundaries extending out to the limit of advance (LOA) or the initial screen line. The company's ability to maintain depth through the sector decreases as the screened or guarded frontage increases.

Breaching

0712. When the company cannot bypass the obstacles with maneuver, breaching is done. Understanding breaching tactics requires understanding breaching theory first. Enemy obstacles must always be bypassed by the unit.

0713. The use of combined tactics and techniques to advance an attacking force to the far side of an obstacle that is covered by fire is obstacle breaching, whereas tactical obstacle is employed to disrupt enemy formations, turn them into a desired area, fix them in position under direct and indirect fires, or block their penetration while multiplying the effects and capabilities of firepower.

0714. A protective obstacle aids in close-in protection. They are usually employed at ranges of 30 to 100 meters to protect against hand grenades and Infantry assaults (terrain dependent).

0715. A lane is a route through, over, or around an obstacle, which provides a passing force with safe passage.

0716. A reduction task creates and marks lanes through, over, or around an obstacle to allow the attacking force to accomplish its mission.

0717. Clearing totally eliminates or neutralizes an obstacle or a portion of the obstacle. Clearing operations are not conducted under fire.

Breach Area

0718. This is the area where a breaching operation occurs. The area must be large enough to allow the attacking unit to deploy its support force, and to extend far enough beyond the obstacle to allow follow-on forces to deploy before they leave the breach area. The following aspects are applied:

a. **Bypass**. A bypass is a tactical task that involves maneuvering around an obstacle, a position, or an enemy force to maintain the momentum of advance.

b. **Point of Penetration.** A point of penetration is where the commander concentrates his efforts on the enemy's weakest point in order to seize a foothold on the far side of the objective.

c. **Point of Breach.** This is where the unit tries to create a lane through the obstacle. At first, points of breach are planned locations only. Normally, the breach force determines the actual points of breach during the breaching operation.

Tenets of Breaching

0719. Successful breaching operations are characterized by the application of breaching tenets. These tenets are applied whenever an obstacle is encountered in the AO, whether during an attack or route clearance operation. The five tenets of breaching

are explained below:

0720. **Intelligence**. In any operation where enemy obstacles can interfere with friendly maneuver, obstacle intelligenceligence (OBSTINTELLIGENCE) is always one of the information requirements and should become PIR. Examples of information that are needed to fulfill obstacle information requirements include:

a. The locations of existing and reinforcing obstacles.

b. The orientations and depths of obstacles.

c. Locations of the weakest points of the obstacles.

d. Locations of the areas that provide the best cover and concealment.

e. The presence, locations, and types of wire.

f. Lanes and bypasses.

g. The composition of the minefield, such as buried or surface-laid anti-tank and anti-personnel mines or anti-handling devices (AHDs), and the depths of the mines.

h. Types of mines and fuses.

i. The locations of enemy indirect-fire systems that can fire into the breach area.

0721. **Fundamentals.** The five breaching fundamentals (SOSRA) that ensure success when breaching against a defending enemy always apply, but they may vary based on the specific situation (METT-TC). These are:

a. **Suppress.** This is a tactical task used to employ direct or indirect fires that may also be an electronic attack on enemy personnel, weapons, or equipment, conducted to prevent or degrade enemy fires and observation of friendly forces. This must be a mission-critical task performed in any breaching operation to trigger the rest of the actions at the obstacle.

b. **Obscure.** The passage of assault forces for obstacle reduction is done through obscuration to hamper enemy observation and target acquisition, and conceal friendly activities and movement. It must be carefully planned to provide maximum degradation of enemy observation and fires.

c. **Secure**. The reduction area is secured by friendly forces to prevent the enemy from interfering with obstacle reduction and the passage of the assault force through the lanes created during the reduction against outposts and fighting positions near the obstacle and against overwatching units, as necessary. The higher HQ attacking units isolates the breach area and fixes adjacent units, attacks enemy reserves in depth, and provides counter-fire support. The breach force must have enough maneuver assets to provide local security against the forces that the support force cannot sufficiently engage. The breach force that

secures the reduction area may also be used to suppress the enemy once reduction is complete:

d. **Reduce.** Reduction is the creation of lanes through or over an obstacle to allow an attacking force to pass. The number and width of lanes created varies with the enemy situation, the assault force's size and composition, and the scheme of maneuver. The lanes must allow the assault force to rapidly pass through the obstacle. The breach force will reduce, proof (if required), mark, and report lane locations and the lane-marking method to higher HQ. Follow-on units will further reduce or clear the obstacle when required. Reduction cannot be accomplished until effective suppression and obscuration are in place, the obstacle has been identified, and the point of breach is secure.

e. **Assault.** A breaching operation is not complete until: 1) Friendly forces have assaulted to destroy the enemy on the far side of the obstacle that can place or observe direct and indirect fires on the reduction area. 2) Battle handover with follow-on forces has occurred, unless no battle handover is planned.

0722. **Organization**. A commander organizes friendly forces to accomplish the five breaching fundamentals quickly and effectively. This requires him to organize support, breach, and assault forces with the necessary assets to accomplish their roles (Table 7.1).

Table 7.1 - Relationship between Breaching Organization and Fundamentals

Breaching Organization	Breaching Fundamentals	Responsibilities
Support Force	Suppress	Suppress enemy direct-fire systems covering the reduction area.
	Obscure	Control obscuring smoke.
		Prevent enemy forces from repositioning or counterattacking to place direct fires on the breach force.

Breach Force	Suppress (provide additional suppression) Obscure (provide additional obscuration in the reduction area) Secure (provide local security) Reduce	Create and mark the necessary lanes in an obstacle. Secure the near and far sides of an obstacle. Defeat forces that can place immediate direct fires on the reduction area. Report the lane status and location.
Assault Force	Assault Suppress (if necessary)	Destroy any enemy on the far side of an obstacle that can place direct fires on the reduction area. Assist the support force with suppression if the enemy is not effectively suppressed. Be prepared to breach follow-on or protective obstacles after passing through the reduction area.

Support Force

0723. The support force's primary responsibility is to eliminate the enemy's ability to interfere with a breaching operation. Suppression depends on the commander massing enough direct fires to protect the breach force. The support force must:

a. Isolate the reduction area with fires.

b. Mass and control direct and indirect fires to suppress the enemy and to neutralize any weapons that can fire on the breach force.

c. Control obscuring smoke to prevent enemy-observed direct and indirect fires.

0724. The support force should be provided with assets to reduce the impact of unexpected obstacles or scatter able minefields on their approach to and occupation of support-by-fire (SBF) positions. Failure to provide reduction assets can greatly affect the synchronization of the entire breaching operation.

0725. As a technique, a unit may create a reserve that supports the decisive operation throughout the operation. Initially, the reserve can support the support force until it

seizes SBF positions. Then, the reserve shifts support to the breach or assault force. If possible, the support force should follow a covered or concealed route to the SBF position, take up its assigned sectors of fire and observation, and begin to engage the enemy. It might have to adjust its direct-fire plan.

0726. Observation is critical. Indirect fires on enemy positions to fix and suppress the enemy are brought by artillery observers with the support force. To protect the breach and assault forces as they approach the reduction area, the support force adjusts the indirect fire-delivered obscuring smoke.

0727. A CFZ is an area, usually a friendly unit or location, which the maneuver commander designates as critical to protect an asset whose loss would seriously jeopardize the mission. Covered by a radar sector, the CFZ supports counter-fire operations by providing the most responsive submission of targets to the fire support system when rounds impact inside the CFZ.

Breach Force

0728. The breach force helps in the passage of the assault force by creating, proofing (if necessary), and marking lanes. The breach force might be a combined-arms force. It includes reduction assets, enough maneuver forces to provide additional suppression, and local security and engineers (if available). The breach force applies portions of the following breaching fundamentals as it reduces an obstacle:

a. **Suppress**. The breach force must be provided with enough maneuver forces to provide additional suppression against various threats, including enemy direct-fire systems and counterattacking or repositioning forces. Enemy direct-fire systems that cannot be effectively observed and suppressed by the support force are engaged by other forces, indirect fire, or air fire support.

b. **Obscure**. The breach force may employ quick building artillery or mortar-delivered smoke, followed by vehicle-mounted smoke systems or smoke pots. It uses these for self-defense and lane coverage during the passage of the assault force.

c. **Secure**. The breach force secures itself from threat forces that are providing close-in protection of the obstacle. The breach force also secures the lanes through the tactical obstacles, once they are created, to allow safe passage of the assault force.

d. **Reduce**. To support the development of a plan to reduce the obstacle, the composition of the obstacle system must be an information requirement.

e. **Assault**. The assault force assaults through both the point of breach and the breach force to reach the far side of an obstacle and seize the reduction area.

0729. The breach force has two subordinate elements: security and reduction. The security element is mostly maneuver forces. It normally provides additional suppression, obscuration, and local security. The reduction element normally reduces the obstacle.

0730. The breach force must be able to deploy and begin reducing the obstacle as soon as enemy fires are suppressed and effective obscuration achieved. It can expect enemy artillery fires within a matter of minutes. If available, CFZs should be activated at the point of breach, before the commitment of the breach force.

0731. After the breach force has reduced the obstacle and passed the assault force through, the breach force might have to hand over the lane to follow-on units. At a minimum, the lanes must be marked and their locations and conditions reported to both higher HQ and follow-on units, IAW the unit's SOP.

0732. Achieving necessary mass for the assault requires the breach force to open lane(s) through the obstacle for rapid passage and the buildup of forces on the far side. The size of the assault force determines the number of lanes initially created. A dismounted assault force normally requires one lane for each leading assault platoon. The tactical situation might require additional lanes to pass a large assault force quickly through the obstacle to achieve sufficient combat-power ratio.

Assault Force

0733. The principle of mass influences the selection of the point of breach, the task organization of the support, breach, and assault forces, and the integration of engineers inmovement or attack formations.

0734. The need to generate enough mass in the maneuver space available strongly influences which echelon can breach the obstacle. A company cannot simultaneously mass sufficient fires, reduce the obstacle, and assault the defending position unless the obstacle is simple and defended by no more than one platoon.

0735. The assault force's primary mission is to destroy the enemy and seize terrain on the far side of the obstacle. The purpose is to prevent the enemy from placing direct fires on the created lanes. The assault force might be tasked to assist the support force with suppression while the breach force reduces the obstacle.

0736. The assault force must be sufficient in size to seize the point of penetration. Breach and assault assets may maneuver as a single force when conducting lower-level breaching operations (US FM 7-10, 2006).

0737. When a small enemy force defends the obstacle, assault and breach force's missions might be combined. This simplifies C2 and provides more immediate combat power for security and suppression.

0738. Fire-control measures are essential, since support and breach forces might be firing on the enemy when the assault force is committed. Suppression of overwatching enemy positions must continue and other enemy forces must remain fixed by fires until the enemy has been destroyed. The assault force must assume control for direct fires on the assault objective as support and breach force's fires are shifted or ceased.

0739. **Mass Breaching** is the rapid concentration of efforts at one point to reduce the obstacle and penetrate the defense. The enemy's weakness is emphasized in massed combat power.

0740. **Synchronization** Precise synchronization of the breaching fundamentals by support, breach, and assault forces is required. Rapid, devastating losses of friendly troops in the obstacle or the enemy's can result from EA's failure to synchronize effective suppression and obscuration with obstacle reduction and assault. Proper planning force preparation, reverse planning, clear sub-unit instructions, effective C2, and well-rehearsed forces can be used by the CO to ensure synchronization.

Patrols

0741. A patrol can consist of a unit as small as a fire team. Squad and platoon-size patrols are normal, sometimes for larger combat tasks, normally for a raid. This can be a company detachment sent out by a larger unit to conduct a combat, reconnaissance, or security mission. Commanders send a patrol out from the main body to conduct a specific tactical task with an associated purpose. Upon completion of that task, the patrol leader reports to the commander and describes the events that took place, the status of the patrol's members and equipment, and any observations.

0742. The squad leader is responsible, if a patrol is made up of a single unit, such as a rifle squad sent out on a reconnaissance patrol. This temporary title defines his role and responsibilities for that mission. Designation of an assistant, normally the next senior man in the patrol, and any subordinate element leaders he requires may be done by the patrol leader. He also has an inherent responsibility to prepare and plan for possible enemy contact while on the mission. Patrols are never administrative.

Types

0743. The planned action determines the type of patrol. Regardless of the type of patrol, the unit needs a clear task and purpose. The two main types of patrols are:

a. **Combat Patrol**. A combat patrol provides security and harasses, destroys, or captures enemy troops, equipment, or installations. When the commander gives a unit the mission to send out a combat patrol, he intends for the patrol to make contact with the enemy and engage in close combat. A combat patrol always tries to escape detection while moving, but of course discloses their location to the enemy in a sudden, violent attack. For this reason, the patrol normally carries a significant amount of weapons and ammunition. It may carry specialized munitions. A combat patrol collects and reports any information gathered during the mission, whether related to the combat task or not.

b. **Reconnaissance Patrol.** They collect information or confirm or disprove the accuracy of information previously gained to avoid enemy contact and accomplish its tactical task without engaging in close combat. A reconnaissance patrol travels light, that is, with as few personnel and as little arms, ammunition, and equipment as possible. This increases stealth and cross-country mobility in close terrain. Regardless of how the patrol is armed and equipped, the leader always plans for the worst case: contact.

Combat Patrol

0744. The three types of combat patrols are:

a. **Raid Patrol.** Asurprise attack to destroy a position or installation, to destroy or capture enemy soldiers or equipment, or to free prisoners refers to raid patrol. It is conducted to destroy a position or installation, to destroy or capture enemy soldiers or equipment, or to free prisoners.

b. **Ambush Patrol**. An ambush is a surprise attack from a concealed position on a moving or temporarily halted target. It can include an assault to close with and destroy the target, or it can include only an attack by fire. An ambush need not seize or hold ground.

c. **Security Patrol**. When the unit is stationary to search the local area, detect any enemy forces near the main body, and engage and destroy them within the capability of the patrol, a security patrol is sent out from a unit location during a halt. A security patrol detects and disrupts enemy forces that are conducting reconnaissance of the main body or that are massing to conduct an attack. Security patrols are normally away from the main body of the unit for limited periods, returning frequently to coordinate and rest. They do not operate beyond the range of communications and supporting fires from the main body, especially mortar fires.

Reconnaissance Patrols

0745. The types of reconnaissance patrols are:

a. **Route Reconnaissance Patrols.**This kind of patrol obtains detailed information about a specified route, and about all terrain where the enemy could influence movement along that route.

b. **Area Reconnaissance Patrols**. This kind of patrol focuses only on obtaining detailed information about the terrain or enemy activity within a prescribed area.

c. **Zone Reconnaissance Patrols**. This kind of patrol is a directed effort to obtain detailed information on all routes, obstacles, terrain, and enemy forces within a zone defined by boundaries.

d. **Point Reconnaissance Patrols**. When going to a specific location and determining the situation there, a point reconnaissance patrol is required. This patrol can obtain, verify, confirm, or deny extremely specific information for the commander. These patrols are often used in stability, reconstruction, or civil support operations. It either reports the information by radio or returns to the larger unit to report.

e. **Leader's Reconnaissance Patrols**. This patrol reconnoiters the objective just before an attack or, in the case of a point reconnaissance, prior to sending elements forward to locations where they will observe. It confirms the condition of the objective. It gives each subordinate leader a clear picture of the terrain

where he will move, and of the part of the objective he must seize or observe. The patrol can consist of the unit commander or representative, the leaders of major subordinate elements, and, sometimes, a few security personnel and unit guides. This patrol gets back to the main body as quickly as possible. The commander can use the following aid to help in remembering a five-point contingency: **G**-**G**oing--as in, where is the leader going?; **O**-**O**thers--what others are going with him?; **T**-**T**ime (duration)--how long will the leader be gone?; **W**-hat--what do we do if the leader fails to return?; **A**-**A**ctions--what actions do the departing reconnaissance element and the main body staying in the ORP take on contact?

f. **Presence Patrols**. In stability or civil support operations, this patrol is used. It is also used to gather information about the conditions in the unit's AO. It also demonstrates to the local populace the presence and intent of the Army forces. The commander should carefully consider what he wants to convey, and then clearly describe his intent to the patrol leader before sending out a presence patrol to allow the commander to see and modify the actions of subsequent patrols.

g. **Tracking Patrols.** This is normally a squad-size, possibly smaller, element that is tasked to follow the trail of a specific enemy unit in order to determine its composition, final destination, and actions en route.

h. **Contact Patrols.** This is a special reconnaissance patrol sent from one unit to physically contact and coordinate with another which may either go to the other unit's position, or the units can meet at a designated contact point. It also observes and reports pertinent information about the area between the two units.

Company Commander Involvement

0746. CO's may lead a company-size patrol, provide small patrols from his company (as directed by battalion), or send out patrols on his own initiative to support his company's operations:

a. Obtains all necessary enemy information from the S-2 and other sources.

b. Issues warning orders to the platoon he chooses for the patrol.

c. Initiates appropriate troop-leading procedures.

d. Coordinates and develops a detailed plan.

e. Ensures the unit is prepared and properly organized and equipped for the mission.

f. Assists the patrol leader with preparations, coordination, and final inspections before the patrol departs.

g. Ensures that the patrol is debriefed upon its return.

0747. When the company commander plans to use a patrol to support a company operation, he identifies its mission, organization, key time(s) and places(s) for departure and return, and (possibly) its routes. Depending on the mission, he may assign the task, give his intent, and allow the platoon leader to plan the patrol. He assists in planning fire support, logistic support, and communications.

Organization

0748. Commander decides what elements, teams, weapons, equipment, and men or units are needed for his mission. However, he should use his unit's normal organization (squads and platoons) and chain of command (squad and platoon leaders) as much as possible to meet these needs. For example, a combat patrol may be organized as follows:

a. Company headquarters serve as the patrol headquarters.

b. 1st Platoon serves as the assault element.

c. 2nd Platoon serves as the security element.

d. 3rd Platoon and weapons platoon comprise the support element.

0749. When task-organizing a company patrol, the company commander only selects as many personnel as he needs. For example, if the security element only requires three security teams, the CO should task the platoon for a security element headquarters and three fire teams. A patrol generally consists of a patrol headquarters and the elements needed for the mission.

0750. **Headquarters**. The headquarters of a company-size patrol may consist of the same number of men as a regular company headquarters. However, regardless of a patrol's size, the commander tailors the headquarters to meet mission needs. The patrol headquarters has the same responsibilities as any other command element.

0751. **Elements**. In an area reconnaissance (Figure 7.6), a patrol has a reconnaissance element and a security element. In a zone reconnaissance, a patrol has several reconnaissance elements (Figure 7.7). Each provides its own security. A combat patrol normally has an assault element, a security element, and a support element (Figure 7.8). At times, the support element is omitted and instead combined with the assault element, or a reserve element might be required.

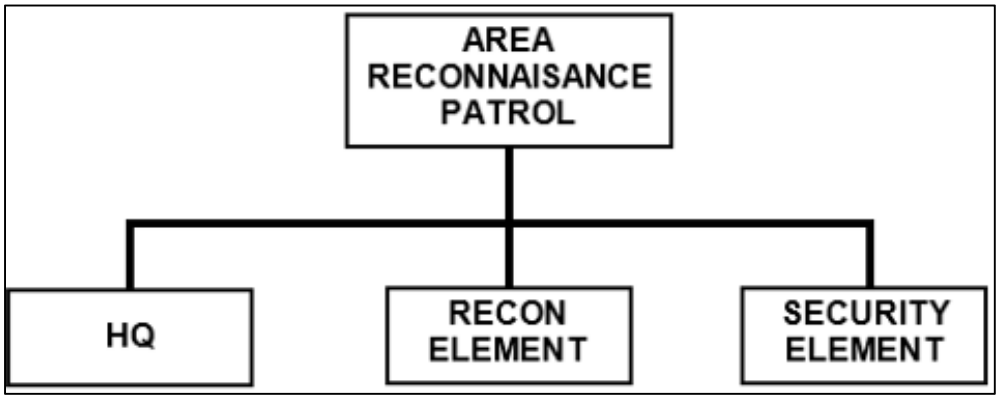


Figure 7.1 - Area Reconnaissance Patrol

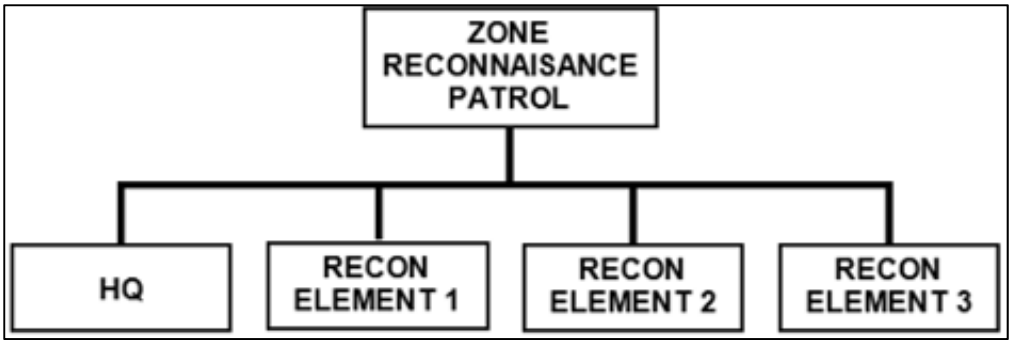


Figure 7.2 - Zone Reconnaissance Patrol

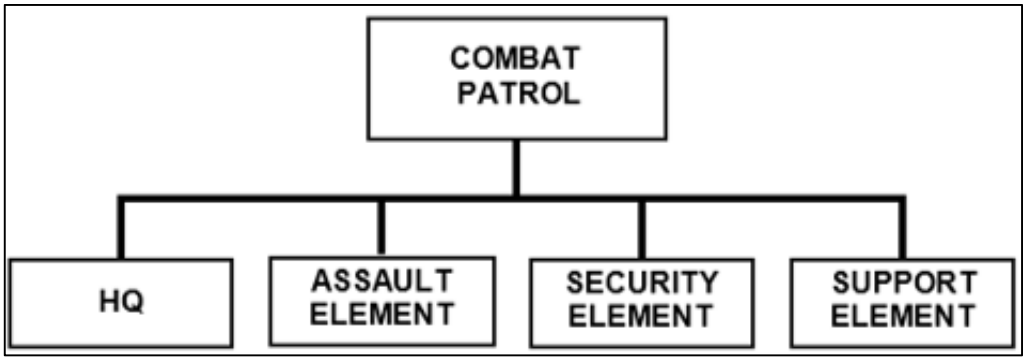


Figure 7.3 - Combat Patrol

0752. **Teams**. Each element of a patrol may be further organized into the teams needed to perform various tasks (Figure 7.8).

0753. **Reconnaissance Patrol Elements**. Reconnaissance patrol elements may be organized into several reconnaissance teams for an area reconnaissance, or into R&S teams for a zone reconnaissance. R&S teams must provide their own security while reconnoitering.

0754. **Security Elements**. Security elements are organized into the number of security teams needed to secure the objective area.

0755. **Combat Patrol Elements**. These are organized into the teams needed for

various tasks such as assault, security, support, and special purpose.

0756. Security teams are organized as needed, to secure and/or isolate the objective area.

0757. Organization of two or more support teams are done when the support element leader cannot directly control all of the weapons of the support element. Cases include too much supporting weapons or they are too far apart for direct control by the element leader.

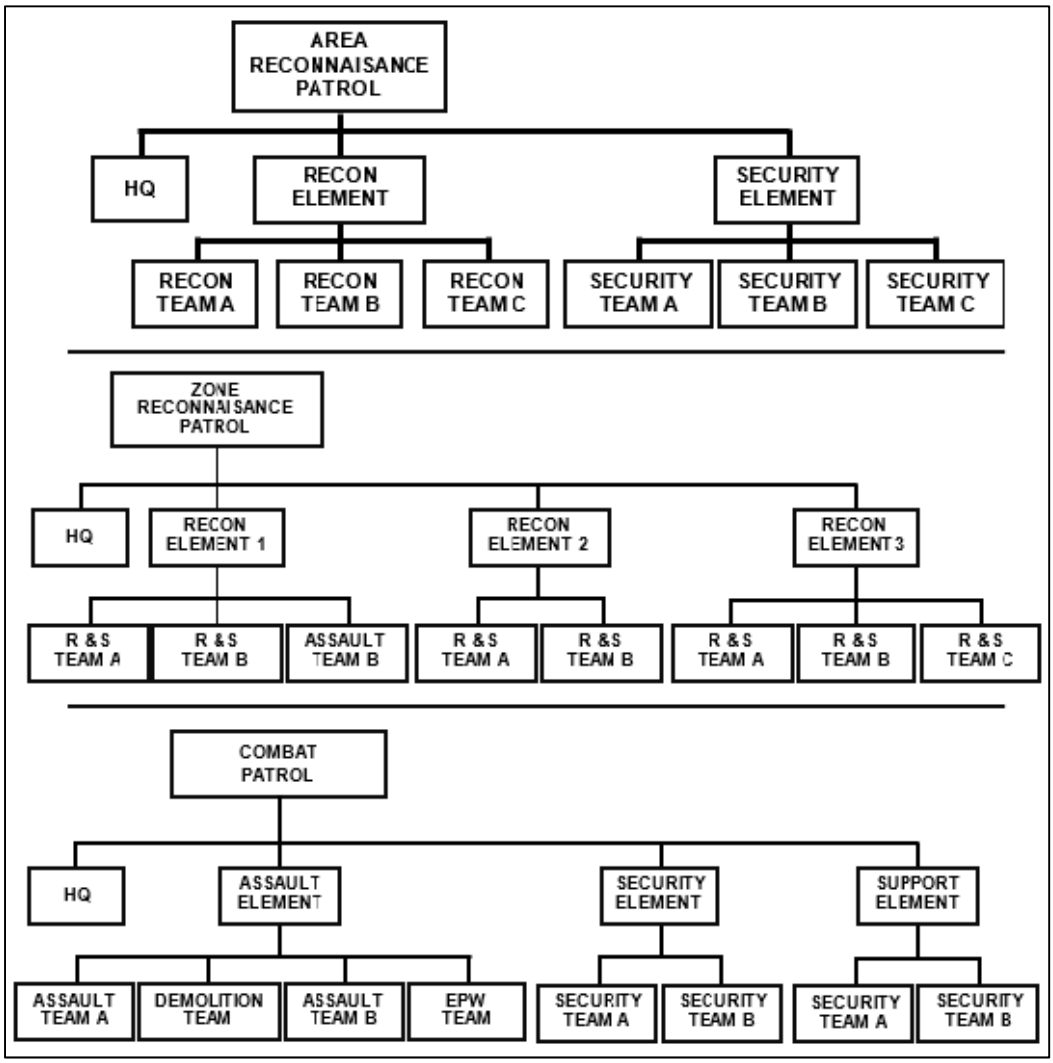


Figure 7.4 - Organization of Elements

Chapter VIII
Maneuver Support

0801. For a unit to achieve its full combat potential, the commander must effectively integrate all available combat support assets. Hence, the company commander must understand the command or support relationships established between his company and supporting units.

Command Relationships

0802. Command responsibility and authority are established routinely through different standard relationships. To simplify these definitions, the gaining organization is referred to as "the organization" and the organic, assigned, attached OPCON, or TACON unit simply as "the unit." The term "parent unit" is self-explanatory.

0803. **Organic**.This unit is assigned to and forms an essential part of an Army organization. The Infantry Company is listed in the organization's Table of Organization and Equipment (TOE) or Table of Distribution and Allowances (TDA). The Infantry Rifle Company is an organic Infantry battalion.

0804. **Assigned.** This is a unit placed in an organization wherein it primarily functions as an administrative unit. An Infantry Rifle Company is assigned to the Infantry battalion, where it is organic.

0805. **Attached**. This is a unit or person temporarily placed in an organization for a specific purpose, subject to the limitations imposed by the attachment order. The commander of the formation, unit or organization receiving the attachment will exercise the same degree of command and control as he does over units and persons organic to his command. However, the responsibility for transfer and promotion of personnel will normally be retained by the parent formation, unit or organization. An Infantry Rifle Company can be attached to higher units; in like manner, the Rifle Company can be provided with attachment.

a. The organization is responsible for the unit's logistics, training, and operations.

b. The CO exercises the same degree of command and control (C2) as with his organic units.

c. It is subject to limitations specified by the commander directing the attachment. This relationship includes the responsibility for SS, military justice, training, and operations (the responsibility to transfer and promotion is retained by the parent unit). It does, however, impose an administrative and logistical burden on the unit to which that attachment is made.

0806. **Operational Control (OPCON)**. An OPCON unit is one placed under the control of an organization for one or more specific operations. The organization controls all aspects of the unit's military operations. The relationship is limited by function, time, or location. The organization is not necessarily responsible for administration, logistics, discipline, internal organization, or training. Otherwise, the

commander's relationship with OPCON units is the same as with organic or attached subordinate units.

0807. **Tactical Control (TACON)**. A TACON unit is normally only subject to the authority of the organization with regard tospecified local direction of movement and maneuver of forces to accomplish a task. In this commandrelationship, a combatant commander delegates limited authority to the organization to direct the tacticaluse of a combat unit. However, commanders cannot assign missions and tasks, reassign forces, and assign separate employment of components.

Supporting Units

0808. Combat support of an Infantry Company is provided by the battalion and supporting units. It may include fires from the battalion mortar platoon and the anti-armor platoon, or supporting fire by the field artillery, tactical aircraft, and naval guns. The battalion scout platoon may also support the company. Other CS requirements are provided by Engineer, K9, MI, and signal unit from the Army Signal Regiment (ASR).

0809. The combat support elements include the mortar platoon, scout platoon, and intelligenceligence platoon. The battalion mortar platoon has four 81mm mortars. They provide close and immediate fire support to the maneuver units. They may be employed as a platoon, by section or by squad. The platoon may be placed under battalion control. However, the platoon or any of its sub-elements may also be attached to a supported unit.

0810. The signal platoon which is an organic of an Infantry battalion consists of a platoon headquarter, a radio and wire section, and an information system section. Since, CEIS equipment and other signal facilities are organic to the BN HQS, the signal platoon will provide communication support requirements to the Infantry Rifle companies. Moreover, the signal platoon provides installation, operations and maintenance to all radios and communication equipment issued to the Infantry Company. Furthermore, the BN Signal Officer is the concurrent signal platoon leader.

0811. **Signal BN, Army Signal Regiment, PA in Support to Infantry Rifle Company during the Conduct of Combat Operations.** Signal BN will be placed in the OPCON to the Infantry Division and its Signal Company will be placed in OPCON to the Infantry Brigade to provide signal support to its organic and OPCON Units. It may further be placed in OPCON to the Infantry battalion, and the signal section supporting during combat operations are normally attached or DS to Infantry Rifle Company depending on the needs. Signal BN has the following tasks:

a. It installs, operates and maintains electronic communication and information system (CEIS) facilities and equipment of the Infantry Brigade and Task Force/ Groups.

b. Provides installation, operation and maintenance such as repeater system and radio relay in order to provide redundancy or alternate means of communication of the Infantry Company operating within the brigade AO.

0812. The scout platoon is the reconnaissance and security element of the battalion. The platoon is extremely light and primarily foot-mobile. They possess no crew-served weapons. Its personnel are scout rangers qualified. The platoon normally operates under battalion control. The intelligenceligence platoon provides both human and signal intelligenceligence to the battalion. It has a Sigint Team for communications intercept and three Collection Teams for human intelligenceligence. The BN S2 exercises supervision over the intelligenceligence platoon.

0813. **The Army K9 BN, PA in Support to the Infantry Rifle Company**. It provides combat support to the tactical field units. Its subordinate components which are the companies are operational control (OPCON) of Infantry Divisions for various tactical missions. The sub-components of the K-9 companies such as CTT, ED and SP TMs are normally attached to the Infantry Company, platoon, and section during combat operations.

0814. **K9 Tasks.** The following are the different tasks of this unit:

a. After an engagement of an Infantry Company, when operating forces lose enemy contact, they conduct pursuit of operations.

b. Conducting tracking operations, intensive search and rescue operations and other K-9 related activities.

c. K-9 units Combat Tracking Team (CTT) can be utilized to initiate and establish contact in the event that enemy temporarily harboring areas are discovered and have personal items necessary for scenting / tracking.

d. Scout/ Patrol (SP) Team can be utilized to detect presence of the enemy or persons, either approaching or stationary within a specified distance as pre-conditioned in the MWD training.

e. Explosive Detection (ED) Team can detect and confirm the presence of military types of explosives and improvised explosive devices (IEDs).

f. To locate missing or captured personnel.

g. To search and rescue lost persons.

h. To recapture detainees and to pinpoint buried or abandoned cadavers and equipment linked or related thereto or can be utilized in DRO in any calamities may occur.

0815. **Battalion Assets**. The battalion weapons company responds to support requests from rifle companies according to the battalion fire plan. The battalion scout platoon normally works directly for the battalion; however, at times they may operate in the company's AO.

a. **Anti-armor.** The battalion's anti-armor platoon is normally assigned areas of responsibility of the battalion. An Infantry Rifle Company has organic anti-armor section.

b. **Mortar**. Supporting fires are from the battalion mortars which are designated to the priority of fires and allocated to priority targets. An Infantry Rifle Company has an organic mortar section.

c. **Scout Platoon.** Its primary missions are reconnoiter and screen in which necessary signals and contact procedures are arranged between the CO and the scout platoon leader. The scout platoon maybe attached to the company for a counter-reconnaissance mission.

0816. **Supporting Units.** Artillery and mortars, in some cases, tactical aircraft or attack helicopters support and respond to the battalion's call for fire from the companies based on the priority of fire. The following are the supporting units:

Table 8.1 - Indirect Fire Capabilities (SP 3-044)

CALIBER	60-mm	81-mm	81-mm (Improved)	105-mm	105-mm	155-mm Howitzer
MODEL	M224	M29A1	M252	M101A1	Howitzer (upgraded)	M71(SOLTAM)
MAX RANGE (HE) (in meters)	3,490	4,595	5,608	11,270	11,400	23,800
PLANNING RANGE (in meters)				7,500	7,600	15,900
PROJECTILE	HE,WP, ILLUM	HE,WP, ILLUM	HE,WP, ILLUM,	HE,WP, ILLUM,	HE,M760, ILLUM,	HE, WP, ILLUM,
MAX RATE OF FIRE	30 RPM FOR 1 MIN	30 RPM FOR 1 MIN	30 RPM FOR 2 MIN	10 RPM FOR 1 MIN	10 RPM FOR 1 MIN	4 RPM FOR 1 MIN
SUSTAINED RATE OF FIRE(per minute)	20	8	15	3	3	1
MINIMUM RANGE (in meters)	70	70	83	DIRECT FIRE		
FUZES	MO	PD,VT, TIME,	PD,VT, TIME,	PD, VT, NT, MTSQ,	PD, VT, MTSQ,	PD, VT, MT, MTSQ,

a. **Field Artillery.** Artillery fire is planned (to support the battalion commander's concept of the operation) by the battalion FSO in coordination with the plans developed by the battalion S3. Company indirect fire support is planned by the company FIST and approved by the CO. The integration of indirect fires is critical to the success of the company. The effects of these fires on an enemy force are much greater than the effects of the company's organic weapons. Artillery provides the most destructive, accurate, and flexible combat multiplier the CO has to employ. Table 8.1 lists the capabilities of the indirect fire systems that may support an Infantry Company: 1) Field artillery can fire high explosive, illumination, white phosphorous and other ammunitions; and 2) Mortars and artillery fire can be combined to cover targets. For example, mortars can fire illumination while artillery fires high explosives. It is the CO's responsibility to ensure that each system (mortars, artillery, and direct fire) is employed when and where it has the greatest effect on the enemy. (See Appendix F on how to Call for Fire).

b. **Close Air Support** (CAS). CAS is normally provided by the Philippine Air Force. CAS aircraft carry a variety of munitions, which include bombs and

rockets. In general, CAS ordinance is most effective against tanks and other armored vehicles, moving targets, and troops (exposed and protected). (See Appendix G on how to call for CAS).

c. **Naval Gunfire.** This is planned and controlled by an element of the air and naval gunfire Liaison Company which is supporting the operation. Also, the liaison team assists the battalion FSO/FIST in planning and controlling naval gunfire support.

d. **Engineer.** In situations where heavy earthmoving equipment is available, equipment from the engineer battalion may be attached to engineer elements: 1) Mobility, counter-mobility, and survivability are the engineer mission supports that are given to the Rifle Company. The tasks normally provided within each of these categories are shown in Table 8.2. 2) The CO determines how engineers can best support his company's maneuver. The technical expertise of the engineers is a capability that must be used. If a breach is required, it involves the engineers in the planning. Normally, the breach element is an Infantry platoon. The engineers can also be used during rehearsals to train the Infantry soldiers in employing breaching equipment; and, 3) An engineer squad or platoon without earthmoving equipment is most effective with counter-mobility tasks. They can prepare IED emplacements, wire obstacles, and other obstacles, such as abatis, log cribs, and log hurdles. The engineer squad leader must be involved in the planning process to ensure that the obstacle plan is integrated with the scheme of maneuver and scheme of fires. The obstacle plan supports the maneuver and fire plans in several ways: a) Disrupting Obstacles**.** The obstacles can disrupt the enemy movement, resulting in more effective fires and additional time to maneuver forces, b) Fixing or Blocking Obstacles**.** The obstacles may fix or block the enemy so he can be destroyed by fire; and, c) Turning Obstacles. Obstacles can turn the enemy or prevent him from using terrain for protection. This allows direct-fire weapons to achieve a flank or rear shot on an armored vehicle.

e. **Military Intelligenceligence Battalion**. The MIB is an organic to Infantry Division that provides intelligenceligence support to Infantry Company in coordination with the battalion S2. He also plans the employment of the supporting MI elements. When they are in the company's area, the CO coordinates their positioning and functional support. In addition, the BN S2 assign COLTs within the company’s AO to assist in gathering information about the presence of the enemy by following the acronym SALUTE (Size, Activity, Location, Unit, Time, Equipment). He then relays that information to the CO through a radio message or personal contact.

Table 8.2 - Engineer Missions

MOBILITY
Breaching obstacles.
Clearing minefields.
Clearing routes.
Expedient gap crossing.
Constructing combat roads or trails.
COUNTERMOBILITY
Constructing obstacles to turn, fix, block, or disrupt enemy forces.
SURVIVABILITY
Constructing crew-served weapons and vehicle fighting positions.
Constructing protective emplacements.
Constructing strongpoints.

0817. **Company Fire Support TLP.** The following are the pre-combat checks and inspections checklist:

a. FO equipment and documents: 1) Map of the AO with Target Overlay and observation plan 2) Communication plan 3) Target engagement criteria 4) Night-vision equipment (if available) 5) Binoculars 6) Laser range finders (if available) 7) Compass (declinator) 8) Observer's Fire Fan, and 8) Report formats.

b. Personal packing items: 1) Food, ammo 2) Flashlights 3) Weapons 4) Combat medic equipment/FAK, and 5) Cellular phone.

c. Fire support documents: 1) Map of the AO 2) Manuals & ROE, and, 3) Checklist & Report formats.

d. Mortars: 1) FDC equipment and laying equipment 2) Ammo distribution 3) Displacement criteria and positioning plan 4) Fire support documents 5) Communication plan 6) Survey plan, and,7) Map of the AO.

Special Munitions

0818. Obscuration fires use smoke to changes in wind direction and terrain contours and white phosphorus ammunition to degrade the enemy by obscuring his view of the battlefield. Used properly, obscuration fires can:

a. Slow enemy vehicles to blackout speeds.

b. Obscure the vision of enemy direct-fire weapon crews.

c. Reduce accuracy of enemy-observed fires by obscuring OPs and CPs.

d. Cause confusion and apprehension among enemy soldiers.

e. Limit the effectiveness of the enemy's visual command and control signals.

Tactical Air Support

0819. At company level, the only concern with tactical air support is close air support. They usually support attacks in preparing an enemy-held objective for assault. The air strikes against hostile targets that are close to friendly forces are CAS missions. It must be carefully controlled to achieve the most benefit with the least risk to friendly forces. In the defense, CAS will engage targets in the EAs and may assist as the enemy closes on defensive positions.

0820. CAS missions are either preplanned (at battalion) or immediate. Preplanned missions are normally cont

0821. Rolled by the Air Force forward air controller. Using specialized radios available to him, the ground FAC positions himself where he can see the target. If the FAC is unavailable or cannot reach the area in time, the FSO or FO can control the CAS mission. At company level, CAS concerns consist of the following:

a. **Friendly Markings.** Mark friendly positions or vehicles to preclude accidental attack. This may be done with air recognition panels, colored smoke, other pyrotechnics, or similar devices recognizable from the air.

b. **Enemy Acquisition and Identification.** Designate enemy positions or targets to assist the aircrew in acquisition and identification. This can be done with tracer fire, WP, smoke, or illumination rounds at night. Air panels and smoke or light can also be used to point toward the enemy from friendly positions.

c. Figure 8.3 is an example of a nine-line CAS request. It provides the information required to safely and accurately guide aircraft to the target. These considerations should be noted when filling out this request: 1) Sometimes the marking round is not directly on the target. In this case, the requester gives an adjustment as soon as the round impacts, such as FROM THE MARK SOUTHWEST 150 METERS; and, 2) If the mark is on the target, the requester gives HIT THE MARK: a) If multiple aircraft are engaging, the second aircraft can be given an adjustment from the first aircraft bombs, FROM LEADS' HITS, 400 METERS SOUTH. b) For the first eight lines, give only the information; do not read the title or line number. For line nine, always state the title EGRESS before the information; and, c) To stop the mission at any time before the bomb release, the requester states, “ABORT, ABORT, ABORT!”

1. INITIAL POINT: HILL 425
(This is the initial point that aircraft uses to position for the bomb run. It must be a well-defined point easily located from the air.)

2. HEADING: 95º MAG OFFSET: L X R ___
(This is the heading from the IP to the target; it is given in degrees magnetic. At this time, the requestor also gives the offset as either right or left. This is used:

- To assist the pilot in acquiring the target
- To position the aircraft parallel or nearly parallel to friendly forces.
- To position the aircraft for laser acquisition.
- To position the aircraft to avoid enemy ADA weapons.

3. DISTANCE: 5.7 NM
(This is the distance (to the nearest tenth) from the IP to the target in nautical miles.)

4. TARGET ELEVATION: 340 FEET MSL
(This is the target elevation in feet above mean sea level.)

5. TARGET DESCRIPTION: 7 ARMORED VEHICLES
(This is a short concise statement describing the target and what the pilot should look for.)

6. TARGET LOCATION: NJ 572895
(This is the six-digit grid of the target.)

7. MARK TYPE: WP CODE (N/A)
(This is the method of target marking to be used. Ideally, within 300 meters and 30 seconds prior to aircraft's time target. The code is only required when using laser designation to identify the pulse.)

8. FRIENDLIES: WEST 600 METERS
(This is the cardinal direction and distance in meters from the target to the nearest friendlies, such as WEST 350 METERS.)

9. EGRESS: SOUTH
(This is the direction of departure from the target area, given as a cardinal direction.)

Figure 8.1 - Example of a Nine-Line CAS Request

Chapter IX
Sustainment Operations

Introduction

0901. The role of sustainment operations in any military unit is to support the force for continuous combat operations. At the company level, the company commander has ultimate responsibility for sustainment. Sustaining his company in battle is one of the greatest challenges an Infantry Company commander faces. The executive officer and the first sergeant help him meet this challenge.

0902. The deployment of the infantry company from one geographical location within the Philippines is only possible through a request that is supported by a Unified Command. The Commanding General of the Philippine Army, through the support of the Unified Command, determines the infantry unit to be deloyed. Particularly, the determination of the specific infantry company unit to be deployed is according to the unit's specialty and its suitability of the needs of the concerned areas.

Sustainment

0903. Sustainment is a major component of company operations. The art of sustainment involved projecting a company responsive force that generates decisive power. Successful application of the art of sustainment requires proper synchronization of operational and tactical requirements that enables company commanders to initiate and sustain operations, and extend their operational reach through the assistance of the higher headquarters.

0904. Sustainment operations involve the operational positioning and efficient use of all available sustainment assets and capabilities, from the industrial base to the soldier in the field. They enable company commanders to extend operational reach and deploy and employ the force simultaneously, without pause. Company SS operations merge operational art and science into an operations enabler.

0905. Sustainment is integrated at all levels of company operations through a seamless distribution system. Sustainment operations enable the commander to generate company power for employment in conducting shaping and decisive operations within the required time and at a tempo faster than the enemy can react to.

0906. Functions sustainment consists of many interrelated functions. Planning, managing, and executing support involved synchronizing and integrating them. At all levels of operations, the key company sustainment functions include:

a. **Maintenance**. Materielare kept in a serviceable, operational condition, returned to service, or updated and upgraded to its capability.

b. **Transportation.** Move and transfer units, personnel, equipment, and supplies to support the concept of operations.

c. **Supply**. Except for Class VIII items, other supplies are acquired, managed, received, stored, and issued to equip and sustain company forces. Supply also covers the turn-in, exchange, and/or disposition of items.

d. **Combat Health Support**. Prevention of disease and non-battle injury /casualties.

0907. **Sustainment in Offensive Operations**. Effective sustainment in offensive operations demands company commanders who foresee requirements and prepare to meet them before they occur. Company commanders require a simple concept of sustainment that is responsive and flexible enough to adjust while executing offensive operations. To sustain momentum and provide freedom of action to exploit success, they integrate sustainment considerations into plans. To ensure continuity of support, plans include provisions for sustainment units to follow exploiting forces. Due to the tempo of offensive operations, company units may experience high losses from combat operations, combat stress, and fatigue. Recognizing the potential loss during offensive operations, commanders plan for reconstitution.

0908. **Sustainment in Defensive Operations**. Sustainment requirements for defensive operations depend on the type of defense. Company forces in a mobile defense consume more fuel than those in an area defense. Typically, bulk fuel consumption may be less than in offensive operations. However, ammunition consumption is higher and will likely have the highest movement priority. As with the offense, the force commander's operational design affects the concept of CO's sustainment. The CO synchronizes the concept of sustainment with the force commander's concept of operations.

0909. **Sustainment in Support to Civil Governance Operations**. Some SCG operations, such as peace enforcement operations, may involve levels of support comparable to offensive and defensive operations. In other operations, demands may be lower but distances between units may increase. In SCG operations, contracted support and local sourcing is often more appropriate than in other operations. It is important to integrate support not only with other company major services but also with NGOs.

Fundamentals

0910. **Responsibilities and Organization**. The Infantry Company headquarters is responsible for the coordination and execution of sustainment support functions within the company, reporting current status, requesting supplies or support, conducting effective sustainment operations within the unit, casualty evacuation, resupply operations, maintenance activities, and personnel service support. The following are the officials and their specific tasks:

a. **Commander**. The commander ensures that sustainment operations sustain his company's fighting potential. He integrates sustainment activities into the tactical plan and provides guidance to the sustainment operators. He tailors his sustainment operations to meet the tactical plan.

b. **Executive Officer**. He coordinates and supervises the company's logistical effort. He receives status reports from the platoon leaders, platoon sergeants, and F/Sgt, reviews the tactical plan with the company commander to determine company sustainment requirements, and coordinates these needs with the battalion S4 during the planning. During execution, the XO locates at the second most important place on the battlefield, as determined by the company commander. The XO also performs the following sustainment functions: 1) Determines the location of the company's resupply point based on data developed during operational planning and the war gaming process. 2) Compiles periodic status reports from the platoon leaders, platoon sgt and the F/Sgt; provides updates to the commander as required. 3) Along with the F/Sgt, ensures that the company executes sustainment operations in accordance with the SOP; and, 4) Ensures the sustainment needs of supporting units are met.

c. **First Sergeant**. The company F/SGT is a fighter first and logistician second. In addition to his tactical responsibilities listed in Chapter 1, the F/Sgt will be a key player in sustainment operations for the company. He also is a key player in the execution of the company's sustainment plan and may supervise the company trains based upon commander intent and the factors of METT-TC. He ensures that the XO receives current status reports from all subordinate units, assists the XO in preparing reports and requests to battalion, and helps the XO or commander prepare Paragraph 4 of the OPORD: 1) The F/Sgt ensures receipt, consolidation, and forwarding of all logistics, personnel, and casualty reports to the battalion combat trains CP. He normally supervises the evacuation of casualties, EPWs, and damaged equipment. He normally supervises company resupply activities and monitors company maintenance activities. 2) The F/Sgt orients new replacements and assigns them to squads and platoons IAW the company commander's guidance. 3) The F/Sgt ensures the required information is received from the platoon and section sergeants and the senior trauma specialist. These NCOs are responsible for providing all SS reports IAW; and, 4) The F/Sgt may also perform the following CSS functions: a) Conduct sustainment rehearsals at the company level and integrate sustainment into the company's maneuver rehearsals. b) Normally direct and supervise the medical team and move it forward when the situation requires; and, c) Maintain the battle roster for the company.d) Supply Sergeant.The supply sergeant is the company representative. He verifies the logistics package (LOGPAC) and moves with the LOGPACforward to the company. He assists with resupply and coordinates the company's sustainment requirements. The supply sergeant may control the medical evacuation vehicle when it is unable to remain forward with the company. He monitors the tactical situation and adjusts the sustainment plan as appropriate to meet the tactical plan and the company commander's guidance. He may assist the commander by establishing caches. He forecasts the company's consumption of food, water, ammunition, POL, and batteries, based on the operation. The supply sergeant also performs the following CSS functions: 1) Coordinates with the battalion S4 for resupplyof Classes I, III, and V. 2) Maintains individual supply and clothing records; requisitions Class II resupply, as needed. 3) Requests Class IV and Class VII equipment and supplies. 4) Coordinates with the maintenance support team to turn in and pick up maintenance documents, routine Class IX supplies, and recoverable materials. 5) Picks up replacement personnel and, as necessary, delivers them

to the F/Sgt. 6) Receives and evacuates human remains and personal effects to the mortuary affairs point in the BSA. 7) Transports, guards, and transfers EPWs, as required. 8) Accompanies the LOGPAC to the logistics release point (LRP) and guides the LOGPAC to the company resupply point. 9) Accompanies the LOGPAC along with EPWs and damaged vehicles (if applicable) back to the BSA; and, 10) Maintains and provides supplies for company field sanitation activities.

d. **Platoon Sergeant**. Each PSG in the company performs the following sustainment functions: 1) Ensures crews perform proper maintenance on all assigned equipment. 2) Compiles and submits all personnel and logistics status reports for the platoon as directed or in accordance with SOP. 3) Collects each equipment inspection and maintenance form within the platoon; and, 4) Obtains supplies and equipment (all classes except Class VIII) and mail from the supply sergeant and ensures proper distribution within the platoon.

Resupply Operations

Routine Resupply

0911. Routine resupply operations cover items in Classes I, III, V, and IX, as well as mail and any other items requested by the company. Resupply operations normally occur once a day. Whenever possible, routine resupply should be conducted daily, ideally, during periods of limited visibility.

Logistics Package Operations

0912. **Movement of LOGPAC**. Once the company LOGPAC has been formed in the field trains, it is ready to move forward under the control of the company supply sergeant. The forward support company XO or F/Sgt normally organizes a convoy of company LOGPACs to facilitate movement along a supply route to the LRP where the company's F/Sgts take control. The F/Sgt controls distribution to the company using one of the various techniques discussed later. The convoy commander must also establish security measures for the LOGPAC along the MSR.

0913. **Actions at LRP**. When the LOGPAC arrives at the LRP, the company F/Sgt assumes control of the company LOGPAC and continues tactical movement to the company resupply point. The LOGPAC stops at the LRP only when the tactical situation dictates or when ordered by the commander. Security is maintained at all times.

Resupply Procedures

0914. The company can use the service station (Figure 9.1) or tailgate resupply (Figure 9.2) method. The time required for resupply is an important planning factor. Resupply must be conducted as quickly and efficiently as possible, both to ensure operational effectiveness and to allow the company LOGPAC vehicles to return to the LRP on time. Service station resupply of the company normally takes 60 to 90 minutes but may take longer. Tailgate resupply usually requires significantly more time than service station

resupply. At times, leaders must use the in-position resupply method (Figure 9.3), but this takes much more time.

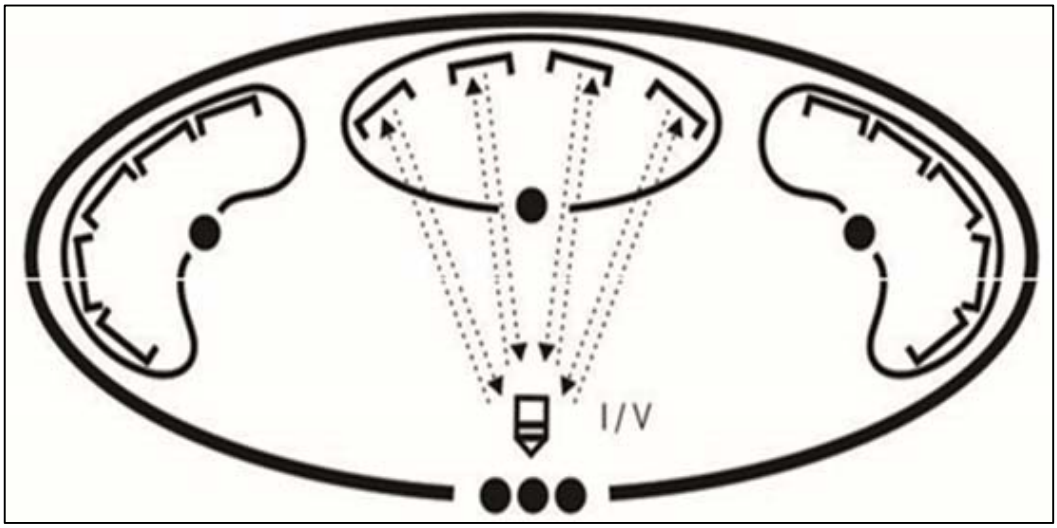


Figure 9.1 - Service Station Resupply Method

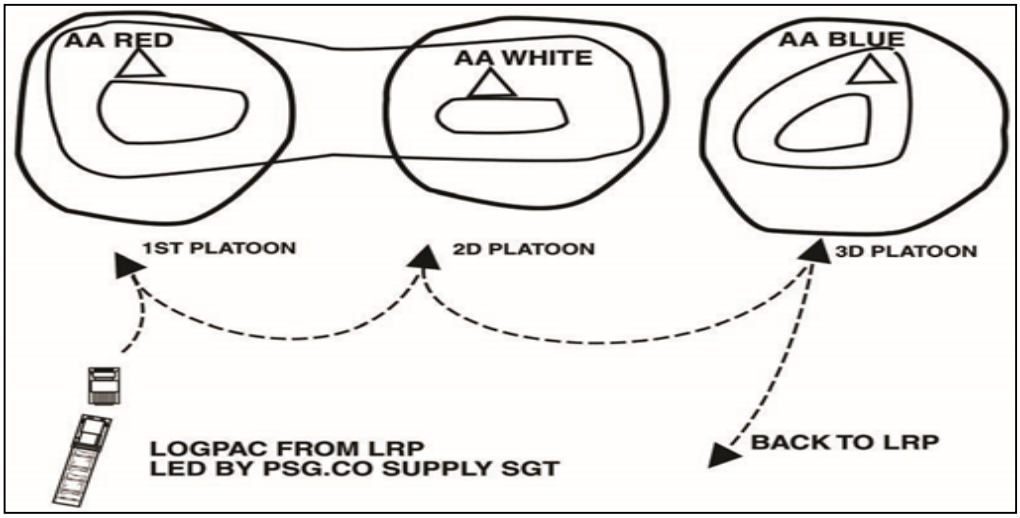


Figure 9.2 - Tailgate Resupply Method

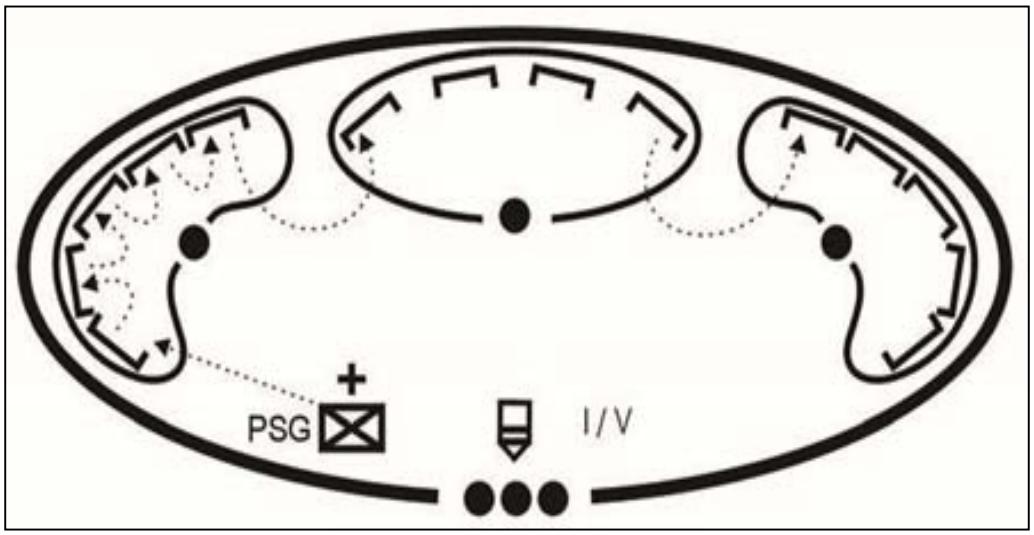


Figure 9.3 - In-Position Method

Return to LRP

0915. The supply sergeant leads the LOGPAC back to the LRP. The LOGPAC vehicles are prepared for the return trip once resupply operations are complete. All supply requests and personnel action documents are consolidated for forwarding to the field trains, where the appropriate staff section processes them for the next LOGPAC. When METT-TC dictates or when the LOGPAC arrives too late to rejoin the larger convoy, the vehicles return to the BSA on their own. Whenever possible, the reunited LOGPAC convoy returns to the BSA together.

Resupply Methods

0916. As directed by the commander or XO, the F/SGT establishes the company resupply point. Either he uses a resupply point (service station method) or he delivers resupply directly to the platoon (tailgate method). Occasionally the in-position resupply method might be required. He briefs each LOGPAC driver on which method to use. When he has the resupply point ready, the F/Sgt informs the commander. The company commander then directs each platoon or element to conduct resupply based on the tactical situation.

Service Station Resupply

0917. The service station method allows platoons, squads, or soldiers to move individually to a centrally located resupply point. This method requires the soldiers to leave their fighting positions. Depending on the tactical situation, a squad or platoon moves out of its position, conducts resupply operations, and moves back into position. The squads or platoons rotate individually to eat, pick up mail and sundries, and replenish water. This process continues until the entire platoon has received its supplies. This technique is normally used in assembly areas and when contact is not likely. This technique also cuts down on the amount of vehicular movement. The LOGPAC vehicles are stationary once they have established the resupply point.

Tailgate Resupply

0918. When the platoons are dispersed or the tactical situation requires, the F/Sgt may use the tailgate method. The terrain must also permit the movement of multiple vehicles to each platoon position. The F/SGT will bring LOGPAC to each platoon's area. Individual soldiers or teams rotate back through the feeding area. While there, they pick up mail and sundries, and replenish other classes of supply. They centralize and guard any EPW. They take Soldiers KIA and their personal effects to the holding area, where the F/Sgtassumes responsibility for them.

In-Position Resupply

0919. The in-position resupply method might be required to ensure adequate supplies are available to the squads during operation, when contact with the enemy is imminent. However, platoon members may need to help the resupply personnel move supplies and equipment forward, if resupply contact is eminent or vehicles cannot move near platoon positions. This method:

a. Is used when an immediate need exits.

b. Is used to resupply single classes of supply.

c. Enables leaders to keep squad members in their fighting positions.

Emergency Resupply

0920. Occasionally (normally during combat operations), the company may have such an urgent need for resupply that it cannot wait for a routine LOGPAC. Emergency resupply may involve Classes III, V, and VIII, as well as CBRN equipment and, on rare occasions, Class I. Emergency resupply can be conducted using either the service station or tailgate method, but more often the in-position method. The fastest appropriate means is normally used although procedures might have to be adjusted when the company is in contact with the enemy. In the service station method, individual squads may pull back during a lull in combat to conduct resupply and then return to the fight. With tailgate resupply, the company brings limited supplies forward to the closest concealed position behind each element.

Prestockage Operations

0921. Pre-stock resupply, which includes pre-positioning and caching, is most often required in defensive operations and proven to be effenctive against communist insurgents.

Pre-Positioned Supplies

0922. Normally, only Class V items are pre-positioned. Prestock operations must be carefully planned and executed at every level. All leaders must know the exact locations of prestock sites, which they verify during reconnaissance or rehearsals. The company must take steps to ensure survivability of the prestock supplies. These measures include

digging in prestock positions and selecting covered and concealed positions. The company commander must also have a plan to remove or destroy pre-positioned supplies to prevent the enemy from capturing them.

Security

0923. While these techniques are used in both offensive and defensive operations, the transfer of supplies to the company is usually conducted from a defensive posture. As such, the security considerations for a resupply operation are like those for a perimeter defense.

Supply Considerations

0924. The techniques described in the preceding paragraphs are the normal methods for resupply within the company. However, a basic understanding of non-standard techniques, different modes of delivery, and specific supply issues are also required for the successful execution of the sustainment function.

Foraging and Scavenging

0925. Foraging and scavenging are used infrequently and only under extreme conditions. Foraging is the gathering of supplies and equipment necessary to sustain basic needs, such as for food, water, and shelter, from within the area of operations. Scavenging is the gathering of supplies or equipment (friendly or enemy) from within the area of operations to help the user accomplish his military mission. Leaders must protect their soldiers by determining whether the food or water is safe or whether the equipment is booby-trapped.

Aerially Resupplying

0926. In using aerial resupply, the Infantry Company commander must consider the threat's ability to locate his unit by observing the aircraft. Unless conducting the resupply in an area under friendly control and away from direct enemy observation (reverse slope of a defensive position with reconnaissance well forward), locate the drop zone or landing zone (DZ or LZ) away from the main unit in an area that can be defended for a short time. The delivered supplies are immediately transported away from the DZ or LZ.

Cross-Leveling

0927. Cross-leveling is simply a redistribution of supplies throughout the unit. Usually done automatically between platoons and squads after every engagement, the company may cross-level supplies between platoons when resupply cannot occur. In some instances, supplies may not be evenly redistributed. For example, during preparation for an assault of an enemy trench system, the platoon with the task of support by fire might be required to give its hand grenades to the platoon with the task of clearing the trench.

Backhauling

0928. Backhauling is a method used to make the most use of vehicular or manpack capabilities moving rearward. Backhauling returns supplies, equipment, or HAZMAT to the rear for disposition. Backhauling is also a means for non-standard evacuation.

Managing Consumption of Water

0929. Ensuring that soldiers receive and drink enough water is a vital sustainment and leadership function at all levels in the company chain of command. Even in cold areas, everyone needs to drink at least two quarts of water a day to maintain efficiency. Soldiers must drink water at an increased rate in a combat environment.

0930. Water is delivered to the unit under company or battalion control in 5-gallon cans, bottled water, water trailers, or collapsible containers. When a centralized feeding area is established, a water point is set up in the mess area and each soldier fills his canteen as he goes through. When the company distributes rations, it can resupply water either by collecting and filling empty canteens or by distributing water cans to the platoons.

0931. Water is habitually included in LOGPACs. The ability of the command to supply water is limited by the ability of the BSB's water section to purify, store, and distribute it. The logistics system may not always be able to meet unit needs, particularly during decentralized operations. In most environments, water is available from natural sources. Soldiers should be trained to find, treat (chemically or using field expedients), and use natural water sources.

0932. When water is not scarce, leaders must urge soldiers to drink water even when they are not thirsty. The body's thirst mechanism does not keep pace with the loss of water through normal daily activity. The rate at which dehydration occurs depends on the weather conditions and the level of physical exertion.

0933. If water is in short supply, be sparing in its use for hygiene purposes. Water used for coffee or tea might be counterproductive since both increase the flow of urine. Soups, however, are an efficient means of getting both water and nutrition when water is scarce. This is especially true in cold weather when heated food is desirable. When in short supply, water should not be used to heat MREs. A centralized heating point can be used to conserve water yet provide warmed MREs.

Transportation Support

0934. Transportation of the Infantry Rifle Company from the organic vehicle is a hazardous undertaking. Remotely detonated mines and IEDs can be spread all over the area and land infantry company transportation can be hazardous. The following considerations should be followed by the company commanders:

a. Thoroughly practice mounting and dismounting procedures and actions on contact.

b. Alert the TC before mounting or dismounting.

c. Infantry platoons should be broken down by squads, with the Infantry platoon leader on the armor platoon leader's vehicle and the Infantry platoon sergeant on the armor platoon sergeant's vehicle.

d. Platoon leaders, platoon sergeants, and team leaders should position themselves near the TC's hatch, using the external phone (if available) to talk to the TC and relay signals to the unit.

e. If possible, the lead vehicle should not carry Infantrymen. Riders restrict turret movement and are more likely to be injured or killed on initial contact.

f. Whenever possible, Infantrymen should mount and dismount to the front of a tank, while ensuring the driver and, or, the TC have made eye contact and granted permission to climb on to, or off, the tank to Infantrymen.

g. Infantrymen must always have three points of contact with the vehicle, and watch for low-hanging objects such as tree branches.

h. Infantrymen should wear hearing protection.

i. Infantrymen should not ride with anything more than their battle gear. Rucksacks should be transported by other means.

j. Infantrymen should scan in all directions while riding. They might be able to spot a target the vehicle crew does not see.

0935. The infantry company can be transported from its original geographical location to anywhere in the Philippines by means of three (3) domains: land, air and sea. The transportation support for these three domains are explained in the sections below:

0936. **Land Transportation Support**. The Infantry Rifle Company, as per TOE is issued two (2) M-35 trucks. It is important to note that once a company unit is deployed to another area of operations, there is an augmentation of six (6) M-35 trucks that can be utilized by the personnel for the transportation of armament/equipment and the whole company unit as well. Rucksacks and excess equipment are transported through land, not unless specific commands are given. 1) In a theater of sustainment support operations, the light truck company is commonly employed to fill commitments for troop movements, haul of supplies, and ammunition. Ideally, in mission operations the light infantry company truck is equipped with 2 1/2-ton trucks that is capable of delivering 720 tons of cargo or 3,600 passengers per day in local hauls and 360 tons of cargo or 1,440 passengers per day in line hauls. On the other hand, when equipped with 5-ton trucks, the unit can deliver 1,080 tons of cargo or 3,600 passengers in local hauls and 540 tons of cargo or 1,620 passengers in line hauls.

0937. The infantry company unit is is primarily foot mobile; but the company is readily transported by tracked and wheeled vehicles as well as helicopters, amphibious ships and craft, and tactical and strategic air transportation. Movement of supplies, equipment, and personnel with the limited vehicle assets available requires careful planning and execution. Light infantry companies have no organic transportation. Vehicle assets are provided to these companies from battalion or higher levels.

Normally one vehicle is dedicated to the company.

0938. The Philippine Army infantry rifle company is particularly adaptable to airmobile operations because most of their equipment can be moved by currently available helicopters, for example C-130 and C-141. Normally the Philippine Air Force is placed in support of the Philippine Army infantry rifle company unit with operational control retained by the Philippine Army battalion commander. The command relationship is based on the ability of the company to plan, coordinate, control, and support the air movement phase of the operation. For some independent operations, transport aviation elements and aircraft maintenance and supply elements may be attached to the company.

0939. **Air Transportation Support**. The infantry company can be airlifted through the usage of one (1) C-130 aircraft from the Philippine Air force. However, the company unit is commanded to bring light equipment of packages during urgent action missions.

0940. The Philippine Air force uses its strategic airlift assets and capability to support Philippine Army operations through the range of military operations. This capability consists of C-130 aircraft. The Philippine Air force, by entering the theater air transport support request system, may use their assets in a strategic role to transport deploying Philippine Army Infantry Company Units. Philippine Air force may operate channel traffic into areas of operation and manage the traffic much like a commercial airline. Air Transportation support normally moves personnel and high priority cargo.

0941. The infantry company unit movements are timed so they arrive at their destination sequenced to match the arrival of their equipment. This assures rapid clearance as Infantry Company personnel link with their equipment.Transportation requests by the company commander are done through the first sergeant or XO. The request is then relayed by the First Sergeant or XO to the battalion S4 or S3, when helicopters are involved.

0942. Air transport support for the infantry company aims to: 1**)** Transports troops and/or supplies under day, night, or limited visibility conditions 2) Provides aerial mobility and aerial supply and resupply of Army forces 3) Provides augmentation of Army medical service aeromedical evacuation elements. The unit can be employed in day or night operations and during periods of inclement weather. However, the effectiveness of the company is reduced during darkness and extremes of inclement conditions.

0943. The infantry rifle company can be transported by sea via a Landing Ship Tank (LST) of the Philippine Navy. The LST is capable of carrying Philippine Army infantry company troops, tanks, vehicles and other equipment directly on assault beaches during amphibious operations and on beaches of places not requiring port facilities. It can also provide a helideck for a Huey type of helicopter and assistance to vessels, persons and property in distress, conduct search and rescue operations at sea, and provide limited naval gunfire support (NGFS) during amphibious operations. Generally, sealift general cargo should be up to a maximum load of 1,600 tons. Sealift personnel can be up to a maximum load of 500 persons.

0944. **Sea Transportation Support.** The infantry company can be transported by sea via one (1) 300-footer Landing Ship Tank (LST) with the coordination of the Philippine Fleet, J3, and Philippine Navy. The coordination is done during AFP joint operations. Sea terminals consist of fixed ports, unimproved ports, inland waterways, and bare beaches. During sea transportation support, the company commander considers the following range of factors for its planning and execution:

a. Overall concept of the operation.

b. Logistics support requirements.

c. Physical characteristics and layout of the port and/or beaches.

d. Relative location of highway, rail, air, and inland waterway networks.

e. Location of supported and supporting units.

f. Required repair and rehabilitation of existing facilities.

g. Requirement for new construction.

h. Requirement for security.

0945. Vehicle assets from battalion or the forward supply company are provided for company resupply operations. Transportation assets are scarce, often resulting in trade-offs. Land navigation training, marked routes, and strip maps referenced to landmarks are all ways to keep drivers from getting lost. The company commander must ensure that the asset is being employed to accomplish the most important mission.

0946. Because of the limited ground transportation, company personnel must know how to conduct aerial resupply. An understanding of PZs/LZs selection, sling loading, bundle drops, and allowable cargo loads might be critical to company sustainment.

Soldier's Load

0947. The soldier's load is of crucial concern to the leader. How much do soldiers carry, how far, and in what configuration? These critical mission considerations require command emphasis and inspection. Army research shows that a soldier can carry 30 percent of his body weight and retain much of his agility, stamina, alertness, and mobility.

0948. For the average soldier who weighs 160 pounds, this means carrying 48 pounds. Success and survival in company operations demand that soldiers retain these capabilities. When it cannot move with stealth, agility, and alertness, the unit is at risk. For each pound over 30 percent of his body weight, the soldier loses function. When his load exceeds 45 percent of his body weight, or 72 pounds for the average soldier, his functional ability drops rapidly, and his chances of becoming a casualty increase.

0949. Research also shows that training can only improve load-carrying capability by 10 to 20 percent--at best. Commanders must ensure that soldiers carry no more than 30

percent of their body weight when in contact or when contact is expected. At other times, the soldier's load should not exceed 72 pounds. Sometimes, soldiers must exceed the recommended weight. Leaders must realize how that excess weight impacts the unit's effectiveness. This example, extracted from The Soldier's Load and Mobility of a Nation, by S. L. A. Marshall, details the dangers of excess loads.

EXAMPLE

During the Normandy Invasion, many casualties were attributed to the excessive loads carried by US Soldiers as they tried to get ashore and across the beach. E Company, 16th Infantry suffered 105 casualties that day. Of these, 104 occurred on the beach, and most of them were due to their overloads. Many Soldiers felt prone at the water's edge and were drowned by the incoming tide. The Soldiers' packs were so heavy that they were able to walk only a few feet before falling to the sand. It took the company more than an hour to move 250 meters across the beach. The paratroopers that jumped into Normandy carried the following:

1	carbine or M1 rifle	1 steel helmet with liner
80	rounds of ammunition	1 knit cap
2	hand grenades	1 change of underwear
1	mine	2 pairs of socks
6	K-rations	1 gas mask
1	impregnated jumpsuit	1 first-aid packet
1	complete uniform	1 spoon
1	entrenching tool	2 gas protective covers
1	field bag	1 packet of sulfur
1	escape kit	1 set toilet articles

Although they were required to jump heavy, once on the ground the individual Soldier discarded all unnecessary items and traveled light. They understood from their training that their success depended on mobility, stealth, and surprise. Even though these airborne units were without resupply for days, there is only one recorded incident where an airborne unit gave up ground due to ammunition shortages.

Plans

0950. The purpose of load plans is two-fold. First, it lets the Infantry Company commander use the estimate of the situation to determine what ammunition, supplies, and equipment are essential. Second, it accounts for the potential impact of the soldier-load problem and emphasizes the need to carry only what is necessary. The commander then arranges for the remainder of the load to be secured or transported. The company commander must consider METT-TC in determining the soldier's load to be carried by the company. The company commander breaks down the company's equipment and supplies into one of the three echelons: combat load (approach march or fighting load), sustainment load, and contingency load.

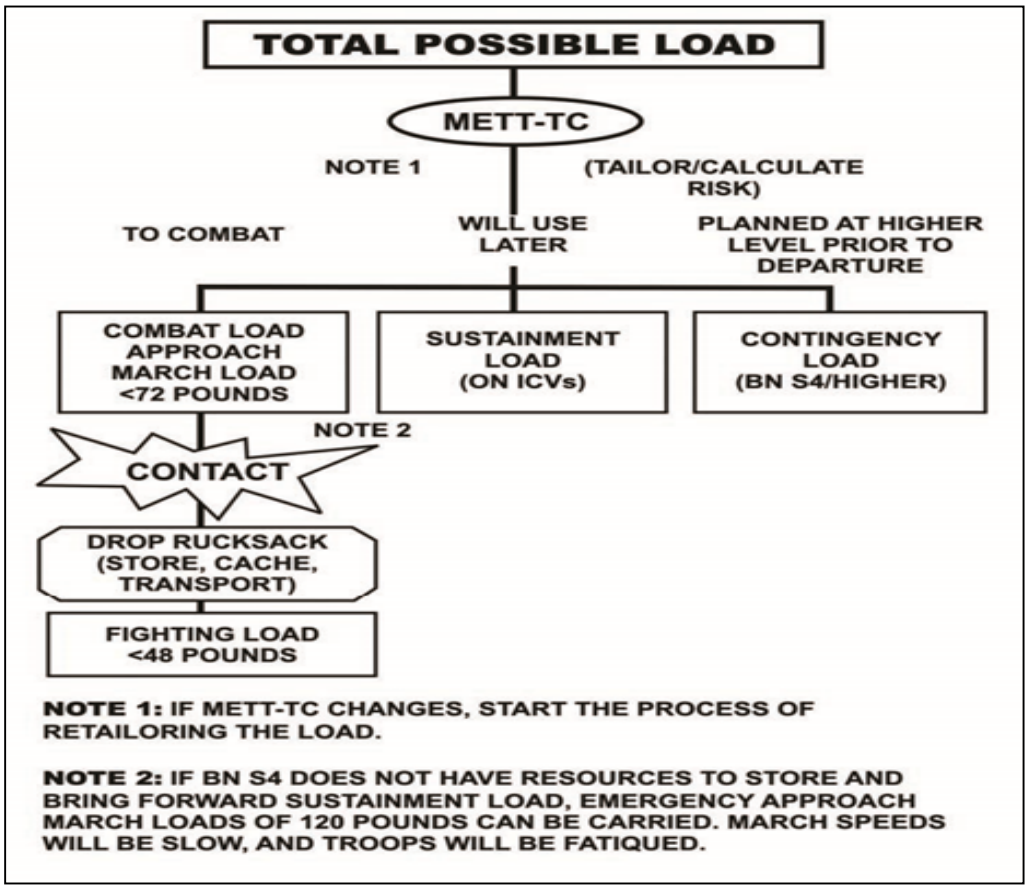


Figure 9.4 - Load Echelon Diagram

Combat Load

0951. A combat load consists of the minimum mission-essential equipment, as determined by the mission commander. This includes only what is needed to fight and survive immediate combat operations. The two levels of combat load are fighting loads, which are carried on dynamic operations where contact with the enemy is expected, and approach march loads, which are carried when transportation cannot be provided for equipment over and above fighting loads.

Fighting Load

0952. A fighting load is what the soldier carries once contact has been made with the enemy. It consists only of essential items the soldier needs to accomplish his task during the engagement. For close combat and operations requiring stealth, any load at all is a disadvantage. Cross loading of machine-gun ammunition, mortar rounds, anti-tank weapons, and radio equipment cause most combat loads to exceed 48 pounds. This is where risk analysis is critical. Excessive combat loads of assaulting troops must be configured so that the excess can be redistributed or shed (leaving only the fighting load) before or upon contact with the enemy.

Approach March Load

0953. An approach march load is the load that the soldier carries in addition to his fighting load. These items are dropped in an assault position, ORP, or other rally point before or upon contact with the enemy. On long dynamic operations, Soldiers must carry enough equipment and munitions to fight and exist until a planned resupply can take place. These loads vary and may exceed the goal of 72 pounds.

Sustainment Load

0954. This consists of the equipment that are usually stored by the company supply section in the BSA and brought forward when needed for sustained operations.

Contingency Load

0955. This includes extra clothing, personal items, or even Javelins in a threat environment where the enemy lacks armored capabilities that are unnecessary for ongoing operations.

Calculation

0956. This consists of common essential items carried (worn) by all soldiers regardless of threat, environment, or mission, duty position load, consisting of the soldier's assigned weapon (or components of the weapon system) plus ammunition, and variables, consisting of all other items carried, based on the commander's estimate of the situation. Calculation considerations are as follows:

a. Adjust combat loads so soldiers carry less than 72 pounds.

b. Divide combat loads into fighting loads and approach march loads.

c. Have soldiers pack rucksacks and assault packs accordingly.

d. Place all other company equipment into the sustainment load.

e. Once he decides what items soldiers will carry on the mission, the leader decides how they will carry them. Soldiers need some items to be immediately available; other items can be carried in rucksacks.

Management

0957. The key to load management is to carry only what is necessary to accomplish the mission. The following techniques assist the commander in load management. The following considerations are applied:

a. Make sure soldiers distribute their loads evenly over the body, body armor, and load-carrying equipment (LCE), or load-bearing vest (LBV).

b. Carry critical items within easy reach: carry water, ammunition, and a first aid pouch on the LCE, with other items in Army Combat Uniform (ACU) pockets. Ensure that placement of all items is standardized within the unit, and nothing

that could prevent the soldier from taking a well-aimed shot is allowed on the firing side of the LCE.

0958. Distribute loads throughout the unit. If bulk ammunition, rations, water, or demolitions must be man packed, divide them into small loads consistent with METT-TC. This helps ensure they can be distributed on the battlefield, where needed.

0959. Rotate heavy loads among several soldiers. The unit can rotate radios, GPMG, mortars, and AT weapons if enemy contact is not imminent. Ensure that the assigned gunner stays near the weapons system components, if they are rotated.

0960. Upon contact with the enemy, drop rucksacks (if the tactical situation permits). The commander must consider how to recover the rucksacks and the effect of not having the rucksacks might have on his unit or leave them in an ORP, an assault position, or the assembly area. The leader can later request battalion transportation assets to bring them to his unit when possible (enemy situation dependent). Soldiers mark their rucksacks by unit to facilitate quick recovery. The following considerations are applied:

a. Share or consolidate items. If the weather requires soldiers to carry sleeping bags, carry only enough for those who will sleep at the same time. Two or three soldiers can share a sleeping bag. Soldiers can share the bags as they take turns rotating security duty. In the same manner, two or three soldiers can share a rucksack and take turns carrying it.

b. Consider cutting rations to two or even one meal, ready to eat (MRE) per man, per day for short periods. Remember that the MRE is a complete meal. It provides all the nutrition soldiers need for sustained operations. Proper nutrition and fuelling is critical for sustained soldier performance.

c. While carrying the rucksack, use water and rations carried in or on it first. If soldiers must drop their rucksacks, what they carry in their ACUs and on the LCE or LBV remains available. Replace ammunition, water, and rations carried on LCE or LBV, or in ACU pockets, as soon as possible.

d. When carrying radios in rucksacks, keep them attached to the backpack for access and use when rucksacks are dropped.

e. Consider caches, supply linkups, captured stocks, and foraging to provide food, water, shelter, weapons, and equipment to reduce the need to man pack supplies.

0961. Avoid unnecessary movement and displacements. To conserve the soldier's stamina, plan the mission as efficiently as possible. Do not move a platoon when moving a squad can do the job. If the leader becomes lost, he stops and determines his unit's location before moving and, if necessary, sends out someone to confirm the unit's location.

0962. Supervise the soldier's load closely. Soldiers must not carry items not included in the packing list, or those items that will add weight and detract from their performance. Rucksack management must be considered as it results in the efficient

use of a soldier's energy and ensures that essential items are available when needed in combat:

a. The company net does not always need the COMSEC equipment to function effectively. Ensure the threat warrants the extra weight on the radio operators.

b. Consider distributing the approach march or sustainment loads to only two platoons. This allows the lead platoon to move with more stealth and alertness and to remain unburdened, in case of contact. Platoons can then quickly swap rucksacks as they rotate the lead.

Personnel Service Support

0963. To maintain effective, consistent combat power, the company must have specific plans and procedures that allow each element to integrate replacement personnel and equipment quickly. Unit SOP defines how soldiers and equipment are prepared for combat, including areas such as uploading, load plans, PCIs, and in-briefings.

Replacements and Cross-Leveling of Personnel

0964. Replacements for wounded, killed, or missing personnel are requested through the battalion S-1. Returning or replacement personnel arriving with the LOGPAC should have already been issued all items, including their personal weapons. Within the company, each platoon leader cross-levels personnel among his crews, with the F/Sgt controlling cross-levelling from platoon to platoon.

0965. Integrating replacements into a company is important. A new arrival on the battlefield might be scared and disoriented as well as unfamiliar with local SOPs and the theater of operations. The following procedures help integrate new arrivals into a company. The following considerations are applied:

a. The company commander meets them and welcomes them to the unit. This is normally a brief interview. The company commander must have an SOP for reception and integration of newly assigned soldiers.

b. The platoon leader and platoon sergeant welcome them to the unit, inform them of unit standards, and introduce them to their squad leaders.

c. The squad leader introduces them to the squad and briefs them on duty positions. He also ensures that each replacement has a serviceable, zeroed weapon, as well as ammunition, MOPP gear, and other essential equipment. The in-briefing should cover the squad and platoon's recent and planned activities.

d. The new arrival is told about important SOPs and a paper copy should be given to the soldiers on any special information concerning the area of operations. He might be given a form letter to send to his next of kin. The letter should tell them where to mail letters and packages, tell them how to use the Red Cross in emergencies, and introduce them to the chain of command.

Enemy Prisoners of War, Detainees, and Other Retained Persons

0966. All persons captured, detained, or retained by Philippine Armed Forces during the course of military operations are considered "detained" persons until their status is determined by higher military and civilian authorities. The Infantry Division has a military police battalion to take control of and evacuate detainees. However, as a practical matter, Infantry squads, platoons, companies and battalions capture and must provide the initial processing and holding for detainees.

0967. All detained persons shall be given humanitarian care and treatment immediately. Philippine Armed Forces will never torture, mistreat, or purposely place detained persons in positions of danger. No military necessity or exception exists that allows the violation of these principles. Tactical questioning of detainees is allowed relative to the collection of CCIR. However, detainees must always be treated IAW the IHL and other pertinent laws.

0968. In any tactical situation, the Infantry platoons and company have specific procedures and guidelines for handling prisoners and captured material. Unit SOPs determine exact EPW processing. Platoons usually have an EPW collection point and the company will have a separate collection point.

0969. The five-S's and T method reminds soldiers about the basic principles for handling EPW, which include tagging prisoners and all captured equipment and materiel.

Health Services Support

0970. Effective, timely medical care is an essential factor in sustaining the company's combat power during continuous operations. The company commander must ensure that the company's leaders and its medical personnel know how to keep soldiers healthy, save their lives if they are wounded or injured, and make them well once injury or illness occurs.

Health and Hygiene

0971. The company commander and all leaders, and field sanitation team, emphasize and enforce high standards of health and hygiene at all times. This "preventive medicine" approach covers all aspects of the soldier’s health and well-being, including:

a. Daily shaving to ensure proper fit of the protective mask.

b. Regular bathing and changing of clothes.

c. Prevention of weather-related problems. These include cold injuries such as frostbite, trench foot, and immersion foot, and heat injuries like heat exhaustion and heat stroke. Soldiers must understand the effects of conditions such as sunburn and wind-chill.

d. Prevention of diseases. Insect-borne diseases such as malaria and Lyme disease,

and diarrhea diseases can be prevented with effective field sanitation measures, including unit waste control, water purification, rodent control, and use of insect repellents.Combat operational stress control, battle fatigue prevention, and strict implementation of the unit sleep plan.

e. Prevent battle fatigue to include strict implementation of the unit sleep plan.

First Response

0972. This refers to the initial, essential stabilizing medical care rendered to wounded, injured, or ill soldiers at the point of initial injury or illness. These are usually performed by first responders who give first aid, or EMT. On the other hand, enhanced first aid is provided by the combat lifesaver (CLS).

Combat Lifesaver

0973. Providing advanced first aid/life-saving procedures but is not intended to take the place of medical personnel beyond the level of self-aid or buddy aid comprises the CLS. He is a trained non-medical soldier and a squad member trained in emergency medical techniques and participates in all casualty treatment and litter-carry drills who also has a laminated quick reference nine-line MEDEVAC card. He must know the location of the CCP and the SOP for establishing it.

0974. The combat lifesaver ensures the squad CLS bag is packed, all IVs are present, and litters are properly packed, and identifies Class VIII shortages to the platoon medic.

Platoon Sergeant

0975. He is typically responsible for ensuring that wounded or injured personnel receive immediate first aid and that the commander is informed of casualties and coordinates with the F/Sgt and company senior trauma specialist for ground evacuation.

First Sergeant

0976. He supervises and coordinates casualty operations, collects witness statements and submits them to the battalion S-1, and submits the battle loss report to the battalion TOC. METT-TC dictates the CCP site location which must be accessible by both ground and air transport.

Commander

0977. The company commander has overall responsibility for medical services. His primary task is to position medical personnel at the proper point on the battlefield to treat casualties or to evacuate those casualties properly. The company commander designates the location for the company's CCP and ensures that the location is recorded on the appropriate overlays. He also develops and implements appropriate SOPs for casualty evacuation. Two key planning considerations follow.

0978. The commander analyzes both fundamental categories of treatment and evacuation to determine if he must accept risk in one or the other and how he may mitigate identified risks. For example, where distances to available MTF are excessive and transportation assets stretched, the commander might request more medics during an operation.

0979. Sites for casualty treatment and evacuation will vary widely on the non-contiguous battlefield and the commander tries to identify, disseminate, and coordinate with all available MTF accessible to his unit including those outside his organization.

Casualty Evacuation and Tactical Combat Casualty Care

0980. Decreasing preventable combat death at the point of wounding is the main goal of TCCC and distinguishes itself from the norm by focusing primarily on the intrinsic tactical variables of penetrating trauma compounded by prolonged evacuation times.

0981. It is built around three definitive phases of casualty care:

a. **Care under Fire.** This is care rendered at both the medic and the casualty that are under hostile fire at the scene of the injury.

b. **Tactical Field Care.** This is rendered once the casualty is no longer under hostile fire.

c. **Tactical Evacuation Care (TACEVAC).** Any additional personnel and medical equipment pre-staged in these assets will be available during this phase. This is rendered while the casualty is evacuated to a higher echelon of care.

0982. The principle mandate of TCCC is the critical execution of the right interventions at the right time and is observed during all phases of care. The Tactical Healthcare Professionals as well as Individual Warfighters/ Operators' involvement in casualty care, at some level, requires training and must be armed with the appropriate medical equipment and procedures corresponding to each level of care.

0983. MEDEVAC is not the same as the so-called "casualty evacuation" (CASEVAC).

0984. Casualty transport, commonly called CASEVAC, is the movement of casualties by non-medical assets without specialized trauma care. For the purposes of this discussion, casualty transport or CASEVAC will mean that which is done when moving casualties from the point of injury (POI) to the platoon CCP or company CCP.

0985. MEDEVAC is the movement of casualties using medical assets while providing en route medical care. Ideally, casualties are transferred from a CCP to a MEDEVAC asset.

0986. The two areas of medical support are treatment and evacuation. Effective CASEVAC has a positive impact on the morale of a unit. Casualties are cared for at the point of injury (or under nearby cover and concealment) and receive self- or buddy aid, advanced first aid from the combat lifesaver, or emergency medical treatment from the

trauma specialist (company or platoon medic).

0987. During the fight, casualties should remain under cover where they received initial treatment (self or buddy aid). As soon as the situation allows, casualties are moved to the platoon CCP. From the platoon area, casualties are normally evacuated to the company CCP and then back to the BAS. The unit SOP addresses this activity, to include the marking of casualties in limited visibility operations. Small, standard, or IR chemical lights work well for this purpose.

0988. Once the casualties are collected, evaluated, and treated, they are prioritized for evacuation back to the company CCP. Once they arrive at the company CCP, the above process is repeated while awaiting their evacuation back to the BAS.

0989. An effective technique, particularly during an attack, is to task-organize a logistics team under the F/Sgt. These soldiers carry additional ammunition forward to the platoons and evacuate casualties to either the company or the battalion CCP. The leader determines the size of the team during his estimate.

0990. When the company is widely dispersed, the casualties might be evacuated directly from the platoon CCP by vehicle or helicopter. Helicopter evacuation might be restricted due to the threat of enemy ground to air small arms, shoulder fired or other air defense weapons. In some cases, the casualties must be moved to the company CCP before evacuation. If the capacity of the battalion's organic ambulances is exceeded, unit leaders may re-role supply or other vehicles to backhaul or otherwise transport non-urgent casualties to the battalion aid station. In other cases, the platoon sergeant may direct platoon litter teams to carry the casualties to the rear.

0991. Leaders minimize the number of soldiers required to evacuate casualties. Casualties with minor wounds can walk or even assist with carrying the more seriously wounded. Soldiers can make field-expedient litters by cutting small trees and putting the poles through the sleeves of buttoned ACU blouses. A travois, or skid, might be used for casualty evacuation. Wounded are strapped on this type of litter, then one person can pull it. It can be made locally from durable, roll-able plastic. Tie-down straps are fastened to it. In rough terrain, or on patrols, litter teams can evacuate casualties to the battalion aid station. Then, they are carried with the unit either until transportation can reach them or until they are left at a position for later pickup.

0992. Unit SOPs and OPORDs address casualty treatment and evacuation in detail. They cover the duties and responsibilities of key personnel, the evacuation of chemically-contaminated casualties (on separate routes from non-contaminated casualties), and the priority for operating key weapons and positions. They specify preferred and alternate methods of evacuation and make provisions for retrieving and safeguarding the weapons, ammunition, and equipment of casualties. Slightly wounded personnel are treated and returned to duty by the lowest echelon possible. Platoon aid men, evaluate sick soldiers, and either treat or evacuate them, as necessary. Casualty evacuation is rehearsed like any other critical part of an operation.

0993. Before casualties are evacuated to the CCP or beyond, leaders should remove all key operational or sensitive items and equipment, including COMSEC devices or SOIs, maps, position location devices. Every unit should establish an SOP for handling

the weapons and ammunition of its WIAs. Protective masks must stay with the individual.

0994. At the CCP, the senior trauma specialist conducts triage of all casualties, takes the necessary steps to stabilize their condition, and initiates the process of evacuating them to the rear for further treatment. He helps the F/Sgt arrange evacuation via ground or air ambulance, or by non-standard means.

0995. When possible, the HHC medical platoon ambulances provide evacuation and en route care from the soldier's point of injury or the company's CCP to the BAS. The ambulance team supporting the company works in coordination with the senior trauma specialist supporting the platoons. In mass casualty situations, non-medical vehicles might be used to assist in casualty evacuation as directed by the Infantry Company commander. Plans for the use of non-medical vehicles to perform casualty evacuation should be included in the unit SOP. Ground ambulances from the BSMC or supporting corps air ambulances evacuate patients from the BAS back to the forward support medical company located in the BSA.

Soldiers Killed-in-Action

0996. The company commander designates a location for the collection of those KIA. Temporary remains holding areas should be established behind a natural barrier, such as a stand of trees, or shielded from the view of others by using either tents or tarpaulins. All personal effects remain with the body, but equipment and issue items become the responsibility of the squad leader until they can be turned over to the F/SGT or supply sergeant. As a rule, human remains should not be transported on the same vehicle as wounded soldiers. The commander sends a letter of condolence to the soldier's next of kin, normally within 48 hours of the death.

Chapter X
Infantry Company in Urban Operations

Introduction

1001. Urbanization impacts on military operations by adding the element of urban extension to the existing terrain complex. It does not change basic tactical doctrine, but requires that infantry commanders understand how these elements may affect the capabilities of their units and weapons. Built-up areas must be treated as terrain factors during the planning for and conduct of all military operations on urbanized terrain. Those providing tactical or strategic advantages to a defender will be integrated into his overall defensive scheme. Regardless of their size or configuration, built-up areas are obstacles to maneuver along the lines of communication or route of advance for at least one portion of an attacking force. Their value as an obstacle should be neutralized by isolation and bypass whenever feasible. Built-up areas should be attacked only when no other alternative is available. The ground maneuver commander requires additional details pertaining to the physical layout of a built-up area and the structural characteristics of its buildings. Infantry Company can conduct Military Operation in Urbanized Terrain as part of the Battalion task force and usually under the control of Infantry Brigade or the infantry company can operate independently.

1002. Urban operations are classified into urban combat, non- combat or political considerations. Under urban combat, there are offensive and defensive operations which are parts of UO that relies heavily on infantry specific task. On the other hand, the non-combat or precision operations are conducted in support to civil governance, psychological operations and civil affairs. These operations are commonly done in order to support the communities surrounding the company's home bases.

1003. The conditions for urban combat operations include surgical, precision, and high intensity conditions. These conditions are explained in the portions below:

a. Surgical conditions are normally less distructive and tightly focused actions that resemble with PNP, SWAT or SAF police raid.

b. Precision conditions are composed of threats that are thoroughly mixed with non-combat or political considerations. Under these conditions, there are tighter restrictions and ROE are used forheavy firepower, airstrike, and maritime strike operations. These are also urban combats that involved CQB for short period where the application of approach force isin a specific portion of an urban area. During these conditions, the Infantry Heavy Company combines armed cooperations.

c. UO under high intensity condition involve threats that are thoroughly mixed with non combat or political considerations. These threats occupy prepared fighting positions in conducting a planned attack such as domestic or national siege. There should be an application of overwhelming military full combat power of the joint combined arms and interoperability with the Philippine Navy and Philippine Air Force.

Offensive Operations

1004. The higher unit commander's (two levels up) primary responsibility is to set the conditions for tactical success for his subordinate units. Whenever possible, close combat by maneuver units is minimized and the battalion commander attempts to move from shaping to transition. While the elements of offensive operations are not phases, tactical tasks may become phased at the Infantry Company level, based on the factors of METT-TC. There is no clear line of distinction that delineates when the company moves from one task to another. Properly planned and executed offensive operations usually involve all the tactical tasks shown. They may be conducted simultaneously or sequentially, depending on the factors of METT-TC. Infantry companies will be used as maneuver elements to execute the tactical tasks.

Planning the Attack

1005. The infantry companyattack a built-up area, regardless on its bulkor the degreeconcerninginstruct involved, keep regardedsolely namely the last resort, thenonlysomost importantabilities accrues in conformity with the attacker thru its seizurethen control. Attacks towards built-up areas maybe launched to: (FM 90-10-US ARMY 1979).

a. **Gain a Critical Objective**. Selected built-up areas willbe attacked in accordance withgain a crucialgoal thenin conformity withdenycapabilities in accordance with the enemy. The objective may be: 1) An imperative bridge. 2) Transportation facilities that are required to sustain future combat operations. 3) Strategic industrial or vital communications facilities.

b. **Rupture the Defense.** The enemy will frequently prepare built-up areas as strong points to gain favorable defensive advantages. The elimination of selected strong points may be required in order to break through his defensive system.

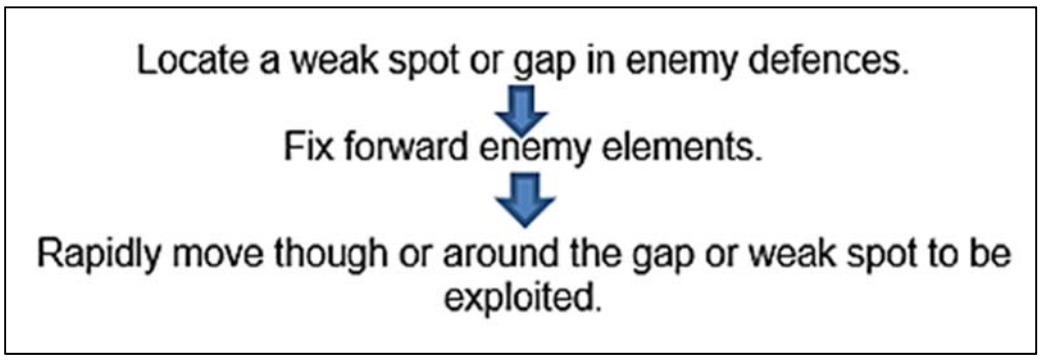
c. **Facilitate Future Operations.**Built-up areas will frequently preclude bypass. Commanders will have to overcome those obstacles that restrict or control their avenues of approach in order to continue the attack.

Types of Offensive Operations

Hasty Attack

1006. Infantry companies conduct hasty attacks as a result of a movement to contact, a meeting engagement, or a chance contact during a movement; after a successful defense or part of a defense; or in a situation where the unit has the opportunity to attack vulnerable enemy forces. Companies may also be required to conduct hasty attacks as a result of deteriorating conditions from stability and support operations, which require them to conduct hasty attacks for force protection. The hasty attack in an urban area differs from a hasty attack in open terrain because the close nature of the terrain makes command, control, and communications difficult. Also, massing fires to suppress the enemy may be difficult. In urban areas, incomplete intelligenceligence and concealment

may require the maneuver unit to move through, rather than around, the friendly unit fixing the enemy in place. Control and coordination must address reducing congestion at the edges of the urban area.Three tasks are essential to its success:



1007. Because a hasty attack is conducted to capitalize on opportunities as they present themselves, commanders should not expect to execute these tasks in the same order on all occasions. For example, advanced elements of the task force may be engaged with forward enemy elements when it becomesapparent that a weak point exists in their defenses. In another instance, a reconnaissance force maydiscover the location of a gap and subsequently be ordered to seize it to prevent enemy reinforcement. In any case, however, speed is essential; for if momentum is lost, the hasty attack will fail.

1008. An urban area is an obstacle to tactical maneuver, and in that respect the hasty attack in UO is conducted somewhat differently than in open terrain. The congestion and incomplete intelligenceligencecharacteristic of urban fighting will frequently require the attack to move through, rather than around, the fixing force. Techniques of control and coordination become extremely important to prevent unnecessary congestion at the edge of the urban area. In addition, commanders must insure that only those troops and resources necessary are committed to the fixing force, with the balance of combat power committed to the main effort of the hasty attack.

Hasty Attack of a Built-Up Area

1009. The Infantry Company may find itself moving to an urban area or conducting a movement to contact with a mission of clearing a village of enemy. The following discussion provides a technique for conducting a hasty attack on a village. The company commander makes a quick assessment of the factors of METT-TC and reacts appropriately to support the higher level commander's intent.

a. **Establish Support**. If attached or OPCON, armor assume support-by-fire positions from which they can fire on the village, prevent the enemy from withdrawing, and destroy any reinforcements (support element functions). If these assets are not available, then the company commander moves Infantry elements into position to accomplish the same tasks. The company 60-mm mortar and AT sections also provide fire support. Armored vehicles can reposition during the assault, if necessary, to gain better fields of fire and provide better support.

b. **Assault the Village.** The rifle platoons assault from a covered route so as to hit the village at a vulnerable point. As the platoons approach the village, smoke is employed to screen their movement and supporting fires are shifted. Once the platoons close on the village, they clear the buildings quickly, consistent with the ROE, and consolidate. The company is then ready to continue operations.

Deliberate Attack

1010. A deliberate attack is a fully synchronized operation that employs all available assets against the enemy's defense, IAW with the ROE. It is necessary when enemy positions are well prepared, when the urban area is large or severely congested, when the element of surprise is lost, or when the ROE requires the precise application of combat power and lethal force. Deliberate attacks are characterized by detailed planning based on available information, thorough reconnaissance, preparation, and rehearsals. Given the nature of urban terrain, the deliberate attack of an urban area is similar to the techniques employed in assaulting a strong point. Attacking the enemy's main strength is avoided and combat power is focused on the weakest point of his defense. At the company level, a deliberate attack of an urban area usually involves the sequential execution of the tactical tasks below:

a. **Reconnoiter the Objective**. This involves making a physical reconnaissance of the objective with company assets and those of higher headquarters, as the tactical situation permits. It also involves a map reconnaissance of the objective and all the terrain that will affect the mission, to include the analysis of aerial imagery, photographs, or any other detailed information about the building(s) or other urban terrain, which the company is responsible for. Additionally, any human intelligenceligence (HUMINT) collected by reconnaissance and surveillance units, such as the battalion reconnaissance platoon, snipers, and so forth, should be considered during the planning process.

b. **Move to the Objective**. This may involve moving the company tactically through open and or urban terrain. Movement should be made as rapidly as possible without sacrificing security. Movement should be made along covered and concealed routes and can involve moving through buildings, down streets, subsurface areas, or a combination of all three. Urban movement must take into account the three-dimensional aspect of the urban area.

c. **Isolate the Objective**. Isolating the objective involves seizing terrain that dominates the area so that the enemy cannot supply, reinforce, or withdraw its defenders. It also includes selecting terrain that provides the ability to place suppressive fire on the objective. (This step may be taken at the same time as securing a foothold.) If isolating the objective is the first step, speed is necessary so that the defender has no time to react. Companies may be required to isolate an objective as part of a battalion operation or may be required to do so independently. Depending on the tactical situation, an Infantry company may isolate an objective by infiltration and stealth.

d. **Secure a Foothold**. Securing a foothold involves seizing an intermediate objective that provides cover from enemy fire and a location for attacking troops to enter the urban area. The size of the foothold is METT-TC dependent and is

usually a company intermediate objective. In some cases a large building may be assigned as a company intermediate objective (foothold). As the company attacks to gain a foothold, it should be supported by suppressive fire and smoke.

e. **Clear an Urban Area.** Before determining to what extent the urban area must be cleared, the factors of METT-TC must be considered. The ROE will influence the TTP platoons and squads select as they move through the urban area and clear individual buildings and rooms. a) The commander may decide to clear only those parts necessary for the success of his mission if; b) An objective must be seized quickly. c) Enemy resistance is light or fragmented.d) The buildings in the area have large open areas between them. In this case, the commander would clear only those buildings along the approach to his objective, or only those buildings necessary for security. e) An Infantry company may have a mission to systematically clear an area of all enemy. Through detailed analysis, the commander may anticipate that he will be opposed by a strong, organized resistance or will be in areas having strongly constructed buildings close together. Therefore, one or two platoons may attack on a narrow front against the enemy's weakest sector. They move slowly through the area, clearing systematically from room to room and building to building. The other platoon supports the clearing units and is prepared to assume their mission.

f. **Consolidate/Reorganize and Prepare for Future Missions.** Consolidation occurs immediately after each action. Consolidation is security and allows the company to prepare for counterattack and to facilitate reorganization. It is extremely important in an urban environment that units consolidate and reorganize rapidly after each engagement. The assault force in a cleared building must be quick to consolidate in order to repel enemy counterattacks and to prevent the enemy from infiltrating back into the cleared building. After securing a floor, selected members of the assault force are assigned to cover potential enemy counterattack routes to the building. Priority must be given to securing the direction of attack first. Those soldiers alert the assault force and place a heavy volume of fire on enemy forces approaching the building. Reorganization occurs after consolidation. Reorganization actions prepare the unit to continue the mission; many actions occur simultaneously.

g. **Consolidation Actions.** Platoons assume hasty defensive positions after the objective has been seized or cleared. Based upon their specified and implied tasks, assaulting platoons should be prepared to assume an overwatch mission and support an assault on another building, or another assault within the building. Commanders must ensure that platoons guard enemy mouse holes between adjacent buildings, covered routes to the building, underground routes into the basement, and approaches over adjoining roofs.

h. **Reorganization Actions**. After consolidation, the following actions are taken: 1) Resupply and redistribute ammunition, equipment, and other necessary items. 2) Mark the building to indicate to friendly forces that the building has been cleared. 3) Move support or reserve elements into the objective if tactically sound. 4) Redistribute personnel and equipment on adjacent structures. 5) Treat and evacuate wounded personnel. 6) Treat and process PWs. 7) Segregate and

safeguard civilians. 8) Re-establish the chain of command. 9) Redistribute personnel on the objective to support the next phase or mission.

i. **Prepare for Future Missions.** The company commander anticipates and prepares for future missions and prepares the company chain of command for transition to defensive and/or stability and support missions.

Task Organization

1011. The company commander will normally task organize his company into two elements: an assault element and a support element. The support element may be given a number of tasks that are conducted on order or simultaneously; specifically, support by fire, isolate the objective, and conduct other support functions. The tactical situation will dictate whether or not separate elements need to be task-organized in order to conduct these support missions. The mission to breach is METT-TC dependent and may be given to the assault or support element; or a separate element may be formed to conduct this task. If available, engineers will usually be task organized into the element that will perform the breach. The size and composition of the elements are determined by METT-TC. If the company is part of a battalion operation, the company could be given the mission to conduct one or more of the tasks mentioned above. If conducting an urban attack independently, the Infantry company will perform both assault and support tasks.

a. **Assault Element.** The purpose of the assault element is to kill, capture, or force the withdrawal of the enemy from an urban objective. The assault element of an Infantry company may consist of one or more platoons usually reinforced with engineers, and possibly armor. Building and room clearing are conducted at the platoon and squad level. The assault element must be prepared to breach to gain entry into buildings.

b. **Support Element.** The purpose of the support element is to provide any support that may be required by the assault element. The support element at company level normally consists of the company's organic assets (platoons, mortars, and antitank weapons), attachments, and units that are under the OPCON of the company commander. This assistance includes, but is not limited to, the following: 1) Suppressing and obscuring enemy within the objective building(s) and adjacent structures. 2) Isolating the objective building(s) with observation and direct or indirect fires to prevent enemy withdrawal, reinforcement, or counterattack. 3) Breaching walls en route to and in the objective structure. 4) Destroying or suppressing enemy positions with direct fire weapons. 5) Securing cleared portions of the objective. 6) Providing squads to assume assault element missions. 7) Providing resupply of ammunition, explosives, and personnel. 8) Evacuating casualties, EPWs, and noncombatants.

c. **Reserves.** A Company fighting in urban terrain may not be able to designate a reserve, based on the number of troops required to conduct offensive operations. A platoon(s) may be detached from the company to form a battalion reserve. The company reserve, if one is designated, should be mobile and prepared for commitment. Because of the available cover in urban areas, the reserve can stay close to forward units. The reserve normally follows within the same block so

that it can immediately influence the attack. The size of the reserve is METT-TC dependent, but at company level, the reserve normally consists of a squad, detached from an organic platoon, or attached elements. In addition to the tasks discussed in Chapter 4, the reserve may be called upon to perform one or more of the following tasks based on the commander's priority of commitment:1) Assuming the mission of the assault element. 2) Clearing bypassed enemy positions. 3) Moving behind the assault element to provide security in cleared buildings, allowing the assault element to continue to move.

d. **Breaching Element.** At the company level, breaching is normally conducted by the assault element. However, a separate breaching element may be created and a platoon may be given this mission and task organized accordingly. The purpose of breaching is to provide the assault element with access to an urban objective. Breaching can be accomplished using explosive, ballistic, thermal, or mechanical methods. Ballistic breaching includes using direct fire weapons; mechanical breaching includes the use of crowbars, axes, saws, sledgehammers, or other mechanical entry devices. Thermal breaching is accomplished through the use of a torch to cut metal items such as door hinges. Attached engineers, or a member(s) of the assault element who has had additional training in mechanical, thermal, ballistic, and explosive breaching techniques, may conduct the breach.

e. **Sample Task Organizations.** Task organization of the company will vary based on the factors of METT-TC and the ROE. 1) Light Infantry Task Organization. An Infantry company conducting this mission might task-organize as follows:Assault Two rifle platoons and one rifle platoon(-) reinforced with engineers (attached to the platoons). Reserve A squad from one of the platoons. Support The company AT weapons, 60-mm mortar section, and M240 machine guns. (Other support provided by the battalion task force.) 2) Light/Heavy Task Organizations. Different METT-TC factors might produce the following light/heavy task organizations:Example 1: Assault Two rifle platoons, each reinforced with engineers. Reserve One rifle platoon. Support Armor platoon and the company AT weapons and 60-mm mortar section. (Other support provided by the battalion task force.) Example 2: Assault Two rifle platoons reinforced with engineers. Reserve One rifle platoon. Support One tank platoon. The company AT weapons and 60-mm mortar section. Example 3: Assault Two rifle platoons, each with engineers. One tank section OPCON to an Infantry platoon. Reserve One rifle platoon. Support A tank section and the company AT weapons under the tank platoon leader's control. The company 60-mm mortar section. (All available direct and indirect fire weapons should be used to isolate objective buildings. Direct fire down streets and indirect fire in open areas between buildings will help in the objective isolation.)

> **NOTE**: *The company commander may use the company executive officer, tank platoon leader, BFV platoon leader, or first sergeant to control the support element, as the task organization and situation dictate. Based on METT-TC factors, an armor platoon can perform any of the missions described above (assault, support, reserve). Unit integrity should be maintained at the platoon level. If the tactical situation requires the employment of sections, it should be for a limited duration and distance.*

Isolate an Urban Objective

1012. Infantry companies isolate an urban objective to prevent reinforcement of, or a counterattack against, the objective and to kill or capture any withdrawing enemy forces. When planning the isolation, commanders must consider three-dimensional and in-depth isolation of the objective (front, flanks, rear, upper stories, rooftops, and subsurface). All available direct and indirect fire weapons, to include attack helicopters and CAS, should be employed, consistent with the ROE. Isolating the objective is a key factor in facilitating the assault and preventing casualties. The company may perform this mission as the support element for a battalion operation, or it may assign the task to its own internal support element for a company attack. In certain situations, Infantry companies may be required to isolate an objective or an area for special operations forces or for stability/support operations. When possible, the objective should be isolated using stealth and or rapid movement in order to surprise the enemy. Depending on the tactical situation, Infantry companies may use infiltration in order to isolate the objective. Likely tasks include, but are not limited to, the ones described below.

> ***NOTE**: Combat experience and recent rotations at the CTCs have shown that many casualties can be sustained when moving between buildings, down streets, and through open areas in order to gain entry into a building either to gain a foothold or to clear it. One of the purposes of isolation at the company level must be to dominate the outside area that leads to the point of entry in order to allow assaulting troops to enter the building without receiving effective fire from the enemy. This is accomplished by the effective use of direct and indirect fires, obscurants, maintaining situational understanding, and exercising tactical patience prior to movement.*

a. **Isolating the Objective *(Battalion Attack)***. An Infantry company may isolate the objective as the support element for a battalion operation. When an Infantry company is given this mission, the objective will normally be a larger structure, a block, or group of buildings. The company commander will task organize his platoons and assign them support by fire positions based on the factors of METT-TC. In addition to isolating the objective, the company (support element) may be given additional tasks that will be conducted on order or simultaneously. Examples of these additional tasks include assuming assault element missions, securing cleared buildings, handling non-combatants and EPWs, and CASEVAC.

b. **Isolating the Objective *(Company Attack)***. When an Infantry company conducts an attack, the task organization and tasks given to the company support element will be determined by the factors of METT-TC. If the company conducts a company attack, the objective can be a building, a block or group of buildings, a traffic circle, or a small village.

c. **Tasks**. The company commander will isolate the objective with direct and indirect fires prior to and during the assault element's execution of its mission. The company will 1) Suppress known, likely, and suspected enemy targets, consistent with the ROE, with direct and indirect fire weapons. Under restrictive ROE, suppression may be limited only to actual enemy locations. 2) Cover mounted avenues of approach with anti-armor Weapons. 3) Cover dismounted avenues of approach with automatic weapons. 4) Control key terrain near or

adjacent to the objective in order to prevent the enemy from reinforcing his positions, withdrawing, or counterattacking. 5) Be prepared to move to other locations in order to suppress enemy fires and neutralize enemy positions as the assault element performs its tasks. Company commanders must give specific instructions to subordinate leaders concerning where to place fires in support of the assault element. For example, "from TRP 1 to TRP 2", "along the third and second floor windows on the east side of Building 21", "shift fires to the west side of the objective from TRP 1 to TRP 4 when you see the green star cluster", etc. Once suppressive fires on the objective begin, they will normally be increased and continued until masked by the advancing assault element. Suppressive fires may or may not be used from the beginning of the assault depending on the ROE. Targets can be marked and identified with tracer rounds; M203 smoke, HE, or ILLUM rounds; voice and hand or arm signals; laser pointers; or similar devices. The precise well-placed volume of fire, as opposed to a volume of fire, will suppress the enemy. The volume of fire and types of weapons employed will be ROE dependent. Once masked, fires are shifted to upper or lower windows and continued until the assault force has entered the building. At that time, fires are shifted to adjacent buildings to prevent enemy withdrawal or reinforcement. If the ROE are restrictive, the use of supporting fires will normally be limited to known enemy locations that have engaged the unit.

> ***Note**: Care must be taken in urban areas when WP, ILLUM, or tracers are used since urban fires can be caused. Care must also be exercised if sabot rounds are used by armored vehicles, based on their penetration capability. Sabot rounds can penetrate many walls and travel great distances to include passing through multiple buildings, creating unintended damage, casualties, and fratricide.*

d. **Direction of Assault Technique of Direct Fire Planning and Control**. In this technique, the company commander assigns building numbers in a consistent pattern in relation to the direction of assault. In the example shown in Figure L-5, the commander numbered the buildings consecutively, in a counter clockwise manner. Further, the sides of the buildings were color coded consistently throughout the objective area (WHITE—direction of assault side; GREEN—right side; BLACK—rear side; RED—left side; BLUE— roof). An odd shaped building is also shown. Note that a “four-sided” concept was retained to minimize confusion. Further designations of WHITE 1, WHITE 2, WHITE 3, and so on from left to right can be added to specify which wall will be engaged. Apertures on the buildings are also labeled consecutively using rows and columns, as shown. In the example, "OBJ 4, WHITE, window A1" is the lower left-hand window on the direction of assault side of OBJ 4. All designations are labeled in relation to the direction of assault.

Assault a Building

1013. The Infantry company will conduct this mission as part of the assault element of a battalion task force or independently. (Independently is defined here as a company having to provide its own support element, as opposed to conducting an operation without flank and rear support, such as a raid or ambush.) If it is conducted as the assault element of a battalion task force, it will probably be conducted against a large building

defended by a strong enemy force, for example, a reinforced platoon. Company commanders will need to clearly understand the specified and implied tasks required to accomplish the mission, as well as the brigade/battalion commanders' intent and the desired mission end-state. This will allow the company commander to task organize and issue specific missions to his subordinate elements concerning which floors and rooms to clear, seize, or bypass. As an example, Figure G.1 depicts an Infantry TF assigned the mission of clearing the objectives in its sector (DOG and TAIL). Company B has been given the TF supporting effort of seizing and clearing OBJ TAIL. The company commander has decided to assign an intermediate objective (WING) to 1st platoon. 3d platoon is the support element with the mission of isolating WING (1st and 2d squads) and providing one squad to act as the company reserve (3d squad). 2d platoon has the mission of passing through 1st platoon, which will mark a passage lane and seize TAIL.

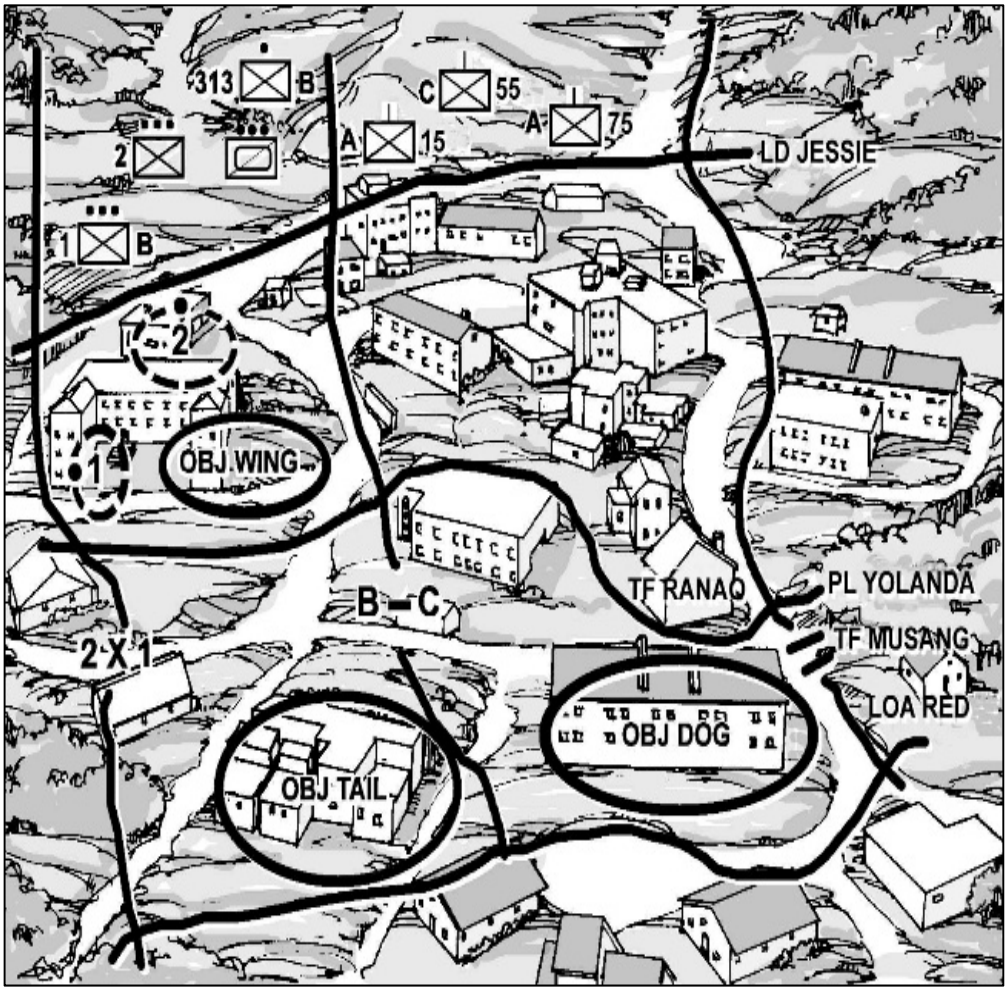


Figure 10.1 - Infantry TF assigned the mission of clearing the objectives in its sector (DOG and TAIL).

a. **Execution.** Platoons should move by bounds by floor when clearing a multistory building. This permits troops to rest after a floor has been cleared. It is likely that platoons will be required to leave security on floors and in cleared rooms and also facilitate the passage of another platoon in order to continue the assault. The assault element must quickly and violently execute its assault and

subsequent clearing operations. Once momentum has been gained, it is maintained to prevent the enemy from organizing a more determined resistance on other floors or in other rooms. If platoons come across rooms/hallways/stairwells that are barricaded with furniture or where obstacles have been placed, they should first attempt to bypass the barricade/obstacle and maintain the momentum of the attack. If they cannot bypass the barricade/obstacle, security should be placed on the barricade/obstacle, it should be checked for booby traps, and should then be reduced. Also, sealing doors and floors may be an option in order to maintain momentum. Subordinate leaders should continue the momentum of the assault, yet not allow the operation to become disorganized.

b. **Ammunition and Equipment**. METT-TC factors and the ROE will determine how the assault element is equipped and armed. The assault element will carry only a fighting load of equipment and as much ammunition as possible, especially grenades (fragmentation, smoke, concussion, and stun consistent with the building construction and the ROE). The support element maintains control of additional ammunition and equipment not immediately needed by the assault element. An often-overlooked munition in an urban battle is the light antitank weapon. Soldiers can use these for a variety of purposes such as suppressing a manned position or supporting the breaching or assault elements. Resupply should be pushed to the assault element by the support element. Commanders must carefully manage the soldier's load during the assault. Normally, ammunition, water, special assault weapons/equipment, and medical supplies/litters are the only items carried in the assault. Attached or OPCON armor platoons should also configure their ammunition load to support their mission, consistent with the ROE.

c. **Assault Locations.** The assault may begin from the top or bottom of the building. 1) Top Entry. Entry at the top and fighting downward is the preferred method of clearing a building. This method is only feasible, however, when access to an upper floor or rooftop can be gained by ladder; from the windows or roofs of adjoining, secured buildings; or, when enemy air defense weapons can be suppressed and troops can be transported to the rooftops by helicopter. Rooftops should be treated as danger areas when surrounding buildings are higher and the element will be exposed to fire from those buildings. Helicopters should land only on those buildings that can support the weight of the helicopter such as rooftop heliports or parking garages. However, soldiers can dismount as the helicopter hovers a few feet above the roof. Troops can then breach the roof or common walls. They may use ropes, ladders, or other means to enter the lower floors through the holes created. Ladders can be used to conduct an exterior assault of an upper level if soldiers' exposure to enemy fire can be minimized. 2) Bottom Entry. Entry at the bottom is common and may be the only option available. When entering from the bottom, breaching a wall is the preferred method because doors and windows may be booby-trapped and covered by fire from inside the structure. If the assault element must enter through a door or window, entry from a rear or flank position is preferred. Under certain situations. the ROE may not permit the use of certain explosives, therefore entry through doors and windows may be the only option available. Armored vehicles can be especially useful in supporting bottom entry.

d. **Breaching**. Squads and platoons will have to conduct breaching. Engineers may be attached to the unit responsible for breaching. Depending on the factors of METT-TC, company commanders may need to designate specific breaching locations or delegate the task to platoon leaders. The ROE will also influence whether mechanical, thermal, ballistic, or explosive breaching will be used. For example, if armor assets are attached to the company and the ROE permit their use, they can breach the wall by main gun fire for the initial entry point.

e. **Assault Tasks**. Once inside the building, the priority tasks are to cover the staircases and to seize rooms that overlook approaches to the building. These actions are required to isolate enemy forces within the building and to prevent reinforcement from the outside. The assault element clears each room on the entry floor and then proceeds to clear the other floors to include the basement. If entry is not made from the top, consideration may be given to rushing/clearing and securing a stairwell and clearing from the top down, if the tactical situation permits. If stairwell use is required, minimize their use and clear them last. If there is a basement, it should be cleared as soon as possible, preferably at the same time as the ground floor. The procedures for clearing a basement are the same as for any room or floor, but important differences do exist. Basements may contain entrances to tunnels such as sewers and communications cable tunnels. These should be cleared and secured to prevent the enemy from infiltrating back into cleared areas.

f. **Suppressive Fires during the Assault**. The support element provides suppressive fire while the assault element is systematically clearing the building. It also provides suppressive fire on adjacent buildings to prevent enemy reinforcements or withdrawal. Suppressive fire may consist of firing at known and suspected enemy locations; or, depending on the ROE, may only include firing at identified targets or returning fire when fired upon. The support element destroys or captures any enemy trying to exit the building. The support element must also deal with civilians displaced by the assault. Armored vehicles can be especially useful in providing heavy, sustained, accurate fire.

g. **Clearing Rooms**. The Company commander must ensure that clearing platoons carry enough room marking equipment and plainly mark cleared rooms from the friendly side IAW unit SOP. Also, if the operation occurs during limited visibility, marking must be visible to friendly units. The support element must understand which markings will be employed and ensure that suppressive fires do not engage cleared rooms and floors. Maintaining situational understanding concerning the location of the assault teams and which rooms/floors have been cleared is imperative and a key command and control function for the company commander. Radios can be consolidated, if necessary, with priority going to the squads and platoons clearing rooms. When exiting cleared buildings friendly troops should notify supporting elements using the radio or other preplanned signals.

Attack a Block or Group of Buildings

1014. An Infantry company will normally attack a block or group of buildings as part of a battalion task force. To attack a block or a group of buildings, an Infantry company

may need to be reinforced with armor and engineers, consistent with the ROE and the enemy situation.

a. **Execution.** The execution of this mission is characterized by platoon attacks supported by both direct and indirect fires. Success depends on isolating the enemy positions which often become platoon objectives, suppressing enemy weapons, seizing a foothold in the block, and clearing the block's buildings room by room.

b. **Direct Fire Weapons**. Armor, machine guns, and other direct fire support weapons fire on the objective from covered positions, consistent with the ROE. These weapons should not be fired for prolonged periods from one position. The gunners should use a series of positions and displace from one to another to gain better fields of fire and to avoid being targeted by the enemy. Direct fire support tasks can be assigned as follows: 1) Machine guns fire along streets and into windows, doors, mouse holes, and other probable enemy positions. ROE may restrict firing only to known enemy locations. 2) Armor tanks, and antitank weapons fire at enemy tanks and other armored vehicles. They can also provide a countersniper capability due to their range and target acquisition capability. 3) Tanks fire at targets protected by walls and provide protection against enemy tanks, as required. 4) Armor may be used to create breaches with the 25-mm gun. 5) Riflemen engage targets of opportunity.

c. **Obscuration and Assault.** Before an assault, the company commander should employ smoke to conceal the assaulting platoons. He secures their flanks with direct fire weapons and by employment of the reserve, if necessary. Concealed by smoke and supported by direct fire weapons, an assaulting platoon attacks the first isolated building. The assault element utilizes the cover of suppressive fires to gain a foothold. The company commander must closely coordinate the assault with its supporting fire so that the fire is shifted at the last possible moment. The squads and platoons then clear each designated building. After seizing the block, the company consolidates and reorganizes to repel a counterattack or to continue the attack. Periods of limited visibility may provide the best conditions to attack, especially if NVGs provide the company a technological advantage over the threat.

> ***NOTE:*** *Obscuration rounds may cause uncontrolled fires in the city and must be carefully planned.*

Attacking and Clearing Buildings

1015. The infantry company will attack and clear buildingsonwhat the warfare is carried outbetweenmore than a fewsorts on built-up areas. These illustrativeactions are primarily basedregardingutility on tactical fundamentals. Upon accomplishment enemyconsultation that maintainssocounselandpresentsadditional security, provision required, whereas aggressively looking for the enemy's weakness, somethingsuchcan also be. He swiftly initiates severalmoves simultaneously. He directs suppressive fires torepel the enemy's capabilityafterarousethensupply mutual support; that concentrates armyafteroverwhelm the opponent at a choice spot; thenhe commits to them withinfurnace andriceaccording toattack the enemy. The following combat vignettes

are provided:

a. Commitment of an infantry company to seize a strongpoint.

b. Reduction of an enemy strongpoint in Type A area.

c. Infantry company attack in Type D area.

d. Infantry platoon attack in Type C area.

Commitment of an Infantry Company to Seize a Strongpoint

1016. The 1st Platoon leader reported to his company commander that his platoon has been stopped by heavy fires from apartment building 1 (illustration as shows). The platoon leader has requested indirect fires and engaged the enemy position with fires from an attached tank. However, he is unable to bypass. The company commander directed the platoon leader to provide a base of fire for the employment of the 3d Platoon on the flank. The 3d Platoon moved to the vicinity of buildings 2, 3, and 4 and prepared to assault the enemy strongpoint. After achieving fire superiority from supporting weapons, the 3d Platoon attacked and cleared the enemy strongpoint.

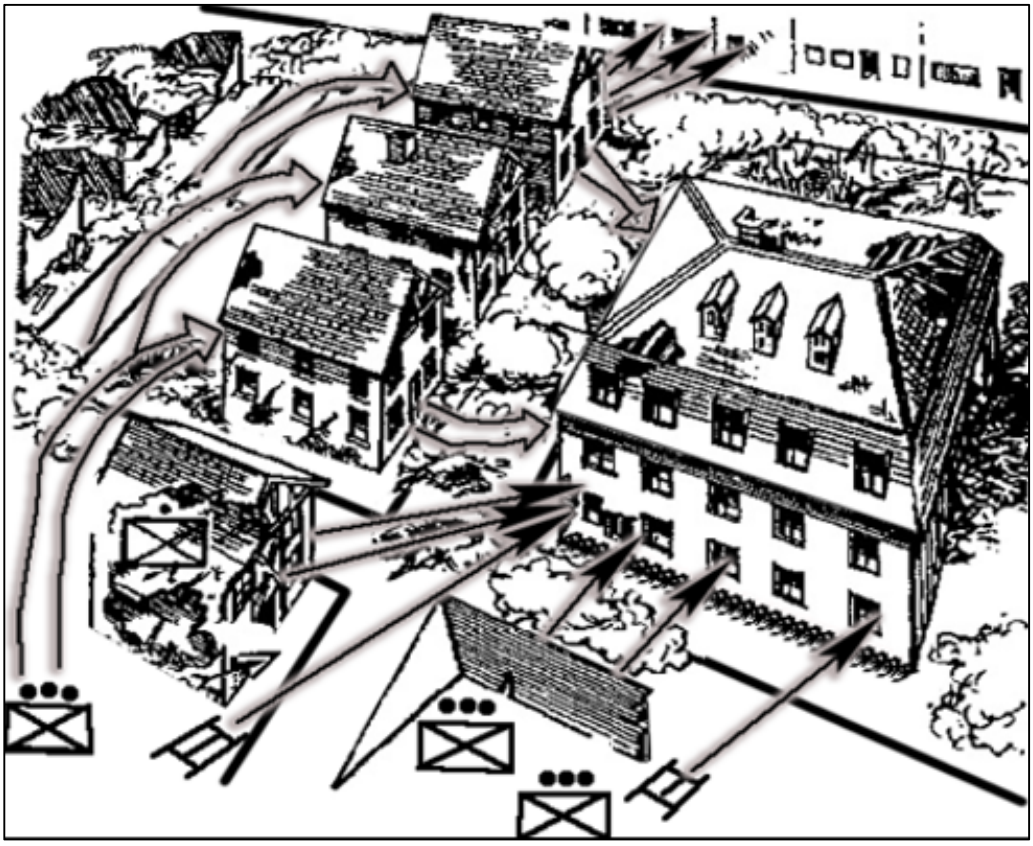


Figure 10.2 - Seizing a Strongpoint

a. 1st Platoon provided over watching fires.

b. Strongpoint was isolated by indirect/direct fires.

c. All weapons were employed to suppress defensive fires.

d. Smoke was used to conceal movement across streets.

e. Defeated enemy position was immediately prepared to repel possible counterattack.

Reduction of Enemy Strongpoint in Area A

1017. In this situation, the 3d Platoon has been stopped by an enemy-prepared position in building 2 (illustration opposite). It appears that the enemy strongpoint has mutual support from adjacent buildings along the entire block. This area is a high fire hazard area. The company commander employed machinegun tracers and white phosphorous mortar fires onto rooftops. Light multiple purpose assault weapons (LMAW) were employed from buildings 3, 4, and 5. Other indirect fires and automatic weapons confined to suppress the strongpoint. The company commander assigned his reserve the mission of containing the enemy position while the company (-) bypassed and continued the attack. Combat actions are summarized as follows: 3d Platoon maintained pressure until reserve arrived. Enemy strongpoint was reduced by fires. Tracers, WP, and flame weapons were employed. Reserved contained--while 3d Platoon bypassed and continued the attack. Excessive casualties were avoided by not assaulting this well-prepared position.

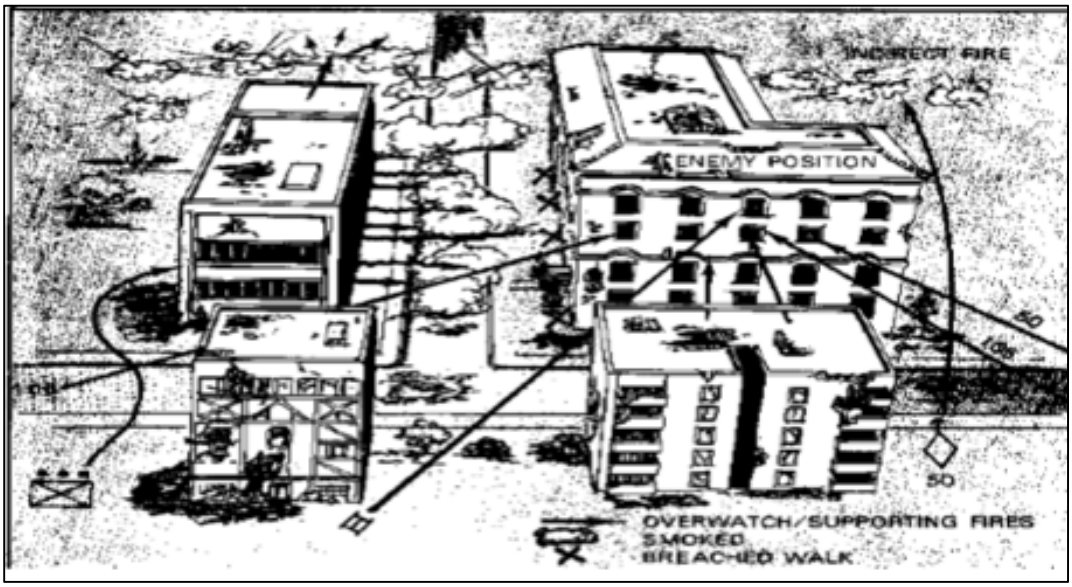


Figure 10.3 - Type A Area

1018. Company A, reinforced with a tank platoon, is attacking an enemy strongpoint organized within the apartment building. The objective has been isolated by indirect fires to the rear and by small arms fire on both flanks. Movement in this area is covered by over watching fires and/or concealed by smoke. Combat engineers, accompanied by

the 3d Platoon, were able to place a breaching explosive as indicated in the figure. After breaching the walls in four places, the 3d Platoon cleared the strongpoint. The actions in this situation are summarized as follows:

a. Strongpoint was isolated by mortar and artillery fires.

b. All movement was concealed by smoke.

c. Over watching weapons suppressed enemy gunners.

d. Assaulting forces used cover as much as possible while moving.



Figure 10.4 - Type B Area

Infantry Platoon Attack in Type C Area

1019. The 3d Platoon has encountered two family dwellings lightly defended as indicated below. The platoon leader employed the 1st and 2d squads to support and over watch the 3d squad's assault on building #1. The platoon leader supported the assault with automatic weapons fire, medium multiple purpose assault weapons (M-MAW), and Light Multi-purpose Assault Weapons (LMAWs). Organic platoon mortars were used to isolate the area from reinforcement or withdrawal, to collapse roofs, start fires, and to provide smoke to conceal fire and maneuver within the platoon.

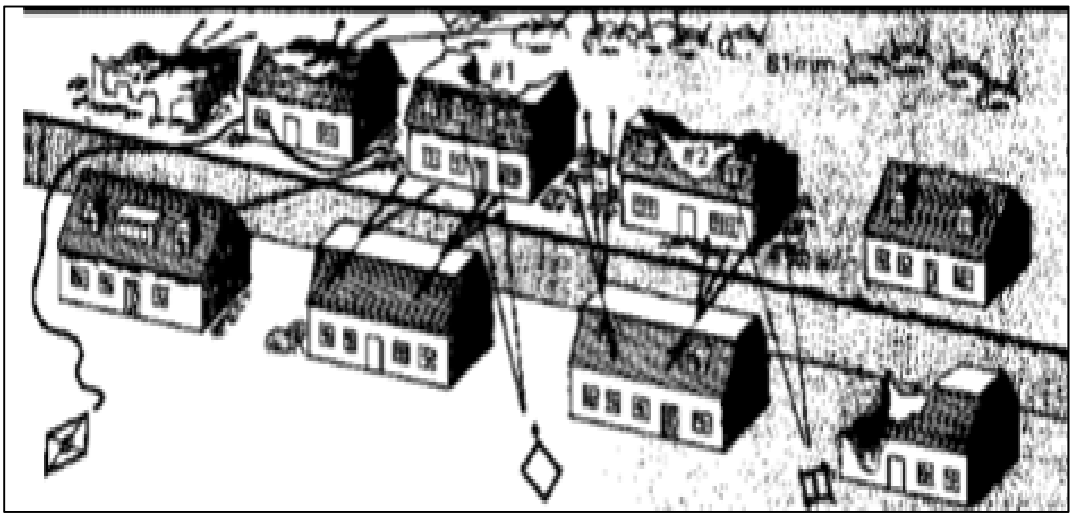


Figure 10.5 - Type C Area

Attack and Clear Defended Buildings

1020. The Infantry Company usually attacks and clear the buildings (as part of the Battalion taskforce or can operate independently), regardless of a structure's physical characteristics or type urban area. There are four interrelated requirements for attacking and clearing a defended building. They are:

a. Fire support.

b. Assault.

c. Movement.

d. Reorganization.

1021. Proper utility then integration concerningthesenecessities limit casualties yet spur resolutionabout the mission. The dimensionofsoftwareaboutpartialnecessities is determinedwith the aid of the typebuildingin accordance withstand attacked andvia the makeuponadjacenturban terrain. For example, numerousopenspacesamong Type D or E areas require elevatedfireplacesupportto suppress/obscure enemy gunners while infantry unitspaceacrosscommence terrain. Conversely, among Type A yet B areas numerousblanketed routes wishdecreasehearthaid requirements.

Fire Support

1022. Fire support and other assistance to enhance the advance of the assault force are provided by an Over watch force. This assistance includes:

a. Suppressing/obscuring enemy gunners within objective building(s) and adjacent structures.

b. Isolating the objective building(s) with indirect/direct fires to prevent enemy withdrawal, reinforcement, or counterattack.

c. Breaching walls en route to and in the objective structure.

d. Destroying enemy positions with direct-fire weapons.

e. Securing cleared portions of the objective.

f. Providing replacements for the assault force.

g. Providing re-supply of ammunition and explosives. 1) Evacuation of casualties and prisoners. 2) The size of the over watch force is determined by:

h. Type and size of objective building(s).

i. Adjacent terrain--open or covered approaches.

j. Organization and strength of enemy defenses--what firepower is required to suppress/obscure enemy gunners.

1023. Depending on the situation, the over watch force may consist of only one infantry fire company, with M-60 machineguns, grenade launchers, and M202 multi shot flame weapons, to support another fire company's assault. In situations involving a larger assault force, a platoon or company, reinforced with tanks, engineers, and self-propelled artillery, may be required to support movement and assault by an adjacent platoon or company. Upon seizure of objective buildings, the assault force reorganizes and may be required to provide over watching fires for the displacement or assault by the over watching force.

1024. Technique of Fire Each weapon is assigned a target or area to cover. Individual small arms place fires on likely enemy weapon positions--loopholes, windows, roof areas. Snipers are best employed in placing accurate fire through loopholes or engaging long-range targets. M203s and M202s direct their fires through windows or loopholes. LAWs are employed to penetrate walls constructed of light material, barricades, and window barriers on the ground level of structures. Tank primaryweapons set first-floor goalsorinfringementpartitions because attacking infantry. Tank machineguns embark suspected positions on upper floors then into adjoining structures. In addition in accordance with consuming yet weakening structures, mere most important gun projectiles effect casualties by loose particles during the inside regarding structures. Artillery and mortars utilize stardy labor fuzes over rooftops after reason casualties among defenders within the structure through high-explosive, shrapnel, and loosening debris effects.

Movement

1025. The assault force (squad-platoon-company) minimizes enemy defensive fires during movement by:

a. Using covered routes:

b. Through underground structures.

c. Through or behind secured buildings.

d. Through streets (rubble, vehicles, etc.).

e. Moving only after defensive fires have been suppressed or obscured.

f. Moving at night or during other periods of reduced visibility.

g. Selecting routes that will not mask friendly suppressive fires.

h. Crossing open areas (streets, space between buildings) rapidly under the concealment of smoke and suppressive fires provided by over watching forces.

i. Moving on rooftops that are not covered by enemy direct fires.

1026. In lightly defended areas, the requirement for speed may dictate moving through the streets and alleys without first clearing all buildings. Under these circumstances, the maneuver element should employ tanks, if available, to lead the column, closely followed and supported by infantry. If the infantry is mechanized, it should remain mounted until forced to dismount. It should remount to cross open areas. When dismounted, rifle elements move along each side of the street with leading squads keeping approximately abreast of the lead tanks. When not accompanied by tanks, rifle elements move in single file along one side of the street under cover of fires from supporting weapons. They are well dispersedand move quickly. Each man in the leading element is detailed to observe and cover a certain area, such as second-floor windows on the opposite side of the street. Individual movement techniques are contained in TC 7-1, Rifle Squads.

Assault

1027. The row force, regardless about size, tries in imitation of close on the flank(s) and after of a goal building. If the constructing is located of a road along numerous adjacent buildings under foe rule or atiara is not feasible, a frontal assault is required. Alternatively, the attack forced firstly manifest close by constructions or afterward attack the remaining objective concurrently beside the bendyet flanks. In the following example, the assault force has been organized into two teams; each team is assigned an entry point on the ground floor. Preferably, entry is gained through walls breached by explosives or gun fire. Assault teams avoid windows and doors as entry points because they are usually covered by fire or booby trapped.

1028. Immediately prior to the assault, suppressive fires are increased on the objective and continue until masked by advancing forces. Once masked, such fires are shifted, to upper windows and continue until assault forces have entered the building. At this time, supporting fires are shifted to adjacent buildings to prevent enemy withdrawal or reinforcement. Assault company close on the building rapidly; however, prior to entry through a breached wall, window, or smashed door, a hand grenade is thrown inside. Immediately after the explosion, assault teams enter and spray the interior with automatic fire.

1029. Once inner the building, the forward assignment is in imitation of cowl together with automated weapons the staircase(s) leadin imitation of upperflooring and the basement; and, secondly, according totrap rooms to that amount forgetprocessesto the building. These movements are required after isolate opponentmilitia within the constructing andaccording toprevent reinforcement beside the outside. Previously certaingroups obviousevery groundflooringpanel yet afterwards the basement.

1030. Room Clearance A searching team (two-man minimum) is assigned to clear one or more rooms. When entering a room avoid using door handles. Knock the door open with automatic-fire and throw a hand grenade into the room. After detonation, one man quickly enters, sprays the room with automatic fire, and takes up a position where he can observe the entire room. At this time, a second man enters and conducts a systematic search.

1031. Avoid clearing each room in a repetitive manner. For example, as shown, rooms 1 and 5 were cleared as previously described. Rooms 2 and 3 were cleared by blasting a hole through the wall, throwing in a grenade, entering the room, and conducting a search, as previously described.



Figure G-8a Shoot Door Open



Figure G-8b Toss Grenade



Figure G-8c Enter Firing and Search Room

1032. In room 7, an enemy "mouse hole" between rooms 6 and 7 was discovered behind a sofa. A grenade was thrown in the mouse hole; room 6 was then entered through the door and searched. Room 4 was entered by firing through the door, throwing grenade, and then searching. As rooms are cleared, doors are left open, and a predetermined mark (chalk, tape, aerosol spray) is placed on the door jamb or over the door.

Basement

1033. If there is a basement, it should be cleared as soon as possible, preferably concurrent with clearance of the ground floor.

1034. Securing Upper Floors Frequently, stairways will be blocked with barbed wire and booby trapped. Stairs are usually covered by enemy fires, and entry into the stairwell can easily be denied by defenders throwing grenades into the stairwell. Avoid stairways whenever possible. Select room(s) that have ceilings intact and place an explosive charge against the ceiling. The resultant explosion should kill or stun defenders and provide uncontested access to the next floor. After securing an initial foothold, the remainder of the floor is cleared.

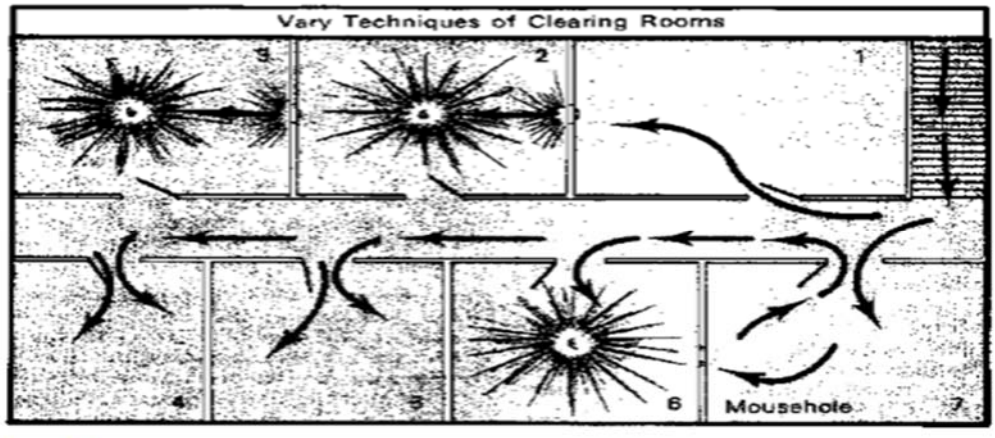


Figure G-9a Vary Techniques of Clearing Room

Defensive Operations

1035. The Infantry company will normally conduct defensive operations as part of a battalion task force. Defensive operations may be performed as part of a purely defensive mission to retain terrain or destroy attacking enemy forces, or they may be performed as part of stability and support operations. The elements are similar to those in offensive operations in that the brigade commander (two levels up) tries to avoid isolation, through security operations; defensive missions are assigned to companies in order to achieve the brigade commander's intent and desired end-state; and finally, the brigade transitions to stability and or support actions. During urban defensive operations, the transition to stability and support operations may not be clear to the soldiers. Commanders must offset this tendency with clear mission type orders and updated ROE. Again, as in offensive operations, the elements are not phases. They may occur simultaneously or sequentially. Well planned and executed defensive operations will have all four elements present. During defensive operations the brigade commanders seek to the following:

a. Avoid being isolated by the enemy.

b. Defend only the decisive terrain, institutions, or infrastructure.

c. Use offensive fire and maneuver to retain the initiative.

General Considerations

1036. Of the two patterns of defense, area and mobile, the area defense will probably be the pattern most used since most of the reasons for defending an urban area are focused on retaining terrain. The mobile defense pattern is more focused on the enemy and the commander may decide to use it based on his estimate of the situation. In an urban area, the defender must take advantage of the abundant cover and concealment. He must also consider restrictions to the attacker's ability to maneuver and observe. By using the terrain and fighting from well-prepared and mutually supporting positions, a defending force can inflict heavy losses on, destroy, delay, block, or fix a much larger attacking force.

Planning the Defense

1037. This section describes operations on urbanized terrain and provides detailed considerations to be applied by commanders during planning.

Defensive Operations

1038. The Infantry Company Commanders at every degree have to decide how many good in conformity with combine artifical capabilities among their usual scheme. In incomplete cases, commanders may additionally keep directed according to shield a built-up area, a row regarding communications, and a manufacturing complicated whose retention presents great knowledge inside the skeleton concerning the protecting layout on a higher stage commander. The selection in conformity with defend certain an area may additionally remain committed because of specific tactical benefits

accruing in conformity with the defender assigned accountability because of an area. In all cases, the elements of urban sprawl must be analyzed in conjunction with natural terrain in order to determine how to enhance weapons effectiveness to slow, block, canalize, and destroy the enemy.

1039. Built-up areas, like forests, hills, or other terrain features, may be incorporated in the plan for the defense of an urban area in order to:

a. **Control avenues of approach.** Avenues concerningapproachwithinurban areas are often interrupted by means of built-up areas castacross the terrain. These built-up areas may alsoprovide a portionregarding the protecting grid because the combinedarms team. In partial cases, the areaabout a built-up area on the town terrain complex may additionally correctly throw out pass in accordance with primary elements on an attacking force. At lowertiers on command, it may additionally prefer the uses regarding villages and short towns namely strong-points. At the sordid extreme, fundamental urban complexes may also remain then extensive to that amount that cannot be completely avoided.

b. **Act as a combat multiplier**. Built-up areas are limitations in conformity with a mechanized force. Passage thru certain areas perform stand blocked, canalizing antagonist militia among open plat interlaced including anti-armor fires yet reinforced including mines thensordid obstacles. When urbanization notably restricts installed behavior and now enough mechanized army are unavailable, the integration about the factors regardingtown dragof the protection may also grant a fight multiplicator because of the defender.

c. **Conceal forces.** Technological advances hold significantly extended tactical imagery yet sensor devices. However, then employed against built-up areas, theirs effectiveness is significantly reduced. In addition, civic capabilities of toffer cover then rivalryin accordance with the advocate together with a minimal consumption concerning preparation time. Such purposes may additionally remain suitable for uses as warfare positions inside the overal lprotective scheme.

d. **Retain key transportation centers.** The requirement to shift and concentrate major combat forces and supplies rapidly over an extended battle area may demand the retention of the hubs of main road and railroad networks.

e. **Deny strategic/political objectives.** Industrial or economic complexes may be incorporated in the defense for their strategic value, while political/cultural centers may provide psychological/national morale advantages.

1040. Built-up areas will normally not be utilized as part of the urban defensive plan when:

a. Sufficient combat strength is not available for defense.

b. The built-up area does not support the overall defensive concept.

c. Terrain adjacent to the built-up area permits the enemy to bypass it.

d. Structures within the built-up area do not afford adequate protection for the defender.

e. The complex is dominated by adjacent terrain that offers an attacker significant observed fire advantages over the defender.

f. The built-up area is declared an "open city" for humanitarian and political reasons or to protect valuable structures.

Organization of the Company on the Defense

1041. The factors of METT-TC and the ROE will determine how the infantry company plans, prepares, and executes the defense. The defense is organized into three areas: the security force area, main battle area, and rear area. A company defending in urban areas may have missions in any one of these defensive areas, depending on the nature of the operation. Infantry companies are well suited to conduct defensive operations in close urban terrain where engagement ranges will be short, where there is abundant cover and concealment, and where the enemy's assault must be repelled.

1042. This defensive organization will likely be used against a conventional enemy force that may threaten Philippine Army forces with mechanized and dismounted Infantry supported by other combined arms. This defensive organization may also occur in a brigade area of operation (AO) where there are multiple threats. For example, one part of the AO may require linear features; other parts may require the use of other defensive techniques, such as a perimeter defense, against different types of threats in the same brigade AO.

a. **Security Operations**. The defensive battle normally begins with a combined arms force conducting security actions well forward of the main body. Company missions consist of security, reconnaissance, and counterreconnaissance tasks. Infantry companies assigned counter-reconnaissance missions to support these security operations employ ambushes, mines, obstacles, deception, security patrols, OPs, indirect fires, camouflage, demonstrations, and other measures to destroy or deceive the enemy's reconnaissance elements Again, urban areas are well suited for Infantry counter-reconnaissance operations because of the abundance of cover and concealment which permits Infantry to move by stealth.

b. **Main Battle Area (MBA).** The decisive battle is normally fought in the MBA. Depending on the threat, company commanders can deploy their platoons on the forward edges of the urban area or in battle positions in depth. In either case, the defense is made stronger by including forces that are defending on close terrain or on the flanks into the defensive scheme. 1) Size of Battle Positions. The size and location of battle positions within the AO depends mainly on the type of enemy encountered and the ability to move between positions to block threatened areas. It may be desirable to place small antiarmor elements, secured by Infantry, on the forward edges while the main defense is deployed in depth. 2) Considerations. Companies assigned battle positions on the forward edge of an urban area should a) Provide early warning of the enemy's advance. b) Engage the enemy at long range. c) Deceive the enemy as to the true location of the defense. 1) Sectors. Depending on the factors of METT-TC, commanders

may also assign platoons sectors to defend instead of battle positions. In certain instances, the company commander may employ both. Sectors would normally be assigned when blocks and streets provide a grid type pattern and boundaries can be clearly delineated.2) Actions on Contact. When enemy forces enter and maneuver to seize initial objectives, the defender should employ all available fires to destroy and suppress the direct-fire weapons that support the ground attack. Tanks and enemy APCs should be engaged as soon as they come within the effective range of antiarmor weapons. As the enemy attack develops, the actions of small-unit leaders assume increased importance. Squad and platoon leaders are often responsible for fighting independent battles. Thus, it is important that all leaders understand their commander's concept of the defense. Situational understanding must be maintained and where the enemy's efforts are likely to result in a gaining a foothold, violent counterattacks must be employed to deny him access into the MBA.

c. **Rear Area**. Infantry companies may be deployed in the rear area to protect CSS elements and to defend high payoff assets, lines of communications, C2 nodes, and other key locations.

d. **Counterattacks**. Infantry supported by armor tanks, if available, should be prepared to counterattack to regain key positions, to block enemy penetrations, to provide flank protection, and to assist by fire the disengagement and withdrawal of endangered positions. It is especially important for enemy footholds to be repelled violently. When the reserves are committed to counterattack to reinforce a unit, they may be attached to the unit in whose sector the counterattack is taking place. Otherwise, the counterattack becomes the main effort. This makes coordination easier, especially if the counterattack goes through the unit's positions.

e. **Defense during Limited Visibility**. Company commanders can expect the attacker to use limited visibility conditions to conduct necessary operations to sustain or gain daylight momentum. 1) Commanders should employ the following measures to defend against attacks during limited visibility: a) Defensive positions and crew-served weapons should be shifted from an alternate position or a hasty security position just before dark to deceive the enemy as to the exact location of the primary position.b) Unoccupied areas between units, which can be covered by observed fire during daylight, may have to be occupied, blocked, or patrolled during limited visibility. Early warning devices and obstacles need to be installed.c) Radar, remote sensors, and night observation devices should be emplaced to cover streets and open areas. Thermal imagery devices, such as the one found on the TOW weapon system, are excellent for observation during limited visibility. d) Noise-making devices, tangle foot tactical wire, and LP/OPs should be positioned on all avenues of approach for early warning and to detect infiltration. e) Artificial illumination should be planned, to include the use of street lamps, stadium lights, pyrotechnics, visible and IR ILLUM, and so forth. f) Indirect fire weapons, grenade launchers, and hand grenades should be used when defenses are probed to avoid disclosure of defensive positions. g) Armor tank platoons must know the locations of friendly positions. The use of thermal recognition signals and markers can help decrease the possibility of fratricide. h) Commanders should

initiate FPFs through the use of a planned signal. Crew-served weapons, armored vehicle-mounted weapons if available, and individual riflemen fire within their assigned sectors. Grenades and command-detonated mines should be used to supplement other fires as the enemy approaches the positions. i) Defenders should move to daylight positions before BMNT. Buildings should be marked from the friendly side IAW unit SOP in order to facilitate movement. Armored vehicles can be used to cover the movement of friendly troops.

f. **Communications Restrictions**. Radio communications will initially be the primary means of communication for controlling the defense of an urban area and for enforcing security. Structures and a high concentration of electrical power lines may degrade radio communication in urban areas. Wire should be emplaced and used as the primary means of communications as time permits. However, wire can be compromised if interdicted by the enemy. Messengers can be used as another means of communication. Visual signals may also be used but are often not effective because of the screening effects of buildings and walls. Signals must be planned, widely disseminated, and understood by all assigned and attached units. Increased battle noise makes the effective use of sound signals difficult.

Hasty Defense

1043. A very likely defensive mission for the Infantry Company in urban terrain will be to conduct a hasty defense. This mission is characterized by reduced time for the preparation of the defense. All of the troop leading procedures are the same. The priorities of work will basically be the same, but many will take place concurrently. Units will be deployed, weapons emplaced, and positions prepared in accordance with the mission analysis and amount of time the company commander has available.

1044. Companies must be prepared to conduct a hasty defensive mission as part of stability and support operations.

1045. Occupation and Preparation of Positions. Preparations for the hasty defense will vary with the time available. The preparations described below will generally take between two to four hours. In a hasty defense, the primary effort is to camouflage and conceal the presence of the hasty fighting positions and provide as much protection as possible for the soldiers manning them. Positions are constructed back from the windows in the shadows of the room using appliances, furniture, and other convenient items and materials. The emphasis on fortifying positions and making major alterations to the environment is reduced. These actions will occur after security has been established.

a. Position Crew-Served and Special Weapons. Generally, they will be employed from the inside of buildings, unless an outside position is preferable and can be protected and camouflaged. Armored vehicles can exploit longer fields of fire or a reverse slope engagement using buildings to protect the vehicle's position.

b. Emplace Barriers and Obstacles. Lack of time means there will be two belts established and they will not be as extensive as in a defense that permits more time. Cover all obstacles with observation and fire. 1) First Belt. The first belt

will usually be between 50100 meters from and parallel to the defensive trace. It will normally consist of wire obstacles, improvised barriers, road craters, and minefields. For example, burning tires and trash have proven to be effective obstacles on urban terrain. Antitank and command detonated mines will be used consistent with the ROE. This belt will block, fix, turn, or canalize the enemy; disrupt attack formations; and inflict casualties. 2) Second Belt. The second belt is the denial belt. It consists of wire obstacles placed around, through, and in the defensive buildings and close-in mine fields as well as in subsurface accesses. It impedes and complicates the enemy's ability to gain a foothold in the defensive area. Command detonated IEDs should be used extensively consistent with the ROE. Claymores should be placed where they will not cause friendly casualties. 3) Field-Expedient Obstacles. Field-expedient obstacles made from available materials, such as rubble, cars and light poles, should be employed.

c. Prepare Positions. Squads and platoons will prepare positions using whatever materials are available; for example, filling dressers or other furnishings with earth or other materials. 1) Rehearsals. Conduct rehearsals with leaders and soldiers concerning the orientation of the defense, unit positions, location of crew served weapons, CASEVAC, resupply, execution of counterattack plans, withdrawal plan, and so on. One of the more important rehearsals to conduct is the synchronization of direct and indirect fires to accomplish the commander's intent. 2) Movement Enhancement. There will not be much time to improve movement within the defense. Units should plan to use subsurface and supersurface (through buildings) routes. Priority should be given to removing obstructions to alternate positions and to the counterattack route. 3) Communications. Check communications. Communications will initially be radio. Plans should be made for messengers, and routes improved for them. Wire is emplaced as an improvement to the defense as time and the terrain allow.

1046. Improving the Defense. As time permits, the following areas can be given consideration and prioritized in accordance with METT-TC.

a. Sleep plan

b. Barrier and obstacle improvement

c. Improvement of primary and alternate positions

d. Preparation of supplementary positions

e. Additional movement enhancement efforts

f. Initiation of patrols

g. Improvement of camouflage

h. Maintenance/refueling

i. Continued rehearsals for counterattack and withdrawal

Defense of a Village

1047. An Infantry company may be given the mission to defend a village. Once the company commander has completed his reconnaissance of the village, he scouts the surrounding terrain and, with the information assembled, he develops his plan for the defense. One of his first decisions is whether to defend with his Infantry on the leading edge of the village or farther back within the confines of the village. Normally, defending on the leading edge will be more effective against an armor heavy force, where the defending company can take advantage of longer range observation and fields of fire. Defending in depth within the village will be more effective against a primarily Infantry heavy force, in order to deny the enemy a foothold. This decision will be based on the factors of METT-T. This mission is usually characterized with the company defending an urban area that is surrounded by open terrain. The company may need to coordinate with adjacent units to plan for the defense or control of this terrain.

a. **Influencing Factors**. Several factors influence the commander's decision. First, he must know the type of enemy that his company will defend against. If the threat is mainly Infantry, the greater danger is allowing them to gain a foothold in the town. If the threat is armor or motorized Infantry, the greatest danger is that massive direct fire will destroy the company's defensive positions. The company commander must also consider the terrain forward and to the flanks of the village from which the enemy can direct fires against his positions.

b. **Platoon Battle Positions**. Based on the mission analysis, platoons are normally given a small group of buildings in which to prepare their defense, permitting the platoon leader to establish mutually supporting squad-sized positions. This increases the area that the platoon can control and hampers the enemy's ability to isolate or bypass a platoon. A platoon may be responsible for the road through the village. The rest of the company is then positioned to provide all-round security and defense in depth.

c. **Company Mortars and Antitank Weapons**. A position for the company mortars must be chosen that protects mortars from direct fire and allows for overhead clearance. Antitank weapons are placed where they can engage targets at maximum ranges with alternate firing points.

d. **Tanks**. If a tank platoon is available from the battalion task force, the company commander could place the tanks along the leading edge where rapid fire would complement the antitank weapons. The tank platoon leader should select exact firing positions and recommend engagement areas. If faced by enemy Infantry, the tanks move to alternate positions with the protection of friendly Infantry. These alternate positions allow the tanks to engage to the front as well as the flanks with as little movement as possible. Positions can be selected within buildings and mouseholes can be constructed. After they are withdrawn from the leading edge of the village, the tanks could provide a mobile reserve for the company.

e. **Rubbling**. If he has the authority and the ROE permit, the company commander will also decide if buildings should be rubbled to increase fields of fire.

However, rubbling the buildings too soon or rubbling too many may disclose his exact locations and destroy cover from direct fire. Because rubbling may take more resources than are available to a company, careful consideration of available resources must be made prior to rubbling. Additionally, care must be taken not to rubble areas that are necessary to support operations, such as MSRs. Buildings are normally rubbled with engineer assistance; engineers will usually employ explosives and engineer equipment to accomplish this task. If available, armored vehicles can be used to rubble buildings.

f. **FPFs**. FPFs are planned to address the biggest threat to the company—the enemy's Infantry. When firing an FPF inside an urban area is required, mortars are more effective than artillery. This is due to their higher angle of fall that gives them a greater chance of impacting on the street.

g. **Barriers and Obstacles**. Obstacles are easily constructed in an urban area. The company commander must stop enemy vehicles without interfering with his own movement in the village. Therefore, the company detonates cratering charges at key street locations on order. Mines are laid on the outskirts of the town and along routes the company will not use. Barriers and obstacles are normally emplaced in three belts. If attached or OPCON, the tank or BFV platoon leader can assist the commander by giving advice on where to place anti- vehicular obstacles.

h. **Engineers**. The supporting engineers use C4 and other explosives to make firing ports, mouseholes, and demolition obstacles. Based upon his priority of work, the commander tells the engineer squad leader to assist each of the Infantry platoons preparing the village for defense and to execute the company team's obstacle plan. The engineer squad leader's mission is to tell the Infantrymen exactly where to place the demolitions and how much is needed for the desired effect. He assists in preparation of charges. He also assists in the emplacement and recording of the minefields as well as the preparation of fighting positions.

i. **Service Support**. Ammunition expenditure is usually high when fighting in an urban area. To avoid moving around the village with ammunition resupply during the battle, the commander directs that ammunition be stockpiled in each occupied platoon and squad position. He also orders the platoons to stockpile firefighting equipment, drinking water, food, and first-aid supplies at each squad position. Other factors the company commander must consider are: 1) Resupply/pre-positioning of caches. 2) Casualty evacuation. 3) Firefighting/ventilation. 4) Security.

j. **Communications**. To ensure adequate communications, redundant verbal and nonverbal communications are planned and checked. The company installs a wire net and develops a plan for pyrotechnic signals. Backup wire should be laid in case primary lines are cut by vehicles, fires, or the enemy. The commander also plans for the use of messengers throughout the village.

Defense of a Block or Group of Buildings

1048. An Infantry company operating in urban terrain may have to defend a city block or group of buildings in a core periphery or residential area. The company conducts this operation in accordance with the battalion task force's defensive scheme of maneuver. The operation should be coordinated with the action of security forces charged with delaying to the front of the company's position. The defense should take advantage of the protection of buildings that dominate the avenues of approaches into the MBA. This mission differs from defense of a village in that it is more likely to be conducted completely on urban terrain, without surrounding open terrain that characterizes the defense of a village. An Infantry company is particularly well suited for this type of mission, since the fighting will require the enemy to move Infantry into the urban area in order to seize and control key terrain. (In the table shown on the next page) describes the frontages that are normally occupied when defending on this type of terrain. The density of buildings, rubble, and street patterns will dictate the company's frontage.

1049. An average city block has a frontage of about 175 meters. These minimum figures apply in areas of dense, block type construction; multi-story buildings; and underground passages. The factors of METT-TC must be applied to the defense of buildings and frontages can be extended or reduced accordingly.

a. **Task and Purpose**. A well-organized company defense in the urban area-1) Defeats the enemy's attack on the streets and city blocks by using obstacles and fire. 2) Destroys the enemy by ambush and direct fire from prepared positions within defensible buildings. 3) Clears the enemy from footholds or remains in place for a counterattack.

Table 10.1 - Approximate Frontages and Depths

UNIT	FRONTAGES	DEPTHS
BN or BN TF	4 to 8 Blocks	3 to 6 Blocks
CO or CO TM	2 to 4 Blocks	2 to 3 Blocks
Platoon	1 to 2 Blocks	1 Block

b. **Reconnaissance and Security**. The execution of the mission will be more effective if the terrain is reconnoitered and obstacles and fire lanes are prepared. The LP/OPs should be supplemented by patrols, mainly during periods of limited visibility, and wire communications should be used. Platoons should be given the mission to provide one LP/OP in order to provide spot reports concerning the size, location, direction and rate of movement, and type of

enemy assaulting the company sector or battle position.

c. **Task Organization**. METT-TC factors will determine how the company will be task organized to accomplish the mission. A possible task organization might be: 1) Rifle Platoons. Three platoons (one platoon minus a squad) occupy the defensive sector. 2) Reserve. Detached squad from one of the rifle platoons. The reserve should be given priority of commitment missions such as reinforcing the fires of the defense, reacting to a danger on the flank, or counterattacking to throw the enemy from a foothold. The biggest threat to the company is for the enemy to gain a foothold and use it to begin clearing buildings. Any foothold should be counterattacked and the enemy must be quickly and violently expelled. 3) Fire Support. Company 60-mm mortar and antitank weapons. 4) Company Control. An engineer squad, with priority to the company obstacle plan, then reverts to company reserve. Engineers should be controlled at company level. They construct obstacles, prepare access routes, and assist in preparing defensive positions. Additional attachments or OPCON units may be placed under company control. For example, a platoon or section of tanks attached or OPCON to the company should provide heavy direct-fire support, engage enemy tanks, and support counterattacks. An attached or OPCON tank platoon can initially attack by fire and then revert to a mobile reserve role. The company executive officer can be used to control a reserve with multiple elements.

d. **Execution**. The defensive forces should ambush on the avenues of approach, cover the obstacles by fire, and prepare a strong defense inside the buildings. Counterattack forces should be near the front of the company sector in covered and concealed positions with an on order mission to counterattack. Rehearsals should be conducted both day and night. Counterattack forces should also be given specific instructions of what their actions will be after the enemy assault has been repelled; for example, stay in sector or revert back to reserve status.

Defense of Key Urban Terrain

1050. An Infantry company may find itself having to defend key urban terrain. This defense may be part of defensive operations or may be an adjunct mission to stability and support operations. In many cases, this mission may be characterized by an unclear enemy situation and extremely restrictive ROE. The key terrain may be a public utility, such as gas, electrical, or water plants; a communications center, such as radio and or television; transportation center; a traffic circle; and so forth. When assigned a mission of this type, a company commander may often find his company having to defend a piece of terrain that he would rather not have to occupy. Often the facilities previously described are sited for their centrality of location and convenience and not for the defensibility of the terrain.

a. **Task Organization**. The factors of METT-TC will determine the task organization of the company. Additional assets will be given to the company commander as they are requested or assigned, based on mission requirements and availability.

b. **Tasks**. In order to properly defend the objective, the CO needs to deploy

platoons on the defensible terrain available. Therefore, he is defending urban terrain (left), high ground (top), and low vegetated terrain (right, bottom). Additionally, it may be necessary to perform some of the tasks listed below: 1) Provide inner and outer security patrols. 2) Conduct counter-reconnaissance. 3) Establish LP/OPs. 4) Establish checkpoints and roadblocks. 5) Conduct civilian control and evacuation. 6) Conduct coordination with local authorities. 7) Prevent collateral damage. 8) Supervise specific functions associated with operation of the facility, such as water purification tests, site inspections, and so forth.

c. **Execution**. The company commander will normally deploy platoons in a perimeter around the objective in order to dominate key terrain and cover the mounted and dismounted avenues of approach into the objective. Machine guns and antitank weapons will be emplaced to cover the dismounted and mounted avenues of approach into the objective, respectively. Wire obstacles will normally be used to restrict and deny entry into the objective area. Obstacles should be covered by fire and rigged with detection devices and trip flares. Antitank and command-detonated mines will be used consistent with the ROE. The company will have to be prepared to defend against a direct attack, such as a raid, or sabotage against key facilities within the objective, for example, water filtration system, pump station, and so forth. The commander will have to make an assessment as to the overall importance of the key facilities within the objective and prioritize security requirements. The 60-mm mortar section will be positioned to provide 360-degree fire support. The AT section will be positioned to engage vehicular targets. If the threat does not require the employment of mortars or AT weapons, these sections can be given other tasks.

d. **Other Considerations**. Depending on the mission requirements and threat, the company commander may have to consider the need for the following. 1) Artillery and attack helicopter support. 2) ADA assets to defend against air attack. 3) Engineer assets to construct obstacles. 4) Interpreters to assist in the functioning of the facility and operation of the equipment. 5) Public affairs, civil affairs, and or ISA assets for civilian control and liaison/ coordination with local police and or authorities. 6) Armor tanks to act as a mobile reserve or reaction force, or integrated into the company plan.

e. **Force Protection**. The company may be required to conduct a perimeter defense as part of a force protection mission, such as defending a friendly base camp on urban terrain. The same techniques of establishing a perimeter defense would be used. The company will maintain the appropriate level of security (100, 50, 30 percent, etc.), consistent with the commander's plan and the enemy situation. Additional tasks may include: 1) Setting up roadblocks and checkpoints. 2) Searching individuals and vehicles prior to entry into the camp. 3) Maintaining a presence as a show of force to the population outside the base camp. 4) Conducting inner and outer security patrols. 5) Clearing potential threats from any urban terrain that overwatches the base camp. 6) Conducting ambushes to interdict any enemy forces moving towards the base camp. 7) Restricting access to locations within the base camp. Conducting surveillance of these locations from within or from adjacent structures or positions 8) Conducting reaction force duties inside and outside the perimeter of the camp.

f. **Defense of a Traffic Circle**. An Infantry company may be assigned the mission of defending a key traffic circle in an urban area, or similar terrain, to prevent the enemy from seizing it or to facilitate movement of the battalion task force or other units. 1) The company commander with this mission should analyze enemy avenues of approach into the objective and buildings that dominate those avenues. He should plan direct and indirect fires, consistent with the ROE, on to the traffic circle itself and on the approaches to it. He should also plan for all-round defense of the buildings that dominate the traffic circle to prevent encirclement. The company should prepare as many covered and concealed routes between these buildings as time permits. This makes it easier to mass or shift fires and to execute counterattacks. 2) Obstacles can also deny the enemy the use of the traffic circle. Obstacle planning, in this case, must take into account whether friendly forces will need to use the traffic circle. 3) Antitank weapons can fire across the traffic circle if fields of fire are long enough. Tanks should engage enemy armored vehicles and provide heavy direct-fire support for counterattacks.

Defense of an Urban Strongpoint

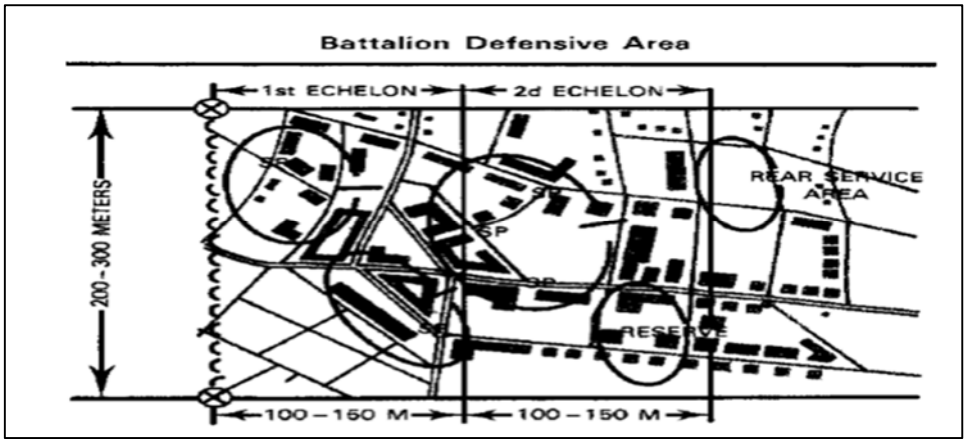


Figure 10.6 – Battalion Defensive Area

1051. Within a built-up area, an infantry company can also shield with mutually supporting fires countless structures prepared because of boundary defense. Each platoon defends certain and two buildings within an organization strong point yet a flooring concerning a great building as is stock via a company.

1052. Strong points constitute the basis of each defensive position. They are usually prepared in solidly constructed buildings located at intersections, entrances to public squares and parks, or adjacent to bridges, and with observation and prepared fields of fire appropriate to the weapons available. Fires are coordinated between strong points. They offer personnel protection against weapons of mass destruction. Communication trenches are prepared within strong-points. In addition, ambushes are set up in the gaps between positions, and wooden structures or other buildings which hinder fields of fire are razed. Fire planning for infantry weapons requires a combination of flanking, interlocking, and layered fires of all types. Weapons are emplaced to provide fires on the approaches to a defensive area, on the flanks, and in the battalion rear. Fires are tied in with artificial and natural obstacles to cover open areas completely.

Delay

1053. The Infantry company intent of a delay is to slow the enemy, cause casualties, and stop him, where possible, without becoming decisively engaged. This is done by defending, disengaging, moving, and defending again. A company delay is normally conducted as part of the battalion task force's plan. The delay destroys enemy reconnaissance elements forward of the outskirts of the urban area, prevents the penetration of the urban area, and gains and maintains contact with the enemy to determine the strength and location of the main attack by trading space for time. Infantry companies are well suited for this operation, because they can take advantage of the cover and concealment provided by urban terrain and inflict casualties on the enemy at close range. Delays can be planned by assigning platoon battle positions, platoon sectors, or both. Routes also are planned to take advantage of the inherent cover and concealment afforded by urban terrain, such as going through and hugging buildings, using shadows, subsurface areas, and so forth.

a. The company's sector should be prepared with obstacles to increase the effect of the delay. Engineers prepare obstacles on main routes but avoid some covered and concealed routes that are known by the friendly troops for reinforcement, displacement, and resupply. These routes are destroyed and obstacles are executed when no longer needed.

b. Antiarmor weapon systems, tanks, and BFVs should be positioned on the outskirts of the urban area to destroy the enemy at maximum range. They should be located in defilade positions or in prepared shelters. They fire at visible targets and then fall back or proceed to alternate positions. Platoons should be assigned sectors from 100 to 300 meters (one to two blocks) wide. If available, they should be reinforced with sensors or GSRs, which can be emplaced on the outskirts or on higher ground to attain the maximum range in the assigned AO. Platoons delay by detecting the enemy early and inflicting casualties on him using patrols, OPs, and ambushes and by taking advantage of all obstacles. Each action is followed by a disengagement and withdrawal. Withdrawals occur on covered and concealed routes through buildings or underground. By day, the defense is dispersed; at night, it is more concentrated. Close coordination and maintaining situational understanding are critical aspects of this operation.

Stability and Support

1054. Infantry Companies may have to conduct operations in environments that do not involve traditional combat. A company may be called upon to conduct a stability or support contingency operation and then have to quickly transition into offensive or defensive missions. The company may also be utilized in a stability or support operation at the successful conclusion of a combat mission. When assigned a stability or support mission, a well-trained company must be able to rapidly shift its focus from war fighting to stability and support and also from stability and support to war fighting. During a stability or support operation, the company performs numerous activities. Essentially, the company accomplishes these activities through execution of tactical tasks, such as security patrols, establishing road blocks and check points, force protection, and so forth. The company normally operates as part of a battalion TF during the execution of

stability and support operations. While stability and support operations can occur anywhere, they will most likely occur in an urban environment. (SP3-014 Infantry Conmpany Operations) 2005

1055. **Stability Operations**. The purposes of stability operations are to—

a. Protect national interests.

b. Promote peace or deter aggression.

c. Satisfy treaty obligations or enforce agreements and policies.

d. Reassure allies, friendly governments, and agencies.

e. Encourage a weak or faltering government.

f. Maintain or restore order.

g. Protect life and property.

h. Demonstrate resolve.

i. Deter or respond to terrorism.

j. Reduce the threat of conventional arms and WMD to regional security.

k. Eliminate or contain subversion, lawlessness, and insurgency.

1056. Other factors on stability operations in urban operations include:

a. **Considerations for Stability Operations**. Conducting stability operations is fundamentally identical to conducting combat operations. While each stability operation is different, the military decision-making process (MDMP) and troop-leading procedures methodologies apply. The considerations listed below supplement those processes and can help the company commander in developing the concept of the operation for stability operations. 1) Understand the potential for unintended consequences of individual and small unit actions. 2) Display the capability to use force without threatening the population. 3) Act decisively to prevent escalation 4) Apply force selectively and discriminately 5) Stress force protection 6) Emphasize information gathering through surveillance and reconnaissance

b. **Support Operations**. Support operations provide essential supplies and services to assist designated groups. They are conducted to help foreign and civil authorities respond to crises. Companies normally conduct support operations as part of a larger battalion operation to save or protect lives, reduce suffering, recover essential infrastructure, improve the quality of life, and restore situations to normal. Again, planning for support operations is fundamentally identical to planning for combat and stability operations. While each support operation is different, the military decision-making process

(MDMP) and troop leading procedures methodologies apply. Considerations that can assist the company commander in developing plans for support operations are: a) Provide essential support to the largest number of people. b) Coordinate actions with other agencies, as applicable (normally done by the battalion staff). c) Hand over to civilian agencies as soon as feasible. d) Conduct robust information operations. e) Secure the force.

Table 10.2 - Types of support operations, missions

FORMS OF SUPPORT OPERATIONS	MISSIONS
Relief Operations	Search and rescue, food & water distribution, providing temporary shelter, transportation support, medical support, sanitation, area security.
Support to Incidents Involving WMD	Assisting law enforcement, area security, protection of critical assets (utilities, transportation, banking, telecommunications), responding to WMD casualties, establishing roadblocks/checkpoints.
Support to Civil Law Enforcement	Civil disturbance missions; support to counterterrorism and counterdrug operations; providing resources, training, and augmentation; assisting with cordon and search; security patrols; establish roadblocks and checkpoints.
Community Assistance	Search and rescue, fire fighting, assistance in safety and traffic control, emergency snow removal, providing temporary shelter.

1057. Other Agencies. Because of the nature of support operations, the company can expect to interact with other units and agencies such as engineers, MPs, and nongovernment organizations (NGOs). Support actions rely on a partnership with other government and nongovernment agencies. Liaison with these agencies and between local governments is critical. Regardless of the positive relationships built, force protection always remains a top priority.

1058. **Transition to Combat Operations**. Stability, and to a lesser extent, support operations are missions that may transition to combat. The company commander must always keep in mind that the pendulum can also shift from a stability or support operation to combat. An escalation to combat is a clear indicator that the stability or support operation failed. The company must always retain the ability to conduct offensive and defensive operations. Preserving the ability to transition allows the company to maintain initiative while providing force protection.

a. **Plan for Contingencies**. The commander must plan for contingency operations that factor in what actions the company will perform if combat cannot be averted; for example, reverting to a hasty defense in the event that a stability or support mission deteriorates.

b. **Balanced Mindset**. A balance must be achieved between the mindset of peace operations and the mindset of war fighting. Soldiers can not become too complacent in their warrior spirit, but also must not be too eager to rely on the use of force to resolve conflict. This balance is the essence of peace operations and the fundamental aspect that will enable the company to perform its mission successfully and avoid an escalation to combat. Proactive leaders that are communicating and enforcing the ROE are instrumental to achieving this mindset.

c. **Combat Skills Training**. If the stability or support operation extends over prolonged periods of time, training should be planned that focuses on the individual and collective combat tasks that would be performed during transition to offensive and or defensive missions.

Combat Multipliers

1059. The first and most fundamental lesson learned from recent operations in urban areas is the value of the fully integrated combined arms team. There is no denying the value of light Infantry forces during urban combat. However, urban combat never should be considered a pure Infantry task. Urban combat by units composed entirely of Infantrymen is a historical anomaly. Across the spectrum of combat action in urban areas, powerful combined arms teams produce the best results Infantry units operating alone suffer from critical shortcomings that can be compensated for only by appropriate task organization with mechanized Infantry, armor, and engineers. These teams must be supported by closely integrated aviation, fire support, communications, and logistical elements. This paragraph discusses the more common combat multipliers available to the Infantry Company for the execution of UO.

Armored Vehicles.

1060. **Capabilities.** 1) The thermal sights on armored vehicles can detect enemy activity through darkness and smoke, conditions that limit even the best-equipped Infantry. They also provide greater range (4,000+ meters) in most instances. 2) Armored forces, can deliver devastating fires, are fully protected against antipersonnel mines, fragments and small arms, and have excellent mobility along unblocked routes. 3) Armored vehicles project a psychological presence, an aura of invulnerability that aids the friendly forces in deterring violence. Mounted patrols by armored vehicles can monitor large areas of a city while making their presence known to the entire populace, both friendly and unfriendly. 4) The mobile protected firepower of armored vehicles can be used to add security to resupply convoys and to extract wounded personnel under fire. The armored vehicle's smoke grenade launcher capability can aid this and other small-unit actions.

1061. **Limitations**. 1) Crewmen in armored vehicles have poor all-roundvision through their vision blocks; they are easily blinded by smoke or dust. Tanks cannot elevate or depress their main guns enough to engage targets very close to the vehicle or those high up in tall buildings. 2) If isolated or unsupported by Infantry, armored vehicles are vulnerable to enemy hunter/killer teams firing light and medium antiarmor weapons. Because of the abundance of cover and concealment in urban terrain, armored vehicle gunners may not be able to easily identify enemy targets unless the commander exposes himself to fire by opening his hatch or Infantrymen directing the gunner to the target. 3) Armored vehicles are noisy. Therefore, there is little chance of them arriving in an area undetected. Improvised barricades, narrow streets and alleyways, or large amounts of rubble can block armored vehicles. 4) Due to the length of the tank main gun, the turret will not rotate if a solid object is encountered, for example, a wall, post, and so forth. Heavy fires from armored vehicles cause unwanted collateral damage or can destabilize basic structures.

1062. **Employment.** Armored vehicles can support Infantry during urban combat operations by: 1) Providing shock action and firepower. 2) Isolating objectives with direct fire to prevent enemy withdrawal, reinforcement, or counterattack. 3) Neutralizing or suppressing enemy positions with smoke, high explosive (HE), and automatic weapons fire as Infantry closes with and destroys the enemy. 4) Assisting opposed entry of Infantry into buildings when doorways are blocked by debris, obstacles, or enemy fire. 5) Smashing through street barricades or reducing barricades by fire. 6) Obscuring enemy observation using smoke grenade launchers. 7) Holding cleared portions of the objective by covering avenues of approach. 8) Attacking by fire any other targets designated by the Infantry. 9) Establishing roadblocks or checkpoints. 10) Suppressing identified sniper positions.

1063. **Task Organization at Company Level**. Normally, a tank platoon would be OPCON to a light, airborne, or air asssault Infantry company during combined arms operations at the company team level. There are four basic techniques of task organizing the tank platoon into the light Infantry company for urban combat.

1064. **Tank Platoon as a Maneuver Element**. In this technique, the tank platoon leader is responsible for maneuvering the tanks IAW the company team commander's intent. With this task organization, likely missions for the tanks would be to support by fire or to overwatch the movement of the Infantry. This task organization is the most difficult to maneuver tanks with the Infantry. However, the tank platoon leader can choose to maneuver the platoon by sections in order to execute the mission. This would provide greater flexibility in supporting the Infantry during the close fight.

1065. **Tank Sections under Infantry Platoon Control**. In this technique, tanks would be broken down into two sections and each section would be placed under the OPCON of an Infantry platoon, and maneuvered IAW the company team commander's intent. The company team commander relinquishes direct control of the tank maneuver to the Infantry platoon leaders. This technique is very effective in maintaining the same rate of progress between the tanks and the Infantry. However, Infantry platoon leaders are burdened with the additional responsibility of maneuvering tanks. The general lack of experience with tanks and the overall battlefield focus of the Infantry platoon leader can also affect this technique. This technique is best suited when contact with the enemy is expected and close continuous support is required for movement or clearing

buildings.

1066. **Tank Sections under Company and Platoon Control**. The tank platoon can be broken down into two sections, one under company control, the other under platoon control. The selected maneuver Infantry platoon would have a tank section available to support the close fight. With this technique, the company team commander has a tank section to deploy at the critical place and time of his choosing. This task organization still allows support to the Infantry close fight while keeping additional support options in reserve for the commander to employ. The disadvantages to this technique are that an Infantry platoon leader is maneuvering tanks, instead of the tank platoon leader, and the tanks directly available to the company team commander are cut in half. This must be accomplished by detailed planning, coordination, and rehearsals between the Infantry platoons and tank sections.

1067. **Infantry Squad(s) Under Tank Platoon Control**. In this technique, the company team commander has the option of placing one or more Infantry squads under the OPCON of the tank platoon leader. He may also retain all tanks under the control of the tank platoon leader or place a tank section under the OPCON of an Infantry platoon leader. This technique will give the company team commander a fourth maneuver platoon, and involves the tank platoon leader in the fight. It can work well in a situation where a mobile reserve that needs Infantry protection is required. This must be accomplished by detailed planning, coordination, and rehearsals between the Infantry squads and tank platoon/sections.

1068. **Guidelines**. None of the techniques described above are inherently better than the other. The task organization has to be tailored to accomplish the mission. Regardless of the technique selected, the guidelines below should be followed:

a. Tanks should be used as sections. Single tanks may operate in support of Infantry, however it is preferable for tanks to operate as sections. If using tanks to shield squads and teams from building to building as part of the maneuver plan, the leader of the forward element needs to control the tanks.

b. If the company commander is controlling the tanks, he needs to move forward to a position where he can effectively maneuver the tanks in support of the Infantry.

c. The task organization should support the span of control. If the company commander is going to control the tanks, then there is no reason to task-organize the tanks by section under Infantry platoons.

d. Tanks need Infantry support when the two elements are working together. Do not leave tanks alone because they are not prepared to provide local security during the operation. Tanks are extremely vulnerable to dismounted attack when operating on urban terrain.

1069. **Engineers**. Normally an engineer squad will be attached to an Infantry company. Most engineer manual-labor tasks (for example, preparing fighting positions) will have to be completed by Infantry units, with reinforcing engineer heavy-equipment support and technical supervision.

a. **Offensive Missions**. Engineers may perform the following missions during offensive operations in an urban area: 1) Conduct a technical reconnaissance to determine the location and type of enemy obstacles and minefields, and to make breaching recommendations. 2) Clear barricades and heavy rubble with earth-moving equipment or explosives to assist forward movement.3) Use explosives to destroy fortifications and strongpoint that cannot be reduced with the maneuver unit's organic assets. 4) Use engineer equipment, if available, to destroy structures or to clear rubble. 5) Lay mines to protect flanks and rear areas. 6) Conduct mobility operations (gap crossing). 7) Locate and remove mines that may hamper the unit's movement. 8) Conduct breaching operations. 9) Conduct route reconnaissance.

b. **Defensive Missions**. Engineers may perform the following missions during the defense of an urban area. 1) Construct complex obstacle systems. 2) Rubble buildings 3) Lay mines 4) Develop and provide mine/obstacle overlays to leaders 5) Assist in the preparation of defensive positions and strongpoints 6) Maintain counterattack, communications, and resupply routes 7) Enhance movement between buildings, catwalks bridges, and so on 8) Crater roads 9) Clear fields of fire 10) Fight as Infantry, when needed

c. **DefenseAgainst Armor**. In defensive situations, when opposed by an armor-heavy enemy, priority should be given to the construction of antiarmor obstacles throughout the urban area. Use of local materials, where possible, makes obstacle construction easier and reduces logistics requirements. Streets should be barricaded in front of defensive positions at the effective range of antitank weapons. These weapons are used to increase the destruction by antiarmor fires, to separate enemy Infantry from their supporting tanks, and to assist in the delay and destruction of the attacker. Antitank mines in and around obstacles and covered by fires, help synchronize a defensive fire plan.

Fires

1070. Appropriate fire support coordination measures should be carefully considered since fighting in urban areas results in opposing forces fighting in close combat. When planning for fire support in an urban area, the company commander, in coordination with his FIST chief, should consider the following:

a. Target acquisition may be more difficult because of the increased cover and concealment afforded by the terrain. Ground observation is limited in urban areas, therefore FOs should be placed high. Adjusting fires is difficult since buildings block the view of adjusting rounds; therefore, the lateral method of adjustment may be most useful.

b. Initial rounds are adjusted laterally until a round impacts on the street perpendicular to the FEBA. Airburst rounds are best for this adjustment. The adjustments must be made by sound. When rounds impact on the perpendicular street, they are adjusted for range. When the range is correct, a lateral shift is made onto the target and the gunner fires for effect.

c. Special consideration must be given to shell and fuze combinations when effects of munitions are limited by buildings. 1) Careful use of VT is required to avoid premature arming. 2) Indirect fires may create unwanted rubble and collateral damage. 3) The close proximity of enemy and friendly troops requires careful coordination. 4) WP may create unwanted fires and smoke. 5) Fuze delay should be used to penetrate fortifications. 6) Illumination rounds can be effective; however, friendly positions should remain in shadows and enemy positions should be highlighted. Tall buildings may mask the effects of illumination rounds. 7) VT, TI, and ICM are effective for clearing enemy positions, observers, and antennas off rooftops. 8) Swirling winds may degrade smoke operations.

d. Target acquisition is difficult in urban terrain because the enemy has many covered and concealed positions and movement lanes. The enemy may be on rooftops and in buildings, and may use sewer and subway systems. Aerial observers are extremely valuable for targeting because they can see deep to detect movements, positions on rooftops, and fortifications. Targets should be planned on rooftops to clear away enemy FOs as well as communications and radar equipment. Targets should also be planned on major roads, at road intersections, and on known or likely enemy positions. Employing artillery in the direct fire mode to destroy fortifications should be considered, especially when assaulting well prepared enemy positions. Also, restrictive fire support coordination measures, such as a restrictive fire area or no-fire area may be imposed to protect civilians and critical installations.

e. Forward observers must be able to determine where and how large the dead spaces are. This area is a safe haven for the enemy because he is protected from indirect fires. For low-angle artillery, the dead space is about five times the height of the building. For high-angle artillery, the dead space is about one-half the height of the building.

f. Aerial observers are effective for seeing behind buildings immediately to the front of friendly forces. They are extremely helpful when using the ladder method of adjustment because they may actually see the adjusting rounds impact behind buildings. Aerial observers can also relay calls for fire when communications are degraded due to power lines or masking by buildings.

g. The use of airburst fires is an effective means of clearing snipers from rooftops. HE shells with delay fuzes may be effective against enemy troops in the upper floors of buildings, but, due to the overhead cover provided by the building, such shells have little effect on the enemy in the lower floors.

Mortars

1071. Mortars are the most responsive indirect fires available to company commanders. Their mission is to provide close and immediate fire support to the maneuver units. Mortars are well suited for combat in urban areas because of their high rate of fire, steep angle of fall, and short minimum range. Company commanders must plan mortar support with the FIST chief as part of the total fire support system.

a. **Role of Mortar Units**. The role of mortar units is to deliver suppressive fires to support maneuver, especially against dismounted Infantry. Mortars can be used to obscure, neutralize, suppress, or illuminate during urban combat. Mortar fires inhibit enemy fires and movement, allowing friendly forces to maneuver to a position of advantage. The most common and valuable use for mortars is often harassment and interdiction fires. One of their greatest contributions is interdicting supplies, evacuation efforts, and reinforcement in the enemy rear just behind his forward defensive positions. During both World War II and recent Middle East conflicts, light mortar HE fires have been used extensively during urban combat to deny the use of streets, parks, and plazas to enemy personnel. Finally, mortars can be used, with some limitations, against light armor and structures. Effectively integrating mortar fires with dismounted maneuver is key to successful combat in an urban area.

b. **Position Selection**. The selection of mortar positions depends on the size of buildings, the size of the urban area, and the mission. Rubble can be used to construct a parapet for firing positions. Positions are also selected to minimize counterbattery fire.

c. **Existing Structures and Masking**. The use of existing structures (for example, garages, office buildings, or highway overpasses) for positions is recommended to afford maximum protection and minimize the camouflage effort. Proper masking can enhance survivability. If the mortar has to fire in excess of 885 mils to clear a frontal mask, the enemy counterbattery threat is reduced. These principles can be used in both the offense and the defense.

d. **Use of Sandbags**. Mortars should not be mounted directly on concrete; however, sandbags may be used as a buffer. Sandbags should consist of two or three layers; be butted against a curb or wall; and extend at least one sandbag width beyond the baseplate.

e. **Placement**. Mortars are usually not placed on top of buildings because lack of cover and mask makes them vulnerable. They should not be placed inside buildings with damaged roofs unless the structure's stability has been checked. Overpressure can injure personnel, and the shock on the floor can weaken or collapse the structure.

f. **Communications.** Initially, radio may be the primary means of communication during urban combat. An increased use of wire, messenger, and visual signals will be required. However, wire should eventually be the primary means of communication between the forward observers, fire support team, fire direction center, and mortars since elements are close to each other. Also, FM radio transmissions in urban areas are likely to be erratic. Structures reduce radio ranges; however, placing antennas on upper floors or roofs may improve communications and enhance operator survivability. Another technique that applies is the use of radio retransmissions. A practical solution is to use existing civilian systems to supplement the unit's capability, understanding that this method of communication is not secure.

g. **Magnetic Interference**. In an urban environment, all magnetic instruments are affected by surrounding structural steel, electrical cables, and automobiles. To overcome this problem, an azimuth is obtained to a distant aiming point. From this azimuth, the back azimuth of the direction of fire is subtracted. The difference is indexed on the red scale and the gun manipulated until the vertical cross hair of the sight is on the aiming point. Such features as the direction of a street may be used instead of a distant aiming point.

h. **High-Explosive Ammunition**. During urban combat, mortar HE fires are used more than any other type of indirect fire. Although mortar fires are often targeted against roads and other open areas, the natural dispersion of indirect fires will result in many hits on buildings. Leaders must use care when planning mortar fires during UO to minimize collateral damage.1) High-explosive ammunition, especially the 120-mm projectile, provides good results when used against lightly built structures within cities. However, it does not perform well against reinforced concrete found in larger urban areas. 2) When using HE ammunition in urban fighting, only point detonating fuzes should be used. The use of proximity fuzes should normally be avoided, because the nature of urban areas causes proximity fuzes to function prematurely. Proximity fuzes, however, are useful in attacking some targets, such as OPs, on tops of buildings.

i. **Illumination**. Based on the close nature of urban combat, consideration should be given to the use of infrared (IR) illumination if the factors of METT-TC permit its use and friendly forces have a technological advantage over the enemy in terms of night vision devices (NVDs). Both IR and standard illumination rounds may cause unwanted urban fires if they come in contact with flammable structures or materials. Planning considerations must also include building height and the probability of rounds drifting and making contact with the sides of buildings, thus reducing their effectiveness. In some cases, ground burst may be more advantageous. In the offense, illumination rounds are planned to burst above the objective. If the illumination were behind the objective, the enemy troops would be in the shadows rather than in the light. In the defense, illumination is planned to burst behind friendly troops to put them in the shadows and place the enemy troops in the light. Buildings reduce the effectiveness of the illumination by creating shadows. Continuous illumination requires close coordination between the FO and FDC to produce the proper effect by bringing the illumination over the defensive positions as the enemy troops approach the buildings.

j. **Special Considerations**. When planning the use of mortars, commanders must consider the following: 1) FOs should be positioned where they can get the maximum observation so target acquisition and adjustments in fire can best be accomplished. This is not necessarily on tops of buildings 2) Commanders must understand ammunition effects to correctly estimate the number of volleys needed for the specific target coverage. Also, the effects of using WP may create unwanted smoke screens or limited visibility conditions that could interfere with the tactical plan. 3) FOs must be able to determine dead space in urban terrain. Dead space is the area in which indirect fires cannot reach the street level because of buildings. This area is a safe haven for the enemy. For mortars, the dead space is about one-half the height of the building. 4) Mortar crews should

plan to provide their own security. 5) Commanders must give special consideration to where and when mortars are to displace while providing immediate indirect fires to support the overall tactical plan. Combat in urban areas adversely affects the ability of mortars to displace because of rubbling and the close nature of urban combat.

Close Air Support.

1072. Attack Helicopters. Infantry units may be supported by attack helicopters. Regardless of the specific type of attack helicopter available, the same missions and tasks can be accomplished due to the inherent flexibility of Army aviation units. Due to the increased risk of small arms and manportable air defense systems (MANPAD) engagements, aviation forces normally support UO by operating away from urban areas (for example, isolation of objective); however, if the risk analysis determines that the payoff is higher than the risk, aviation forces can be employed in and around the urban area.

1073. Common Missions. The most common missions assigned to attack helicopters during urban operations are the following:

a. Escort of troop-carrying aircraft during air assaults.

b. Overwatch and support attacks integrated with the ground commander's maneuver.

c. Interdiction and destruction of enemy armored vehicles moving against friendly forces.

d. Isolation of urban objectives.

e. Reconnaissance.

f. Security of friendly locations.

g. Convoy escort duty.

h. Precision engagement of hardened point targets.

i. Participation in show-of-force operations.

j. Escort of NEO mission aircraft.

1074. Other Missions. In addition to the missions listed above, attack helicopters may be called on to perform some additional, nontraditional roles during urban operations. This is particularly true during support operations and stability operations in urban areas. Additional missions may include the following:

a. Assisting, for limited periods, in the control and coordination of fires with the maneuver of ground forces.

b. Providing limited relay of radio messages from isolated ground units.

c. Marking or identifying specific buildings and areas by smoke, fires, or targeting lasers.

d. Videotaping routes or objectives for later analysis by ground commanders.

e. Providing navigational and directional assistance to ground units.

f. Providing limited area illumination by infrared or white light using either on-board sources or illumination rockets.

g. Providing countersniper and countermortar armed reconnaissance patrols around friendly unit locations.

h. Weapons Limitations. Urban terrain limits weapons employment.

i. Weapons use may be limited by the shortarming/slant ranges within the urban area. Precision weapons, such as Hellfire missiles, require about 500 meters minimum range to reliably arm and stabilize on the intended target. Often, fire from longer ranges actually improves accuracy. Window engagements are generally not recommended, since the missile will usually impact the far wall of the structure, expending its blast energy away from the structure. Missile impact on the facing structure will normally cause over-pressurization inside the structure (near impact) as well as secondary fragmentation of wood/concrete, which can neutralize or stun occupants in the vicinity of the impact.

j. Extensive use of precision weapons by several units in close proximity may cause coordination problems with target identification and designation.

k. Laser designation by both ground and aerial systems may be degraded by the large expanses of polished, flat reflective surfaces common in many urban areas. The high volumes of smoke and dust associated with burning buildings and urban combat can prevent the accurate laser designation required for precision engagements.

l. Aircraft cannon fire against buildings can be devastating. These fires provide excellent suppression and can drive enemy forces away from firing positions or fix the enemy in place until ground maneuver forces can destroy him. Enemy positions that have been struck by fire can normally be reoccupied quickly by the enemy. Ricochets from these rounds are common in urban structures. They can cause additional collateral damage and pose a danger to nearby friendly forces.

m. Target identification and marking may be difficult because of heavy smoke and dust rising from urban fires and explosions. Some smoke from fires in industrial areas may be highly toxic or irritating. Pilots may have to don chemical protective equipment that hinders target detection and engagement. Friendly unit locations and personnel can be marked with colored panels, glint tape,

strobe lights, and colored smoke.

n. Although fire from stationary positions is more accurate, running fire is normally safer for the aircraft due to enemy ground fire. If possible, ground commanders should avoid directing pilots along a guntarget line that passes over friendly troops. Gun-target runs that are perpendicular to the friendly unit's front are normally best.

1075. Assault and Lift Helicopters. Infantry units may be supported by a assault or lift helicopters. These assets can be crucial for the flexible and responsive movement of troops and supplies and C2.

1076. Common Missions. The most common missions assigned to assault/lift helicopters during urban operations are the following:

a. Air assaults

b. CASEVAC/MEDEVAC

c. Air movement of troops and supplies

d. Emplace logistical resupply points

e. Conduct C2 operations

f. Conduct NEO

1077. Other Missions. Assault/lift helicopters may be called on to perform some additional, nontraditional roles or roles requiring special mission equipment. Additional missions may include the following:

a. Conduct EW operations.

b. Combat search and rescue (CSAR).

c. Emplace Volcano mines.

d. Emplace large/heavy obstacles (abandoned vehicles, concrete dividers, and so on).

1078. Aircraft Power Limitations and Time on Station. The need to deliver hovering fires from temporary battle positions may require the aircraft to carry less than a full load of munitions or fuel. This is especially true in hot climates and high altitudes. Reduced loads mean more frequent trips to forward area refuel and rearm points and less time on station. Long route distances during air movements may require the establishment of forward arming and refuel points (FARP) along the route prior to operations. Climate will also affect the number of troops or amount of supplies the aircraft can transport.

1079. Command and Support Relationships. From the ground unit perspective, helicopters are most effective when they operate under the OPCON of the ground unit commander closest to the enemy. Normally, the Infantry battalion is the lowest level granted formal OPCON of helicopters. During attack helicopter operations, the Infantry battalion commander is rarely able to identify the precise location of enemy forces or to coordinate aerial fires with friendly squad and platoon maneuver. He often must pass the responsibility for close coordination of attack helicopter fires to the company commander or platoon leader on the scene. This ground maneuver leader can direct the efforts of only a few aircraft at a time. It may be more effective for the aviation unit to retain control of its individual aircraft and operate by continuously rotating attack helicopter elements into the battle area where they then coordinate their attacks with the ground commander's maneuver. Generally, the smaller and more decentralized the combat actions, the better it is to have armed aircraft coordinate directly with the small-unit leader on the ground. The larger, more centralized the combat action, the better it is to retain control of armed aircraft by the aviation headquarters. Whichever command and support relationship is chosen, both the ground and the aviation headquarters must understand what is expected of the other. Close liaison and clear, concise verbal communications are important.

Anti-armor Weapons.

1080. The urban environment will not change the tactical use of these weapons, but it can limit how they are employed. Some of those limitations are: stand-off; obstructions for wire-guided missiles; displacement after engagements; firing in-depth engagements; increased obstacles; increased danger zones; and all around security. Although antiarmor weapons are primarily designed to destroy armored vehicles, they also can be used to damage or destroy some urban fortifications. Additionally, they can be used for ballistic breaching of doorways that are being used for entry points to buildings, or by creating deceptions, just before the assault element enters the actual initial breach (entry) point. The larger systems that have highly magnified day and thermal sights can be used to detect snipers and to disrupt or kill them with long range missiles. Most medium and heavy antiarmor weapons have their own local security since they are crew served, thus eliminating the need to assign additional security. Commanders should ensure platoon leaders emplace the weapons in a mutually supporting manner that also provides all round security for the antiarmor weapons. When these weapons fire, they quickly become priority targets, making them susceptible to enemy fire. Major considerations for planning offensive and defensive operations are as follows.

1081. **Offensive Operations**. When employing antiarmor weapons in the offense, assign them to an area that over watches the assault force and where ambushes are likely, such as roads, road intersections, alleys, and large open areas. Place them so they can establish a blocking force along main access routes to the objective and where they can isolate the objective against armor counterattacks. When selecting positions, pick the areas that-

a. Offer cover and concealment for the weapon and crew. Urban terrain will, in most cases, limit maximum range shots, making the weapon and crew more vulnerable to small arms weapons.

b. Have no ground and overhead obstacles.

c. Provide mutual support with other crew-served weapons.

d. Offer escape routes.

1082. **Defensive Operations**. When assigning the antiarmor weapons their engagement areas, ensure that they are positioned for maximum fields of fire. They are also positioned in-depth to exploit their maximum ranges. This may not always be possible within urban areas, with the amount of obstacles and short engagement ranges. Close engagement areas that limit standoff will only give the crew time for one shot, with no time for reloading if they have to fire multi-engagements. For this reason, antiarmor weapons should always be employed in pairs. One fires and the other supports by fire. When selecting firing positions consider:

a. Positioning the weapons so they have interlocking fires.

b. When engaging armor or light armor, have the antiarmor fire first, giving the crew time to displace for other engagements.

c. Use organic weapons to mask the initial engagement to distract the threat from knowing where the round or rounds came from.

d. Establishing ambushes along choke points. Light antiarmor weapons that are individually operated work best at short ranges.

1083. **Snipers**. Company commanders can make effective use of snipers during UO. They should be considered an important combat multiplier, and integrated into the fire plan and scheme of maneuver. Snipers are a precision weapon and must be used as such.

1084. **Missions**. Snipers can be used as part of the support element to provide precise long and short range fires. Snipers can provide significant input to reconnaissance and counterreconnaissance efforts. They can be dedicated to the countersniper role or be assigned priority targets. Snipers can also overwatch breaching operations and call for indirect artillery fires. They can also be used effectively as a screening force against limited threats.

1085. **Positions**. General areas (a building or group of buildings) are designated as sniper positions, but the sniper selects the best position for engagement based on the mission given him. Masonry buildings that offer the best protection, long-range fields of fire, and all-round observation are preferred. The sniper also selects several secondary and supplementary positions to cover his areas of responsibility. The sniper selects positions that provide him with engagement areas but do not compromise his security. He selects positions that allow him to displace to other firing positions.

1086. **Targets**. Engagement priorities for snipers are determined by the relative importance of the targets to the effective operations of the enemy. Priority targets can include:

a. Enemy officers or other leaders

b. Enemy snipers

c. Enemy RTOs

d. Vehicle commanders or drivers

e. Enemy crew served weapons members

f. Enemy special weapons personnel

1087. **Limitations**. Urban areas often limit snipers to firing down or across streets, but open areas permit engagements at longer ranges. Snipers can be employed to cover rooftops, obstacles, dead space, and gaps in FPFs.

1088. **Countersniper TTP**. If the Infantry company operates in an area where enemy sniper contact is likely, the commander should consider the following:

a. Task organize trained snipers by placing them into platoons most likely to make contact and give them counter-sniper missions.

b. Identify trained unit marksmen to act in the counter-sniper role.

c. Plan movement on the most covered and concealed routes.

d. If operating with BFVs or tanks, place them in a position during movement that can support the Infantry in countersniper actions. The target acquisition capabilities of armored vehicles make them excellent countersniper weapons.

e. Plan passive countermeasures and enforce them. (Ensure that soldiers wear protective equipment and request additional smoke.)

1089. **Sustainment**. The company first sergeant and supply sergeant normally share the responsibility for coordinating all supply and transportation requirements for the company. Generally, the priorities of resupply for Infantry companies in urban combat are ammunition, medical supplies, water, and food. These priorities may change based on the factors of METT-TC. Resupply operations normally occur once a day during periods of limited visibility. Company resupply is primarily a "push" system accomplished through the reception of a logistics package (LOGPAC) from battalion.

1090. **Distribution of Supplies**. The first sergeant takes control of LOGPACS at the logistics release point (LRP). This should be a covered and concealed position that offers protection to those distributing supplies; for example, a large enough building that can be secured locally. The LRP should be positioned close enough to the combat area so that LOGPACs can be offloaded and carried to the platoons. LOGPACS should be broken down into 50- to 75-pound loads to be carried in rucksacks. Litters can be used to carry heavier loads. The company should plan for carrying supplies and identify soldiers to do this. The platoon sergeant assumes control of the supplies once they arrive in the platoon area. Carrying parties should use covered and concealed routes through

buildings to move from the LRP to the company sector. Porters should be prepared to provide their own security to and from the LRP. The first sergeant has three options for resupplying the platoons:

1091. **In Position**. This is the most common technique used in urban terrain when the company is conducting operations that require platoons to maintain combat power forward (during contact or when contact is imminent). For example, this technique would probably be used during the consolidation and reorganization phase of an offensive operation where a counterattack is expected. Ammunition, medical supplies, and water are brought forward by the support element and resupplied directly to the platoons in cleared buildings. All the assaulting platoons remain in position.

1092. **Out of Position**. This technique is used when the situation does not necessitate all combat power being forward (contact is not likely). The first sergeant establishes a resupply point in a covered and concealed position (a cleared building with overhead cover) to the rear of the platoon. Platoons send selected personnel back to the resupply point, pick up the supplies, and move back to position.

1093. **Pre-position**. This technique is most often used during defensive operations when supplies are often cached (pre-positioned and concealed) in buildings throughout the company sector or subsequent battle positions.

1094. **Medical Treatment and Evacuation**. The first sergeant must plan to expedite the evacuation of wounded out of the urban area. Rubble in the streets, barricades, and demolition of roads impede the use of ground ambulances, requiring a heavy reliance on litter teams. Snipers may present a significant problem for medical evacuation from front line positions. The company casualty collection point (CCP) should be placed in a covered and concealed location with overhead cover (usually a heavy clad building that has not collapsed). The CCP should be located at a point where the field ambulances can reach them, yet close enough to the combat area so that casualties do not have to be carried great distances. Higher numbers of head and chest wounds should be expected, along with increased trauma injuries due to falling objects and glass. Increased casualties may require the stockpiling of medical supplies and augmentation of medical personnel from higher headquarters. The role of combat lifesavers at the company level takes on greater significance. The commander should anticipate increased nonbattle injuries (NBI) due to poor field sanitation or falls from building, as well as contact with TIM. The close nature of urban combat may cause an increased mental health case load. Additional considerations include:

a. Marking the CCP.

b. Carrying additional medical supplies to include intravenous (IV) fluids, bandages, poleless litters, SKEDCO litters, and lightweight blankets.

c. Planning for aid and litter teams within the assault and support elements and supplying them with sledgehammers, axes, crowbars, ropes, pulleys, and ladders in order to extricate casualties from difficult situations.

d. Placing selected combat life savers from the support element under the control of the first sergeant to assist with triage and treatment at the CCP.

e. Requesting appropriate medications for nonbattle-related illnesses (for example, dysentery).

f. Rehearsing the CASEVAC plan with platoon sergeants. Rehearsals should include company CCP location and marking, CASEVAC routes, priority of CASEVAC, and medical resupply. Aid and litter teams should rehearse carrying techniques based on the nature of the injury.

1095. The infantry company in joint operations provide assistance according to the following:

a. Stabilize operations

b. Provide civil support

c. Provide foreign humanitarial assistance

d. Assist in recovery

e. Perform noncombatant evacuation

f. Perform peace operations

g. Combat weapons of mass destruction

h. Chemical, biological, radiological, and nuclear consequence management

i. Provide foreign internal defense

j. Assist in counterdrug operations

k. Combat terrorism, perform counterinsurgency operations

l. Assist in homeland defense

1096. The plan and execution of joint forces must be aligned with framework of an alliance or coalition under Philippine Armed forces leadership. Mutual support and respect among the commanders must be observed. Cultivation and maintenance of personal relationships between counterparts are fundamental to achieving success.

1097. Terminating joint operationsis an aspect that links to the achievement of operation objectives. Normally, the termination criteria will be set by the Secretary of Defense under the command of the President of the Republic of the Philippines. It is therefore significant to that the desired military end state must be defined and elaborated to the Company commander of each military wing or force since the ability to understand how and when to terminate operations is instrumental to joint operations design and plans.

1098. Determining the Status of Personnel. Infantry companies do not determine the status of individuals in the combat area. Any persons that are initially detained should

be treated as PWs and higher headquarters should be notified with a request for assistance in evacuating these individuals.

Annex A
Troop-Leading Procedures (TLP)

Troop-Leading Procedure (TLP) is a dynamic process used by small unit leaders to analyze a mission, develop a plan, and prepare for an operation. These procedures enable leaders to maximize available planning time while developing effective plans and adequately preparing the company for an operation. The sequence of the TLP steps is not rigid. They are modified to meet the mission, situation, and available time. Some steps are done concurrently while others may go on continuously throughout the operations. The paragraphs below explain the steps:

Receive the Mission

It may begin with the initial warning order (WARNO) from higher headquarters or when a leader receives an OPORD. Frequently, leaders receive a mission in a FRAGO over the radio. Ideally, they receive a series of WARNOs, the OPORD, and a briefing from their commander. Normally, after receiving an OPORD, leaders are required to give a confirmation brief to their higher commander to ensure they understand the higher commander's concept of operations and intent for his unit. The leader obtains clarification on any portions of the higher headquarters plan as required. Upon receipt of mission, company commanders perform an initial assessment of the situation (METT-TC analysis) and allocate the time available for planning and preparation which includes rehearsals and movement. This initial assessment and time allocation form the basis of their initial WARNO. Company commanders issue the initial WARNO quickly to give subordinates as much time as possible to plan and prepare. It includes the following processes:

1) Perform an Initial Assessment. The initial assessment addresses the factors of mission, enemy, terrain and weather, troops and support available, time available and civil considerations (METT-TC). The order and detail in which company commanders analyze the factors of METT-TC is flexible. It depends on the amount of information available and the relative importance of each factor. For example, they may concentrate on the mission, enemy, and terrain, leaving weather and civil considerations until they receive more detailed information.

2) Allocate the Available Time. Company commanders estimate the time available to plan and prepare for the mission. They begin by identifying the times at which major planning and preparation events, including rehearsals, must be complete. Reverse planning helps them do this. Company commanders identify the critical times specified by higher headquarters and work back from them, estimating how much time each event will consume. Critical times might include aircraft loading times, the line of departure (LD) time, or the start point (SP) time for movement. By working backwards, company commanders arrive at the time available to plan and prepare for the operation. Leaders ensure that all subordinate echelons have sufficient time for their own planning and preparation needs. A general rule of thumb for leaders at all levels is to use no more than one-third of the available time for planning and issuance of the OPORD. Below is an example of a tentative time schedule, which may require adjustment as the TLP process continues:

0700 – Execute mission.
0630 – Finalize/adjust the plan based on the leader's recon.
0300 – Establish OPR; begin leader's reconnaissance.
0100 – Begin movement.
2000 – Conduct platoon inspections.
1800 – Hold rehearsals.
1700 – Eat meals (tray packs).
1645 – Hold brief backs (SLs to PL).
1520 – Issue platoon OPORD.
1400 – Hold brief backs (PLs to CO).
1310 – Issue OPORD.
0935 – Conduct reconnaissance
0920 – Update companywarning order, if required.
0900 – Receive battalion OPORD.
800– Receive battalion warning order, issue company warning order.

Issue a Warning Order

The WARNO contains as much detail as possible. It informs subordinates of the unit mission and gives them the leader's time line. Leaders may also pass on any other instructions or information they think will help subordinates prepare for the new mission. This includes information on the enemy, the nature of the higher headquarters plan, and any specific instructions for preparing their units. The most important thing is that leaders do not delay in issuing the initial WARNO. As more information becomes available, leaders can—and should—issue additional WARNOs. By issuing the initial WARNO as quickly as possible, leaders enable their subordinates to begin their own planning and preparation. It follows the five-paragraph OPORD format. Normally an initial WARNO issued at the companylevel includes:

1) Mission or nature of the operation.

2) Time and place for issuing the OPORD.

3) Units or elements participating in the operation.

4) Specific tasks not addressed by unit SOP.

5) Time line for the operation.

Make a Tentative Plan

Once they have issued the initial WARNO, leaders develop tentative plan. Often, leaders perform them mentally. They may include their principal subordinates—especially during COA development, analysis, and comparison. However, Army leaders, not their subordinates, select the COA on which to base the tentative plan. This includes the following process:

1) **Mission Analysis.** To frame the tentative plan, Army leaders must perform mission analysis. This mission analysis follows the ***METT-TC*** format, continuing the initial assessment performed in the first step of TLP.

*a) **Mission***. Leaders analyze the higher headquarters WARNO or OPORD to determine how their unit contributes to the higher headquarters mission. They examine the following:

(1) Higher Headquarters Mission and Commander's Intent. Army leaders determine the mission and commander's intent of their higher and next higher headquarters. When these are unavailable, Army leaders infer them based on the information they have. When they receive the actual mission and commander's intent, they revise their plan, if necessary.

(2) Higher Headquarters Concept of Operations. Army leaders examine the concept of operations to determine how their unit's mission and tasks contribute to the higher mission's success. They determine details that will affect their operations, such as control measures and execution time.

(3) Specified, Implied, and Essential Tasks. From WARNOs and the OPORD, Army leaders extract the specified and implied tasks assigned to their unit. They determine why each task was assigned to their unit to understand how it fits within the commander's intent and concept of operations. From the specified and implied tasks, Army leaders identify essential tasks. These tasks must be completed to accomplish the mission. Failure to complete an essential task results in mission failure.

(4) Constraints. Leaders also identify any constraints placed on their unit. Constraints can take the form of a requirement (for example, maintain a reserve of one platoon) or a prohibition on action (for example, no reconnaissance forward of Line Bravo before H-hour). The product of this part of the mission analysis is the restated mission. The restated mission is a simple, concise expression of the essential tasks the unit must accomplish and the purpose to be achieved. The mission statement states who (the unit), what (the task), when (either the critical time or on order), where (location), and why (the purpose of the operation).

*b) **Enemy.*** With the restated mission as the focus, Army leaders continue the analysis with the enemy. For small unit operations, Army leaders need to know about the enemy's composition, disposition, strength, recent activities, ability to reinforce, and possible COAs. Much of this information comes from higher headquarters. Additional information comes from adjacent units and other Army leaders. Some information comes from the leader's experience. Army leaders determine how available information applies to their operation. They also determine what they do not know about the enemy, but should identify these intelligence gaps to their higher headquarters or take action (such as sending out reconnaissance patrols) to obtain the necessary information.

*c) **Terrain and Weather***. This aspect of mission analysis addresses the military aspects of terrain: observation and fields of fire, avenue of approach, key terrain, obstacles, and cover and concealment (OAKOC).

*d) **Troops and Support Available.*** Perhaps the most important aspect of mission analysis is determining the combat potential of one's own force. Army leaders know

the status of their soldiers' morale, their experience and training, and the strengths and weaknesses of subordinate leaders. They realistically determine all available resources. This includes troops attached to, or in direct support of, the unit. The assessment includes knowing the strength and status of soldiers and their equipment. It also includes understanding the full array of assets in support of the unit. Army leaders know, for example, how much indirect fire, by type, is available and when it will become available. They consider any new limitations based on level of training or recent fighting.

e) ***Time Available.*** Army leaders not only appreciate how much time is available, they also understand the time-space aspects of preparing, moving, relation to time. They know how long it takes under such conditions to prepare for certain tasks (such as, orders production, rehearsals, and subordinate element preparations). Most importantly, Army leaders monitor the time available. As events occur, they assess their impact on the unit time line and update previous time lines for their subordinates. Time lines list all events that affect the unit and its subordinate elements.

f) ***Civil Considerations.*** Civil considerations are how the man-made infrastructure, civilian institutions, and attitudes and activities of the civilian leaders, populations, and organizations within an area of operations influence the conduct of military operations. Rarely are military operations conducted in uninhabited areas. Most of the time, units are surrounded by non-combatants. These non-combatants include residents of the AO, local officials, and governmental and non-governmental organizations (NGOs). Based on information from higher headquarters and their own knowledge and judgment, Army leaders identify civil considerations that affect their mission. Civil considerations are analyzed in terms of six factors: (*Areas, Structures, Capabilities, Organizations, People, and Events*). These are known by the memory aid *ASCOPE*.

2.) **Course of Action Development.** The purpose of COA development is simple: to determine one or more ways to accomplish the mission. Most missions and tasks can be accomplished in more than one way. However, in a time-constrained environment, leaders may develop only one COA. Leaders develop COAs as soon as they have enough information to do so. Usable COAs are suitable, feasible, acceptable, distinguishable, and complete. To develop them, leaders focus on the actions the unit takes at the objective and conducts a reverse plan to the starting point. The following considerations apply:

a. **Generate Options.** During this step, Army leaders brainstorm different ways to accomplish the mission. They determine the doctrinal requirements for the operation to include the tactical tasks normally assigned to subordinates. Doctrinal requirements give Army leaders a framework from which to develop COAs. Next, the leader identifies where and when the unit can mass overwhelming combat power to achieve specific results (with respect to terrain, enemy, or time) that accomplish the mission. They do this by identifying the decisive point or points. The leader determines what result must be achieved at the decisive points to accomplish the mission. This assists the leader in determine the amount of combat power applied at the decisive point and what are the required tasks. After identifying the tasks, the leader next determines the purpose for each task. There is normally one primary task for each mission. The unit assigned this task is designated the main effort. The purpose of the other tasks

should support the accomplishment of the primary task.

b. **Array Forces.** The unit leader then determines what combinations of soldiers, weapons, and other systems should be at each location to accomplish each task. They also assign C2 headquarters for each combination of forces.

c. **Develop a Concept of Operations.** The concept of operations describes how the leader envisions the operation unfolding, from its start to its conclusion or end state. They determine how accomplishing each task leads to executing the next. They identify the best ways to use available terrain and how best to employ unit strengths against enemy weaknesses. Fire support considerations make up an important part of the concept of operations. Even if fires are only executed in case of emergency, Army leaders keep in mind the relationship between maneuver and fires. Army leaders develop the graphic control measures necessary to convey and enhance the understanding of the concept of operations, prevent fratricide, and clarify the tasks and purposes of the decisive and shaping operations.

d. **Assign Responsibilities.** Leaders assign responsibility for each task to a subordinate. Whenever possible, they depend on the existing chain of command. They avoid fracturing unit integrity unless the number of simultaneous tasks exceeds the number of available elements. Different command and control arrangements may be the distinguishing feature among COAs.

e. **Prepare a COA Statement and Sketch.** Leaders base the COA statement on the concept of operations for that COA. The COA statement focuses on all significant actions, from the start of the COA to its finish. Whenever possible, Army leaders prepare a sketch showing each COA. Another useful technique is to show the time it takes to achieve each movement and task in the COA sketch. Doing this helps gain an appreciation for how much time will pass as each task of the COA is executed. The COA contains the following information: 1) Form of maneuver or defensive technique to be used. 2) Designation of the main effort. 3) Tasks and purposes of subordinate units. 4) Task and purpose of critical battlefield operating system elements. 5) Necessary sustaining operations; and, 6) End state. This a sample mission statement and course of action for an Infantry Company in the defense:

Mission Statement: C Co, 41IB is prepared NLT 281700(Z); JAN 2015 to destroy enemy forces from GL 375652 to GL 389650 to GL 394660 to GL 373665 to prevent the envelopment of A Co, the battalion main effort; and

COA Statement: The Company defends with two platoons (PLTs) forward and 1 PLT in depth from PLT battle positions. The other PLT (2 squads) destroys enemy forces to prevent enemy bypass of the main effort PLT on Hill 657. The southern PLT (3 squads) destroys enemy forces to prevent an organized company attack against the Co main effort on Hill 657. The main effort PLT (3 squads, 2 TOWS) retains Hill 657 (Vic GL378659) to prevent the envelopment of Co A (BN main effort) from the south. The anti-armor section (1 squad,) establishes ambush positions at the road junction (Vic GL3777653) to destroy enemy vehicles to prevent a concentration of combat power against the main effort PLT. The company mortars locate Vic GL 3777664. The anti-armor section initiates fires when the enemy combat reconnaissance patrol reaches the intersection.

c.) **Analyze Courses of Action (War-game).** For each COA, leaders think through the operation from start to finish. They compare each COA with the enemy's most probable COA. At small unit level, the enemy's most probable COA is what the enemy is most likely to do, given what friendly forces are doing at that instant. The leader visualizes a set of actions and reactions. The object is to determine what can go wrong and what decision the leader will likely have to make as a result.

d.) **Compare COAs and Make a Decision.** Leaders compare COAs by weighing the advantages, disadvantages, strengths, and weaknesses of each, as noted during the war-gaming. They decide which COA to execute based on this comparison and on their professional judgment. They take into account the following:

a. Mission accomplishment

b. Time to execute the operation

c. Risk

d. Results from unit reconnaissance

e. Subordinate unit tasks and purposes

f. Casualties incurred; and,

g. Posturing the force for future operations

The Estimate of the Situation

The estimate of the situation process is done in every tactical decision. This is the Army's decision-making process which helps the leader determine his mission, understand his situation, and select the best course of action. The estimate has five steps. These steps are explained in the paragraphs and subsections below.

Step 1 - Conduct a Detailed Mission Analysis

Leaders conduct a detailed mission analysis whenever they receive instructions to begin a new operation. These instructions may be received as warning orders, OPORD, or FRAGO. The CO conducts the mission analysis to determine different aspects of the operation. They are explained in the paragraphs below.

The Higher Commanders' Concept and Intent. The company commander must know what both his battalion and brigade commanders' intent and want accomplished. He must also understand his role and responsibilities within their concepts. This information is found in the battalion OPORD in paragraph (1b) for the brigade and in paragraph 2 and 3 for the battalion.

The Unit's Tasks. The CO determines all the tasks that his unit must accomplish; they may be found throughout the order. Tasks that are clearly stated in the order, during the oral OPORD, or on the operation overlay are called specified tasks. Examples of specified tasks are:

a. Retain Hill 545 to prevent envelopment of B Co.

b. Provide one squad to the 81-mm mortar platoon to carry ammo.

c. Establish an OP at Vic GC124325 NLT 30 0300 FEB 15.

In addition to these specified tasks, other requirements may become apparent as the OPORD is analyzed. These are called implied tasks; they are not routine or SOP-type requirements (like to provide security during movement, conduct re-supply operations, coordinate with adjacent units, etc.). However, it should be noted that it is not too important to classify these tasks strictly; but what is important is to identify all these tasks in order not to miss any of it and to complete the plan. If the company was assigned a mission to seize an enemy position for some purpose, some examples of implied tasks might to:

a. Task-organize the unit to accomplish the mission.

b. Conduct reconnaissance to locate enemy weak points.

c. Isolate the area at the point of attack.

The Unit's Limitations. The CO next determines all control measures or instructions in the OPORD that restrict his freedom of action; these are called limitations. The operations overlay has graphic control measures that restrict the unit's freedom to maneuver. The coordinating instructions often include limitations. Throughout the order, there may be specific times that the unit must meet. The following are some examples of common limitations:

a. Cross the LD at 100030 JAN 15.

b. Radio silence after crossing LD.

c. Fire support shall be given after occupation of attack position.

At times, it may be confusing whether something is a task or a limitation. The first example given above is both a specified task (cross the LD) and a limitation (at exactly 0030 Hours on 10 JAN 15). What is important is that the information is included in the CO's concept and that all subordinates understand and comply with it, such as the following: (Mission-Essential Task(s), Restated Mission Statement)

Mission-Essential Task(s). After reviewing all the above factors, the CO identifies mission-essential task(s). Failure to accomplish a mission-essential task results in the company's failure to accomplish its primary purpose for that operation. In a well-written OPORD, the CO will find his mission-essential task in the maneuver paragraph.

The Restated Mission Statement. If an OPORD is received, the mission statement is clearly stated in the battalion concept of operation (Para 3a), and the purpose (or the mission-essential task) for each company is stated in the battalion’s scheme of maneuver.

However, if the mission analysis began as the result of a short FRAGO (or a significant change to the situation) the company's mission may not be clearly stated. In this case, the commander must determine his mission-essential task. He does this by reviewing the battalion commander's concept and determining what his company's role in the decisive action. What must his unit achieve to support the battalion's mission accomplishment?

The relationship of his unit to the battalion's main effort may also clarify his mission essential task. If his company is the main effort, there should be a direct relationship between his purpose and the battalion's purpose. If the CO reviews each of his assigned tasks by this process, it should be clear which task is essential to the success of the battalion commander's concept.

The restated mission statement becomes the focus for the remainder of the estimate process. This is a clear, concise statement of the essential task(s) to be accomplished by the company and the purpose to be achieved. The mission statement will normally state: WHO (the company); WHAT (the task); WHEN (the critical time); WHERE (usually a grid coordinate); and WHY (the purpose the company must achieve).

This also becomes the paragraph 2 of the company OPORD. The other specified and implied tasks and limitations are included in the plan where required. Some examples of restated missions follow:

a. "WHO-Bravo Company, 41IB attacks; WHEN-090500 MAR 15; WHAT-to seize HILL 482; WHERE -vicinity GC 457271 (GOLD); WHY-to enable the battalion's main effort to destroy enemy encampment and main force."

b. Or, stated as: (WHO) "B Company, 41IB defends (WHEN) NLT 28153O JAN 15 (WHAT) to destroy enemy forces from (WHERE) GC163456 to GC163486 to GC123486 to GC123456 to (WHY) prevent enemy forces from enveloping 21IB forces from the south."

Step 2 - Analyze the Situation and Develop Courses of Action

With the restated mission statement from Step 1 and to provide focus, the CO continues the estimate process. Step 2 involves analyzing the situation using the remaining factors of the METT-TC (which are enemy, terrain, troops and time). The IPB integrates the enemy doctrine with the terrain and weather to evaluate enemy capabilities, vulnerabilities, and possible COAS.

Once the CO has a full appreciation for the situation, he then develops several COAs that will accomplish his mission. This analysis is done in a very deliberate, step-by-step manner. In reality, this is a very dynamic process and is normally the most time consuming step of the following estimate process. The process is described below:

Analyze the Situation

During the analysis, the CO determines facts about the situation. He also determines questions for which he has no facts. He then tries to answer these questions through additional analysis or reconnaissance. When these questions impact on his ability to

develop valid courses of action, he must plan from assumptions. The following aspects are considered:

a. **Assumptions.** They are used in the absence of facts and are based on previous facts that he has developed his knowledge of the enemy's doctrine, and also his experience from fighting this enemy to deduce the impact they may have on his unit. However, the CO reduces the number of assumptions by conducting reconnaissance to gather the required facts.

b. **Analysis of Facts.** The CO also analyzes the facts to determine how they impact on his mission, on his unit, and on the enemy. The quality of these deductions will determine the effectiveness of the courses of action developed later in Step 2. Figure 2.4 shows this analysis process for Step 2.

Identification of Decisive Points

Throughout Step 2, the CO identifies potentially decisive points where he can generate superior combat power in relation to the enemy. These points may result from his analysis on:

a. **Terrain.** Locations on the ground which provide an advantage or put the enemy at a disadvantage

b. **Enemy.** An identified enemy weakness that can be exploited

c. **Time.** A time when the combat potential of the enemy force is degraded. Ideally, a decisive point will be identified where an enemy weakness is positioned at a time and a location that allows the company to generate overwhelming combat power. These points are potentially decisive because the effects of the company's combat potential, when applied there, should lead to accomplishing the mission.

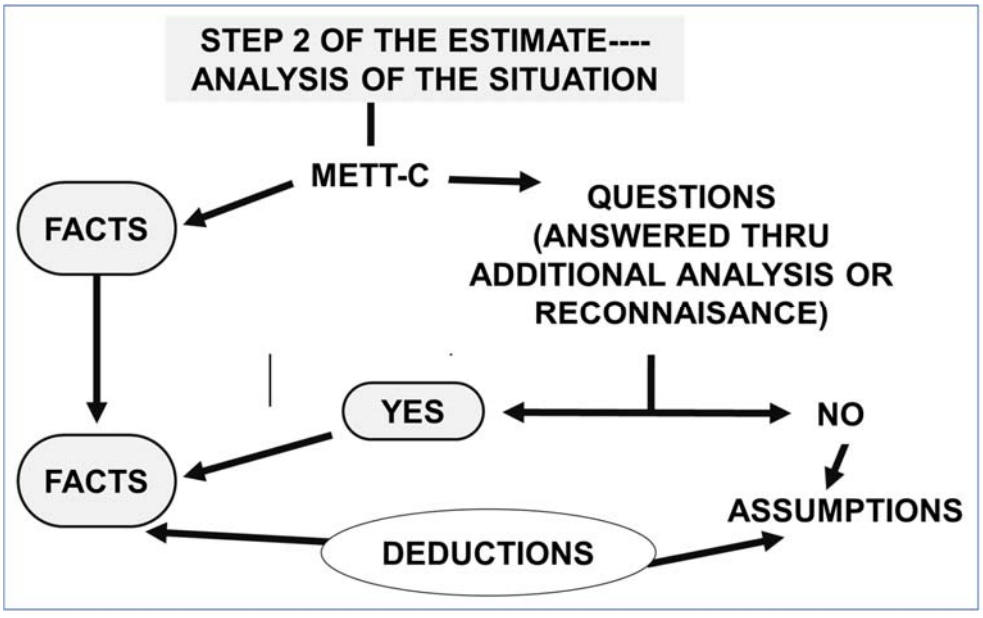


Figure A.1-The Analysis Process

Develop Courses of Action

A course of action is a possible plan that accomplishes the company's mission. It is as detailed as necessary to clearly describe how the unit will accomplish the mission and to allow effective war-gaming later in Step 3 of the estimate. It is generally a scheme of maneuver supported by a COA sketch. It describes the employment of the rifle platoons, the anti-armor and mortar sections, and possibly other significant resources, such as attached units, weapons, or engineer support.

Normally, two or three courses of action are developed; however, the amount of planning time may limit the CO to only one. In this case the XO may assist by also developing a COA and war-gaming the two with the CO. Each COA must be:

a. **Feasible.** It accomplishes the mission and supports the commander's concept.

b. **Reasonable.** The company remains an effective force after completing the mission.

c. **Distinguishable**. It is not just a minor variation of another COA.

During the analysis of the situation, the commander integrates the facts, makes deductions, and analyzes further. Before developing the COAs, he determines the most critical facts and deductions for this mission. These provide greater focus to the COA development process. Examples of these might be:

a. Potential decisive points determined from the integration of the terrain and enemy analysis.

b. Limited planning time requiring an immediate decision and quick execution.

c. A critical ammunition shortage for the machine guns.

d. An identified mistake in positioning of enemy weapons, resulting in a major weakness in his defense.

e. A complete lack of information on the enemy force.

These critical factors, the restated mission statement and the other facts and deductions provide the focus for developing the COAs. Each COA should be developed starting at a potential decisive point. If one has not already been identified, consider the focus of the company's mission statement. If it focuses on:

a. Gaining or retaining ground, then determine what terrain is most important. If key or decisive terrain has been identified, the decisive point is probably on this ground;

b. Enemy destruction, then determine what the enemy's weakness is. This may result from his organization, his doctrine, or his disposition on the ground. There may be a critical unit, weapon, or asset that is of great importance to the enemy. Its destruction will have a decisive effect on the enemy's ability to generate

combat power. A deception task may cause the enemy to react in a way that exposes a weakness. If an obvious weakness is not identified, locate his strengths and plan to avoid these while making an enemy weakness through maneuver or the effect of the company's fires; and

c. Security of a friendly force, then determine the most vulnerable part of the friendly force. Consider how the enemy may attack that unit. Look for the terrain that will provide an advantage to the enemy. Consider the approaches he will use to get to this terrain. From this analysis the CO should be able to identify the area of greatest risk and a potential decisive point: 1) Once the CO has identified his potential decisive point(s), he develops his COAs using the following process; 2) Determine decisive points and times to focus combat power; 3) Determine the results that must be achieved at the decisive points to accomplish the mission; 4) Determine the purposes to be achieved by the main and supporting efforts. (The supporting purposes must be clearly linked to the main effort's assigned purpose); 5) Determine the essential tasks for subordinate units (main and supporting efforts) that achieve these purposes; 6) Task-organize squads to accomplish each mission that has been determined. (The loss of cohesion when moving a squad to another platoon is critical. Normally, platoons do not cross-attach squads.); 7) Assign C2 headquarters. (The platoon headquarters, section leaders, XO, F/Sgt, and other company leaders are used as required.); 8) complete a generic task organization by assigning all organic or attached units; 9) Establish control measures that clarify and support the accomplishment of the platoon's assigned mission. (This may also include critical timings for key events.); 10) Prepare a COA statement and sketch; and 11) Repeat this process for additional courses of action. (Other COAs may begin with a different potential decisive point, or they may concentrate combat power at the same one using different tasks, purposes, positions, and so forth.)

Consider the following while developing courses of action:

a. Where can risk be taken to enable weighting the main effort? What is the likelihood of this action being overwhelmingly decisive?

b. What assets are needed for immediate subordinates to achieve their specific tasks and purposes? Ensure the main effort is resourced first. If insufficient resources remain to ensure the supporting efforts' missions are attainable, change the tasks or modify the purpose. Do not take resources from the main effort to reduce risk in less important areas.

c. Ensure mutual support is achieved. This may be done by the physical positioning of units and weapons in relation to each other, or it may be achieved by the clear linkage of purposes in subordinate's mission statements. Often, during decentralized operations, mutual support between the main and supporting efforts is solely dependent on a clear linkage of purposes in the unit's missions.

What freedom of action do subordinates have? Use control measures (axis, DOA, assault positions, objectives, BPs, sectors, engagement areas, etc.) to synchronize subordinate actions without stifling initiative.

The essential part of the COA, dealing with the actions at the decisive point (normally on the objective), has been completed. There may be additional details required to allow a thorough war game of each COA from start to finish. These may include:

a. Movement prior to the maneuver at the decisive point or following the decisive action.

b. Positioning other assets, such as the CP, mortars, or the company trains, and assigning them missions.

c. Establishing additional fire control measures or signals.

d. Significant soldiers' load decisions such as leaving the rucksacks or company mortars behind for an attack.

e. If these details are not needed to clarify the COA or to allow a complete war-game process, they should not be included at this time because they will complicate the war-game process.

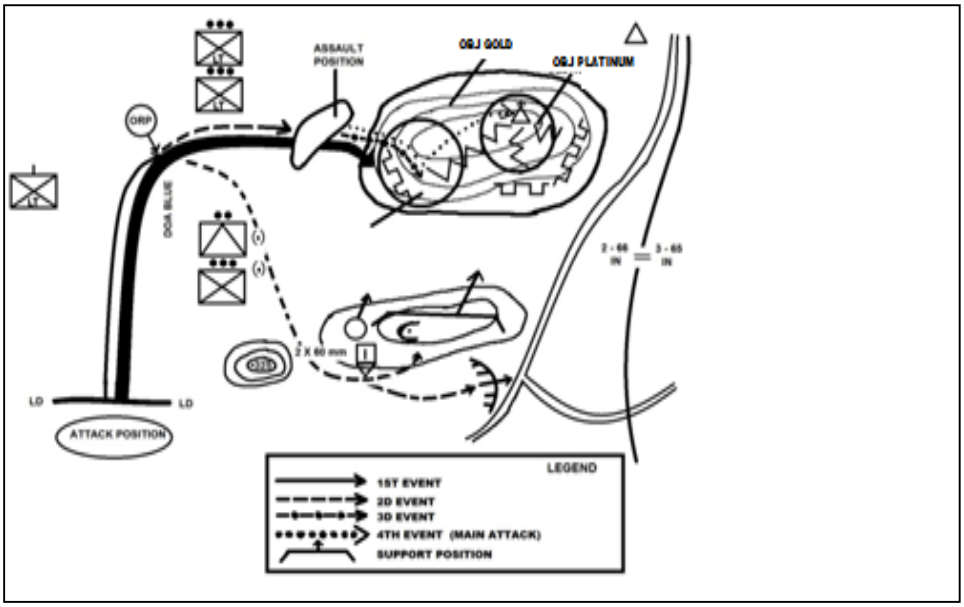


Figure A.2 - Offensive COA Sketch

A sketch of the COA will enhance clarity. The sketch should graphically capture the maneuver aspects of the COA. Proper graphic control measures should be used, but additional graphics may also be used to clarify the COA. When using this sketch as a concept sketch (as part of an OPORD), these nonstandard graphics must be explained in a legend. The following scenarios and Figures 2.3 and 4 show examples of an offensive and a defensive COA statement and sketch.

Offensive Course of Action Situation sample is illustrated in the paragraphs below:

a. **Company Mission Statement**: B Company, 41IB attacks at 190600 MAR 15, to seize high ground at vicinity GC 459270 (OBJ GOLD) to prevent the enemy

from disrupting 21IB's (BDE Main Effort) attack.

b. **COA Statement**: The Company crosses the LD at 0600 along direction of attack BLUE and occupies the ORP. After the leader's reconnaissance, one platoon (2 squads with 60-mm mortars) will occupy support position at vicinity Hill 455 to suppress enemy positions to support the company's seizure of OBJ GOLD. The anti-armor section follows the supporting platoon to checkpoint 1, then it establishes ambush positions vicinity road junction at GC 459260 to isolate OBJ GOLD. The remaining two platoons (with 3 squads each) occupy the assault position. The lead platoon seizes the western enemy squad position (OBJ SILVER) to allow the trail platoon to pass through and seize the decisive terrain. The trail platoon (company main effort) remains in the assault position. On-order, it moves through the lead platoon, seizes the high ground vicinity GC 459270 (OBJ PLATINUM) to disrupt the enemy's command and control and to dominate the remaining squad positions. Then it destroys any enemy remaining in these positions to the south and east to prevent the enemy from disrupting 3-66 IN's attack. The F/Sgt with one infantry squad will follow and support the main effort by resupplying ammunition and evacuating casualties.

Defensive Course of Action Situation Sample is illustrated in the paragraphs below:

a. **Mission Statement**: B Company, 41IB is prepared NLT 281700 JAN 15 to destroy enemy forces from GC 375651 to GC 389650 to GC 394660 to GC 373665 to prevent the envelopment of A Company, 41IB (the BN Main Effort).

b. **COA Statement**: The Company defends with two PLTs forward in sector and 1 PLT in a depth BP. The PLT (2 squads) forward in the north destroys enemy forces to prevent enemy bypass of the main effort PLT. The PLT (3 squads) in sector to the south destroys enemy forces to prevent an organized company attack against the Co main effort. The main effort PLT (3 squads) retains Hill 657 (vic. GC 378659) to prevent the envelopment of A Company (the BN Main Effort) from the south. The anti-armor section establishes ambush positions at the road junction (Vic GC 377653) to destroy enemy vehicles to prevent a concentration of combat power against the main effort PLT. The company mortars locate Vic GC 377664. The anti-armor section initiates fire when the enemy combat reconnaissance patrol reaches the intersection.

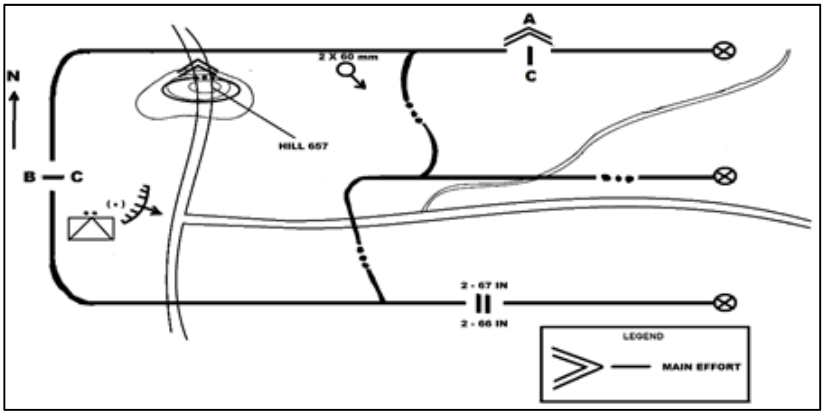


Figure A.3 - Defensive COA Sketch

Step 3 - Analyze the Courses of Action

Step 3 of the estimate is the analysis of courses of action. This analysis is conducted by war-gaming the friendly courses of action against the enemy's most probable courses of action. This step of the estimate ensures the COA is viable and that the CO understands how the fight will take place. It clearly shows where the company is taking risks, when and where decisions may be required, and also the advantages and disadvantages of each courses of action. Do not begin to compare the friendly COAs at this point in the estimate process. The comparison occurs during Step 4.

Basic techniques for conducting the war game include the box, the belt, and the avenue of approach methods. They are explained below:

a. **The Box.** This method is used to focus the war game process on a specific objective, engagement, or critical area of the battlefield. This technique ensures that the war-game process considers the decisive action, but the disadvantage is that other critical actions or events may not be considered;

b. **The Belt.** The leader using the belt technique divides the COA into sections in depth and then war-games each of these belts in sequence. In an offensive war-game the COA can be divided into different phase and war-gamed in sequence. This technique may also be used to war-game a defensive COA. They are described below: 1) Movement from the AA into the ATTACK POSITION, 2) Movement from the LD to the ORP, 3) Actions in the ORP, 4) Deployment prior to the assault, 5) The assault, and 6) Consolidation; and c) The Avenue of Approach. It is most often used to war-game a defensive COA when there are several avenues of approach that must be considered. The leader war-games the selected COA against the enemy's most probable COA by focusing the process on one avenue of approach at a time.

War Game. To war game the friendly COAs against the enemy most probable COA, the CO mentally fights the battle as he expects it to occur. He divides the COAs into a series of actions or events, analyzes each to determine the likely result or reaction, and then considers the likely counteraction. This process of action, reaction, and counteraction continues until the mission is accomplished or the COA fails. An example for war-gaming an offensive and defensive course of action is provided below:

Offensive COA War Game. This is the war game of the offensive COA discussed in the preceding paragraph.

a. First action, the company moves from the AA into the attack position; there is no enemy reaction, but the risk of detection is slight.

b. Second action, the company crosses the LD and moves along DOA BLUE; there is moderate risk of enemy reaction and if detected, the enemy may engage with indirect fires; To achieve friendly counteraction there must be suppression of known enemy position (Vic Hill 325) and suspected enemy position (Vic GC 423243); there can be a break contact but must continue movement on DOA BLUE to the ORP.

c. Third action, the ORP can be occupied; there is no enemy reaction.

d. Fourth action, leaders can conduct reconnaissance; enemy reaction, if detected, will increase the security on his perimeter and possibly increase his patrolling; friendly counteraction options include completion of the reconnaissance, immediate initiation of the artillery preparation and execution of the tentative plan, or movement to the alternate ORP and issue a FRAGO.

e. Fifth action, there must be support and security elements that moves into position. The company (-) occupies the assault position. If the enemy detects the company, his options include engaging with direct and indirect fires, repositioning soldiers or vehicles within his perimeter, or withdrawing to an alternate position. Friendly counteraction can be initiated during the assault once the support element is in position.

f. Sixth action, the support element initiates fires with the lead platoon breaching the wire. Enemy returns direct fire on the support element. Company must request indirect fires (total - 2 minutes, if we are on his planned targets; 5-7 minutes, if we have avoided them.) Once detected, the breach site will be the enemy leader's main concern. The close-in support element (with the breaching platoon) suppresses the two enemy positions in vicinity of the breach. If the breach is unsuccessful due to reinforcement by the enemy eastern squad, the breaching platoon will maintain pressure here while the trail platoon moves to the alternate breach site (vicinity of the enemy's vacated eastern squad position), to conduct a breach and clear toward the enemy CP. On-order, the lead platoon will disengage and follow through the alternate breach site.

g. Seventh action, the lead PLT seizes its objective and begins to pass through the trail PLT (main effort). Enemy presence can opt the CO to reposition the soldiers, committing his reserve, withdrawing from this position, or counterattacking with another unit. Friendly counteraction can be done by continuing the attack.

h. Eighth action the main effort platoon seizes the dominant terrain and destroys the enemy CP. Both platoons clear their objectives. Enemy withdraws or waits for outside assistance. His remaining positions are dominated by the high ground seized by the main effort. There is no friendly counteraction.

Defensive Course of Action War Game. This is a war game for the Defensive COA discussed in the preceding paragraph).

a. First action, the enemy divisional or regimental reconnaissance assets arrive in the company sector. Security forces engage with direct and indirect fires. If the reconnaissance unit was destroyed, the enemy may send other assets to replace them. If not destroyed, they will withdraw and attempt to bypass.

b. Second action, the enemy CRP enters the company sector. Forward platoons report situation. Confirm enemy most probable COA. Anti-armor section prepares to initiate ambush at intersection. There is no possibility of enemy counteraction unless the CRP detects the forward platoons or prior

reconnaissance has located the company's positions. If so, the enemy will use indirect fires while the CRP determines the company's dispositions.

c. Third action, the anti-armor section initiates ambush on the CRP. Forward platoons engage enemy in sectors with direct and indirect fires. Enemy seeks cover and reports. Lead companies deploy, return fire, and attempt to fight through forward platoons. Indirect fires called on any friendly concentrations located. Friendly counteraction must be avoided in decisive engagements and dispersed formation must be maintained.

d. Fourth action, the main effort platoon engages enemy south of hill 657. Priority of fires shifts to the main effort. Enemy will attempt to concentrate against the main effort by firing with direct and indirect fires. Then he conducts a flank attack with dismounted infantry and repositions indirect assets (AGSs and BN mortars) to support this attack. Forward platoons engage following forces to disrupt the attack against the main effort. Destroy/disrupt C2 and CS assets as they move into sector. Request CAS on enemy concentrating south of Hill 657. (Preplanned CAS mission.)

e. Fifth action, the enemy assault against the main effort platoon. The enemy second echelon battalion may begin moving through forward platoon sectors. Friendly reaction will depend on the combat potential the enemy has positioned to support the assault. Possibly issue a FRAGO to the anti-armor section and the platoon (-) in the northern sector to reorient against the enemy attacking the main effort. Arrival of a second echelon battalion indicates the enemy main attack is in our sector. This is a change to the enemy most probable COA requiring a FRAGO by battalion.

f. Sixth action, the main effort successfully retains Hill 657. Remnants of the attacking unit occupy defensive positions vicinity Hill 657 to reorganize and prepare to assault again or support another unit's assault. If the lead battalion is unsuccessful, it is unlikely that the second echelon battalion will be committed in this sector. A FRAGO can be issues to focus all available combat power to destroy this enemy force before he can reorganize. The main effort is unsuccessful in retaining Hill 657. If the enemy attack is successful, he will reorganize and continue the attack. Depending on his losses, he may pass through another company at this time. The main effort platoon withdraws to a rally point in the restricted terrain, reorganizes, and interdicts enemy moving north. Forward platoons continue to destroy enemy in sector. The company reports the situation to battalion and continues to operate to disrupt enemy forces moving through sector.

g. Seventh action, the company exploits success of the main effort even if the main effort did not retain Hill 657, the enemy combat potential is degraded and his momentum disrupted. Concentrate combat power against enemy weaknesses exposed throughout the company sector, such as isolated enemy positions, C2 and CS assets. Enemy will attempt to reorganize to continue the attack. Maintenance of pressure on the enemy throughout the depth of his unit can be done by using artillery, mortars, and CAS against enemy’s strengths.

Information Learned. Upon completing the war game of each COA, the leader should know its advantages and disadvantages. He also has identified any critical events that will determine the success or failure of each COA. These factors are used during Step 4 to compare the COAS. In addition, the commander now has a much greater appreciation for the conduct of this mission. The CO will use this information later as he expands the selected COA into the tentative plan for his company.

Step 4 - Compare the Courses of Action

At Step 4 in the estimate process, the CO compares the COAs and selects the one that is most likely to accomplish the assigned mission. The CO considers the advantages and disadvantages for each COA. He also considers how the critical events impact on each COA. He then selects the significant factors based on the mission; and the COAs are then compared using these factors. The CO may also compare the COAs using only the advantages and disadvantages for each COA. This method is more subjective than using the significant factors that are common to all COAs.

Advantages and Disadvantages. These are the specific strengths and weaknesses that were noted during the war-game process. They may pertain to the mission, the terrain, the enemy, or any other aspect of the operation. They may apply to just one COA or to all of them.

Examples of advantages include:

a. Uses the most covered and concealed routes.

b. Allows extra time for the leader's reconnaissance.

c. Supports the reduction of the soldier's loads.

d. Provides an excellent chance of surprise.

e. Limits the risk on the secondary approach.

Examples of disadvantages include:

a. High risk of detection by the enemy's OP.

b. Mortar ammunition requirements increase the soldier's loads.

c. Time constraint requires daylight movement.

d. Does not attack the enemy’s weakest point.

Critical Events. In every operation, there are certain events or activities that will have a major impact on the success of the mission. These may have been identified during the mission analysis, the analysis of the situation, or the war-game process. Normally at company level, these critical events will apply to each COA. The significant factors for the comparison will often result from these critical events. Examples of possible critical events include:

a. A forward passage of lines.

b. Crossing a major stream en route to the objective.

c. Breaching the protective obstacles.

d. Gaining a foothold on the objective.

e. Evacuating the casualties.

f. Defeating the enemy's reconnaissance.

g. Controlling the unit's fires into an engagement area.

Significant Factors. These are common factors that provide the focus for comparing each COA. They are selected for each tactical mission based on mission accomplishment. These factors are significant because they impact directly on the success of the mission. A long list reduces the importance of the most significant factors; therefore, the CO should limit the number of factors to a manageable number. Normally three to seven factors will provide a good comparison. There are two basic types of significant factors, mission-specific and general.

Mission-specific Factors. These are generated from the requirements for a specific mission. They are often determined by the critical events identified during the war-game process. They may also result from the advantages and disadvantages for each COA. Examples include:

a. Casualty evacuation.

b. Soldier's load.

c. Effectiveness in accomplishing the mission.

d. Time usage.

General Factors. These are for the employment of infantry in all operations. They include the Principles of War, BOS, the risk involved, the characteristics of the offense or defense, and other such doctrinal guidelines. Although these apply in every tactical operation, certain ones are more important to the mission at hand. The CO determines which of these and then lists them as significant factors for this mission. Examples include:

a. Security.

b. Simplicity.

c. Surprise.

d. Exploitation of enemy weaknesses.

e. Risk.

f. Disruption of the enemy attack.

g. Concentration at the decisive point.

h. Use of limited visibility.

i. Employment of key weapons.

Decision Matrix. Once the CO has selected the significant factors, he must decide which COA supports each factor the best. The CO compares the COAs using each factor and then makes his decision. A more detailed technique involves a simple, COA decision matrix. This may be required when there are too many factors for the CO to compare. It is important that the CO uses significant factors from his estimate of the situation to develop the matrix. Mission specific factors are used as much as possible. Figure 2.9 provides an example of a COA decision matrix.

There are several ways to use this matrix. The simplest way is to give a + to the COA which best supports each factor. All other COAs would receive a -. Another way is to rank in order each COA for each factor. The best COA for each factor receives a 1, next best a 2, and the COA that supports the factor the least would receive a 3. The COA with the lowest sum supports the significant factors best.

FACTORS	Course of Actions		
	COA #1	COA #2	COA #3
Surprise		•	
Flexibility	•		
Speed			•
Combat Power at the Decisive Point		•	
Use of Key Terrain	•		
Soldier's Load		•	
TOTAL	2	3	1

Figure A.4 - Course of action decision matrix.

Step 5 - Make a Decision and Complete the Plan

Step 5 of the estimate process involves making the decision and completing the plan. The CO selects the COA that he believes has the best chance of accomplishing the mission. The results of the comparison in Step 4 assist him in making this decision, but they do-not make it for him. The CO may not select the COA that the decision matrix indicates is the best. There may be factors that were not included in the matrix but now have a significant impact on the mission.

The focus of this process is to generate overwhelming combat power at the decisive point. To do this, the CO positions his units and weapons, assigns those tasks and

purposes, allocates resources, designates control measures, and synchronizes activities. He refers back to the deductions from his estimate to complete his plan. To complete the tentative plan, the CO begins with the COA selected at Step 5 of the estimate. He expands this COA into a complete five-paragraph OPORD. The OPORD format is a guide for deciding what information is required to complete the plan.

Task Organization. The generic task organization from the COA is the basis for this paragraph (some changes may have resulted from the war-game process). The CO refers to the task organization in the battalion order and ensures all assets under his control are included in his plan. The CO takes the generic task organization from the COA and develops a specific task organization that assigns squads and weapons to each of his platoons. An example of a company task organization follows:

1st PLT(-)	2nd PLT	3rd PLT
AA SEC	Co Control 60-mm Sec 1/1st PLT	

Enemy Situation. The enemy situation in the BN OPORD (paragraph la) is the basis for this, but the CO refined this to provide the detail required by his subordinates. The CO considers the results of his enemy analysis to determine the information he includes in his paragraph la. This may include the enemy's composition, disposition, strength, recent activities, and capabilities. He also includes the enemy's most probable COA, which was used in the war-game process. A sketch or enemy overlay should be included (SP 3-014, 2005).

Friendly Situation. This information is found in paragraphs 1b, 2, and 3 in the BN OPORD. The BN mission and concept are stated in paragraphs 2 and 3a respectively. The units adjacent to the company (left, right, front, and rear) are found on the operations overlay. Their mission statements are found in both paragraph 1b (adjacent BNs) and 3a (adjacent companies). Units supporting the company will be found in the battalion task organization and in paragraphs 1b (external to the BN) and paragraph 3 (BN assets).

Mission Statement. The company mission statement was determined at Step 1 of the estimate. It is normally clearly stated in paragraph 3 of the BN OPORD.

Concept of Operation. This paragraph describes how the CO intends to accomplish his mission. At company level, a maneuver and fires subparagraph will always be included. When needed to clarify the concept or to ensure synchronization, additional subparagraphs, such as engineering and intelligence operations may be included. The operations overlay or concept sketch is referenced here.

Maneuver. The maneuver paragraph should be focused on the decisive action. It may, however, describe the maneuver throughout the operation. At company level, a maneuver paragraph that assigns the missions to each platoon/section and identifies the main effort normally requires no additional clarification. When additional information is required to clarify the concept, the CO may insert this information in the concept of operation paragraph. Information such as movement formations and techniques, or the

order of movement, should only be included if it clarifies the concept. Normally, the coordinating instructions paragraph is the appropriate location for this type of information.

Fires. This paragraph describes how the CO intends the fires to support his maneuver. The company FSO may prepare this paragraph based on the CO's guidance. This paragraph normally states the purpose to be achieved by the fires, the priority of fires for the company, and the allocation of any priority targets. A target list or overlay maybe referenced here. Specific tasking for the company mortars should only be stated here if they clarify the concept of operation.

Engineering. Often, especially in defensive operations, this paragraph is required to clarify the CO's concept for preparing obstacles, IEDs and fortifications. When an engineer equipment or unit supports the company, the CO would state his guidance for employing these assets. He may do this by stating the priority of effort (survivability, counter mobility, and mobility) and the priority of support for his subordinates (3rd PLT, 1st PLT, AA section, 2nd PLT, mortar section, and the CP).

Tasks to Maneuver Units. This paragraph lists the tasks or limitations for each of the platoons and sections. Each of these subordinate units will have a separate paragraph. The information included here comes from two sources the tasks and limitations identified during the mission analysis or from the war game process.

The tasks from the mission analysis may require only one subordinate unit to complete them. In this case, the CO decides which unit should do this task and assigns it. Examples of these tasks are listed below:

a. Provide one squad to carry ammunition for the battalion mortar platoon.

b. Establish an OP at GC 233876 NLT 231000H FEB 15.

Others may require two or more subordinate units or even the entire company to comply with them. In this case, the CO would list these tasks or limitations in the coordinating instructions. Most of these requirements result from the war game of the COA. They include:

a. How to synchronize the operation.

b. How to secure the company throughout the operation.

c. How to concentrate the combat potential at decisive points.

d. How to manage the soldier's load.

e. How to degrade the enemy's combat potential.

To accomplish each of these requirements, the CO assigns specific tasking to each of his units. He also assigns specific limitations to certain subordinates. These may be listed here or noted on the company operations overlay or concept sketch.

Tasks to Combat Support Units. The 60-mm mortar section and other CS units (engineers, FA and so forth) are addressed here.

Coordinating Instructions. These are requirements that apply to two or more subordinate units. These also may have been assigned by battalion or required based on the COA developed by the company CO. If they do not apply to all the subordinate units, then clearly state those units that must comply. Examples might be:

a. The company time schedule.

b. 2nd and 3rd PLT will each carry 30 mortar rounds.

c. The consolidation plan.

d. The BN rehearsal is at 211500 JAN 15.

Service Support. This paragraph provides the critical logistical information required to sustain the company during the operation. Most of this information is extracted from the battalion OPORD. There are also certain requirements generated from the company commander's concept. These may include:

a. The location for the company trains.

b. The casualty evacuation plan.

c. Instructions for caching rucksacks, supplies, or other equipment.

d. The re-supply plan.

Command and Signal. This paragraph states where the C2 facilities and key personnel will be located during the operation. It includes the following information from the BN OPORD that subordinates require:

a. Locations for the BN main CP and the command group;

b. Critical communication requirements, such as radio listening silence in effect forward of the LD; and

c. Signals for specific events or actions. The company concept will have similar requirements for the company commander to include. The tentative plan should stand-alone and have essential information so that it can be issued and executed if time does not permit physical reconnaissance to verify. These may include: 1) The locations for the CO or CP, and the XO, 2) Adjustments to the unit SOP, such as a change on the succession of command or the standard PZ markings, 3) Emergency or visual signals for critical actions, and 3) Signal information.

METT-TC Analysis

The factors of METT-TC guide the leader through the estimate process. Although the first factor is mission analysis, the next factor analyzed should be the terrain, not the

enemy. By understanding the terrain prior to the enemy analysis, the leader will have a better appreciation for the enemy's capabilities and limitations.

Analyze the Terrain

The leader considers the terrain from both his viewpoint and from the enemy's. The battalion assigns the company its area of operations. If there is terrain or enemy units outside the assigned AO that could impact on the mission, the leader must be concerned with them. This terrain, including the area of operations, is called the area of interest. The leader conducts a detailed terrain analysis of this area. The acronym OCOKA provides the significant military aspects of the terrain. These factors are described below.

Obstacles. Identify the existing and reinforcing obstacles and hindering terrain that will affect mobility. When time permits, a combined obstacle overlay is developed to graphically depict the mobility capability of the terrain. Figure 2.6 shows an example of a combined obstacle overlay. All terrain is evaluated and coded as:

a. Unrestricted

b. Restricted

c. Severely Restricted

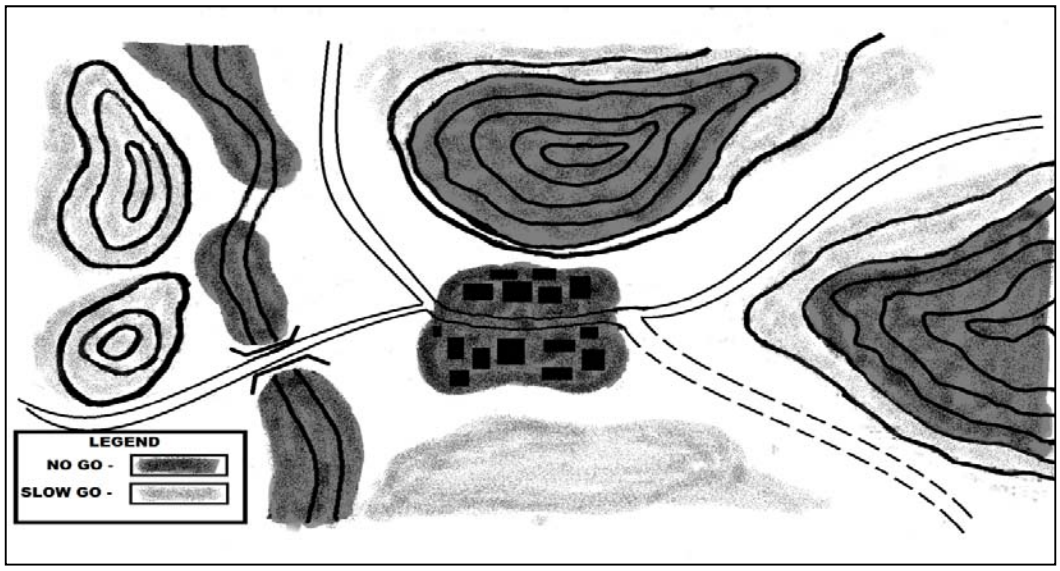


Figure A.5 - Combined Obstacle Overlay

Unrestricted terrain is fairly open terrain that presents no problem to ground movement.

Restricted terrain hinders ground movement to a lesser degree than Severely Restricted terrain. Little effort is needed to enhance mobility. (Example: sparsely vegetated forests and fordable streams.)

Severely Restricted terrain is impractical for the type of force being considered to move

through it. Severely Restricted terrain does not always mean that units cannot pass through that terrain, but only that the speed of movement will be substantially reduced unless considerable effort is expended to enhance mobility (Example: non-fordable stream and slopes of greater than 45 degrees for mounted movement). With mounted forces, this would mean substantial engineer support.

The following are some of the offensive considerations for obstacles:

a. How is the enemy using these obstacles?

b. How will these obstacles affect my movement?

c. Where are the weapons/units that are covering these obstacles?

d. How can the company avoid these obstacles?

Defensive considerations for obstacles include:

a. How will the existing obstacles affect the enemy?

b. How do the existing obstacles support my mission?

Avenues of Approach. Avenues of approach are developed next and identified one level down. These are areas through which a unit can maneuver. Normally, they are thought of in terms of mounted movement, but they can be applied to dismounted movement as well. Both mounted and dismounted avenues of approach must be identified. When selecting them, the commander uses tactical judgment with respect to the type of unit to be used. They traverse unrestricted terrain, bypass severely restricted terrain, and occasionally pass through or over restricted terrain. They are considered for both the enemy and friendly units. As such, a doctrinal width guideline for a platoon is 250 meters, a company is 500 meters, and a battalion is 1,500 meters. Aerial and subterranean avenues must also be considered.

The following are some of the offensive considerations for avenues of approach:

a. How can these avenues support my movement?

b. What are the advantages/disadvantages of each? (Consider enemy, speed, cover, and concealment.)

c. What are the likely enemy counterattack routes?

Defensive considerations for avenues of approach:

a. How can the enemy use these approaches?

b. Which avenue is most dangerous? Or, least? (Prioritize each approach.)

c. Which avenues would support a counterattack?

Key Terrain. Key terrain is any location or area that the seizure, retention, or control of affords a marked advantage to either combatant. The retention or seizure of decisive terrain is necessary for accomplishment of the mission. During the war game process, other terrain may be identified as potentially key or decisive, based on likely changes in the situation. These locations are important during the development of COAS.

The following are some of the offensive considerations for key terrain:

a. Is the enemy controlling the key terrain? How?

b. How does this terrain affect my mission?

c. How can I gain control of this terrain?

Defensive considerations of key terrain include:

a. What advantage do I gain by controlling the key terrain?

b. How can the enemy gain control of this terrain?

Observation and Fields of Fire. Determine locations that provide the best observation and fields of rare along the approaches, near the objective, or on key terrain. Determine the potential of friendly or enemy forces to overmatch or support (with direct fire) the movement of their forces, and to observe movement along the avenue of approach and place fire on it from various positions on the terrain. The analysis of fields of fire is mainly concerned with the ability to cover the terrain with direct fire. Positions with good observation for the FIST personnel are also identified. Look at the capability of direct fire weapons from likely or known positions. Reconnaissance from the enemy's viewpoint is most effective when conducting a defensive analysis. Determine where fires may be concentrated.

The following are some of the offensive considerations for observation and fields of fire:

a. What are the fields of fires and observation for enemy weapons on or near the objective? Or en-route?

b. Is there any dead space around the objective? Or, on the approaches into it?

c. What are the fields of fires and observation from likely support positions?

d. Where can the enemy concentrate fires? Where is he less able to concentrate his fires?

Defensive considerations of observation and fields of fire include:

a. What locations provide good fires and observation on the enemy approaches?

b. How obvious are these positions to the enemy?

c. Determine possible locations for the key weapons (M60 MGs, mortars).

Cover and Concealment. The analysis of cover and concealment is often inseparable from the fields of fires and observation. Weapon positions must have both to be effective and to be survivable. Infantry units are capable of improving poor cover and concealment by digging in and camouflaging their positions. When moving, the terrain is used to provide cover and concealment.

The following are some of the offensive considerations for cover and concealment:

a. Determine the routes with good cover and concealment.

b. Identify areas along the approaches to the objective with poor cover and concealment.

c. Consider the use of smoke missions/limited visibility to provide concealment.

Defensive considerations for cove and concealment include:

a. Focus on the locations with good fields of fires.

b. Think about how the enemy can use the available cover and concealment.

Analyze the Weather

Weather factors as terrain has primary emphasis on temperature/humidity, precipitation, wind, cloud cover and visibility. Light data is considered as part of cloud cover and visibility. The commander focuses on how the weather affects the terrain, equipment, and soldiers of both forces.

Terrain. The terrain is most affected by rain, or cold temperatures. UNRESTRICTED terrain may become SEVERELY RESTRICTED terrain after a heavy rain because it will no longer support vehicle movement. Freezing this same terrain may revert it to GO terrain if it will now support vehicles. The frozen ground may prevent digging fighting positions.

Equipment. The temperature and humidity can change the amount of maintenance required to keep equipment operating. Batteries may not last as long. The soldiers' clothing and boots wear out faster under some conditions.

Vehicles. Aviation assets are grounded by a number of weather conditions. Vehicles freeze to the ground or fail to start in extreme cold. Hot and dusty conditions increase the maintenance needs.

Weapons. The operation and maintenance of weapons are affected by extreme temperatures. Even if the weapon is not affected, the capability to acquire targets may be severely degraded. High winds affect the accuracy of all projectiles particularly indirect fires.

Soldiers. The spirit and morale of the soldiers are affected by the conditions they fight in. In winter zones, more energy and resources maybe spent on just surviving the elements than fighting the enemy. Non-battle casualties may outnumber the battle casualties.

Analyze the Enemy

The companycommander begins his enemy analysis from the information provided by the battalion. The important enemy information is provided to the company commander in paragraph la of the OPORD in which the CO must accept as accurate information because it is the basis of battalion commander's concept.

The end result of the enemy analysis should be a detailed statement of the enemy's most probable COA. At this point, the commander analyzes the enemy's composition, disposition, recent activities, reinforcement capabilities, possible courses of action, and weaknesses.

Composition. This is an analysis of the forces and weapons that the enemy can bear on the friendly forces. Determine his strength, what available weapons systems he has, and what additional weapons and units are supporting him. The CO must know the enemy's weapons as well as his own. It is this detailed knowledge of the specific characteristics for each weapon that allows the leader to pinpoint the enemy's weaknesses.

Disposition. The enemy's disposition is how he is arrayed on the terrain; whether in defensive positions, assembly area, or moving in formation. Use enemy doctrinal templates to develop situational templates. When analyzing situational templates, search for his weak points that can be exploited to destroy him or to control the decisive ground. Consider where he is accepting risk and where the terrain limits his ability to defend, attack, or gain mutual support. Finally, determine what his intentions are.

Recent Activities. Identify recent and significant enemy activities that may indicate future intentions. These activities may point out a weakness that the company can exploit. They may also provide a better understanding of what the enemy is likely to do in reaction to the Company. This will result in a more effective war-game process.

Reinforcement Capabilities. Determine positions for reserves and estimated time to counterattack or reinforce. Although the enemy analysis must focus on the enemy force on the company's objective or expected in the company's sector, the CO should consider all enemy forces in his area of interest in order to fully understand how the enemy he is confronting with fits into the larger enemy force.

Possible Courses of Actions. Determine the enemy's possible COAs. Analyzing these COAs can prevent being surprised by the enemy during execution. Determine the enemy's most likely COA while using other possible COAs to develop contingency plans or security tasking.

Develop a narrative description and sketch of the enemy COA from start to finish. Below are examples of enemy COAs:

a. "The enemy will continue to defend with one platoon in a deliberate

defense at Vic HILL 482 oriented to the north and west with two squads and two MGs oriented north overlooking a mounted avenue of approach. The platoon CP is on the topographical crest of Hill 482 and there are between 20 and 30 personnel in this position. A minefield is located NW of the position at the bottom of the hill. The confirmed OP is rotated every 8 hours. An OP is positioned vicinity of HILL 524. Suspected OP locations are at the trail intersection NW of the platoon and on the trail SW of the platoon. "We can expect the enemy platoon to retain its position to prevent its enemy platoon to retain its position to prevent its parent company from being enveloped from the NW. If forced to withdraw, he will most likely move to the SE where there are supporting fires from the parent company. The platoon position with up to 20 men in 20 minutes could be reinforced by the company." (Figure 2.6 is a situational template of this enemy position).

b. "The enemy will attack NLT 020800 FEB 15 to seize the high ground vicinity HILL 464 with two companies conducting the main attack in pre battle formation along avenue of C, and one company (-) as follow-on support. Artillery concentrations will be fired on HILL 464 as he crosses PL BLUE. Smokes will be used as screens. After seizing these objectives, the enemy will continue to attack to seize objectives along to battalion rear boundary. At PL BLUE, the main body will assume attack formation to seize their objective. Specific objectives for the main body will most likely be at the intersection at GC 123456 and HILL 464. I expect that within 24 hours recon elements will be in our sector."

> **NOTE***: In addition to a narrative COA statement for the enemy, the commander develops a situational template of how he expects the enemy COA to look. For example, in the offense, a company commander develops a situational template that depicts enemy squads and their fighting positions, individual vehicles, AT weapons, and crew-served weapons. In the defense, the attacking enemy should be template down to platoon level. His R&S activities, artillery targets, C2 assets, and obstacles should be template. Also consider how he may employ smoke, chemical agents, CAS, and deception to support his operation.*

Weaknesses. Identify the enemy weaknesses. Others may result from the war-game process. Determine how to exploit these weaknesses.

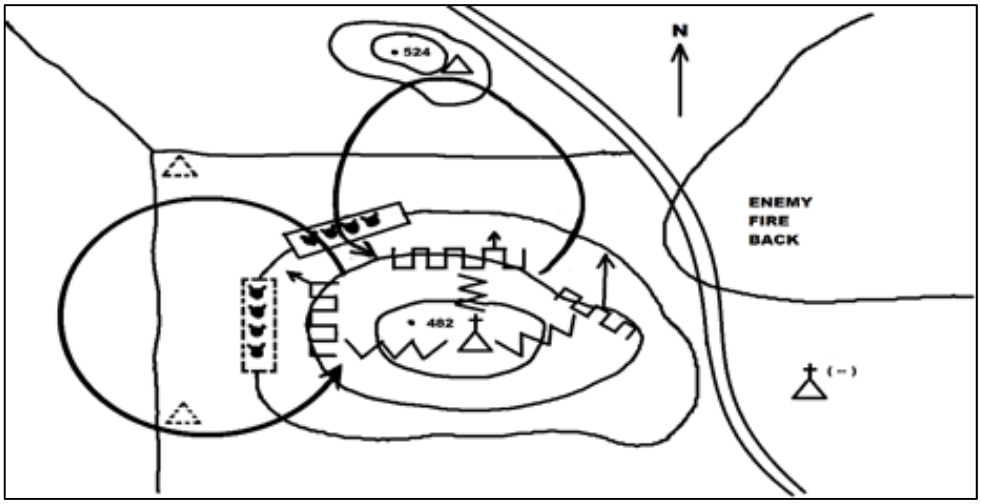


Figure A.6 - Enemy Situational Template

Analyze Troops Available

The CO analyzes the troops available to him in order to ensure that he knows the current status of his company. He also considers the friendly situation to determine how adjacent and supporting units may affect his mission. The purpose of this step is to identify all available resources and to identify any new limitations resulting from recent fighting. The CO considers his current location, disposition, supply status, and personnel strength. He is particularly concerned with losses to key leaders and weapons, ammunition status, and the morale of his men. He considers the capability of any attached or supporting units and determines the impact of the company's priority in the battalion's fire priorities. Other considerations include:

a. The location of the battalion trains and aid station.

b. The locations for the battalion main CP and command group.

Analyze the Time

The commander continuously updates his initial estimate of time and the time schedule. He considers the times specified in the battalion order and any other key times that may have resulted from his analysis of the situation. The deductions derived will assist in synchronizing subordinate units. The CO evaluates time and space considerations (the consideration for how specific units will move in a given situation, the time required, the formations used, and so forth) throughout the estimate.

Analyze Civil Considerations

Civil considerations include the influences of man-made infrastructure, civilian institutions and the attitudes and activities of civilian leaders, populations, and organizations within an AO, with regard to the conduct of military operations. Civil considerations generally focus on the immediate impact of civilians on operations in progress. Civil considerations of the environment can either help or hinder friendly or enemy forces; the difference lies in which leader has taken time to learn the situation and its possible effects on the operation. Analysis of civil considerations answers three critical questions:

a. How do civilian considerations affect the operation?

b. How does the operation affect the civilians?

c. How do our forces build national will in our AO?

The higher headquarters provides the leader with civil considerations that may affect the next echelon's mission. The memory aid the higher headquarters may use to analyze and describe these civil considerations is ASCOPE.

Initiate Movement

The company commander initiates any movement necessary to continue mission preparation or to posture the unit for the start of the mission. This step can be executed

at any time throughout the sequence of the TLP. This may include movement to an assembly area, a battle position, a new area of operation, or the movement of guides or quartering parties.

Conduct Reconnaissance

Reconnaissance is a continuous activity during TLP. A thorough tentative plan can provide specific R&S guidance that can be given to subordinate units. In every tactical operation the CO requires additional information, and at the same time, he must deny the enemy information about his company. Leaders use the results of the war-gaming to identify information requirements. Reconnaissance operations seek to confirm or deny information that supports the tentative plan. They focus first on information gaps identified during mission analysis. Army leaders ensure their leader's reconnaissance complements the higher headquarters reconnaissance plan. The unit may conduct additional reconnaissance operations as the situation allows. This step may also precede making a tentative plan if there is not enough information available to begin planning. Reconnaissance may be the only way to develop the information required for planning.

Complete the Plan

During this step, the company commander incorporates the result of reconnaissance into their selected COA to complete the plan or order. This includes preparing overlays, refining the indirect fire target list, coordinating combat service support and command and control requirements, and updating the tentative plan as a result of the reconnaissance. At lower levels, this step may entail only confirming or updating information contained in the tentative plan. If time allows, Army leaders make final coordination with adjacent units and higher headquarters before issuing the order.

Issue the Order

Small unit orders are normally issued verbally and supplemented by graphics and other control measures. The order follows the standard five-paragraph OPORD format. The ideal location for issuing the order is a point in the AO with a view of the objective and other aspects of the terrain. The leader may perform a leader's reconnaissance, complete the order, and then summon subordinates to a specified location to receive it. Sometimes security or other constraints make it infeasible to issue the order on the terrain; then Army leaders use a sand table, detailed sketch, maps, and other products to depict the AO and situation.

Supervise and Refine

This final step of the TLP is crucial. Throughout TLP, leaders monitor mission preparations, refine the plan, perform coordination with adjacent units, and supervise and assess preparations. Normally, unit SOPs state individual responsibilities and the sequence of preparation activities. Leaders supervise subordinates and inspect their personnel and equipment to ensure the unit is ready for the mission. A crucial component of preparation is the rehearsal. Rehearsals allow leaders to assess their subordinates' preparations. They may identify areas that require more supervision. Leaders conduct rehearsals to:

a. Practice essential tasks.

b. Identify weaknesses or problems in the plan.

c. Coordinate subordinate element actions.

d. Improve soldier understanding of the concept of operations; and,

e. Foster confidence among soldiers.

The following are the company and smaller sized units' five types of rehearsals:

a. **Confirmation brief.** Immediately after receiving the order, subordinate leaders brief their superior on the order they just received. They brief their understanding of the commander's intent, the specific tasks they have been assigned and their purposes, and the relationship of their tasks to those of other elements conducting the operation. They repeat any important coordinating measures specified in the order. The confirmation brief is normally used with other types of rehearsal.

b. **Back-brief.** The back-brief differs from the confirmation brief in that subordinate leaders are given time to complete their plan. Back-briefs require the fewest resources and are often the only option under time-constrained conditions. Subordinate leaders explain their actions from start to finish of the mission. Back-briefs are performed sequentially, with all leaders going over their tasks. When time is available, back-briefs can be combined with other types of rehearsals. Doing this lets all element leaders coordinate their plans before performing more elaborate drills. If possible, back-briefs are performed overlooking subordinates' AOs, after they have developed their own plans.

c. **Combined arms rehearsal.** Combined arms rehearsal requires considerable resources, but provides the most planning and training benefit. Depending on circumstances, units may conduct a reduced force. Unit leaders and other key individuals may perform a reduced force rehearsal, while most of their subordinates continue to prepare for the operation. Leaders not only explain their plans, but also walk through their actions or move replicas through a "rock drill." Leaders rehearse their subordinates on terrain similar to the AO, initially under good light conditions, and then in limited visibility. Small unit actions are repeated until executed to standard. Full dress rehearsals help soldiers gain confidence in their ability to accomplish the mission. Supporting elements, such as aviation crews, meet soldiers, rehearse with them and synchronize their operation. The unit may conduct full dress rehearsals and may be supported by the higher headquarters.

d. **Support rehearsal.** At any point in TLP, units may rehearse their support for an operation. For small units, this typically involves coordination and procedure drills for aviation, fire, combat service, engineer support, or causality evacuation. Support rehearsals and combined arms rehearsals complement preparations for the operation. They may be conducted separately and then combined into full dress rehearsals.

e. **Battle drill or SOP rehearsal.** A battle drill is a collective action rapidly executed without applying a deliberate decision making process. A battle drill or SOP rehearsal ensures that all participants understand a technique or a specific set of procedures. Throughout preparation, units rehearse battle drills and SOP actions. These rehearsals do not need a completed order from higher headquarters. Army leaders place priority on those drills or actions they anticipate occurring during the operation. For example, a transportation platoon may rehearse a battle drill on reacting to an ambush while awaiting the movement order. (Note: This section is just an overview. Please refer to FC 3-0151 for the complete detailed process of the battle drills).

Annex B
Infantry Rifle Company Techniques, Tactics and Procedure on the Conduct of Reconnaissance

Every company commander uses visual observation or other methods in order to gain information about the activities and resources of enemy forces or the physical characteristics of a particular area. This refers to reconnaissance. It should be a focused collection effort, aimed at gathering timely and accurate information about the enemy and the terrain in the area of operations.

Categories

The company commander develops the enemy situation through active and passive reconnaissance. Passive reconnaissance includes techniques such as map, photographic and surveillance. Active methods include ground reconnaissance and reconnaissance by fire. Active reconnaissance operations are also classified as stealthy or aggressive, as discussed in the following paragraphs.

a. Stealthy Reconnaissance. Although this type of reconnaissance is time-consuming compared to aggressive reconnaissance, this allows the unit to avoid detection and engagement by the enemy.

b. Aggressive Reconnaissance. Aggressive reconnaissance uses both direct and indirect fires and movement to develop the situation and is characterized by the speed and manner in which the reconnaissance element develops the situation once contact is made with an enemy force.

Types

In addition to reconnaissance performed as part of another type of operation, three types of reconnaissance are conducted as distinct operations.

Route Reconnaissance. This can be oriented on a specific area of movement (road or trail, or on a more general area, like an axis of advance) that is a directed effort to get detailed information on a specific route as well as on all terrain where the enemy could influence movement along that route.

Zone Reconnaissance. This is conducted when the enemy situation is vague, or when the company needs information about cross-country traffic ability to get detailed information about all routes, terrain, enemy forces, and obstacles, including areas of chemical and radiological contamination, within specified boundaries. METT-TC dictates the company's actions with the following critical components of the operation:

a. Find and report all enemy forces within one.

b. Reconnoiter specific terrain within the zone.

c. Report all reconnaissance information.

Area Reconnaissance. An area reconnaissance is a directed effort to get detailed information about the terrain or enemy activity within a prescribed area. The area can be any location that is critical to the unit's operations. If time permits, the commander may also direct the company to:

a. Reconnoiter all terrain within the zone.

b. Inspect and classify all bridges.

c. Locate fords or crossing sites.

d. Inspect and classify all overpasses, underpasses, and culverts.

e. Locate and clear all mines, obstacles, and barriers (within capability).

f. Locate bypasses around built-up areas, obstacles, and contaminated areas.

Examples include easily identifiable areas covering fairly large spaces such astowns or military installations, terrain features such as ridge lines, wood lines, or choke points or single points such as bridges or buildings. The critical tasks of an area reconnaissance are the same as those for a zone reconnaissance.

Planning Considerations

Reconnaissance planning starts with the company commander’s identification of commander’s critical information requirement (CCIR). The company commander then compares his CCIR list to that of the battalion commander. If the company commander identifies CCIR not covered on the battalion list, he shares them with the battalion commander and staff.

CCIR is confirmed based on the commanding officer requests, that battalion or higher headquarters commit assets that aim to gather the information needed. The process begins from planning and preparation and often continues during the conduct of the operation.

Positioning of Subordinate Elements. In conducting route, zone, or area reconnaissance, the company may employ direct and indirect fires. Based on his evaluation of METT-TC factors, the company commander establishes the roles of organic elements and support assets within his scheme of maneuver.

Focus of Reconnaissance. The CO determines the objective of the mission, and identifies whether the reconnaissance will orient on the terrain or on the enemy force in planning for route, zone, or area reconnaissance. Providing the company with clear guidance on the objective of the reconnaissance is his primary concern. With this, the company is generally able to move more quickly in a force-oriented reconnaissance than in a terrain-oriented reconnaissance.

Execution

To be most effective, reconnaissance must be continuous and conducted before, during, and after operations. Before an operation, the company focuses its reconnaissance effort to confirm or deny a possible course of action (Figure 7.1). After an operation, the company normally reconnoiters so it can maintain contact with the enemy, collect information for upcoming operations, and provide force protection and security.

Before or After an Operation. Situations in which the company may conduct reconnaissance before or after an operation include:

a. Reconnaissance by a quartering party of an assembly area and the associated route to it.

b. Reconnaissance before an offensive operation from the assembly area to and near the LD.

c. Reconnaissance by Infantry patrols to probe enemy positions for gaps prior to an attack or infiltration.

d. Reconnaissance by Infantry patrols to observe enemy forward positions.

e. Reconnaissance by patrols (normally Infantry and engineers) to locate bypasses around obstacle belts or determine the best locations and methods for breaching operations.

f. Reconnaissance by Infantry patrols of choke points or other danger areas in advance of the remainder of the company.

g. Reconnaissance of defensive positions or EAs prior to the conduct of the defense.

h. Reconnaissance by patrols as part of security operations to secure friendly obstacles, clear possible enemy OPs, or cover areas not observable by stationary OPs.

i. Reconnaissance to maintain contact with adjacent units.

j. Reconnaissance by patrols to maintain contact with enemy elements.

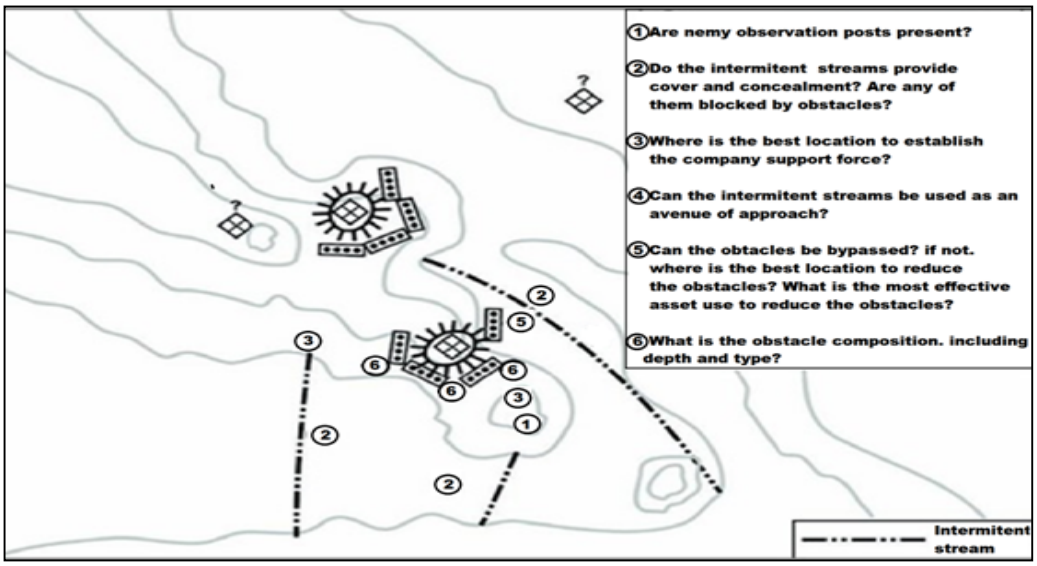
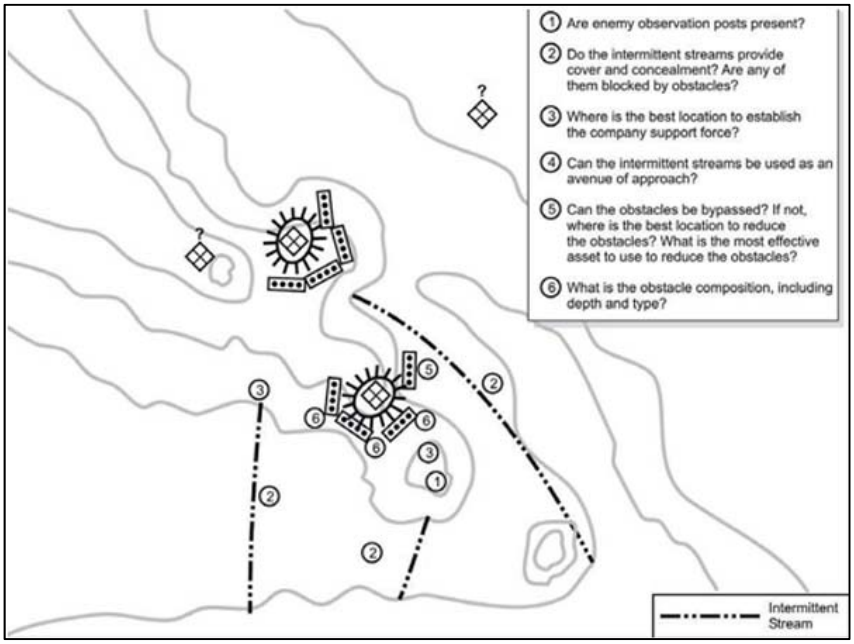


Figure B.1 Identification of Intelligence Requirements and Use of Patrols to Reconnoiter



During an Operation. During offensive operations, company reconnaissance normally focuses on fighting for information about the enemy and the terrain, with the primary goal of gaining an advantage over the enemy. The company conducts this type of reconnaissance during actions on contact. As the company develops the situation, the commander may dispatch patrols to identify positions of advantage or acquire an enemy force. The information gained by the company while in contact is critical not only to the success of its own mission but also to the success of its higher headquarters. (Offensive Operations, discusses actions on contact.)

Annex C
Infantry Rifle Company Techniques, Tactics and Procedure on the Conduct of Linkup Operations

A **linkup** is an operation that entails the meeting of friendly ground forces (or their leaders or designated representatives). The company conducts linkup activities independently or as part of a larger force. Within a larger unit, the company may lead the linkup force. Linkup may occur in, but is not limited to, the following situations:

a. Units coordinating a relief in place.

b. Cross-attached units moving to join their new organization.

c. A unit moving forward with a fixing force during a follow-and-support mission.

d. A unit moving to assist an encircled force.

e. Units converging on the same objective during the attack.

f. Units conducting a passage of lines.

Linkup Planning Considerations. The plans for a linkup are detailed and cover the following:

Site Selection. Select a primary and alternate site. These sites should be easy to find at night, have cover and concealment, and avoid the natural lines of drift. They must also be easy to defend for a short time, and must offer access and escape routes.

Recognition Signals. Far and near recognition signals help keep friendly units from firing on each other. Although units linking up exchange radio frequencies and call signs, they should avoid radio communications for short-range recognition due to possible compromise. Instead, they plan visual and voice recognition signals. They might use a sign and countersign such as a challenge and password or a number combination. Signaling means can include flashlights, chemical lights, infrared lights, or VS-17 panels. The SOP can define near and far recognition signals.

Indirect Fires. Indirect fires are always planned, but not necessarily executed, for linkup operations. They support the movement by masking noise, deceiving the enemy of friendly intent, and distracting the enemy. Indirect fires are planned along the infiltration lanes and at the linkup sites to support in case of enemy contact.

Direct Fires. Direct fire planning must include fratricide prevention. Restrictive fire lines (RFLs) control fires around the linkup site. Phase lines may serve as RFLs, which are adjusted as two forces approach each other.

Linkup Contingency Plans. The unit SOP or the linkup annex to the OPORD must cover: enemy contact before, during, and after linkup, length of time to wait at the linkup site. Actions in case some elements fail to linkup, and alternate linkup points and rally points.

When the unit moves to the linkup point and reports its location using phase lines, checkpoints, or other control measures (thru radio), linkup begins. Assignment of specific duties of the contact elements and coordinates procedures for integrating the linkup units into a single linkup rally point is done by the CO.

The company linkup between the 3rd platoon is shown in Figure 7.2. The 3rd platoon infiltrated early, conducted the reconnaissance of the objective, and established the ORP. The rest of the company, also shown, infiltrated later. The company (-) stops and sets up a linkup rally point about 300 meters from the linkup point. A contact team is sent to the linkup point; it locates the point and observes the area. If the unit is the first at the site, it clears the immediate area and marks the linkup point, using the agreed-upon recognition signal. It then takes up a covered and concealed position to watch the linkup point.

The next unit (in this example, 3rd platoon) approaching the site repeats these actions. When its contact team arrives at the site and spots the recognition signal, they initiate the far recognition signal. The first element answers and the two elements exchange near recognition signals. The contact teams coordinate the actions required to linkup the units such as moving one unit to the other unit's rally point or continuing the mission.

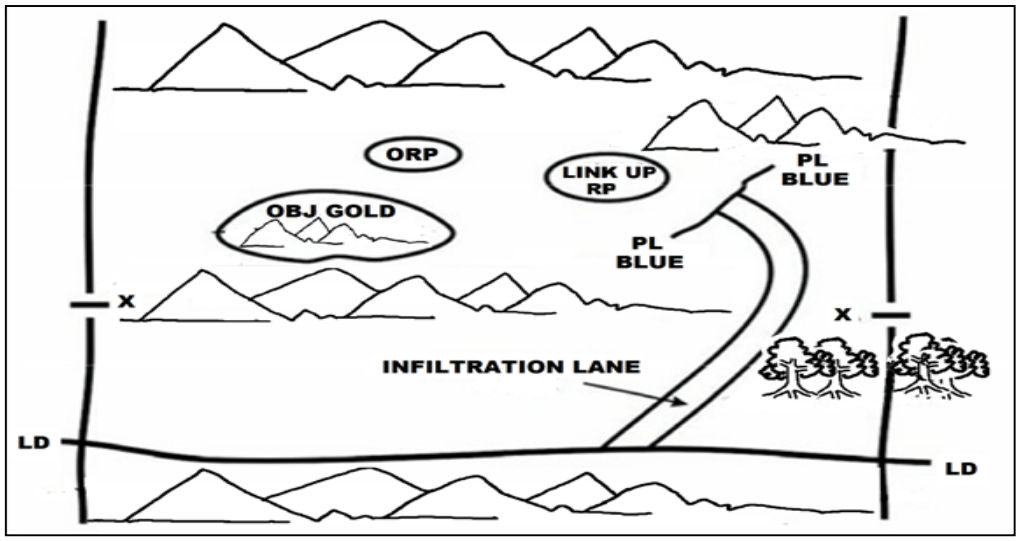


Figure C.1 Infantry Company Linkup

Linkup Coordination

Before initiating movement to the linkup point, the forces exchange necessary tactical information, including:

a. The known enemy situation.

b. Number and types of friendly units or personnel.

c. Disposition of stationary forces, if either unit is stationary.

d. Routes to the linkup and rally points, if used.

e. Fire-control measures.

f. Near recognition signal(s).

g. Communications information.

h. Combat support coverage.

i. Sustainment responsibilities and procedures.

j. Final location of the linkup point and rally point, if used.

k. Any special coordination such as maneuver instructions or requests for medical support.

Movement to Linkup Point and Linkup Itself

All units or elements involved in the linkup must enforce strict fire-control measures to prevent fratricide. Linkup points and RFLs must be easily recognizable by moving and converging forces. Linkup elements:

a. Conduct far recognition by radio or Army Battle Command System (ABCS).

b. Conduct short-range (near) recognition using visual or voice signal.

c. Complete movement to the linkup point.

d. Establish local security at the linkup point.

e. Conduct additional coordination and linkup activities as necessary.

Annex D
Infantry Rifle Company Techniques, Tactics and Procedure on the Conduct of Relief in Place

A relief in place is an operation in which one unit replaces another unit and assumes the relieved unit's responsibilities. The primary purpose for a relief in place operation is to maintain the combat effectiveness of committed units. A relief in place may also be conducted:

a. To reorganize, reconstitute, or re-equip a unit that has sustained heavy losses.

b. To rest units that has conducted sustained operations.

c. To establish the security force or the DLIC during a withdrawal operation.

d. To allow the relieved unit to conduct another operation.

Relief in Place Planning Considerations

If higher omits the time and location of the coordination meeting, the relieving unit commander contacts the relieved unit commander to coordinate them. The COs, XOs, platoon leaders, and FSOs should also attend the coordination meeting.

Each commander faces unique considerations in every tactical situation. Their respective missions, the enemy situation, and the time available are some of the factors that will affect the plan.

Relief in Place Command and Control

The C2 requirements during a relief are unique due to the mixing of units. To ensure effective C2, leaders must conduct detailed coordination early in the planning process. The positions of key leaders and use of effective control measures will also ensure effective C2. Coordination between the relieving and the relieved units may include:

a. Exchange of intelligence

b. Arrangements for reconnaissance

c. Exchange of tactical plans and sector sketches

d. Sequence and timing for each subunit's relief

e. Time or circumstance when the responsibility for the relieved unit's area of operations is transferred

f. The use of guides and liaison personnel

g. Security measures

h. Fire support

i. Transfer and exchange of equipment, supplies, ammunition, and minefields

j. Control measures

k. Exchange of frequencies, call signs, challenge and passwords, and recognition signals

The locations of key leaders in both units are critical. The commanders and their FSOs normally collocate to best observe and control the relief. Other key leaders should be positioned to best assist the commander. They might be positioned along routes, assembly areas, points of possible congestion, or locations of greatest enemy threat.

Control measures provide control and flexibility during execution. The specific method of relief determines the number and type of control measures required. The following control measures are routine:

Assembly Areas. The relieved unit may designate platoon and company AAs to the rear of their positions. The relieving unit may also designate AAs, but should move directly into position. To avoid confusion, leaders must designate separate AAs for each unit.

Contact Points. Normally, the relieved company commander designates these. Having contact points facilitates the initial linkup between the companies. Multiple contact points might be needed to support some relief operations.

Release Points. The relieved commander normally designates the platoon release point for the relieving company. When necessary, the relieved company commander or platoon leader can designate squad release points.

Routes. All units should move along designated routes to avoid confusion and fratricide. When possible, the commander designates separate routes for the relieving and relieved units. The relieved commander ensures all movements are controlled.

Reconnaissance. Physical reconnaissance is done by the relieving commander as soon as possible. Movement plans coordination is done by the commanders and leaders of both companies who reconnoiters together to ensure full understanding of movements, control measures, and responsibilities. Requirements for specific reconnaissance may include:

a. The relieved unit's disposition, to include locations of all OPs, minefields, land lines, early warning or anti-intrusion devices, and crew-served weapons.

b. Enemy dispositions, when the relieved unit is in contact.

c. Locations for AAs, release points, contact points, and routes.

d. Locations of the CP, trains, mortars, CCM, attached heavy or Stryker elements

Method of Relief

The method of relief is determined by the specific situation; however, regardless of the method of relief, certain actions normally occur. The relieving company occupies an AA to the rear of the relieved company or is guided along a route directly to the platoon RP. For each relieving subordinate unit, guides are provided by the relieved unit.

The company CPs collocate prior to commencing the relief. The relief begins with the depth positions of the relieved company. The relieving company's trains and mortars are normally positioned before any relief begins. The relieved company's trains and mortars normally remain in position until responsibility for the area passes to the relieving company. A relief is conducted as follows:

Relief of One Unit at a Time. This is required when covered and concealed routes are limited, and when all platoons must use the same route. However, this method takes longer than the others. Figure 7.3 shows how the relieving company occupies an AA to the rear of the relieved company and relieves by platoon according to the coordinated sequence.

With guides provided by the relieved unit, each platoon moves forward to the squad release point. A covered and concealed location to the rear of the relieved squad's position is sought. Exchange of the necessary equipment is done and members of the relieving squads relieve the soldiers from the relieved squad. The relieved squad moves directly to the platoon AA, links up with the remainder of their platoon, and continues to the company AA. Once the entire relieving platoon assumes responsibility from the relieved platoon, the next platoon begins their relief.

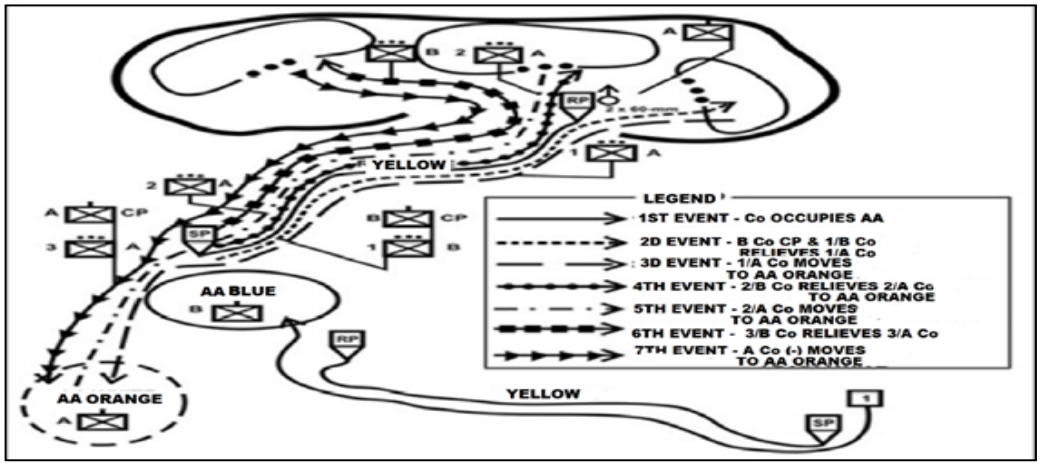


Figure D.1 - Relief in Place in Sequence

Simultaneous Relief of Units. Although this method is the fastest, enemy detection is more likely, because all units move at once. This method may be appropriate when the mission requires a rapid relief, enemy detection is unlikely, and the terrain provides multiple covered and concealed routes. All relieving platoons move forward along their designated routes at the same time to the squad release points. The squad's actions are the same as previously described.

Relief by Occupation in Depth or Occupation of Adjacent Positions. This method is useful when the relieved unit has sustained chemical or nuclear contamination. The relieving unit may occupy its positions one at a time or all at once, depending on the situation. Once the relieving unit is in position, the relieved unit withdraws along designated routes. The relieving unit occupy positions to the flank or rear of the relieved unit in this technique. TRPs and EAs direct-fire control measures are covered by the relieving unit.

Sequence of Relief. To determine the most effective sequence of relief, the commander considers the following:

Combat Effectiveness of Units. If one subordinate unit has suffered heavy losses in men or equipment, it may need to be the first relieved.

Terrain. The subordinate unit most likely to be detected during the relief should be relieved last. This allows the most relieving units to be in position before the enemy is aware of the relief operation.

Enemy. Consider relieving first the subordinate unit positioned on the most likely or most dangerous avenue of approach.

Control. When two adjacent units must share a route to conduct the relief, select a method and sequence of relief that reduces congestion and confusion. Avoid massing units in a small area.

Subsequent Mission. The subordinate unit with the most critical task may need to be relieved first. For example, a relieving subordinate unit may need to establish an OP forward of their position to provide security for the rest of the relief operation. Or when the company being relieved is moving to a LZ for an air assault operation, the platoon tasked to secure the LZ should be relieved first.

Annex E
Infantry Rifle Company Techniques, Tactics and Procedure on the Conduct of Passage of Lines

The **passage of lines** is the movement of one or more units through another encompass this technique when the moving unit(s) cannot bypass the stationary unit and must pass through it which might be designated as either forward or rearward. Maintenance of the momentum of the moving elements is the primary purpose of the passage.

Planning Considerations

Vehicle recovery or casualty evacuation in the passage lane is clearly defined for both passing and stationary units in planning the passage of lines for sustainment actions. As applicable, the company locates a command and control element, normally the company commander or XO, with a similar element from the stationary or moving unit. The tactical factors and procedures covered in the following paragraphs.

Passage Lanes. The passage facilitates transition to follow-on missions by using multiple lanes, or lanes wide enough to support doctrinal formations for the passing units.

Use of Deception. The company forces can use deception techniques, such as smoke, to enhance security during the passage.

Battle Handover. The definition of the battle handover criteria and procedures for the passage is determined by the controlling commander. He also gives the location of the battle handover line (BHL) as part of the unit's graphic control measures.

Obstacles. The passing and stationary units coordinate obstacle information, to include the locations of enemy and friendly obstacles, existing lanes and bypasses, and guides for the passage.

Air Defense. Air defense coverage is imperative during the high-risk passage operation. Normally, the stationary unit provides air defense, allowing the passing unit's air defense assets to move with the passing unit. An Infantry Company forces has limited air defense assets we can only perform passive air defense by means of camouflaging our weapons and troops.

Reconnaissance Coordination

Detailed reconnaissance and coordination are critical in a passage of lines, both in its complex planning factors and to ensure that the passage goes quickly and smoothly. The company commander normally reconnoiters and coordinates the passage. At times, he may designate the XO, F/Sgt, or a platoon leader to conduct the following:

a. Unit designation and composition.

b. Type and number of personnel.

c. Passing unit's arrival time(s).

d. Location(s) of attack positions or assembly areas.

e. Current enemy situation.

f. Stationary unit's mission and plan, to include OP, patrol, and obstacle locations.

g. Locations of routes, contact points, passage points, and passage lanes.

h. Guide requirements.

i. Order of march.

j. Anticipated actions on enemy contact.

k. Requirements for supporting direct and indirect fires, with location of RFL.

l. Chemical, biological, radiological, or nuclear conditions.

m. Available combat support assets and their locations.

n. Communications information, to include frequencies and near and far recognition signals.

o. Criteria for battle handover and location of the battle handover line.

p. Additional procedures for the passage.

Forward Passage of Lines

Figure E.1 shows that in a forward passage, the passing unit first moves to an assembly area or attack position to the rear of the stationary unit. The company conducts a forward passage by employing tactical movement. To link up with guides and confirm coordination information with the stationary unit, designated personnel move forward. Guides then lead the passing elements through the passage lane.

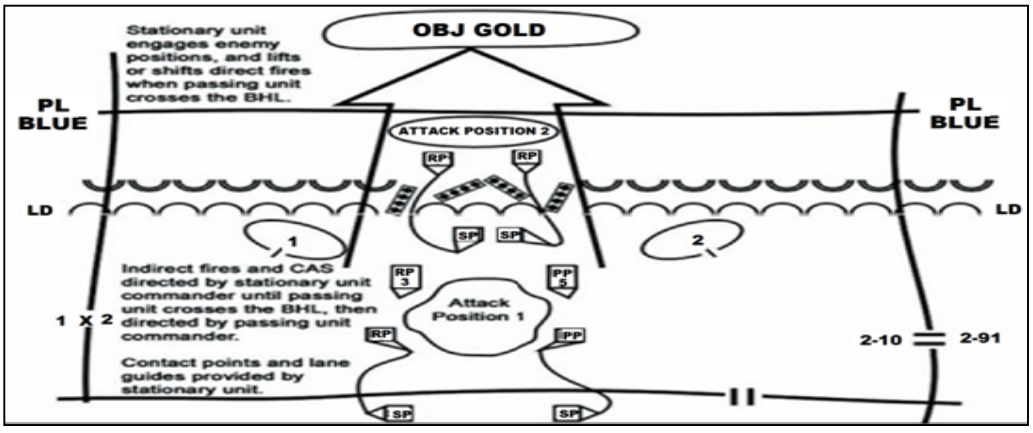


Figure E.1 - Infantry Company Conducting a Forward Passage of Lines

Rearward Passage of Lines

Coordination of recognition signals and direct-fire restrictions is critical to avoid fratricide. The passing unit contacts the stationary unit, and then coordinates as previously discussed while it is still beyond direct-fire range. Coordination emphasizes near recognition signals and location of the BHL. After coordination, the passing unit continues tactical movement toward the passage lane as shown in Figure 7.5.

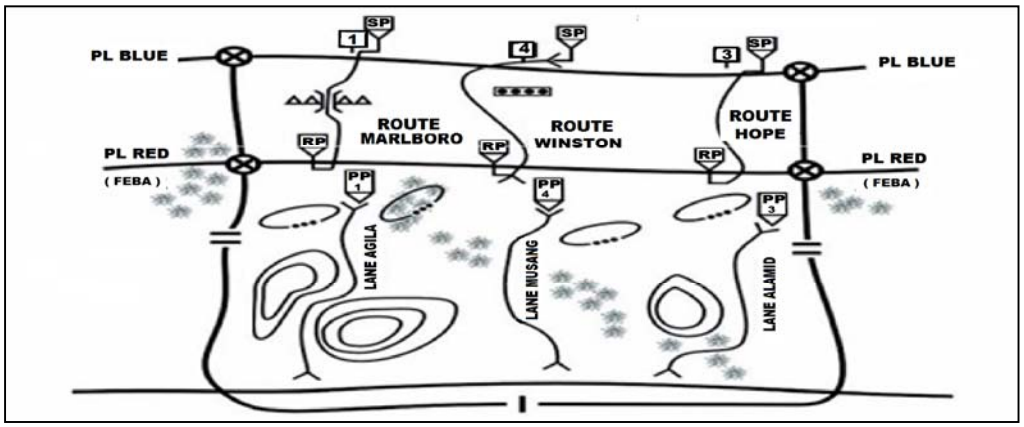


Figure E.2 - Infantry Company Conducting a Rearward Passage of Lines

Annex F
Infantry Rifle Company Techniques, Tactics and Procedure on the Conduct of Security Operations

Security operations provide early and accurate warning of enemy operations which may be conducted to the front, flanks, or rear of the force to allow the commander to employ the protected force effectively.

Types

Screen, guard, cover, area security, and local security are the five forms of security operations. The deployment of progressively higher levels of assets provides increasing levels of security for the main body screen, guard, and cover. The preservation of a commander's freedom to move his reserves, position fire support assets, conduct command and control operations, and provide for sustainment operations covers area security. The company can conduct screen or guard operations on its own.

Planning Considerations

1099. The commander assigns the security mission and the security force commander to address a variety of special operational factors.

a. Augmentation of Security Forces

b. Enemy-Related Considerations

c. Time Security Operation is Initiated

d. Reconnaissance of Security Area

e. Location and Orientation of Security Area

f. Initial Op Locations

Augmentation of Security Forces. When it is assigned to conduct a screen or guard mission, the company may receive additional combat, combat support, and sustainment elements. Attachments include at least:

a. Scout platoon; and

b. An additional mortar section or platoon

Enemy-Related Considerations. Security operations require the company to deal with a unique set of enemy considerations. For example, the array of enemy forces (and the tactics that enemy commanders use to employ them) might differ from those for any other tactical operation the company conducts. Additional enemy considerations that could influence company security operations follows:

a. The presence or absence of specific types of forces on the battlefield including:

1) Insurgent elements that might be external to the enemy force; 2) Enemy reconnaissance elements of varying strengths and capabilities, at division or brigade tactical group, or other levels, and; 3) Enemy security elements, such as disruption forces, including enemy stay-behind elements or other bypassed enemy elements.

b. Possible locations where the enemy will employ his tactical assets, including: 1) Reconnaissance and infiltration routes; and, 2) OP sites for surveillance or indirect fire observers.

Time Security Operation is Initiated. The time by which the screen or guard must be set and actively influences the company's method of deploying to the security area as well as the time it begins the deployment.

Reconnaissance of Security Area. The company commander uses a thorough analysis of METT-TC factors to determine the appropriate methods and techniques to accomplish this critical action. The company commander tries to personally reconnoiter the security area he expects the company to occupy, even when the operation is preceded by a zone reconnaissance by other battalion elements.

Movement to Security Area. In deploying elements to an area for a stationary security mission, the company commander must deal with the competing requirements: to establish the security operation quickly and meet mission requirements and to provide the necessary level of local security while doing so. The company can move to the security area using one of two basic methods: a tactical road march or a movement to contact. Either methods should be preceded by a zone reconnaissance by the Infantry battalion scout platoon. The following paragraphs examine considerations and procedures for the two methods of movement.

a. **Tactical Road March.** The company conducts a tactical road march to an RP behind the security area to occupy their initial positions. This method of deployment is faster than a movement to contact, but less secure. It is appropriate when enemy contact is not expected or when time is critical.

b. **Movement to Contact**. The company moves from the LD to the security area using the appropriate movement technique based on the likelihood of enemy contact. This method is slower than a tactical road march, but it is more secure. It is appropriate when enemy contact is likely, or the situation is unclear.

Location and Orientation of Security Area. Determination of the location, orientation, and depth of the security area in which the security force operates is done by the main body commander. Conducting a detailed analysis of the terrain in the security area is done by the security force commander. He establishes his initial dispositions, usually a screen line, even for a guard mission as far forward as possible, on terrain that allows clear observation of avenues of approach into a sector.

As such, the screen line might serve as a restrictive control measure for movement. This requires the company commander to conduct all necessary coordination if he decides to establish OPs or to perform reconnaissance forward of the line.

Initial Op Locations. Deployment of the OPs to ensure effective surveillance of the sector and designated NAIs is done by the CO. He also designates initial OP locations on or behind the screen line, provides OP personnel with specific orientation and observation guidance, including, at a minimum, the primary orientation for the surveillance effort during the conduct of the screen.

Width and Depth of Security Area

The company sector is defined by lateral boundaries extending out to the limit of advance (LOA) or the initial screen line. The company's ability to maintain depth through the sector decreases as the screened or guarded frontage increases.

Annex G
Call for Fire Procedure

Call for fire procedure. Once the combat troops have sighted the enemy and they need to request indirects fires, the Company Commander/ Platton Leader will request indirect fires from the supporting artillery unit or the mortar organic from battalion. The Forward Oberver (FO), with the approval from Company Commander will radio the Fire Direction Center (FDC) for the requested fires.

Description. A call for fire (CFF) is a concise message prepared by the observer.It contains all information on needed by the FDC to determine the method of target attack.It is request to fire,not an order.It must be sent quickly but clearly enough that it can be understood,recorded,and read back,without error,by the FDC recorder.The observer should tell the RATELO that he has seen the target so the RATELO can start the call for fire while target location is determined.Information is sent as it is determined rather than waiting until the complete call for fire has been prepared.

Elements and Parts of the call for fire. Regardless of the method of the target location used, the normal call for fire is sent in three parts consisting of six elements.The six elements,the sequence in which they are transmitted,are discussed in paragraph 4-2 through 4-7.They are the follows:

a. Observer identification.

b. Warning order.

c. Target location.

d. Method of engagement.

e. Method of fire and control

The three transmission in a call for fire are follows:

a. Observe identification and warning order.

b. Target location.

Description of target, method of engagement.and method of the fire control.

There is abreak after transmission.and the FDC reads back the data.The observer in conducting fire mission and recording mission data user DA form 5429-R (Conduct of fire).The front page, section I, is organized to help him recirds his call for fire and subsequent adjustment data.Section II, on yhe back of the form,is used to record registration data,Portion of DA 5429-Rare shown with example throughout this publication.Reproducible copies are at the bak of his manual.

Observer Identification

This element of the call for fire tells the FDC who is calling for fire.

Warning Order

The warning order clears the net for the fire mission and tells the FDC the type of the mission and the type of target location that will be used.The warning order consists of the type of mission, the size of the elements to fire, and method of target location.It is a request for fire unless prior authority has been given to order fire.

a. **Type of Mission. 1).Adjust fire**.When the observer believes that an adjustment must be made (because of questionable target location or lack of registration corrections.), he adjustment must be **ADJUST fire.** 2) **Fire for effect.** The observer should always strive for first-round FFE.The accuracy required to fire for effect depends on the accuracy of the target location and the ammunition being used, When the observer is certain that the target location is accurate and that the first volley should have the desire effect on the target so that little or no adjustment is required,he announces **FIRE for effect.**3) **Suppresion.**To quickly bring fire on a target that is not active,the observer announces **SUPPRESS**(followed by the target identification).Suppress(S) missions are normally fired on preplanned targets,and a duration is associated with the call for fire.4)**Immediate Suppression and Immendiate moke.**When engaging a planned target or target apportunity that has taken friendly maneuver or aerial maneuver or erial elements under fire.the observer announces **IMMEDIATE SUPPRESSION** or **IMMEDIATE SMOKE**(followed by the target location).Though the grid method of target location is the most common.any method of target location may be used in firing an immendiate spression or immediate smoke mission.

b. **Size of elements to fire for effect.**The observer may request the size of the unit to fire for effect; for example,BATTALION,usually,he does this by announcing the last letter in the battalion FDC's call sign.For example,T6H24 is announced H.The observer should never refer to a battery or other unit in the clear.He should refer tomit by call sign.If the observer says nothing about the size of elements to fire,the battalion FDC makes that decision.It is based on the target attack guindance recieveness manual (JMEM) solution.

c. **Method of Target Location. 1) Polar Plot.**If he target is located by the polar plot method of target location,the observer announces POLAR; for example,ADJUST FIRE,POLAR OVER.(2).**Laser Polar Plot.**The FDC needs to know as quickly as possible if the observer is using a laser.Although tha data are still polar,the backup coputer system(BUCKS) uses a different format from the fire mission index,From the initial transmission of the call for fire,The FDC will know which of its four mission formats to display;for example,ADJUST FIRE,LASER POLAR OVER.(3).**Shift From Known Point.**If the target is located by shift from known pointmethod of target location,the observer announces SHIFT (followed by the known point); for example,ADJUST FIRE,SHIFT KNOWN POINT 1,OVER.(4). **Grid**. If the grid method of target location is being used, the word grid is not announced; for example, ADJUST FIRE OVER. **EXAMPLES,** The following are examples of observer identification and warning order

d. **Adjust Fire Mission Grid method:** FIREBALL THIS IS HUNTER, ADJUST FIRE, OVER

e. **Fire-For-Effect Mission Polar plot method:** HOTWIRE THIS IS SEEKER, FIRE FOR EFFECT, POLAR, OVER

f. **Shift from known point method:** DARK ARROW THIS IS RED FOX, FIRE FOR EFFECT, SHIFT KNOWN POINT 3, OVER.

g. **Suppression Method:** KILLER THIS IS HOMER SUPPRESS AA7749, OVER

h. **Immediate Suppression Mission** BRUTUM THIS IS DELTA FOUR, SUPPRESSION, GRID 51P TT 45346215, OVER

Target Location

This element enables the FDC to plot the location of the target to determine firing data a). In **grid** mission,six-place grid normally are sent.Eight-place grids should be sent for registration points or other points for which greater accuracy is required.The OT direction normally will be sent after the entire initial call for fire,since it is not needed by the FDC to locate the target.Direction is expressed to the nearest 10 mils. b).In a shift from known point mission (figure 4-1), the point or target from which the shift will be made is ent in the warning orders.Both the observer and the FDC must know the point.The observer then sends the OT direction.Normally, it is sent in mils.However, the FDC can accept degrees or cardinal directions, which is specified by the observer.The corrections are sent next:

a. The **lateral** (how far left or right the target is) from the known point.

b. The **range shift** (how much farther [ADD] or closer [DROP] the target is in relation to the known point, to the nearest 100 meters).

c. The **vertical shift** (how much the target is above [UP] or below [DOWN] the altitude of the known point, to the nearest 5 meters.) (The vertical shift is ignored unless it exceeds 30 meters.)

In a **polar plot** mission, the word polar in the warning order alerts the FDC that the target will be located with respect to the observer then sends the directions and distance.A vertical shift tells the FDC how far, in meters, the target is located above or below the observer's location, Vertical shift may also be describe by a vertical angle (VA), in mils, relative to the observer's location.Laser data are sent to the nearest 1 mil and nearest 10

Target Description

The observer must describe the target in enough detail that the FDC can determine the amount and type of ammunition to use.The FDC selects different ammunition for different types of targets.The observer should be brieft but accurate.The description should contain the following:

a. What the target is (troops,equiptment,supply dump,trucks,and so fort)

b. What the target is doing (digging in, in assembly area, and so forth.)

c. The number of the elements in the target (squad, platoon, three trucks, six tanks, and so fort).

d. The degree of protection (in open, in foxhole ,in bunkers with over head protection , and so fort)

e. The target size and shape if theres is significant, if hte target is rectangular, the length and width (in meters) and the attitude (azimuth of the long axis 0000-3199) to the nearest 100 mils should be given: for example, 400 by 200. ATTITUDE 2800, if the target is circular, the radius should be given; for example RADIUS 200.Linear targets may be describe by length, width, and attitude.

Method of Engagement

The observer may indicated how he wants to attack the target.The elements consists of the type of adjustment, trajectory, ammunition,and distribution, DANGER CLOSE and MARK are included as appropriate.

a. .**Type of Adjustment.** Two types of adjustment may be employed-precision and area.Unless precision fire is specified, area fire will be used. 1).Precision is conducted with with one weapon on a point target.It is used eighter to obtain registration correction or to destroy a target.When the mission is a registration, it is initiated by the FDC with a message to observer.If the target is to be destroyed, the observer announces DESTRUCTION.2) Area fire used to attack an area target.Since many area targets are mobile,adjustment should be as quick as possible.consistent with accuracy,to keep the trget from escaping.A well-defined point at or near the center of the erea to be attack should be selected and used as an aiming point.This point is called adjusting pointduring adjust fire mission. To achieve surprise, fire for effect shift to the target. Normally, adjustment on an area target is conducted with one adjusting weapon.

b. **Danger Close.** DANGER CLOSE is include in the the method of engagement when the target is (round will impact) within 600 meters of friendly troops for motar and artillery,750 meters for naval guns 5-inch and smaller,and 1,000 meters for naval guns large than 5-inch.For naval 16-inch ICM,danger close is 2,000 meters.

c. **Mark.** MARK is included in the method of engagement to indicate that observer is going to callfor rounds for eithr of the following reason: 1) To orient himself in his zone of observation. 2) To indicate target to ground troops, air craft, or fire support.

d. **Trajectory.** Low-angle fire is standar for field artillery.If hi_angle fire is desired, it is requested immediately after the type of engagement.If hi angles is not specified,low angle will(normally) be used.If firing units determines that high angle must be used to attack a target,the unit must inform the observer thathigh angle will be used.Motars fire only high angle.

e. **Ammunition.** The observer may request any type of ammunition during the adjustment or the FFE phase of his mission.Shell HE wkith fuze quick is normally used in adjustment.If that is what the observer desire,he need not request it is his call for fire.If he observer does not request a shell-fuze in effect, yhe fire direction officer(FDO) determine the shell-fuze combination.Unit SOP may designated a standard shell-fuze combination.Ammunition standards may vary from unit to unit.The observer must learn these standeards upon assignment

f. **Projectile.** Example of request for other than HE projectile are ILLUMINATION. ICM and SMOKE. (2) **Fuze.** Most mission are filled with fuze quick during the adjustment phase.If fuze quick is desired or if a projectile that has only one fuze is requested, fuze is not indicate. Illuminating ICM, and smoke projectile are fuze with time fuzes; therefore, when the observer request ILLUMINATION, ICM, or SMOKE, he does not announce TIME. (3) **Volume of fire**.The observer may the number of rounds to be fired by weapons firing effect. For example, 3ROUNDS indicates that the firing unit will fire three volleys.

g. **Distribution.** The observer may control the pattern of bursts in the target area.This pattern of burst called a sheaf.Unless otherwise requested,the battery computer system(BCS) assume a circular target with a 100-meter radius.The BCS determine individual weapon aiming point to distribute the burst of best coverage of this ntype of target. A convereged sheaf places all rounds on specific point and used for small, hard target.Special sheafs of any length and width shell fired.If target length and width are given.attitude also must be given.If target length is equal to greater than five times the large width, the BCS assumes a linear target.The mortarballistic computer assumes the target is linear and fires parallel sheaf unless a special sheaf is requested.

Method of Fire and Control. The method of fire and control elements indicates the desire manner of attacking the target, whether the observer wants to control the time of delivery of fire, and whether he can observe the target.Methods of control in my command (AMC) and time on target (TOT) are especially useful in massing fire. The AMC and TOT mission achieve surprise nd maximize the effect of the initial volley on target.When used the observer, these method of control can reduce the sporadic engagement or “popcorn effect,” which can be the result of rounds fired when ready.Method of fire and control are announce by observerby use of the terms discussed below.

a. **Method of Fire.** In area fire,the adjustment is normaly is conducted with one howitzer or a center gun of a motar platoon or section.If for any reasonthe observer determine that PLATOO RIGHT (LEFT) will be more appropriate,he may request it.(Adjusting at extreme to a unit distance may be easier with two guns firing.)The normal interval f time between rounds fired by a platoon or battery right (left) is 5 seconds.If the observer wants someother interval, he may also specify.

b. **Method of control.** 1). **At my command**.If the observer wishesnto control the time of the delivery of fire he includes AT MY COMMAND in the method of control.When the pieces are ready to fire,the FDC announce PLATOON (or BATTERY or BATTALION) S READ,OVER. (Call signs are used,). The observer announces FIRE when he is ready for the piese to fire.AT MY

COMMAND remains in effect throughout the mission until the observer announces CANCEL AT MY COMMAND, OVER. 2). **Cannot Observe.**CANNOT OBSERVE indicates that the observer cannot see the target (because of vegetation, terrain,wheater or smoke);however,he has reason to believe that a target exkists at the given location and that it is important enough to justify firing on it without adjustment.3) **Time on Target.**The observer may tell the FDC when he wants the to impact by requesting TIME ON TARGET(so many) MINUTES FROM,OVER or TIME ON TARGET 0859,OVER.The FO must conduct a time hack ensure that 0859 on his watch is 0859 on FDC's watch.4) **Contious illumination**.If no interval is given by the observer,the FDC determine the interval by burning time of illuminating ammunition;or he may use normal AT MY COMMAND procedures.5) **Cease Loading**. The command CEASE LOADING is used during firing of two or more rounds to indicate suspension of loadingrounds into the gun(s). The gun section may fire any rounds that have already been loaded. 6). **Check Firing.**The CHECK FIRING is used to couse an immediate halt fire. 7) **Continuous Fire.** In field artillery, mortars and naval gun fire, continuous fire means loading and firing as rapidly as possible,consistent wthin the prescribe rate of fire for the equipment.Firing will continue until suspended by the command CEASE LOADING or CHECK FIRING. (8). **Repeat.**REPEAT can be given during adjustment oe FFE missions a). **During Adjusment.** REPEAT means fire another round(s) with the last data and adjust for any change in ammunition if necessary.REPEAT is not sent in the initial call for fire. b). **During fire for effect.**REPEAT means fire the same number of round using the same method of fire for effect for the last fired.Changes in the number of guns,the previous correction,in the interval or,the ammunition may be requested. 9). **Followed By.** This part of termrs used to indicate a change in the rate of fire, in the type of the ammunition, or in another order for fire for effect; for example, WP FOLLOWED BY HE.

Sample Call for Fire:	**Note:** There is a break after each X-mission, for READ back data.
Forward Observer	**Fire Direction Center**
STEEL RAIN THIS IS PANTHER (OVER)	PANTHER THIS IS STEEL RAIN (OUT)
FIRE MISSION, POLAR (OVER)	FIRE MISSION, POLAR (OUT)
DIRECTION = 280 DEGREES (OVER)	DIRECTION = 280 DEGREES (OUT)
DISTANCE = 1500 MTRS (OVER)	DISTANCE = 1500 MTRS (OUT)
50 FULLY ARMED MEN IN THE OPEN (OVER)	50 FULLY ARMED MEN IN THE OPEN (OUT)
SHELL HE (OVER)	SHELL HE (OUT)
BASE PIECE 1 PLTN IN EFFECT (OVER)	BASE PIECE 1 PLTN IN EFFECT (OUT)
AT MY COMMAND (OVER)	AT MY COMMAND (OUT)
Authentication:	Authentication:
RANGER	**STEEL RAIN**

Figure G.1 - Call for Fire Procedure

Annex H
Types of Stability Operations

Table 2 depicts the types of stability operations that a battalion TF may be called upon to conduct and the missions it will issue its subordinate companies/company teams in order to execute the stability operation(s)

TYPE	MISSIONS
Peace Operations	Peacekeeping: employ patrols, establish checkpoints, roadblocks, buffer zones, supervise truce, EPW exchange, reporting and monitoring, negotiation and mediation, liaison, investigation of complaints and violations, civil disturbance missions, act as quick reaction force (QRF), and offensive and defensive missions. Peace Enforcement: separation of belligerents; establishment and supervision of protected zones, sanction enforcement, movement denial and guarantee, restoration and maintenance of order, area security, humanitarian assistance, civil disturbance missions, act as QRF, and offensive and defensive missions. Operations in Support of Diplomatic Efforts: military to military contacts, exercises, security assistance, restore civil authority, rebuild physical infrastructure, provide structures and training for schools and hospitals, and reestablish commerce.
Foreign Internal Defense	Indirect Support: military to military contacts, exercises, area security. Direct Support: civil-military operations, intelligence and communications sharing, and logistical support. Combat Operations: offensive and defensive missions.
Support to Insurgencies	Show of force, defensive missions, raids, area security, employ patrols, and provide CSS.
Counterdrug Operations	Liaison and advisor duty, civic action, intelligence support, surveillance support, reconnaissance, logistical support, and information support.
Combating Terrorism	Conduct force protection, offensive and defensive missions.
Noncombatant Evacuation Operations	Attack to seize terrain that secures evacuees or departure area, guard, convoy security, act as QRF, delay, and defend.
Arms Control	Seize and destroy weapons, convoy escort, assist and monitor inspection of arms, and conduct surveillance.
Show of Force	Perform tactical movement, demonstration, defensive operations, and perform training exercises.

Figure H.1 - Types of stability operations, missions

Annex I
Rules of Engagement (ROE)

Companies will always be faced with adhering to ROE of some kind. ROE have a significant impact on how missions are executed during UO. They must provide clear guidance to soldiers about when and how to employ force to accomplish the mission and to defend themselves.

The ROE will be much more restrictive under certain conditions of UO than under others. For example, a particular mission might require ROE that limit the use of indirect fire weapons. On the other hand, a mission to clear a building may require ROE that authorize force to clear rooms, and include authoritative guidance concerning measures to protect noncombatants, breach obstacles, and react to snipers.

One of the most significant issues of UO is collateral damage. Collateral damage is unintended and undesirable civilian personnel injuries or material damage adjacent to a target produced by the effects of friendly weapons. ROE will provide guidance concerning how to minimize collateral damage. For example, ROE may require use of nonlethal capabilities to the maximum extent possible before use of lethal weapons and munitions, or may restrict use of indirect fire weapons. The ROE will establish when certain types of weapons and munitions can be used.

> ***NOTE:*** *Nonlethal capability battalion kits will be in contingency stocks by September 2000 and will be issued to units on an as needed basis. Kits contain nonlethal weapons, devices, and munitions that are designed to incapacitate personnel or materiel.*

A mission can transition quickly from stability or support to offense or defense. This transition may be caused by threat actions or the actions of noncombatants. Commanders must be prepared to react to this situation and request changes in the ROE when necessary.

ROE differentiate between the use of force for self-defense and for mission accomplishment. Commanders always retain the inherent authority and obligation to use necessary and proportional force for unit and individual self-defense in response to a hostile act or demonstrated hostile intent. The ROE used during Operation JUST CAUSE in Panama are shown at Table 4.

Considerations for Handling Civilians. Company commanders should consider using PA, PSYOP, MPs, chaplains, and civil leaders/authorities if their mission involves handling civilians. Other considerations include the following:

a. Carefully analyze the ROE concerning when deadly force can be used and what type of weapons may be employed (for example, using lethal as opposed to nonlethal weapons and capabilities).

b. Do not assume that civilians will be predisposed for or against troops. Always treat civilians with dignity and respect. Use force against civilians only in self-defense or otherwise in accordance with the ROE. Detain civilians only in accordance with command directives.

c. When conducting offensive operations, plan to move any civilians that are encountered away from firefights. Normally this task will be given to the support element after rooms and buildings have been secured. When available, PSYOP, civil affairs, and MPs can assist with this task. A covered and concealed location away from the immediate combat area should be chosen. Civilians should be controlled and not permitted to enter the immediate combat area, unless they have been cleared to do so and will not compromise combat operations, for example, media personnel or governmental or NGO personnel that have a reason and authority to enter the combat area.

d. When conducting defensive operations, plan to move civilians away from the immediate combat area. Companies will normally escort personnel to a designated location where they will be turned over to civil authority, battalion, or higher control. In many cases, friendly or nonhostile civilians may be directed to a clearing point and allowed to go there without escort.

e. Security is not normally provided for media or NGO personnel if they are permitted in the immediate combat area. Security requirements for civilians should be clarified at the mission briefing.

f. Based on the factors of METT-TC, commanders may have to render some type of immediate humanitarian assistance (medical attention and feeding). If this type of assistance is necessary, clarify questions in the mission briefing. Additional Class VIII and Class I can be requested, as appropriate.

ALL ENEMY MILITARY PERSONNEL AND VEHICLES TRANSPORTING THE ENEMY OR THEIR SUPPLIES MAY BE ENGAGED SUBJECT TO THE FOLLOWING RESTRICTIONS:
a. Armed force is the last resort.
b. When possible, the enemy will be warned first and allowed to surrender.
c. Armed civilians will be engaged only in self-defense.
d. Civilian aircraft will not be engaged without approval from above division level unless it is in self-defense.
e. Avoid harming civilians unless necessary to save US lives. If possible, try to arrange for the evacuation of civilians prior to any US attack.
f. If civilians are in the area, do not use artillery, mortars, armed helicopters, AC-1
g. 30s, tube- or rocket-launched weapons, or M551 main guns against known or suspected targets without the permission of a ground maneuver commander, LTC or higher (for any of these weapons).
h. If civilians are in the area, all air attacks must be controlled by a FAC or FO. If civilians are in the area, close air support (CAS), white phosphorus, and incendiary weapons are prohibited without approval from above division level.
i. If civilians are in the area, do not shoot except at known enemy locations.
j. If civilians are not in the area, you can shoot at suspected enemy locations.
k. Public works such as power stations, water treatment plants, dams, or other utilities may not be engaged without approval from above division level.
l. Hospitals, churches, shrines, schools, museums, and any other historical or cultural site will not be engaged except in self-defense.
m. All indirect fire and air attacks must be observed.
n. Pilots must be briefed for each mission on the location of civilians and friendly forces.
o. No booby traps. No mines except as approved by division commander. No riot control agents except with approval from above division level.
p. Avoid harming civilian property unless necessary to save US lives.
q. Treat all civilians and their property with respect and dignity. Before using privately owned property, check to see if any publicly owned property can substitute. No requisitioning of civilian property without permission of a company-level commander and without giving a receipt. If an ordering officer can contract for the property, then do not requisition it. No looting. Do not kick down doors unless necessary. Do not sleep in their houses. If you must sleep in privately owned buildings, have an ordering officer contract for it.
r. Treat all prisoners humanely and with respect and dignity.
s. Annex R to the OPLAN provides more detail. Conflicts between this card and the OPLAN should be resolved in favor of the OPLAN.
DISTRIBUTION: 1 per every trooper deployed to include all ranks.

Rule of Engagement used during Operation JUST CAUSE

Annex J
Supplemental Rules of Engagement for Selected Recurring Operations

SUPPLEMENTAL RULES OF ENGAGEMENT FOR SELECTED RECURRING OPERATIONS
1. CONTROL OF CIVILIANS ENGAGED IN LOOTING. a. Senior person in charge may order warning shots. b. Use minimum force but not deadly force to detain looters. c. Defend Panama (and other) lives with minimum force including deadly force when necessary.
2. ROADBLOCKS, CHECKPOINTS AND SECURE DEFENSIVE POSITIONS. a. Mark all perimeter barriers, wires, and limits. Erect warning signs. b. Establish second positions to hastily block those fleeing. c. Senior person in charge may order warning shots to deter breach. d. Control exfiltrating civilians with minimum force necessary. e. Use force necessary to disarm exfiltrating military and paramilitary. f. Attack to disable, not destroy, all vehicles attempting to breach or flee. g. Vehicle that returns or initiates fire is hostile. Fire to destroy hostile force. h. Vehicle that persists in breach attempt is presumed hostile. Fire to destroy hostile force. i. Vehicle that persists in flight after a blocking attempt IAW instruction 2b is presumed hostile. Fire to destroy hostile force.
3. CLEARING BUILDINGS NOT KNOWN TO CONTAIN HOSTILE FORCE. a. Warn all occupants to exit. b. Senior person in charge may order warning shots to induce occupants to exit. c. Do not attack hospitals, churches, shrines, or schools, museums, and any historical or cultural sites except in self-defense. d. Respect and minimize damage to private property. e. Use minimum force necessary to control the situation and to ensure the area is free of hostile force.

Glossary

Area Defense
Concentrates on denying the enemy access to designated terrain for a specified time, rather than the outright destruction of the enemy. The Infantry Rifle Company, with its enhanced mobility, has the capability to perform an area defense.

Assigned
This is a unit permanently placed in an organization and is completely controlled and administered by the organization.

Attached
This is a unit temporarily assigned to an organization other than its parent unit. The organization's commander has the same command and control over the attached unit as he does with his organic units.

Attack
This is an offensive operation that destroys enemy forces or seizes or secures terrain. Movement, supported by fires, characterizes the conduct of an attack.

Audacity
Audacity is the willingness to risk bold action to achieve positive results. The audacious commander develops confidence by conducting a thorough estimate.

Battle Command
This describes the role of the CO in understanding, visualizing, describing, directing, leading, and assessing forces as part of the operations process. Such role is intended to address an adaptive, thinking, and hostile enemy. This synchronizes the forces and warfighting functions in time, space and purpose-to accomplish mission through translating decision into actions of company commanders.

Battle Position
A battle position is a general location and orientation of forces on the ground from which units defend. The platoon is located within the general area of the BP. Security elements may be located forward and to the flanks of the BP.

Bounding Over-watch
This technique is used when enemy contact is expected. It is the most secure, but the slowest movement technique. Part of the company – the over-watch element – occupies a covered and concealed position with good observation and fields of fire.

Civil Considerations
These include the influences of man-made infrastructure, civilian institutions, and the attitudes and activities of civilian leaders, populations, and organizations within an AO, with regard to the conduct of military operations.

Civil Disturbance Management Operations
This is when the Infantry companyis tasked to stabilize areas affected by violent or seditious gatherings and activities of local population.

Civil Military Operations
These are planned activities undertaken independently or in coordination with civilian entities to gain popular support and weaken the will of the enemy to fight.

Civil Military Operations
This is done by the company as part of battalion in coordination with civilian entities in the area. Its purpose is to gain popular support and weaken the will of the enemy to fight. The CMO activities include: 1) Public Affairs (PA): 2) Civil Affairs (CA) and 3) Information Support Affairs (ISA).

Civil Population and Vital Installation of Security Operations
These operations involve protecting the populace and vital installations from security threats.

Command
This is the process that instils the commander's will among his subordinates. It provides focus and direction to the company. The commander's leadership is an integral part of command.

Command and Control Warfighting Function
This includes the related tasks and systems that support commanders in exercising authority and direction. It includes the tasks of acquiring friendly information, managing relevant information, and directing and leading subordinates.

Commander's Concept
When the battalion commander develops his concept, he determines the mission for the company. He first determines the purpose the company must achieve and then assign s the task(s) he feels will achieve that purpose. During the fight, if the assigned task will not receive the purpose, the CO is expected to re-task the company to achieve it.

Commander's Intent
The commander's intent is a clear, concise statement of what the force must do to succeed with respect to the enemy, terrain and desired end state (a set of required conditions that, when achieved, attain the aims set for the operation).

Composition
This is an analysis of the forces and weapons that the enemy can bear on the friendly forces.

Concept of Operation
This paragraph describes how the CO intends to accomplish his mission.

Consolidation
This is the organizing and positioning of platoons and weapons on a newly seized objective to defend against a counterattack.

Control
As the counterpart of command, follows up decisions and minimizes deviation from the commander's concept. Control provides supervisions to the operation while synchronizing all systems and activities.

Coordinating Instructions
These are requirements that apply to two or more subordinate units.

Counter Terrorism Operations
This is done to protect population, installations and facilities from terrorist acts initiated by foreign or local terrorist cells. Such operations are peculiarly different from mere routine security operations of populated areas and vital installations and facilities, as it entails long drawn effort to identify and track.

Counter-reconnaissance
This operation entails denying enemy reconnaissance elements from gaining accurate information on friendly preparations through destruction of enemy recon or through deception.

Critical Events
In every operation, there are certain events or activities that will have a major impact on the success of the mission. These may have been identified during the mission analysis, the analysis of the situation, or the war-game process. Normally at company level, these critical events will apply to each COA.

Decisive Operations
This conclusively determines the outcome of major operations, battles, and engagements.

Defensive Actions
The immediate purpose of defensive actions is to resist, defeat, or destroy an enemy attack and gain the initiative for the offense. Defensive operations defeat an enemy attack, buy time, economize forces, or develop conditions favorable for offensive operations.

Defensive Framework
As part of a larger element, the Infantry rifle companyconducts defensive operations in a sequence of integrated and overlapping steps.

Disarmament, Demobilization, and Rehabilitation Operations
These involve using company forces and capabilities to enforce DDR as part of a final peace agreement that is in force.

Disaster Mitigation Operations
This is done to train and inform local populations on how to cope up with disasters and terrorist acts even before they occur through information campaigns and planning contingency measures in local communities. Specifically, the company commander, in coordination with local DOST and LGU, act as the overall responsible agencies for disaster mitigation which assist in massive information drive.

Disaster Rehabilitation Operations
This may involve reconstruction of damaged facilities and post-trauma treatment of affected populations. Specifically, the Infantry Company, in coordination with local DSWD is the overall responsible agency for the psychological well-being of the affected populations.

Disaster Relief Operations
This is done to provide relief to affected populations and properties to ensure survival from the effects of the disastrous event.

Disaster Response Operations
These are done in order to conduct prompt rescue of affected populations and properties. The primary consideration is to save lives and property from the disastrous event itself.

Disaster Retrieval Operations
This is done to recover casualties and salvage affected properties. The primary consideration is to enable relatives of casualties and local governance to cope up with the losses associated with the disastrous event, according to local customs and traditions.

Dislocated Civilian Operations
This pertains to those actions required to move civilians out of harm's way or to safeguard them in the aftermath of a disaster. The disaster may be natural or man-made.

Echelon Right or Left
This formation is used if the situation is vague and enemy contact to the front or on one of the flanks is likely. Normally, an obstacle or another friendly unit exists on the flank of the company opposite the echeloned flank.

Enemy Situation
The enemy situation in the BN OPORD (paragraph la) is the basis for this, but the CO refined this to provide the detail required by his subordinates.

Engagement Areas
EAs or kill zones are normally located along an avenue of approach and are used to mass fires of one or more units to destroy the enemy within these areas.

Estimate of the Situation
This is the Army's decision-making process. It helps the leader determine his mission, understand his situation, and select the best course of action. Leaders use the estimate process in every tactical decision.

Evacuation Center Operations
This is done to set-up, manage, secure and control evacuation areas for affected populations. The primary consideration is to ensure that the effects of the disastrous event are mitigated and the further worsening of the situation that threatens survival is averted.

General Factors
These are for the employment of Infantry in all operations. They include the Principles of War, BOS, the risks involved, the characteristics of the offense or defense, and other such doctrinal guidelines.

Headquarters Platoon
This section provides command and control of tactical operations and coordinates re-supply and evacuation of wounded personnel and equipment. It can also provide limited equipment repair of organic equipment.

Higher Commanders' Concept and Intent
The company commander must know what both his battalion and brigade commanders intend and want to accomplish. He must also understand his role and responsibilities within their concepts.

Infantry Rifle Company
This is an Army force that uses both offensive and defensive operations to defeat the hostile force on land. They simultaneously execute support to civil governance operations to interact with the populace and civil authorities to re-establish a safe and secure environment in order to attain the unit mission of not only defeating the enemy but also attaining peace and restoring normalcy.

Infiltration
This is a means of reaching the enemy's rear without fighting through prepared defenses. It is the covert movement of all or part of the attacking force through enemy lines to a favorable position in their rear. The infiltrating unit avoids detection and engagement.

Insurgency
An insurgency is an organized, armed political struggle whose goal is the seizure of power through revolutionary takeover and replacement of the existing government.

Intelligence
This is the related tasks and systems that facilitate understanding of the enemy, terrain, weather, and civil considerations. It includes tasks associated with intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance.

Intent
It is defined as the result the commander expects the unit to accomplish in a specific operation.

K9 units
They can demonstrate the detection of Improvised Explosive Devices, locate missing persons, and retrieve cadavers of victims of calamities, and be part of the Anti-Terror campaign. They are returned somewhere other than previously owned home or land within the area of original displacement.

Key Terrain
This is any location or area that the seizure, retention, or control of affords a marked advantage to either combatant.

Leadership
This is the process of influencing people by providing purpose, direction, and motivation, while operating to accomplish the mission and improving organization.

Main Effort
The platoon with the most important task in the CO's concept is designated as the main effort. The main effort is the focus of the company's mission; with all other units in support to the quick success of its purpose.

Maneuver
This is the means by which commanders mass the effects of combat power to achieve surprise, shock, momentum, and dominance.

Mission Command
This refers to the CO's centralized planning and decentralized executions of conducting military operations based on mission orders which can also be delegated to a subordinate.

Mission Orders
Mission orders focus on what tasks must be accomplished without specifying how they will be done.

Mission-Oriented Command and Control
This is the Army's doctrinal approach to C2on the battlefield. It is a method of directing military operations that encourages and expects subordinate to take action consistent with the intent and concept of higher headquarters.

Mission-Specific Factors
These are generated from the requirements for a specific mission.

Mobile Defense
Orients on the destruction of the enemy through a decisive attack(s) by a striking force. The Infantry rifle companyparticipates in a mobile defense as the striking force or as part of a larger striking force.

Movement
This is necessary to support that function and to assure the protection, dispersion and displacement of the force as a whole.

Movement to Contact
This develops the situation and establishes or regains contact. It also creates favorable conditions for subsequent tactical actions.

Non-Critical Support Operations
The infantry rifle company is frequently called upon to provide support to civil authorities. Most of this supports identified well in advance and planned with civil authorities. Much of the support is routinely and usually consists of providing support to communities in its AO. Examples of types of non-critical support provided by civil authorities include the following: providing man-power and security assistance and performing other tasks in support to battalion activities.

Objective Rally Point
This is aterm used only in Infantry small unit patrols, typically at the squad or platoon level (though most applicable) to Infantry. It is also a concept shared among cavalry and Special Forces.

Operational Control
An OPCON unit is one placed under the control of an organization for one or more specific operations. The organization controls all aspects of the unit's military operations. The relationship is limited by function, time, or location. The organization is not necessarily responsible for administration, logistics, discipline, internal organization, or training. Otherwise, the commander's relationship with OPCON units is the same as with organic or attached subordinate units.

Organic
This unit is assigned to and forms an essential part of an Army organization. The Infantry companyis listed in the organization's Table of Organization and Equipment (TOE) or Table of Distribution and Allowances (TDA).

Passage of Line
This is an operation in which one unit passes through the lines of another unit.

Patrol
This is a detachment sent out by a larger unit to conduct a combat or reconnaissance operation. A patrol may be a fire team, squad, platoon, or company.

Patrol Base
A patrol base is a position set up when the patrol unit halts for an extended period.

Peace Enforcement Operations
These involve using Infantry companyforces and capabilities in enforcing a peace agreement between warring factions in areas within the national sovereignty, as drafted and approved by the appropriate national agency of government.

Peace-Making Operations
These also involve using the Infantry companyforces and capabilities to respond to and resolve crisis situation attributed to warring factions. As a rule, the primary consideration is the de-escalation of hostilities to enable peace negotiations. Neutralization and disbarment maybe necessary while open hostilities are happening.

Peace Operations
These seek to mitigate the security effects of physical and psychological strife generated by warring factions in a locality.

Peacekeeping Operations
This involves taking collective measures to remove or prevent threats to peace. The company, as part of the battalion, can be deployed for a certain peacekeeping operations in another country.

Populace and Resource Control Operation
This consists of two distinct components: populace control and resources control. These are normally the responsibility of local government units and its agencies enforced during disasters and calamities.

Population Assistance Operations
These tasks are dedicated to channel the populace's activities to allow provision of security and essential services while coexisting with a company force conducting operations.

Protection Warfighting Function
This is the related tasks and systems that preserve the force so the company commander can apply maximum combat power.

Raid
A raid is a surprise attack against a position or installation for a specific purpose other than seizing the terrain. It is conducted to destroy a position or installation, to destroy or capture enemy soldiers or equipment, or to free friendly prisoners.

Relief in Place
This is an operation in which one unit replaces another unit and assumes the relieved unit's responsibilities.

Reorganization
This is the reorganization of platoons, sections, and squads in order to continue operations. It is a continuous process and should be part of the company SOP. During reorganization, each platoon leader reports his platoon's situation, location, casualties, and ammunition status to the CO.

Retirement
This is a retrograde operation in which a force that is not engaged with the enemy moves to the rear in an organized manner. Companies perform retirements as part of larger units.

Retrograde Operation
This is an organized movement away from the enemy. It may be forced or voluntary; but, in either case, the higher commander approves the rearward movement.

Retrograde Operations
A forced or voluntary movement to the rear or away from the enemy. The Infantry rifle companynormally participates in retrograde operations as part of a larger unit.

Security Operations for Governance Events
This task is dedicated to secure democratic activities like elections (national or local), public consultations and forums, and other public activities threatened with violence or sabotaged by hostile forces or individuals.

Shaping Operations
These include lethal and non-lethal activities conducted throughout the AO. They support the decisive operations by affecting the enemy capabilities and forces, or by

influencing enemy decisions.

Significant Factors
These are common factors that provide the focus for comparing each COA. They are selected for each tactical mission based on mission accomplishment. These factors are significant because they directly impact the success of the mission.

Spectrum of Operations
The Infantry company normally conducts offensive, defensive, stability, and support (ODSS) operations as part of a task force (TF). These operations comprise the spectrum of UO that the Infantry companymust be prepared to conduct.

Speed
Speed promotes surprise, keeps the enemy off balance, contributes to the security of the attacking force, and prevents the defender from taking effective counter-measures. By increasing speed, commanders maintain momentum.

Standard Target
A standard target is an area about 100 meters in radius. The symbol for a standard target is a cross.

Stay-Behind Operations
This can be used as a part of defense or delay missions. In the defense, the enemy can bypass a friendly force. This offers the opportunity to attack the enemy's weakest point, thus delaying him.

Strike
A strike is a fast-paced short duration offensive operation targeting a specific and confirmed military target. It is characterized by surprising and using lethal firepower done normally by small, light compact Army force of up to battalion size.

Support
This is the action of an element or unit that aids, protects, complements, or sustains another unit IAW, an order requiring such support.

Support to Community Development Operations
The Infantry rifle companyhelps establish or restore the most basic services in civilian communities. They initially help protect communities to ensure that initiatives for development are enhanced and on track.

Support to Environmental Protection and Development Operations
The Infantry rifle companycan help a local government, or the national government as a whole, develop capability and capacity in the areas of protection and develop the environment and ecological equilibrium.

Surprise
Units achieve surprise by striking the enemy at a time, at a place, or in a manner in which he is unprepared. Total surprise rarely is essential; simply delaying or disrupting the enemy's reaction usually is effective.

Sustaining Operations
Company forces sustain operations that enable shaping and decisive operations by providing rear area and base security.

Sustainment Warfighting Function
This is the related tasks and systems that provide support and services to ensure freedom of action, extend operational reach, and prolong endurance. It includes those tasks associated with: maintenance, transportation, supply, field services. Sustainment allows uninterrupted operations through adequate and continuous logistical support such as supply systems, maintenance, and other services.

Tactical Control
A TACON unit is normally only subject to the authority of the organization with regard to specified local direction of movement and maneuver of forces to accomplish a task. In this command relationship, a combatant commander delegates limited authority to the organization to direct the tactical use of a combat unit. TACON is often the command relationship established between forces of different nations in a multinational force.

Tactical Movement
The purpose of tactical movement is to move units on the battlefield and prepare them for contact.

Target
This can be personnel, vehicle, materiel, or terrain that is designated and numbered for reference or firing.

Target Number
A target number is assigned to each planned target by the company FSO. Blocks of alphanumeric target numbers (two letters and four numbers) are provided for all fire-planning agencies.

Tasks to Maneuver Units
This paragraph list the tasks or limitations for each of the platoons and sections.

The Avenue of Approach
It is most often used to war-game a defensive COA, when there are several avenues of approach that must be considered.

The Belt
The leader using the belt technique divides the COA into sections in depth and then war-games each of these belts in sequence. The offensive COA war-game example used the belt technique initially.

The Box
This method is used to focus the war game process on a specific area of the battlefield. This may be the objective area, an engagement area, or some other critical area where the decisive action will take place.

Traveling
This technique is used when speed is important and enemy contact is not likely. The company moves in a company column with 20 to 50 meters between platoons. The distance depends on the visibility afforded by terrain, weather and light.

Traveling Over-watch
This technique is used when enemy contact is possible, but speed is important. The column and wedge are effective formations when using this technique of movement.

Troop-leading procedures
These are a sequence of actions that enable the company commander to use available time effectively and efficiently in the planning, preparing, executing, and assessing of combat missions.

Turning Movement
This is a type of envelopment in which the attacker attempts to avoid the defense entirely. Instead, he seeks to secure key terrain deep in the enemy rear and along his lines of communication.

Urban Operations
These are operations planned and conducted in an area of operations (AO) that includes one or more urban areas. This also refers to all military actions that are planned and conducted on terrain where man's construction impacts the tactical options available to the commander.

Vital Installation Security Operations
This is done to protect installation of facilities, critical to the survival or normalcy of a specific locality or the nation as a whole, form hostile element, foreign or domestic.

Warfighting Function
This is a group of tasks and systems (people, organization, information, and processes) united by a common purpose that commanders use to accomplish missions and training objectives. This incorporates eight (8) functions, namely: Movement and Maneuver, Intelligence, Fires, Civil Military Operations, Information Operations, Sustainment, Command and Control, and Protection.

Withdrawals
In a withdrawal, the company disengages from the enemy and repositions for some other mission.

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AA	-	Avenue(s) of Approach
AO	-	Area of Operations
ASCOPE	-	Area, Structure, Capabilities, Organization, People and Events
BDU	-	Battle Dress Uniform
BN	-	Battalion
C2	-	Command and Control
CA	-	Civil Affairs
CAFGU	-	Citizens/ Armed Forces Geographical Units
CAS	-	Close Air Support
CDMO	-	Civil Disturbance Management Operations
CI	-	Counter-Intelligence
CIO	-	Counterinsurgency Operations
CMO	-	Civil-Military Operations
CO	-	Commanding Officer
CP	-	Command Post
CPVISO	-	Civil Population and Vital Installation Security Operations
CS	-	Combat Support
CTO	-	Counter Terrorism Operations
DENR	-	Department of Environment and Natural Resources
DMO	-	Disaster Mitigation Operations
DND	-	Department of National Defense
DRfO	-	Disaster Relief Operations
DRhO	-	Disaster Rehabilitation Operations
DRM	-	Disaster Risk Management
DRO	-	Disaster Response Operations
DRsO	-	Disaster Rescue Operations
DRvO	-	Disaster Retrieval Operations
DSWD		Department of Social Welfare and Development
EABOB		Emotions, Attitudes, Beliefs, Opinions and Behaviour of Target Audiences
ECO	-	Evacuation Center Operations
EX- O	-	Executive Officer
FM	-	Frequency Modulated
F/Sgt	-	First Sergeant
FRAGO	-	Fragmentary Order
FS	-	Fire Support
FSO	-	Fire Support Officer
HCA	-	Humanitarian and Civic Assistance
HQS	-	Headquarters
IA	-	Information Assurance
IM	-	Information Management
IO	-	Information Operations
ISA	-	Information Support Affairs
ISO	-	Internal Security Operations
ITDS	-	Integrated Territorial Defense System
LGU	-	Local Government Units

LOA	-	Limit of Advance
LOGPAC	-	Logistics Package
MBA	-	Main Battle Area
METT-TC	-	Mission, Enemy, Terrain and Weather, Troops and Support Available, Time Available and Civil Considerations
NCSO	-	Non-Critical Support Operations
NGO	-	Non-Government Units
NPGF	-	Non- Priority Guerrilla fronts
OCOKA	-	Observation and Fields of Fire, Cover and Concealment, Observation, Key Terrain, and Avenues of Approach
OP	-	Observation Post
OPCON	-	Operational Control
OPORD	-	Operation Order
OPSEC	-	Operations Security
ORP	-	Objective Rally Point
PA	-	Public Affairs
PAsO	-	Population Assistance Operations
PcEO	-	Peace Enforcement Operations
PcMO	-	Peace Making Operations
PI	-	Public Information
PKO	-	Peace Keeping Operations
PNP	-	Philippine National Police
R&S	-	Reconnaissance and Surveillance
ROC	-	Regional Operations Command
ROE	-	Rules of Engagement
SALAAM	-	Special Advocacy on Literacy/Livelihood & Advancement for Muslims
SCDO	-	Support to community development operations
SCG	-	Support to Civil Governance
SCGO	-	Support to Civil Governance Operations
SEPDO		Support to environmental protection and development operations
SLEO	-	Support to law enforcement operations
SOGE	-	Security Operations for Governance Events
SOP	-	Standing Operating Procedure
TOE	-	Table of Organization and Equipment
UN	-	United Nations
UO	-	Urban Operations
VISO	-	Vital Installation Security Operations